AN INTRODUCTION TO



ARAMAIC

Second Edition

Frederick E. Greenspahn

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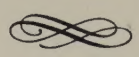
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An Introduction to Aramaic

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Society of Biblical Literature
Atlanta, Georgia

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Dolerite wall relief from Sinjerli (Sam'al) showing King Barrekib on his throne with a scribe. Aramean c. 750 BCE. Vorderasiatisches Museum, Staatliche Museen, Berlin, Germany. Used with permission of Foto Marburg/Art Resource, NY.

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Preface to the Second Edition

The appearance of this new edition provides a welcome opportunity to correct errors that have been drawn to my attention in the first edition (although some have probably been overlooked), to clarify points that may not have been presented as coherently or as accurately as they should have been, to update the contents, and to provide an answer key for the exercises. I am, therefore, grateful to the Society of Biblical Literature and, especially, Rex Matthews for their support in making this possible and to Paul Kobelski and Maurya Horgan for again sharing their expertise so that this edition can be the best possible. Special gratitude belongs to those who have shared their observations about the first edition and, particularly, the errors and problems they found in it. Scott Noegel, Ken Penner, and Eileen Schuller provided particular assistance in this regard. Any other corrections or suggestions readers can share with me would be very much appreciated. In the meantime, I hope this will be an improved and helpful tool for those embarking on the adventure of learning Aramaic.

In the interest of clarity, particular attention should be drawn to the vocabulary lists included in each lesson. These are divided into two sections: words that are "To Be Learned" and others that are for "Reference" only. This distinction makes it possible to define all the words that appear in the selected biblical readings without requiring students to learn more than about ten at a time. Definitions of "Reference" words are repeated in any chapter in which they recur. Of course, all vocabulary words are listed in the glossary.

Preface to the First Edition

This book is intended for students who are just beginning to study Aramaic. Seldom is it the language's inherent value which attracts such individuals; more often, they are motivated (if not always directly) by an interest in the Bible, although some may want to explore early Judaism or Christianity as well. This fact has several fairly obvious corollaries for a book such as this. First, it means that those using it already have some familiarity with Hebrew, typically biblical Hebrew. At the same time, however, that knowledge is probably rudimentary, given the stage at which most students are encouraged, or expected, to learn Aramaic. Finally, it suggests that students are likely to proceed to other Aramaic texts or other Semitic languages, whether they realize it yet or not. In other words, although biblical Aramaic is usually introduced as an end in itself, it most often functions as a bridge between the Hebrew Bible and some other, related area.

This text tries to take these facts seriously. Recognizing students' existing knowledge and motivation, it treats Aramaic as if it were a dialect of Hebrew, without trying to cover all of the language's depth and richness. This is a widespread, if seldom acknowledged, approach with a long pedigree. The fourteenth century grammarian Profiat Duran described Aramaic as "the Holy Tongue corrupted" (לשון הקדש שנשתבש).* That, however, is a patently inaccurate and very unfair way to characterize an independent language that has produced several quite separate bodies of literature, each historically and linguistically important in its own right.

Our only justification for this approach is pedagogic utility. Indeed, pedagogic considerations have governed most of the presentation here, which has been kept as non-technical as possible. Thus verb, noun, and pronoun charts include hypothetical forms (unmarked) on the premise that students will find it easier to learn patterns as a whole without trying to distinguish attested from theoretical forms or to remember where direct evidence is lacking. Where several alternative forms exist, only one is presented. The selection of these preferred forms has frequently been difficult, especially in cases of *ketîv* and *qerê*, where the problem of deciding whether it is pre-Christian or masoretic Aramaic that is being taught had to be con-

Ma'aseh Efod, ed. J. Friedländer and J. Kohn (Vienna: Haltswarte, 1865) p. 40.

fronted. Our decisions have been somewhat eclectic. Thus the second person masculine singular pronoun is presented as אַנְתְּ, in conformity with the *qerê*, rather than the presumably earlier *ketîv* אַנְתָּה, while proper names have been presented exactly as they occur in the standard *Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia*; thus דָּנִיֵּאל, despite the obvious anomaly in the placement of the vowel. In order to ensure the consistency of what students encounter, the biblical text has occasionally been normalized to fit the regular patterns taught in the grammar. Students may, therefore, wish to read the original exactly as it appears in the Bible after finishing this course.

Pedagogical concerns have also affected terminology. Thus the conjugations are identified as G, D, and H in order to facilitate comparison among Semitic languages, which would be complicated by terms such as *peʿal*, *paʿʿel* and *hafʿel*, which are appropriate for Aramaic alone.

A word about the terms "conjugation" and "tense" is also in order. The nature of the phenomena which these terms designate is enmeshed in difficult technical issues. We have chosen to use terms that are likely to be familiar from the study of other languages, letting instructors choose whether to describe the problems involved or to leave that for some later stage of study. Similarly, the periodization presented in chapter 2 is only one of several that are possible. Since any such scheme is inherently arbitrary and heuristic, a straightforward one that would facilitate clarity was selected.

It should by now be obvious that this is not intended to be a reference work, although paradigms and a glossary are included at the end. There is already an abundance of advanced and technically proficient resources for those who choose to continue beyond the introductory level. This book is meant to help students take advantage of those tools. It has, therefore, been constructed as a kind of workbook, organized around the Aramaic passages from the Bible. These are at first simplified and abridged, in order to keep the quantity of new vocabulary to within manageable proportions. Daniel 7, the last biblical passage in Aramaic, is read exactly as it occurs in the Bible (chapter 27).

Each chapter introduces a grammatical feature. Vocabulary has been coordinated with the biblical passages and divided into important (recurring) and reference sections — though both are included in the glossary at the end. (The glossary is not a complete lexicon of biblical Aramaic, but contains only words actually used in the passages which appear in this book; for that reason, it also includes the handful of Hebrew terms that occur in some of the late texts presented in the readings.) Both grammar and vocabulary are reviewed in practice exercises.

While there is much about this presentation of the material that may appear idiosyncratic, I am deeply aware of my debt to many scholars whose knowledge and experience of Aramaic far exceeds my own. Experienced teachers will likely recognize the influence of

Ethelyn Simon, Irene Resnikoff, and Linda Motzkin's *The First Hebrew Primer* (3d edition, Oakland, CA: EKS Publishing Co, 1992), Isaac Jerusalmi's *The Aramaic Sections of Ezra and Daniel* (Cincinnati: Hebrew Union College-Jewish Institute of Religion, 1972), and Ehud ben Zvi, Maxine Hancock, and Richard Beinert's *Readings in Biblical Hebrew, An Intermediate Textbook* (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1993), a debt gratefully acknowledged. The grammar draws heavily on Franz Rosenthal's *A Grammar of Biblical Aramaic* (Wiesbaden: Otto Harrasowitz, 1963) and Hans Bauer and Pontus Leander's *Grammatik des Biblisch-Aramäische* (Halle/Saale: Max Niemayer Verlag, 1927). Rather than supplanting these valuable tools, this book is intended to prepare students to use them easily and profitably. Like training wheels, the surest sign of its success will be when it is no longer necessary. For students to outgrow it will, therefore, be a source of pleasure rather than evidence of its inadequacy. Indeed, after finishing this course, students should be encouraged to acquire other tools, primarily Rosenthal's *Grammar*, which is in English and in print.*

Several individuals contributed to this project in a variety of ways. Marvin Sweeney and David Petersen had the confidence to propose that I undertake it in the first place. Barbara Beckman helped with technical elements of preparing the manuscript, while Jeanne Abrams and Diane Rutter provided a supportive environment. Paul Kobelski and Maurya Horgan shared their skill and creativity to bring that manuscript to final form. Paul Flesher, Peter Miscall, Gary Rendsburg, and Seth Ward reviewed an earlier draft, rooting out errors and proposing improvements, while David Ackerman, Scott Althof, Susan Brayford, Gary Collier, Brandon Fredenberg, Arlene Lance, Joy Lapp, Gilberto Lozano, Aquiles Martinez, Andrew Tooze, and David Valeta shared students' perspectives. For all of these contributions I am deeply grateful. In the end, however, the decision of how to use the information they so generously shared was my own along with responsibility for the finished product, which often, but not always, followed their suggestions. I hope it will provide a straightforward introduction to a subject rarely begun in a simple way and a coherent enough presentation to kindle interest in proceeding further.

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*Other grammars which might be helpful are Alger F. Johns, *A Short Grammar of Biblical Aramaic* (Berrien Springs, MI: Andrews University Press, 1972) and Elisha Qimron, דקדוק הארמית המקראית (Beer Sheba: Ben-Gurion University of the Negev Press, 1990).

Abbreviations

A	alef (א) stem (*ʾafʿel*)
c	common (number)
cstr	construct
D	D stem (*piʿel* or *paʿʿel*)
f	feminine
G	G stem (*qal, peʿal*)
H	H stem (*hifʿil* or *hafʿel*)
imf	imperfect
imv	imperative
inf	infinitive
inter.	interrogative
intrans	intransitive
lit.	literally
m	masculine
obj.	object
p	plural
pass	passive
pf	perfect
ptc	participle
s	singular
š	šin (ש) stem (*shafʿel*)
sf	suffix
t	conjugation with prefixed *t* (as in Hebrew *hitpaʿel*)
trans	transitive

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

What is Aramaic and why should you learn it? Although the Aramaic language is not as familiar as French or Hebrew so that its importance may not appear self-evident, it is as old as the Bible. In fact, the language's name first appears in the Bible (Ezra 4:7, Daniel 2:4, 2 Kings 18:26 = Isaiah 36:11); other ancient sources call it Chaldean or Syrian. The language is named after the ancient Arameans, among whom it originated; they lived in what is today Syria at the same time that the Israelites were establishing themselves in Canaan. Their language spread, eventually becoming *the* language of government and international communication throughout the Near East, from about the time of the Babylonians, who destroyed the Jerusalem temple in the sixth century B.C.E., and continued to be widely used even after the coming of the Greeks until the Arab conquest in the seventh century, long after the Arameans themselves had disappeared.

Strangely, the best known writings in Aramaic were produced by other peoples. According to Jewish tradition it was spoken by Adam (*b. Sanhedrin* 38b), and was probably the native language of Jesus, of numerous talmudic rabbis, and of the third century religious innovator Mani, the founder of what we call Manicheanism. Moreover, a formidable body of literature, including many formative texts of both Judaism and Christianity, were written in or influenced by Aramaic. Aramaic was also used by the Nabateans, an Arab desert people who flourished around the time of Jesus, the later Syrian church, and the Mandeans, a gnostic sect that originated close to two thousand years ago in what is today southern Iraq. It continues to be used as a spoken language to the present day, albeit only in small pockets of Syria, Iraq, and Iran, as well as among Jews and Christians who have migrated to Israel and the United States from these regions.

Today few people study Aramaic because they are interested in the Arameans. Most are motivated by the fact that parts of the Bible are written in Aramaic, specifically major sections of the books of Ezra (4:6–6:18 and 7:12–26) and Daniel (2:4–7:28), as well as one sentence in Jeremiah (10:11) and two words in Genesis (31:47). In order to read the entire "Hebrew" Bible in the original, then, one must know Aramaic.

With only some 200 verses of the Bible in Aramaic, there would be little reason to learn the dialect for that reason alone. However, mastering this limited body of material can open the door to a wide range of possibilities.

Because Aramaic was a dominant language among the Jews of first century Palestine, a wealth of important texts are written in it. Although Jesus' teachings survive only in the Greek New Testament, the Gospels provide ample evidence of Aramaic traditions surrounding him, and the language's influence can be felt in several other passages as well. Being familiar with Aramaic can, therefore, deepen your appreciation of the New Testament. Extensive bodies of both Jewish and Christian literature are also written in Aramaic. Among these are several of the Dead Sea Scrolls, many rabbinic texts, including parts of both talmuds and various midrashim, a substantial number of ancient Jewish Bible translations, called targumim, masoretic notes to the biblical text, and legal and mystical works from as late as the eighteenth century. Within Christian tradition, important writings from the Syrian church, including the Peshitta translation of the Bible, are written in a dialect of Aramaic known as Syriac. In order to provide a taste of the riches which await those who have mastered Aramaic, a small selection from some of these has been included in the final chapters of this book.

Learning Aramaic can also be a first step into the Semitic family of languages as a whole, for those who choose to explore some of its other members. Familiarity with these languages can illuminate elements of biblical Hebrew by providing greater perspective than is possible from knowledge of Hebrew alone, much as we can see things better with two eyes than is possible with only one. For example, it can sensitize us to what might otherwise seem ordinary and unremarkable features of Hebrew, ranging from its system of "tenses" to the existence of internal passives and the changing function of the participle. Indeed, because they belong to the same Northwest branch of the Semitic language family, Aramaic can be a relatively easy second language to learn and a particularly useful way to achieve a deeper understanding of Hebrew itself, offering insights into the nuances of individual Hebrew words and alerting us to differing styles within the Bible. It will, for example, make us aware of "Aramaisms" not only in late passages, such as the books of Esther or Chronicles where one would expect them, but also in earlier parts of the Bible, such as the song of Deborah (Judges 5). These characteristics have even led some scholars to speculate that certain books of the Bible were originally written in Aramaic and only later translated into Hebrew. The knowledge you are about to gain will, therefore, open the door to an entirely new world, one which is interesting and rewarding in its own right.

Because most people who undertake the study of Aramaic are motivated by their interest in the Bible, we will presume that you already have a working knowledge of biblical Hebrew. Since Hebrew and Aramaic share many words, this is a substantial advantage, because it means that you already have an extensive Aramaic vocabulary and understand a variety of Aramaic grammatical principles without even knowing it. For example, many of the following Aramaic words are, undoubtedly, already familiar:

fall ..... נפל	consider ..... חשב	father ..... אַב
lift up ..... נשׂא	seal ..... חתם	stone ..... אֶבֶן
give ..... נתן	dew ..... טַל	brother ..... אַח
end ..... סוֹף	hand ..... יַד	after ..... אַחֲרֵי
until ..... עַד	know ..... ידע	eat ..... אכל
still ..... עוֹד	day ..... יוֹם	these ..... אֵלֶּה
bird ..... עוֹף	be able ..... יכל	say ..... אמר
eye ..... עַיִן	sea ..... יַם	four ..... אַרְבַּע
on ..... עַל	add ..... יסף	in ..... בְּ־
Most High .... עֶלְיוֹן	like, as ..... כְּ־	between ..... בֵּין
with ..... עִם	all ..... כֹּל	house ..... בַּיִת
people ..... עַם	thus ..... כֵּן	build ..... בנה
answer ..... ענה	write ..... כתב	bless ..... ברך
open ..... פתח	to ..... לְ־	reveal ..... גלה
rise ..... קום	heart ..... לֵב (לְבַב)	bear ..... דֹּב
buy ..... קנה	wear ..... לבשׁ	judgment ..... דִּין
call ..... קרא	scroll ..... מְגִלָּה	resemble ..... דמה
draw near ..... קרב	what ..... מָה	he ..... הוּא
battle ..... קְרָב	be full ..... מלא	be ..... הוה
horn ..... קרן	word ..... מִלָּה	she ..... הִיא
wind ..... רוּחַ	king ..... מֶלֶךְ	go ..... הלך
height ..... רוֹם	queen ..... מַלְכָּה	and ..... וְ־
ask ..... שׁאל	from ..... מִן	time ..... זְמַן
praise ..... שׁבח	count ..... מנה	see ..... חזה
dwell ..... שׁכן	(D—appoint)	live ..... היה
send ..... שׁלח	meal offering .. מִנְחָה	strength ..... חַיִל
hear ..... שׁמע	bed ..... מִשְׁכָּב	wisdom ..... חָכְמָה
be low ..... שׁפל	prophesy ..... נבא	be gracious ..... חנן
drink ..... שׁתה	prophecy .... נְבוּאָה	magician ..... חַרְטֹם

You are also already familiar with the outline of Aramaic grammar, whether you have studied it or not. For example, Aramaic verbs are built on 3-letter roots, which can be conjugated in several different patterns, including one in which the middle letter is marked with a

dagesh (doubled), just like Hebrew's *piʿel*, and another characterized by a prefixed ה, like the *hifʿil*.

We will, therefore, take advantage of your Hebrew background, rather than trying to introduce everything you would need to learn if you were studying Aramaic from scratch. Aramaic phenomena will often be explained in terms of their Hebrew counterparts. We will not, for example, describe the alphabet, since biblical Aramaic is written with the same script and follows several of the same principles (e.g., the use of *dagesh lene* in the letters בג״ד כפ״ת) as biblical Hebrew.

However useful it may be to treat Aramaic as a dialect of Hebrew, we need to remember that it is really a separate language. This approach can, therefore, create problems. Chief among these is the fact that the vowels, on which so much of biblical grammar centers, were added by the Masoretes over a thousand years after the biblical books had themselves been written. We should, therefore, at least wonder how reliable a guide they are to ancient Aramaic usage. Of course, that is a problem for the study of biblical Hebrew as well; indeed, since the Masoretes wrote their own notes in Aramaic, they may have been more familiar with Aramaic grammar than with Hebrew and, therefore, imposed some of its principles onto the Hebrew sections of the Bible.

Because of our presumption that your reason for learning Aramaic is based in the Bible, its Aramaic passages will be used as the focus of our study, with sample readings included in each chapter. These have been edited in order to progress from relatively simple to more complex usage, until the last chapter of biblical Aramaic (Daniel 7) will be read exactly as it appears in the Bible. Because our focus will be on grammar and vocabulary, you should turn to the standard commentaries for historical and exegetical questions. The most useful ones on Ezra are those by Loring Batten (International Critical Commentary), Jacob Myers (Anchor Bible), and H. G. M. Williamson (Word Biblical Commentary); and for Daniel, those of James Montgomery (International Critical Commentary), John Collins (Hermeneia), and Louis Hartman and Alexander DiLella (Anchor Bible). Since only part of Ezra and Daniel are in Aramaic,* it would be helpful to read the preceding (Hebrew) sections (Ezra 1:1–4:7), at least in English, before beginning with the Aramaic in chapter 3 of this book.

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*This strange phenomenon is discussed in many of the standard introductions to the Bible, such as Otto Eissfeldt, *The Old Testament, An Introduction* (New York: Harper and Row, 1965) pp. 516–17, 543, and 551.

Chapter 2

A Brief History of Aramaic

The term "Aram" was used in place names almost four thousand years ago; the book of Genesis mentions places called Paddan-Aram and Aram-Naharaim. However, there are no references to the Aramean people themselves until the eleventh century, when the Assyrian ruler Tiglath Pileser I encountered them on military expeditions along the Euphrates. They had apparently established small, independent kingdoms, primarily in Syria, but extending as far east as the Persian Gulf. One Aramean ruler, named Adad-apla-iddina, even seized the Babylonian throne before coming under attack from other Arameans.

The Bible describes close connections between Israel's patriarchs and Aram, where they "returned" from time to time (Genesis 24:1–10, 28:1–5), usually to find suitable wives. Deuteronomy even refers to the Israelites as being descended from "a wandering Aramean" (26:5) in a passage traditionally linked to Jacob, whose father-in-law Laban is called an Aramean in Genesis 31:20. Although scholars are not certain about the historical reliability of biblical statements about the patriarchs, such passages do demonstrate that the Israelites believed they were related to the Arameans.

During the period of Israel's monarchy, the Aramean kingdoms of Zobah and Damascus jockeyed with Israel for power and preeminence. The Bible reports that David defeated Hadadezer, the ruler of Zobah (2 Samuel 8:3–10), and that Solomon battled with Rezon, who had fled from Zobah and become king in Damascus (1 Kings 11:23–25).

After the Israelite kingdom split near the end of the 10th century, regional control passed back and forth between the now-divided kingdoms of Israel and Judah and the Arameans, depending most often on whether the Israelite kingdoms were united or not. Sometimes they were subordinate to the Aramaeans (1 Kings 15:8–20, 20:34, 2 Kings 10:32, 12:17, 13:7,22); at others, they were dominant (1 Kings 20:34, 2 Kings 13:25). In the ninth century, an alliance linking Damascus and Hamath with the Northern Kingdom as well as nine other countries was able to withstand the powerful Assyrian ruler Shalmaneser III (853 B.C.E.); a decade later, the coalition fell apart and these same nations were defeated (841 B.C.E.).

In the middle of the eighth century, Damascus entered into another alliance with Northern Israel, this time including the Phoenicians of Tyre. They tried to gain Judean support, but the king of Judah turned instead to Assyria, which was more than willing to intervene. As a result, the Aramean states were conquered by Tiglath-Pileser III, who claims to

have destroyed "592 towns . . . of the sixteen districts of the country of Damascus."* He put several Aramean kingdoms under direct Assyrian control, including ultimately Damascus itself. The Arameans' political power thus came to an end; however, their language survived, ironically achieving a far wider presence than the people among whom it had originated.

Aramaic is usually divided into several dialects, organized according to chronological and geographic principles. Although several systems have been proposed for doing this, each with its own idiosyncrasies, their general structures are quite similar.

Our earliest evidence of Aramaic comes from the Aramaic kingdoms just described. These are said to be written in "Old" or "Ancient" Aramaic. Among them are several inscriptions from northern Syria (mostly near the town of Aleppo) that were written early in the first millennium B.C.E. (probably between the tenth and the seventh centuries). The language of these texts shares a variety of features with Hebrew, suggesting that the division between the Aramaic and the Canaanite (Hebrew and Phoenician) branches of Northwest Semitic was relatively recent. A sample of an Aramaic text from this period will be read in chapter 28.

The next period of Aramaic is dominated by what is called Official, Imperial, or Standard Literary Aramaic because it served as the official administrative language of the Persian empire from the sixth to the fourth centuries, although it may have begun to spread somewhat earlier, under the Assyrians and Babylonians. This is also the dialect found in the Bible, although some scholars assign the book of Daniel to a later category.

Several ancient sources document the growing prevalence of Aramaic. The Bible reports a request by Judean leaders that the Assyrian army, which was besieging Jerusalem near the end of the eighth century, use Aramaic so that the people would not understand what they were saying (2 Kings 18:26 = Isaiah 36:11), suggesting that the leaders of the time were familiar with it. A century later, when a Philistine ruler sought assistance from the Egyptian Pharaoh, he wrote in Aramaic, demonstrating that the language had already achieved a significant role in international communication.**

After Judah fell to the Babylonian emperor Nebuchadnezzar, the Jews adopted the Aramean form of what had originally been the Phoenician alphabet. (It is important to distinguish between a language and a script; one could, for example, theoretically write English using the Hebrew, Cyrillic or Japanese scripts, or any other alphabet for that matter. Some Aramaic texts were written in Egyptian [demotic] and cuneiform scripts.) Interestingly, derivatives of the older script were still used by Jews from time to time, as in coins produced by the Maccabees and the later rebel leader Bar Kochba as well as some of the Dead Sea Scrolls.

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* James Pritchard, *Ancient Near Eastern Texts Relating to the Old Testament* (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 1969) p. 283.

** See Bezalel Porten, "The Identity of King Adon," *Biblical Archaeologist* 44 (1981) 36–52; the role of Aramaic is comparable to that of Akkadian in the fourteenth-century correspondence between Egypt and its Canaanite subordinates from Tell el-Amarna.

The Arab tribe known as the Nabateans also used an alphabet that was based on the older letters, as do the Samaritans to the present day.

When Persia, which defeated Babylonia in 539, adopted Aramaic for official administrative purposes, the language's importance grew dramatically. Eventually, the Persian empire stretched from Egypt to India, ensuring Aramaic's widespread use and prominence. Official sponsorship also created a kind of standardization, something which did not begin to wane until the encroachment of Greek under Alexander the Great and then, many centuries later, Arabic.

Among those who returned from the Babylonian exile, familiarity with Aramaic was no longer limited to the leaders of Judea. In addition to the extensive sections of Daniel and Ezra which are written in Aramaic, its influence can be felt in Hebrew books of the Bible which were composed after the exile. Some scholars have even understood Nehemiah 8:8 to suggest that the Jews of this period needed to have their scriptures translated into Aramaic.

Aramaic continued unchallenged among Jews until the coming of the Greeks. It was particularly prevalent in Palestine during the time of Jesus, a period for which we use the term "Middle" Aramaic. Since the Persian empire, which had been responsible for the language's earlier uniformity, no longer existed, it is not surprising that regional variation begins to be apparent at this time (note the reference to Peter's distinctive accent in Matthew 26:73). These include the dialects attested in the Dead Sea Scrolls (see chapter 30) and the New Testament, as well as that in use among the Arab tribes known as Nabateans. The earliest layers of the targumim to the Pentateuch (Onkelos) and the Prophets (Jonathan) also probably date from this period. Other dialects are known from Palmyra (biblical Tadmor) and Edessa in Syria, and Hatra, which is in Mesopotamia.

The title "Late" Aramaic is used for material written between the second and the ninth (or possibly later) centuries C.E. From Palestine come a wide range of Jewish sources, including the Palestinian Talmud, midrashim, and several targumim (see chapters 31 and 32). Other writings from this region are by Christians (presumably converts from Judaism) and Samaritans. In the east, one finds Babylonian Jewish (for the Babylonian Talmud), Mandaic, and Syriac texts, with the latter divided into eastern and western dialects.

Finally, there is "Modern Aramaic," which is spoken in several villages near Damascus, the largest of which is Ma'lula, as well as among Christians in southeastern Turkey (near Tur ʿAbdin), Mandeans in southern Iraq, and Jews and Christians from Iraqi and Iranian Kurdistan, virtually all of whom have now migrated to Israel and the United States.

Thus, the Aramaic language has outlived the people whose name it bears, with a rich and extensive literature created by several different communities. Indeed, the language's very survival is the result of its having been adopted, for various purposes, by several different peoples who created with it a substantial body of documents that have played an important historical role.

Chapter 3

The Aramaic Language

Because they are both members of the Northwest branch of the Semitic language family, Aramaic and Hebrew have many words in common, as we saw in Chapter 1. Further evidence of this can be seen by comparing Jesus' words on the cross as presented by the Gospels of Matthew and Mark with the Psalm verse from which they were taken:

ηλι ηλι λεμα σαβαχθανι	(Matthew 27:46)
ελωι ελωι λαμα σαβαχθανι	(Mark 15:34)
אֵלִי אֵלִי לָמָה עֲזַבְתָּנִי	(Psalm 22:1[2])

Although the first three words in these passages are virtually identical,* the difference in the last word of the quote demonstrates that the Gospels are not reporting a Hebrew tradition, since there is no Hebrew word which might be represented by σαβαχθανι. Such a word does, however, exist in Aramaic, where שְׁבַק means "abandon," just like the Hebrew עזב; indeed, the ancient Aramaic translation (targum) of Psalm 22 uses שְׁבַק to translate עזב in this very passage.

The striking similarity between the first three words in both Gospel accounts and their Hebrew equivalent demonstrates how close Hebrew and Aramaic really are. Even the structure of the final verb is essentially the same, once one accounts for their different roots (עזב instead of שְׁבַק); that is to say that in each text the verb's root consonants are separated by the vowel *a* and followed by *ta* (the second person masculine singular suffix) and then *ni* (for the first person singular direct object).**

The Hebrew Bible contains one Aramaic sentence outside the books of Daniel and Ezra. It is found in Jeremiah 10:11:***

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* The transliteration of the New Testament passages is *eli eli lema sabakthani* (Matthew) and *eloi eloi lama sabakthani* (Mark).

** Vowel differences in the first three words as presented by Matthew and Mark may reflect characteristically Aramaic features — the reduction of originally pretonic short vowels (see chapter 5), hence Hebrew לָמָה = Aramaic לְמָה, and the 3d person masculine singular pronominal suffix יהוִֹ (see chapter 13).

*** As one might imagine, the existence of this one Aramaic sentence has raised a host of questions in the minds of biblical scholars, many of whom have theorized that it is a gloss which was introduced into the text by mistake.

כִּדְנָה תֵּאמְרוּן לְהוֹם אֱלָהַיָּא דִּי שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְקָא לָא עֲבַדוּ
יֵאבַדוּ מֵאַרְעָא וּמִן תְּחוֹת שְׁמַיָּא אֵלֶּה.

A close look at this verse demonstrates many similarities with Hebrew:

כִּדְנָה תֵּאמְרוּן לְהוֹם

דְּנָה — כְּ + דְּנָה is equivalent to Hebrew זֶה.

כְּ — means "like" or "as" in Aramaic, just as it does in Hebrew.

אמר — is a very common verb in biblical Hebrew, where it means "say." The -תּ prefix and -וּ suffix indicate that the word is imperfect, 2d person, masculine plural (plural suffixes often have a final -ן in Aramaic, as sometimes occurs in biblical Hebrew), so that the whole form means "you shall say."

לְהוֹם =Hebrew לָהֶם.

Thus, the phrase כִּדְנָה תֵּאמְרוּן לְהוֹם ("thus shall you say to them") corresponds to the Hebrew כֹּה תֹּאמְרוּ לָהֶם.

אֱלָהַיָּא דִּי שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְקָא לָא עֲבַדוּ

Most of these words are very similar to Hebrew:

אֱלֹהִים = אֱלָהַיָּא
שָׁמַיִם = שְׁמַיָּא
לֹא = לָא

The root עבד also occurs in Hebrew, although its meaning "serve" is inappropriate here; the meaning is clearly "make" (i.e. עשׂה).

Since דִּי means "which" or "who," this phrase can be recognized as corresponding to the Hebrew: (הָ)אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא עָשׂוּ (אֶת) הַשָּׁמַיִם וְ. . . .

The context clearly requires that the next word (אַרְקָא) be equivalent to Hebrew הָאָרֶץ.

Notice the Aramaic ending -ָא on אֱלָהַיָּא, שְׁמַיָּא and אַרְקָא where Hebrew uses a prefixed הַ־. Thus the whole phrase means "the gods which did not make the heavens and the earth."

יֵאבַדוּ מֵאַרְעָא וּמִן תְּחוֹת שְׁמַיָּא אִלֵּה

Every word in this section has an exact Hebrew equivalent, so it is easily translated as:

יֹאבְדוּ מִן הָאָרֶץ וּמִן(תַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם (הָ)אֵלֶּה

(shall perish from the earth and from under these heavens)

Notice how this phrase uses אַרְעָא where the earlier part of the verse had אַרְקָא as the equivalent to the Hebrew אֶרֶץ.*

VOCABULARY

You will need the following vocabulary to understand the simplified version of Ezra 4:8-11 that is given below. Before reading that, it would be a good idea to read the preceding sections of Ezra (1:1-4:7) either in the original Hebrew or in English translation.

To Be Learned	*Reference*
letter . . . . . אִגְּרָה	perish . . . . . אבד
the letter אִגַּרְתָּא	these . . . . . אִלֵּה
God (אֱלָהַיָּא) . . . אֱלָהּ	say . . . . . אמר
which, that, of . . . . דִּי	earth . . . . . אַרְעָא
this . . . . . דְּנָה	earth . . . . . אַרְקָא
write . . . . . כתב	and . . . . . וְ־
to . . . . . ל־	from . . . . . מִן
to them . . . . . לְהוֹם	do, make . . . . . עבד
king . . . . . מֶלֶךְ	heaven . . . . . שְׁמַיָּא
the king מַלְכָּא	under . . . . . תְּחוֹת
the scribe . . . . . סָפְרָא	
on, to, against, concerning . . . . עַל	
send . . . . . שלח	

* See page 14 below.

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 4:8–11)

רְחוּם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא כְּתַבוּ אִגְּרָה עַל יְרוּשְׁלֶם לְאַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מַלְכָּא.

דְּנָה אִגַּרְתָּא דִּי שְׁלַחוּ עַל אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מַלְכָּא.

Proper Nouns

אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא — Artaxerxes, the Persian king (ruled 465–425 B.C.E.), who appointed Nehemiah governor of Jerusalem; either he or Darius' son Artaxerxes II (ruled 404-359 B.C.E.) authorized Ezra's mission to Jerusalem. The Bible also spells the name as אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא and אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתָּא (e.g., Ezra 4:7 and 7:12).

יְרוּשְׁלֶם — Jerusalem, where the Judeans who had returned from Babylonian exile had settled. Although the city's name has come to be spelled יְרוּשָׁלַיִם in Hebrew, it appears without a ' in the Bible (see p. 43 below).

רְחוּם וְשִׁמְשַׁי — Officials in Persia's Trans-Euphrates province.

EXERCISES

The following Aramaic sentences use vocabulary that should be familiar from biblical Hebrew (the vowels may be somewhat different). Read each sentence out loud and translate it into English:

(1) סָפְרָא כְּתַב אִגַּרְתָּא לְהוֹם.

(2) אֱלָהַיָּא עֲבַד שְׁמַיָּא.

(3) אֲמַר מַלְכָּא עַל יְרוּשְׁלֶם. . . .

(4) מַלְכָּא שְׁלַח אִגַּרְתָּא לְסָפְרָא.

(5) אֱמַר אֱלָהַיָּא מִן שְׁמַיָּא . . . .

(6) אֲבַד סָפְרָא דְּנָה תְּחוֹת אַרְעָא.

(7) אֱלָהַיָּא אֱמַר דִּי אַרְעָא לְמַלְכָּא.

Chapter 4

CONSONANTS

Although some Aramaic dialects, such as Syriac and Nabatean, have their own scripts, the Aramaic sections of the Bible are written with the same alphabet as its Hebrew passages. Therefore, you already know how to read biblical Aramaic. And since Aramaic belongs to the same Northwest group of the Semitic family of languages as does Hebrew, these two languages have a goodly number of words in common, so that your knowledge of Hebrew provides a substantial Aramaic vocabulary as well. However, the number of these words can be easily multiplied.

The consonantal alphabet used for both Hebrew and Aramaic was probably invented by the Phoenicians, but it did not fit either language perfectly, since both originally had more sounds than the number of Phoenician letters. (English has the same problem, since our 26 letter alphabet, which also derives from the Phoenicians, does not have enough symbols to represent all the sounds we use. That is why we have to use pairs of letters, such as *sh* and *th*, for some sounds.) For Hebrew and Aramaic, certain individual letters were used to represent what were originally different sounds; however, the two languages sometimes use different letters for what were originally the same sounds. Words that look different in Hebrew and Aramaic may, therefore, actually be historically related.

An example of this involves the letter שׁ, which Hebrew uses for what were originally two different sounds — *sh* and *th* (as in English "thin"). The first of these quite separate consonants occurs in the word שלח ("send"), while the second was in the Hebrew word ישב ("sit, dwell"). However, Aramaic uses שׁ only for words which originally included *sh*, representing the *th* sound with the letter ת, which it also uses for the sound *t*, as does Hebrew. Thus, שלח and כתב ("write") are found in both languages, whereas Aramaic has יתב for the Hebrew word ישב.

Semitic	Hebrew	Aramaic	
sh	שׁ שלח	שׁ שלח	(send)
th	שׁ ישב	ת יתב	(dwell)
t	ת כתב	ת כתב	(write)

A similar phenomenon occurs with the letters ד and ז. In Hebrew ז is used both for the sound *z* (as in the word זֶרַע, which means "seed") and for a letter that was once pronounced as *d̲* (like the *th* in "than"), which occurs in the word זֶבַח ("sacrifice"). However, Aramaic uses ז only for the *z* sound, whereas *d̲* is represented with the letter ד, which both languages also use for the sound *d*. Thus, the Hebrew word זֶרַע corresponds to זְרַע in Aramaic, but the Aramaic cognate of the Hebrew word זֶבַח is דְּבַח.

Semitic	Hebrew	Aramaic	
z	ז זֶרַע	ז זְרַע	(seed)
d̲	ז זֶבַח	ד דְּבַח	(sacrifice)
d	ד ידע	ד ידע	(know)

A final example of this phenomenon involves the letter צ, which Hebrew uses for what were originally *three* different sounds: (1) *ṣ*, as in the word צֶלֶם ("image"), (2) *ṭ*, as in קַיִץ ("summer"), and (3) *ḍ*, as in אֶרֶץ ("land"). However, Aramaic represents these with three different consonants — צ, ט, and ע.* Therefore, the Hebrew word צֶלֶם is צְלֶם in Aramaic, but קַיִץ occurs as קֵיט, and אֶרֶץ as אַרַע.

Semitic	Hebrew	Aramaic	
ṣ	צ צֶלֶם	צ צְלֶם	(image)
ṭ	צ קַיִץ	ט קֵיט	(summer)
ḍ	צ אֶרֶץ	ע אַרַע	(earth, sometimes written ארק)

The following chart summarizes these equivalences according to which letter is used in Aramaic. Being familiar with them will make it possible to recognize many Aramaic words that do not look exactly like their Hebrew counterparts.

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* This last consonant is sometimes represented with a ק, as in the form אַרְקָא, which occurs alongside אַרְעָא in Jeremiah 10:11 (see p. 10) and in early inscriptions (see p. 168).

Aramaic	Hebrew	Semitic
	ד	*d*
ד		
	ז	*ḏ*
ז	ז	*z*
	ט	*ṯ*
ט		
	צ	*ṯ̣**
ע	ע	ʿ or *ġ*
ק/ע	צ	*ḍ*
צ	צ	*ṣ*
שׁ	שׁ	*š*
	שׂ	*ṱ*
ת		
	ת	*t*

Other historical-linguistic processes can help in recognizing more word relationships. For example, many Semitic languages form nouns by adding an initial ("prosthetic") א to a three letter root. Thus the number "four" (אַרְבַּע) has four letters in both Hebrew and Aramaic; however, its root is actually רבע, as can be seen from the ordinal רְבִיעִי ("fourth"). Similarly, the word for "arm" exists in two forms, both in Hebrew (זְרוֹעַ and אֶזְרוֹעַ) and in Aramaic (דְּרָע and אֶדְרָע). This principle accounts for the relationship between the Hebrew word חִדָּה and the Aramaic אֲחִידָה, both of which mean "riddle." Conversely, the Aramaic word חַד ("one") corresponds to the Hebrew אֶחָד.

Less certain is the relationship between the word אָע, which means "tree" in biblical Aramaic, and its apparent Hebrew cognate עֵץ. The original root was presumably ʿḍ, which came to be עֵץ in Hebrew and is represented as עק in several fifth century Aramaic documents (see p. 178). It should be עע in biblical Aramaic, but the first ע apparently dissimilated to an א in order to avoid having two identical consonants next to each other.

*This letter is sometimes transliterated as *ḏ* or *ẓ*.

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

we ..... אֲנַחְנָה
in ..... בְּ־
build ..... בנה
participle (mp) ..... בָּנִין
passive imf 3 fs ..... תִּתְבְּנֵא
that ..... דְּךְ
know ..... ידע
passive participle ..... יְדִיעַ
causal pf (1 p) ..... הוֹדַעְנָא
causal ptc (mp) ..... מְהוֹדְעִין
now ..... כְּעַן
not ..... לָא
rebellious *(fs)* ..... מָרְדְתָּא
give ..... נתן
imperfect (3 mp) ..... יִנְתְּנוּן*
the city ..... קִרְיְתָא

Reference

there is ..... אִיתַי
tax ..... בְּלוֹ
search ..... בקר
imf 3 ms ..... יְבַקַּר
if ..... הֵן
memoranda ..... דְּכְרָנָיְא
be ..... הוה
imf 3 ms ..... לֶהֱוֵא**
portion ..... חֶלָק
to you ..... לָךְ
find ..... שׁכח
causal imf 2 ms ... תְּהַשְׁכַּח
שׁלח *perfect 1 p* ..... שְׁלַחְנָא

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 4:12–16)

יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי יְהוּדָיֵא יְרוּשְׁלֶם קִרְיְתָא מָרְדְתָּא בָּנִין. כְּעַן יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא
לְמַלְכָּא דִּי הֵן קִרְיְתָא דְךְ תִּתְבְּנֵא בְּלוֹ לָא יִנְתְּנוּן. עַל דְּנָה שְׁלַחְנָא וְהוֹדַעְנָא לְמַלְכָּא
דִּי יְבַקַּר בְּסִפַּר דָּכְרָנָיְא וּתְהַשְׁכַּח דִּי קִרְיְתָא דְךְ קִרְיָא מָרְדָא. מְהוֹדְעִין אֲנַחְנָה
לְמַלְכָּא דִּי הֵן קִרְיְתָא דְךְ תִּתְבְּנֵא חֶלָק בַּעֲבַר נַהֲרָא לָא אִיתַי לָךְ׃

Note: תָּא- is a feminine suffix; thus both קִרְיָא מָרְדָא and קִרְיְתָא מָרְדְתָּא mean "rebellious city."

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* Note that the initial נ does not assimilate in this form as it does in the Hebrew equivalent.

** See p. 79.

Proper Nouns

יְהוּדָיֵא — (the) Judeans.

עֲבַר־נַהֲרָא — Trans-Euphrates, one of the Persian Empire's several major provinces (satrapies); it stretched along the Mediterranean coast, west (and south) of the Euphrates River, and included the land of Judah (יְהוּד).

EXERCISES

Write the following Aramaic words next to their Hebrew cognates:

(arm) אֶדְרָע	(new) חַדַת	(six) שֵׁת
(riddle) אֲחִידָה	(advise) יעט	(return) תוב
(there is) אִיתַי	(sit, dwell) יתב	(ox) תּוֹר
(land) אַרַע	(lie) כְּדָבָה	(snow) תֶּלַג
(sacrifice) דִּבַח	(guard) נטר	(three) תְּלָת
(gold) דְּהַב	(summer) קַיִט	(unit of weight) תִּקֵל
(memorandum) דְּכְרָן		

יֵשׁ _____	נצר _____
שֶׂלֶג _____	שָׁלוֹשׁ _____
קַיִץ _____	כָּזָב _____
שֶׁקֶל _____	יַעַן _____
זִכָּרוֹן _____	אֶזְרַע _____
שׁוֹר _____	יָשַׁב _____
חֲדָה _____	זָהָב _____
חָדָשׁ _____	אֶרֶץ _____
שׁוּב _____	זֶבַח _____
שֵׁשׁ _____	

Translate into English:

(1) אֲנַחְנָה בְּנַיִן קִרְיְתָא.

(2) סָפְרָא שְׁלַח אִגַּרְתָּא דָּךְ.

(3) תְּהַשְׁכַּח אֱלָהַיָּא בִּירוּשְׁלֶם מָרָדְתָּא.

(4) לָא אִיתַי חֶלָק לְהוֹם בַּעֲבַר־נַהֲרָה.

(5) כְּעַן יְדִיעַ דִּי יְנִתְנוּן יְהוּדָיֵא בְּלוֹ לְמַלְכָּא.

(6) רְחוּם כְּתַב דָּכְרָן דְּנָה.

Chapter 5

VOWELS

The Hebrew Bible was originally written with only consonants. The Masoretes, who added the vowels, used essentially the same system for both the Hebrew and the Aramaic sections; however, the vowel systems are not completely identical. For example, the composite *sh'va* is not limited to guttural letters as it is in Hebrew, but also appears before and after the letters ק and ג and before ל, נ, and ר, as can be seen in the following words:

מַדְּקָה	גְּלִי
קְדָם	בְּנִיְתַהּ
סְגַר	צִפְּרִי

Other differences between Hebrew and Aramaic involve the way each of them treats certain vowels:

(1) The Canaanite Shift ($\bar{a} > \bar{o}$) — long *a* usually became long *o* ($\bar{o}$) in some Northwest Semitic languages, including Hebrew. However, Aramaic belongs to a non-Canaanite group of languages, in which the original vowel ($\bar{a}$) is retained. A familiar example is the Hebrew word שָׁלוֹם. Both vowels in this word were once pronounced *a*, but the second one was long (the Arabic word is *salām*). In the Canaanite branch that vowel became *ō,* but not in Aramaic where the word is, therefore, pronounced שְׁלָם. The following words provide several other examples:

Aramaic		*Hebrew*
אֱנָשׁ	(man)	אֱנוֹשׁ
דָּר	(generation)	דּוֹר
טָב	(good)	טוֹב
לָא	(not)	לֹא
עָלַם	(eternity)	עוֹלָם
קָל	(sound)	קוֹל

(2) Reduction of Short Vowels — short vowels that occur in syllables immediately prior to the accent become long in Hebrew but are reduced in Aramaic. That is why the first syllable of שָׁלוֹם has a *qameṣ* ($\bar{a}$) in Hebrew, but a *sh'va* (שְׁלָם) in Aramaic. Other Aramaic words reflect this same principle:

Aramaic		*Hebrew*
מְאָה	(hundred)	מֵאָה
נְבִיא	(prophet)	נָבִיא
עֲתִיד	(ready)	עָתִיד

Both of these principles can be seen by comparing the Aramaic word for "three" (תְּלָת) with its Hebrew equivalent (שָׁלוֹשׁ), in which the first vowel, which was originally a short *a* preceding the accent, has become a *sh'va* in Aramaic but a long *a* in Hebrew while the second vowel, which was originally a long *a,* has shifted to *ō*. Notice also the equivalence of Hebrew שׁ and Aramaic ת.

(3) Segolate nouns — Many Hebrew nouns with the accent on their first syllable and a *segol* in the second (e.g., מֶלֶךְ, סֵפֶר, and קֹדֶשׁ) developed out of words that were originally mono-syllabic (i.e. מַלְךְ, סְפְר, קָדְשׁ). In Aramaic these usually have only one full vowel, but it is found under the *second* consonant. (As in Hebrew, it often shifts to *a* when there is a guttural or ר nearby.)

Aramaic		*Hebrew*
לְחֶם	(meal)	לֶחֶם
צְלֶם	(statue)	צֶלֶם
תְּקֶל	(unit of weight)	שֶׁקֶל
כְּסַף	(silver)	כֶּסֶף
פְּשַׁר	(interpretation)	פֶּשֶׁר
נְשַׁר	(eagle)	נֶשֶׁר
עְמַר	(wool)	צֶמֶר
תְּלַג	(snow)	שֶׁלֶג
סְפַר	(book)	סֵפֶר
שְׁבַט	(tribe)	שֵׁבֶט
רְגַז	(anger)	רֹגֶז
זְרַע	(seed)	זֶרַע
בְּעֶל*	(master)	בַּעַל

* For the vocalization of this form, compare its Akkadian cognate *bēlu*, in contrast to the Hebrew בַּעַל.

In Aramaic, as in Hebrew, the original vowel often returns when a suffix is added:

e.g., כַּסְפָּא — the silver

סִפְרִין — documents

פִּשְׁרֵהּ — its interpretation

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

then . . . . . אֱדַיִן

stop . . . . . בטל

G (intrans) pf 3 fs . . . . בְּטֵלַת

D (trans) pf 3 p . . . . . בַּטְּלוּ

D (trans) inf . . . . . לְבַטָּלָה

house . . . . . בַּיִת

master . . . . . בְּעֵל

them . . . . . הִמּוֹ

decree . . . . . טְעֵם

official . . . . . בְּעֵל טְעֵם

do . . . . . עבד

Gt (passive) participle מִתְעֲבֵד

work, service . . . . . עֲבִידָה

eternity . . . . . עָלְמָא

before . . . . . קֳדָם

before me . . . . . קָדָמַי

peace . . . . . שְׁלָם

strong . . . . . תַּקִּיף

mp . . . . . תַּקִּיפִין

Reference

go (G) . . . . . אזל

pf 3 mp . . . . . אֲזָלוּ

be . . . . . הוה

G pf 3 mp . . . . . הֲווֹ

days (*p cstr*) . . . . . יוֹמָת

dwell (G) . . . . . יתב

G ptc mp . . . . . יָתְבִין

G inf of בנה . . . . . מִבְנֵא

kings . . . . . מַלְכִין

after . . . . . מִן דִּי

rebellion . . . . . מְרַד

letter . . . . . נִשְׁתְּוָנָא

message . . . . . פִּתְגָמָא

is read . . . . . קֱרִי

issue . . . . . שִׂים

imv mp . . . . . שִׂימוּ

remnant . . . . . שְׁאָר

G pf 2 mp of שלח . . . . . שְׁלַחְתּוּן

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 4:17–24)

פִּתְגָמָא שְׁלַח מַלְכָּא עַל רְחוּם בְּעֵל טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא דִּי יָתְבִין בְּשָׁמְרַיִן וּשְׁאָר עֲבַר־
נַהֲרָה: שְׁלָם. נִשְׁתְּוָנָא דִּי שְׁלַחְתּוּן קֳרֵי קָדְמָי. מְרַד מִתְעֲבֶד בְּקִרְיְתָא דָךְ מִן יוֹמָת
עָלְמָא וּמַלְכִין תַּקִּיפִין הֲוֹו עַל יְרוּשְׁלֶם. כְּעַן שִׂימוּ טְעֵם לְבַטָּלָה מִבְנָא קִרְיְתָא דְךְ.
אֱדַיִן מִן דִּי נִשְׁתְּוָנָא דִּי אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתָּא מַלְכָּא קֳרֵי קֳדָם רְחוּם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא אֲזַלוּ
לִירוּשְׁלֶם עַל יְהוּדָיֵא וּבַטִּלוּ הִמּוֹ. בֵּאדַיִן בְּטֵלַת עֲבִידַת בֵּית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם.

Proper Nouns

שָׁמְרַיִן — Persian province in the central hill country; named after the capital of Israel's Northern Kingdom when it was conquered by the Assyrians in 721 B.C.E.

EXERCISES

Explain the *differences* between the following pairs of Hebrew and Aramaic cognates:

Aramaic	**Hebrew**		**Difference**
לָא	לֹא	(not)	_____
עֲמַר	צֶמֶר	(wool)	_____
דָּא	זֹה	(this)	_____
אֱדְרָע	אֶזְרוֹעַ	(arm)	_____
תְּלַג	שֶׁלֶג	(snow)	_____
שָׁפְטִין	שֹׁפְטִים	(judges)	_____
נְהַר	נָהָר	(river)	_____
תּוּב	שׁוּב	(return)	_____

Aramaic	Hebrew		Difference
שֵׁת	שֵׁשׁ	(six)	_____
סָפַר	סוֹפֵר	(scribe)	_____
נְשִׁין	נָשִׁים	(women)	_____
חֲדַת	חָדָשׁ	(new)	_____
שְׂעַר	שֵׂעָר	(hair)	_____
חֲבַר	חָבֵר	(companion)	_____
דְּהַב	זָהָב	(gold)	_____
עֲשַׂר	עֶשֶׂר	(ten)	_____
אָת	אוֹת	(sign)	_____
תבר	שֹׁבֵר	(break)	_____
עָלַם	עוֹלָם	(eternity)	_____

Translate into English:

(1) כְּתַב בְּעֵל עָלְמָא אִגְּרָה לְמַלְכִין תַּקִּיפִין.

(2) אֲנַחְנָא בָּנִין בַּיִת בְּקִרְיְתָא מָרְדְּתָא.

(3) אֱדַיִן הִמּוֹ בַּטְלוּ מִבְנֵה בִּירוּשְׁלֶם.

(4) שִׁימוּ טְעֵם קֶדֶם סָפְרָא מִן דִּי נִשְׁתְּנָא קֶרִי.

(5) כְּעַן לָא יִנְתְּנוּן עֲבִידָה עַל יְהוּדָיֵא.

(6) מַלְכַיָּא תַּקִּיפַיָּא אֲזָלוּ עַל קִרְיְתָא.

(7) טְעֵם אֱלָהָא קֶרִי קֶדֶם בְּעֵל.

(8) אֱדַיִן אֱמַר שִׁמְשַׁי לְבַטָּלָה מִבְנֵה בַּיְתָא דְנָה.

(9) הִמּוֹ עֲבַדוּ מְרַד בִּירוּשְׁלֶם.

(10) שִׁימוּ שְׁלָם לְהוֹם מִן עָלְמָא.

(11) אֲנַחְנָא מְהוֹדְעִין לְסָפְרָא דִּי בְּטֵלַת עֲבִידַת בַּיְתָא דִּי מַלְכָּא.

Chapter 6

NOUNS, DEFINITE ARTICLE

Nouns behave much the same way in Aramaic as they do in Hebrew: They can be masculine or feminine, absolute or construct, singular or plural (or dual). However, Aramaic nouns are unique in two, nearly ubiquitous features.

(1) Alongside the absolute and construct, Aramaic has a third "state," called "determined." This form typically ends with א־, although it is occasionally spelled with the letter ה. It functions much like the definite article in Hebrew (־ה); that is to say, words with the determinative ending א־ can be translated "the . . ." (In some later dialects of Aramaic this determined form of the noun became the normal one and thereby lost its connotation of definiteness.)

Although there is nothing *formally* comparable to the determined suffix א־ in biblical Hebrew, it does exist in a word which occurs several times in the New Testament and has become standard in modern Hebrew. In Mark 14:36, Jesus refers to God as αββα.* This is obviously the determined form of the noun אָב (“father”), which has survived into modern Hebrew, where it and its feminine counterpart אִמָּא serve as familiar forms, equivalent to the English “Daddy” and “Mommy.”

(2) Masculine plural forms usually end with ן־, rather than the ם־ that is familiar in Hebrew. In fact, the Hebrew Bible contains many masculine forms that end with ן. Before either Aramaic or Hebrew had reached the stage with which we are familiar, masculine plural forms were apparently marked with י־. Later, Hebrew and Aramaic added different consonants to this original suffix. As a result, masculine plural nouns usually end with ין־ rather than ים־ as they do in Hebrew.

Aramaic's added ן can also be found on verbs, most notably in the imperfect:

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* Contrast the parallel passages Matthew 26:39 and Luke 22:42; but see Romans 8:15 and Galatians 4:6. This is the source of our own English term “Abbot.”

	Aramaic	Hebrew
2d feminine singular	תִּכְתְּבִין	תִּכְתְּבִי
2d masculine plural	תִּכְתְּבוּן	תִּכְתְּבוּ
2d feminine plural	תִּכְתְּבָן	תִּכְתֹּבְנָה
3d masculine plural	יִכְתְּבוּן	יִכְתְּבוּ
3d feminine plural	יִכְתְּבָן	תִּכְתֹּבְנָה

The resulting noun patterns are:

		masculine	*feminine*
singular	absolute	מֶלֶךְ	מַלְכָּה *
	construct	מֶלֶךְ	מַלְכַּת
	determined	מַלְכָּא	מַלְכְּתָא
plural	absolute	מַלְכִין	מַלְכָן
	construct	מַלְכֵי	מַלְכָת
	determined	מַלְכַיָּא	מַלְכָתָא

Notice the תָ- ending on the construct and determined forms of the feminine plural. This corresponds to Hebrew's feminine plural suffix וֹת-. (Remember that long *ā* becomes long *ō* in Hebrew.)

Not all nouns fit these patterns perfectly. As in any language, Aramaic has some irregular forms. These include plurals which do not seem to match their singulars, whether in form or in gender:

נְשִׁין "women" (The Bible does not include a singular form, but compare Hebrew אִשָּׁה, for which the plural is נָשִׁים.)

אֲבָהָן "fathers" (This form is inferred from the construct אֲבָהַת, which can be compared to the Hebrew plural אָבוֹת.)

שְׁמָהָן "names," judging from the construct שְׁמָהַת (cf. Hebrew שֵׁמוֹת).

Similarly, the plural for "great" (רַבְרְבִין) is an expanded form of רַב (cf. רַבְרְבָנִים, "chiefs").

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* In the Bible, the feminine suffix הָ- is sometimes spelled with an א, just as the determined suffix אָ- is sometimes spelled with a ה. Notice the inconsistent use of *dagesh*, which occurs in the כ of singular but not the plural forms of both masculine and feminine.

Like Hebrew, Aramaic also has dual forms, although there are not many examples in the Bible. Perhaps some dual forms are indistinguishable from the plural so that we cannot identify them. However, those that can be recognized resemble their Hebrew equivalents, except for the no-longer surprising presence of ן- where Hebrew has ם-:

e.g., יְדַיִן (2 hands)

מְאָתַיִן (200)

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

say . . . . . אמר

participle (m p) . . . . . אָמְרִין

he came . . . . . אֲתָא

son . . . . . בַּר

man (*plural* גְּבְרִין) . . . . . גֻּבַר

and . . . . . וְ/וּ־

who . . . . . מַן *

governor . . . . . פַּחָה

arise (G) . . . . . קוּם

perfect 3 mp . . . . . קָמוּ

issue (an order) . . . . . שִׂים

G pf 3 ms . . . . . שָׂם

name (*plural* שְׁמָהָת) . . . . . שֻׁם

Reference

god . . . . . אֱלָהּ

their gods . . . . . אֱלָהֲהֹם

was (*G pf 3 fs of* הוה) . . . . . הֲוָת

thus . . . . . כְּדִן

to you (*m p*) . . . . . לְכֹם

build *(G infinitive)* . . . . . מִבְנֵא

prophesy (Dt הִתְנַבִּי) . . . . . נבא

prophet . . . . . נְבִיא

eye . . . . . עַיִן

on them . . . . . עֲלֵיהוֹן

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 5:1–5)

וְהִתְנַבִּי חַגַּי וּזְכַרְיָה בַר עִדּוֹא נְבִאַיָּא עַל יְהוּדָיֵא דִּי בִיהוּד וּבִירוּשְׁלֵם בְּשֵׁם אֱלָהּ
יִשְׂרָאֵל עֲלֵיהוֹן. בֵּאדַיִן קָמוּ זְרֻבָּבֶל בַּר שְׁאַלְתִּיאֵל וְיֵשׁוּעַ בַּר יוֹצָדָק לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית
אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם. אֲתָא עֲלֵיהוֹן תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר נַהֲרָה וּשְׁתַר־בּוֹזְנַי וְכֻן אָמְרִין
לְהֹם: מַן שָׂם טְעֵם בַּיְתָא דְנָה לְמִבְנֵא? מַן שְׁמָהָת גֻּבְרַיָּא דִּי דְנָא בָּנַיִן?
וְעֵין אֱלָהֲהֹם הֲוָת עַל יְהוּדָיֵא וְלָא בַטְּלוּ הִמּוֹ.

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* In Exodus 16:15 this word is the basis for a pun with the Hebrew word מָן, meaning "manna."

Proper Nouns

זְכַרְיָה בַּר עִדּוֹא — A Judean prophet of priestly descent during the reign of Darius I (521–486 B.C.E.), who encouraged the reestablishment of the kingdom.

זְרֻבָּבֶל בַּר שְׁאַלְתִּיאֵל — Grandson of Judah's king Jehoiachin, who was appointed governor by the Persians and led a group of exiles back to Judah, where he was viewed by some Judeans with messianic fervor.

חַגַּי — Prophesied to those who had returned to Judah in 520 on the importance of rebuilding the Temple.

יְהוּד — Province of Persian empire, centered in Jerusalem.

יִשְׂרָאֵל — Still used after the exile to refer to the ethnicity of the people chosen by God.

יֵשׁוּעַ בַּר יוֹצָדָק (called יְהוֹשֻׁעַ in Haggai and Zechariah) — Descendant of Seriah, a leading priest who was killed when the Babylonians conquered Jerusalem and whose son Jozadak was taken into exile; he returned to Judah in 520 with Zerubbabel, alongside of whom he played a major role in the reestablishment of sacrifice.

שְׁתַר־בּוֹזְנַי — Persian official.

תַּתְּנַי — Persian governor of Trans-Euphrates under Darius I.

EXERCISES

Fill in the blank with the Aramaic translation of the parenthesized words:

(1) יְהֶדְיָא בָּנַיִן בֵּית _____ (of a king).

(2) דְּנָה כְּתַב אִגְּרָה. (scribe) _____

(3) גֶּבְרַיָּא. (the names of) _____

Fill in the following charts with the noun forms given below:

רֵאשׁ, רֵאשָׁא, רֵאשׁ, רֵאשַׁיָּא, רֵאשִׁין

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

נְבִיאֵי, נְבִיא, נְבִיאַיָּא, נְבִיאִין, נְבִיאָא

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

סִפְרִין, סִפְרֵי, סִפְרַיָּא, סִפְרָא, סְפַר

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

עֲבִידַת, עֲבִידָת, עֲבִידָן, עֲבִידְתָא, עֲבִידָה, עֲבִידְתָא

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

קְרַיְתָא, קִרְיָתָא, קִרְיָן, קִרְיָה, קִרְיְתָא, קִרְיָת

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

אֱלָהִי, אֱלָהַיָּא, אֱלָהָא, אֱלָהִין, אֱלָה

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

סְפָרָא, סָפַר, סָפְרִין, סָפְרַיָּא, סָפְרֵי

	absolute	construct	determined
Singular			
Plural			

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The scribe wrote the names of the men.

(2) The prophets of Israel arose before the kings.

(3) They sent the letter to Trans-Euphrates.

(4) God came to Israel.

(5) They are building the city of Jerusalem

(6) A master issued a decree.

(7) We informed the men of the city.

(8) Who are the governors of Judah and Samaria?

Chapter 7

The Verb System

Verbal systems are a prominent feature of most languages and provide a particularly useful way to classify them. Semitic verbs are based on three-letter roots, which can be conjugated in several different ways. Hebrew is usually said to have 7 of these conjugations (בִּנְיָנִם)—*qal*, *nifʿal*, *piʿel*, *hifʿil*, *puʿal*, *hofʿal*, and *hitpaʿel*. In order to facilitate comparisons with other languages, these are identified here with single letters, which reflect their characteristic features: *Qal* is called G for the German *Grundstamm*, which means "basic conjugation," as does the Hebrew term *qal*. *Piʿel* is designated D for its doubled middle letter. The *hifʿil* will be called H, and the *nifʿal* (which does not exist in Aramaic) N in recognition of the letter which is prefixed to each.

This scheme of 7 separate conjugations is somewhat artificial. In the first place, several of these conjugations are actually related to each other. These include the *puʿal* and the *hofʿal*, which are patently variations (sometimes called internal passives) of the *piʿel* and *hifʿil*, with which they are identical except for their *u-a* vowel pattern, which shifts the meaning from active to passive.* (Significantly, Hebrew's *qal* passive participle, e.g., כָּתוּב, also uses *a* and *u* vowels.)

The *hitpaʿel* (here designated Dt) is built on the *piʿel*, as can be seen from the fact that its middle root letter is doubled. The prefix -הִתְ conveyed a reflexive meaning and was not necessarily limited to a *piʿel* base, as can be seen from other Semitic languages.** The Bible preserves a handful of Hebrew words in which this prefix was added to *qal* forms (הִתְפָּקֵד in Judges 20:15,17, 21:9; note the passive forms beginning with with -הָתְ in Numbers 1:47 and 2:33).

At the same time that several of these seven standard conjugations appear to be related to one another, there are conjugations that this list does not include. Thus Gesenius' Hebrew grammar lists *pôʿēl*, *paʿlēl*, *pĕʿalʿal*, *pilpēl*, *tifʿēl*, and *šafʿēl*.***

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*The Hebrew *qal* probably had an internal passive, too; for the evidence, see *A Grammar of Biblical Hebrew* by Paul Joüon and T. Muraoka (Rome: Pontifical Biblical Institute, 1991) §58, pp. 166–68.

** Although Aramaic is the only Semitic language in which a *t* can be added to the H conjugation, several languages which form their causatives with שׁ have it (including Hebrew הִשְׁתַּחֲוָה); see Sabatino Moscati, *An Introduction to the Comparative Grammar of the Semitic Languages* (Wiesbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1969) §16.17–23, pp. 127–30.

*** A. E. Cowley, *Gesenius' Hebrew Grammar* as edited and enlarged by the late E. Kautzsch (2d English edition, Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1910) §55, pp. 151–54.

Because Aramaic belongs to the same Northwest group of the Semitic language family as does Hebrew, its verbal system is essentially the same and can be characterized with the following pattern:

		Passive	Prefixed t
G	*p^{e}ᶜal*	*p^{e}ᶜil*	Gt—*hitp^{e}ᶜel*
D	*paᶜᶜel*	*puᶜᶜal*	Dt—*hitpaᶜᶜal*
H	*hafᶜel*	*hofᶜal*	Ht—*hitafᶜal* (not in biblical Aramaic)
N	not in Aramaic		

As in Hebrew, each Aramaic conjugation comprises two major tenses, one of which generates its various forms with a series of suffixes (the perfect), while the other uses primarily prefixes (the imperfect). Each also has imperative, infinitive, and participial forms.

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

go . . . . . אזל

G pf 1 p . . . . . אֲזַלְנָא

those . . . . . אִלֵּךְ

interior . . . . . גַּו

3 ms (him, his) *suffix* . . . . . ־֫הּ

3 mp (they, them) *suffix* . . . . . -הֹם

2 mp (you, your) *suffix* . . . . . -כֹם

colleague (*plural* כְּנָוָת) . . . . . כְּנָת

province . . . . . מְדִינָה

head . . . . . רֵאשׁ

great . . . . . רַב

Reference

we said . . . . . אֲמַרְנָא

also . . . . . אַף

everything . . . . . כֹּלָּא

write (G) . . . . . כתב

passive participle . . . כְּתִיב

imf 1 p . . . . . נִכְתֵּב

let it be *(imf 3 ms)* . . . . . לֶהֱוֵה

elder . . . . . שָׂב

ask . . . . . שׁאל

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 5:6–10)

אִגַּרְתָּא דִּי שְׁלַח תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּשְׁתַר־בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתֵהּ דִּי בַּעֲבַר־נַהֲרָה עַל
דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא וְכִדְנָה כְּתִיב בְּגַוֵּהּ: לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שְׁלָמָא כֹלָּא. יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא
דִּי אֲזַלְנָא לִיהוּד מְדִינְתָּא לְבֵית אֱלָהָא רַבָּא. אֱדַיִן שְׁאֵלְנָא לְשָׂבַיָּא אִלֵּךְ אֱמַרְנָא
לְהֹם: מַן שָׂם לְכֹם טְעֵם בַּיְתָא דְנָה לְמִבְנְיָה. וְאַף שְׁמָהָתְהֹם שְׁאֵלְנָא לְהֹם
דִּי נְכְתֵּב שֵׁם גֻּבְרַיָּא דִּי בְרָאשֵׁיהֹם.

Proper Names

דָּרְיָוֶשׁ — Darius I conquered Persia after the death of Cambyses II and reigned from 522 to 486 B.C.E.

EXERCISES

Identify the base conjugation (G, D, or H) to which the following Aramaic verbs belong. Note that some of these forms are passive and reflexive, so that their vowel patterns may differ from those of the active form or they may have a prefixed -הִתְ (or -אִתְ), much like the Hebrew *hitpa"el.*

_____ הִתְקְטָלָה	_____ נְחֵוָא	_____ אָכְלָה
_____ מְהֵימַן	_____ סָגְדִין	_____ הַדַּרְתָּ
_____ מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין	_____ בְּנַס	_____ הוּבַד
_____ מִתְנַשְּׂאָה	_____ הַרְגּוּ	_____ הָחֲרַבַת
_____ יְבַקַּר	_____ הֶעֱלוּ	_____ יִשְׁאֵלֻנְכוֹן
_____ תִּקְנָא	_____ הַשְׁכַּחַת	_____ בְּטֵלַת
_____ רְשַׁמְתָּ	_____ תִּתְרְמוֹן	_____ הַשְׁפֵּלְתְּ
_____ הִתְרְחִצוּ	_____ נְפַלוּ	_____ מַלְל
_____ מְהַלְכִין	_____ הִתְנַבִּי	_____ שַׁבְּחַת
_____ אִתְעַקַּרוּ	_____ בַּטְלוּ	_____ חֲשִׁבִין
_____ מְצַבְּעִין	_____ מְהַעֲדֵה	_____ אֶבְעֵה
	_____ הִתְגְּזֵרַת	

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) We went to the great province.

(2) They sent a letter to the house and to the men inside it.

(3) Now Darius is the head of those elders.

(4) The elders say that the decree is known to them.

(5) Let peace be over Jerusalem.

(6) Everything is written.

Chapter 8

G PERFECT

Not only are the Aramaic verb conjugations (G, D, and H) and tenses (perfect, imperfect, etc.) analogous to those of Hebrew, but the individual forms are also similar, once the various principles that have already been discussed are taken into account. For example, the perfect tense, which describes completed action, uses pronominal suffixes attached at the end of the verbal root. Moreover, although these suffixes are somewhat different from those in Hebrew (but not unrecognizably so), the pattern itself is built on the same (3d person, masculine singular) base—כְּתַב, with the accent on the final syllable as is usual in these languages. Because the short vowel in the first syllable precedes the accent, it is lengthened in Hebrew, resulting in the form כָּתַב, but reduced in Aramaic, yielding כְּתַב.

All the various perfect forms are built on this base. In a few cases the first two letters could both have *sh'va*s (i.e., -כְּתְ); since Aramaic will not tolerate two vocal *sh'va*s in a row any more than Hebrew, the first of these shifts to *ḥiriq* (i.e., -כִּתְ).*

Overall, the G perfect conjugation looks like this:

		Singular	*Plural*
1		כְּתַבְתּ	כְּתַבְנָא
2	masculine	כְּתַבְתָּ (or כְּתַבְתְּ)	כְּתַבְתּוּן
	feminine	כְּתַבְתִּי	כְּתַבְתֵּן**
3	masculine	כְּתַב	כְּתַבוּ
	feminine	כְּתַבַת	כְּתַבָה***

*The same process is responsible for the Hebrew plural imperative שִׁמְרוּ, which results when the imperfect prefix is dropped from יִשְׁמְרוּ, and for the vocalization of prepositional prefixes attached to words beginning with *sh'va*, such as בִּסְפָרִים.

**Note that Aramaic uses different vowels for masculine and feminine forms of perfect verbs in the third (-הֹם/-הֵן) and second persons (-תֶּן/-תּוּן) and for possessive pronouns (-כֶן/-כֹן, see chapter 13), unlike Hebrew, which uses the same vowels in the second person (e.g., כְּתַבְתֶּם/תֶּן and סִפְרֶכֶם/-כֶן).

***Sometimes the masculine form is used as a common plural.

The vowel under the second root letter (e.g., the *pataḥ* under the ת in many of the forms above) is called the "theme vowel" and is particular to specific roots. Examples of verbs with different theme vowels in the perfect include:

בְּטַלַת	she stopped
שְׁאֵלְנָא	we asked
סְגַד	he bowed down

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

earth . . . . . אַרְעָא
be . . . . . הוה / הוא
palace, temple . . . . . הֵיכַל
one . . . . . חַד
give . . . . . יהב
G pf passive 3 p . . . . . יְהִיבוּ
vessel . . . . . מָאן
go out . . . . . נפק
H (causal) pf 3 ms . . . הַנְפֵּק
many, large . . . . . שַׂגִּיא
heaven . . . . . שְׁמַיָּא
year . . . . . שְׁנָה

Reference

father . . . . . אַב
our ancestors . . . . . אֲבָהָתַנָא
these . . . . . אִלֵּה
build . . . . . בנה
passive participle . . . . בְּנֵה
infinitive . . . . . לְבְנֵא
Gt (passive) imf 3 ms יִתְבְּנֵא
exile . . . . . גלה
H (causal) pf 3 ms . . . הַגְלִי
descend . . . . . נחת
H ("deposit") *imv* . . . אֲחֵת
tear down (G) . . . . . סתר
servant . . . . . עֲבֵד
his servants . . . . . עַבְדּוֹהִי
people, nation . . . . . עַם
former time . . . . . קַדְמָה
anger (H) . . . . . רגז
perfect 3 p . . . . . הַרְגִּזוּ
reply (H) . . . . . תוב
they replied . . . . . הַתִיבוּ

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 5:11–15)

הֲתִיבוּ: אֲנַחְנָא עַבְדוֹהִי דִּי אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא וּבְנַיִן בַּיְתָא דִּי הֲוָא בְנֵה מִקַּדְמַת דְּנָה שְׁנִין שַׂגִּיאִן. הַרְגּוּ אֲבָהֲתַנָא לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וַיהַב הִמּוֹ לִנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מֶלֶךְ בָּבֶל כַּסְדָּיָא וּבַיְתָה דְנָה סְתַר וְעַמָּה הַגְלִי לְבָבֶל. בְּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְכוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא דִּי בָבֶל כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם בֵּית אֱלָהָא דְנָה לִבְנֵא וּמָאנַיָּא דִּי בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הַנְפֵּק מִן הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם לְהֵיכְלָא דִּי בָבֶל הַנְפֵּק הִמּוֹ כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא מִן הֵיכְלָא דִּי בָבֶל וְיִהִיבוּ לְשֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר וַאֲמַר: אֵלֶּה מָאנַיָּא אֲחֵת הִמּוֹ בְּהֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וּבֵית אֱלָהָא יְתִבְנֵא.

Proper Names

בָּבֶל — A central Mesopotamian city on the Euphrates, which established an empire in the sixth century that conquered Judah and destroyed Jerusalem, taking its leading citizens into exile.

כּוֹרֶשׁ — Founder of Persian empire, which he ruled from 559–30 B.C.E.; he conquered Media, Lydia, and Babylonia (in 539 B.C.E.), granted the various nations under his control cultural autonomy, and, according to Herodotus, believed himself "more than a man" (1:204).

כַּסְדִּי — Member of a tribe in southern part of Mesopotamia, where the Babylonian empire was centered in the seventh and sixth centuries (for the spelling, see p. 70).

נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר — Chaldean ruler of Babylonian empire (605–562 B.C.E.), who conquered Jerusalem in 587.

שֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר — Babylonian-born Judean who was appointed governor by Cyrus in 538 B.C.E. and returned to Jerusalem with the temple vessels.

EXERCISES

Conjugate the following verbs, all of which have a *pataḥ* theme vowel, in the G perfect:

		יתב	נטל
singular	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		
plural	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		

		רשׁם	שׁלח
singular	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		
plural	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		

Identify the form of the following G perfect verbs:

	Root	Person	Gender	Number
יְדַעְתָּ				
יְדְעַת				
יְהַב				
כְּתַבְנָא				
כְּתַבוּ				
מְלַחְנָא				
נְטְרַת				
נְפַל				
סְלְקַת				
עְבַד				

Translate from Aramaic into English:

(1) אֲזַל מַלְכָּא קֶדֶם קְרִיְתָא.

(2) אֲנַחְנָה יְדַעְנָא דִי בְּעֵל עָלְמָא בִּירוּשְׁלֶם.

(3) כְּתְבַת אִגְּרָה עַל בֵּית מַלְכָּא.

(4) אֱדַיִן שְׁלַח אֱלָהָא טְעֵם עַל מְדִינְתָּא דְּךְ.

(5) יְהַבְתְּ עַבְדִין שַׂגִּיאִין לְפַחַת יְהוּדְיֵא.

(6) אֲבָהֲתַנָא נְתַנוּ מָאנַיָּא אִלֵּךְ לְכוֹרֶשׁ.

(7) רֵאשׁ הֵיכְלָא הֲוָא בַּשְׁמַיָּא.

(8) נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לָא הַנְפֵּק גְּבְרַיָּא לְאַרְעָא.

(9) בַּיְתָא רַבָּא דְּךְ יִתְבְּנֵה בִּשְׁנָה חַדָּה.

Chapter 9

G Participle

Like the G perfect, Aramaic participles are morphologically and functionally similar to their Hebrew counterparts. In both languages they act like nouns. Moreover, they look very much alike, with Aramaic's active participle even vocalized like its Hebrew equivalent (כּוֹתֵב), except that the Hebrew *ō*, of course, appears as *ā* in Aramaic. Thus:

		Masculine	*Feminine*
singular	absolute	כָּתֵב	כָּתְבָה
	construct	כָּתֵב	כָּתְבַת
	determined	כָּתְבָא	כָּתְבְתָא
plural	absolute	כָּתְבִין	כָּתְבָן
	construct	כָּתְבֵי	כָּתְבָת
	determined	כָּתְבַיָּא	כָּתְבָתָא

This vowel pattern is affected by guttural letters, such as ח, ע, and ר, particularly when they come at the end of the root. Thus אָמַר and יָדַע are participles, derived from the theoretical forms אָמֵר and יָדֵעַ. (Do not confuse these with the Hebrew 3d person masculine singular perfect, which looks identical.)

Aramaic also has a passive participle. As in Hebrew, this form is characterized by its theme vowel. In Hebrew that is *ū* (e.g., כָּתוּב, בָּרוּךְ); in Aramaic, it is *ī*:

		Masculine	*Feminine*
singular	absolute	כְּתִיב	כְּתִיבָה
	construct	כְּתִיב	כְּתִיבַת
	determined	כְּתִיבָא	כְּתִיבְתָא
plural	absolute	כְּתִיבִין	כְּתִיבָן
	construct	כְּתִיבֵי	כְּתִיבָת
	determined	כְּתִיבַיָּא	כְּתִיבָתָא

If you have studied the text of the Hebrew Bible, you may recognize the term כְּתִיב, which was used by the Masoretes to indicate places where the "written" text (כְּתִיב) differs from what is to be "read" (קְרֵי). In such passages, many editions of the Bible print the consonants of the כְּתִיב and the vowels of the קְרֵי. For example, the name Jerusalem is often printed יְרוּשָׁלַם, with an extra vowel between the last two consonants. The name was apparently pronounced יְרוּשְׁלֶם when these texts were written (כְּתִיב), just as it is in the Aramaic sections of the Bible (compare the English "Jerusalem"); however, by the time the vowels were added, the final *segol* had shifted to the diphthong *a-i*, yielding the reading (קְרֵי) יְרוּשָׁלַיִם.

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned		*Reference*	
there is	אִיתַי	foundations	אֶשֶׁן
search	בקר	build	בנה
D perfect 3 mp	בַּקְּרוּ	*G infinitive*	לְמִבְנֵה
Dt (passive) imf 3 ms	יִתְבַּקַּר	*Gt (pass) participle*	מִתְבְּנֵה
treasure	גִּנְזֵ	*Gt (pass) imf 3 ms*	יִתְבְּנֵה
gold	דְּהַב	give	יהב
if	הֵן	*Gt imf 3 fs*	תִּתְיְהֵב
good	טָב	scroll	מְגִלָּה
silver	כְּסַף	expenses	נִפְקָה
from	מִן	wish (*noun*)	רְעוּ
we/our	-נָא	give *(G pass participle)*	שְׁיִם
there	תַּמָּה	find	שכח
		be found	הִשְׁתְּכַח
		finished	שְׁלֵם
		return	תוב
		H (trans imf 3 mp)	יַהֲתִיבוּן

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 5:16–6:5)

אֱדַיִן שֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר אֲתָא יְהַב אַשַּׁיָּא דִּי בֵּית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וּמִן אֱדַיִן וְעַד כְּעַן מִתְבְּנֵא
וְלָא שְׁלִם. וּכְעַן הֵן עַל מַלְכָּא טָב יִתְבַּקַּר בְּבֵית גִּנְזַיָּא דִּי מַלְכָּא תַּמָּה דִּי בְּבָבֶל הֵן
אִיתַי דִּי מִן כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שִׂים טְעֵם לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית אֱלָהָא בִּירוּשְׁלֶם וּרְעוּת מַלְכָּא עַל
דְּנָה יִשְׁלַח עֲלֵינָא. בֵּאדַיִן דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם וּבַקְרוּ תַּמָּה בְּבָבֶל וְהִשְׁתְּכַח מְגִלָּה
חֲדָה וְכֵן כְּתִיב בְּגַוַּהּ: בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְכוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם בֵּית אֱלָהָא
בִּירוּשְׁלֶם יִתְבְּנֵא וְנַפְקָתָא מִן בֵּית מַלְכָּא תִּתְיְהֵב וּמָאנֵי בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי דַהֲבָה וְכַסְפָּא
דִּי נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הַנְפֵּק מִן הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם יַהֲתִיבוּן.

EXERCISES

List the participle forms of the following verbs:

Active		נטל	רשם	טרד	קטל
Singular m	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				
Singular f	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				
Plural m	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				
Plural f	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				

Passive		נטל	רשם	טרד	קטל
Singular m	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				
Singular f	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				
Plural m	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				
Plural f	absolute				
	construct				
	determined				

Translate the following sentences into English:

(1) נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר אָמַר דִּי קִרְיְתָא תִּתְיְהֵב לִיהוּדָאִין.

(2) מְגִלָּה רַבָּה שְׁלִיחָה לְפַחַת מְדִנְתָּא.

(3) מַלְכָּא יְדַע דִּי עֲבִידָה בָּטְלָה.

(4) אֲנַחְנָה יָדְעִין לְמִבְנֵה בַּיִת.

(5) אִיתַי דְהַב בְּבֵית גִּנְזָיָא תַּמָּה בְּבָבֶל.

(6) גִּבְרַיָּא בַּקְרוּ הֵן כְּסַף טָב יְהִיב לְסָפְרָא.

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The men rose up against them.

(2) Who sent the silver and the gold from Trans-Euphrates?

(3) There is a governor inside Jerusalem.

(4) We gave a house to them.

(5) The scribe went to the city.

Chapter 10

VOCABULARY

Although it is helpful to know Hebrew when learning Aramaic, their similarities can also be a trap for the unwary Hebraist engaged in the study of an Aramaic text. For the two languages are not the same, and one must avoid unintentionally reading an Aramaic passage as if it were Hebrew when they actually diverge. An example of this is the forms אָמַר and יָדַע, which would be G (*qal*) perfect verbs in Hebrew, but are participles in Aramaic.

Likewise, the languages' vocabulary, though often similar, are not identical. This was demonstrated in chapter 3 by the Gospel accounts of Jesus' words on the cross, which are taken from the beginning of Psalm 22. Although the Gospel versions are virtually identical with the original, the Hebrew word עזב (abandon) has been rendered with its Aramaic equivalent— שׁבק.

Vocabulary differences are evident in the very first Aramaic words in the Bible, which occur in the story of Jacob's flight from his father-in-law (Genesis 31:47). After Laban caught up with Jacob, they made an agreement, and Jacob erected a pile of stones, which he called גַּלְעֵד but which Laban identified as יְגַר שָׂהֲדוּתָא. Although both phrases mean "pile-witness" —Jacob's in Hebrew and Laban's in Aramaic—they, too, bear no resemblance whatsoever.

An especially common idea that is expressed differently in the two languages is "son," which is בַּר in Aramaic but בֵּן in Hebrew. Interestingly, this is not the only case where Hebrew and Aramaic words with the same meaning differ only in the latter's having a ר where Hebrew has a נ. The Aramaic word for "two" (תְּרֵין) correlates with the Hebrew שְׁנַיִם (remember that Aramaic ת can correspond to Hebrew שׁ).

On the other hand, the two languages sometimes use altogether different roots. Several of these are very common words having to do with motion:

	Hebrew	*Aramaic*
"come"	בוא	אתא
"go"	הלך	אזל
"go up"	עלה	סלק
"go down"	ירד	נחת
"go in"	בוא	עלל
"go out"	יצא	נפק

Complicating matters are words (or roots) which exist in both languages but are used differently. For example, רַב can mean either "many" or "great" in Hebrew, but in Aramaic it always means "great"—a concept which Hebrew usually expresses with גָּדוֹל. How, then, does Aramaic say "many"? With a totally different word—שַׂגִּיא (which sometimes also means "great").

	Hebrew	*Aramaic*
"big"	גָּדוֹל	רַב
"many"	רַב	שַׂגִּיא

Similarly, the verb עבד occurs in both languages; however, it means "to serve" or "work" in Hebrew, but "to make" or "do" in Aramaic. Thus it has the same meaning in Aramaic that עשׂה has in Hebrew. As if to compensate, Aramaic also uses another verb—פלח, which means "to serve."

	Hebrew	*Aramaic*
"do, make"	עשׂה	עבד
"work, serve, worship"	עבד	פלח

Translating Aramaic עבד as if it were Hebrew could, therefore, lead to serious misunderstanding.

The very common Hebrew verbs נתן and שׂים also occur in Aramaic, where שׂים has a far broader semantic range than its Hebrew cognate, which means "put." In Aramaic it can mean "issue (a decree)," "appoint," or "give (a name)"; it also occurs in several idioms, including "have regard for" (שׂים טְעֵם עַל) and "set the mind on" (שׂים בַּל לְ־).

In biblical Aramaic נתן appears only in the imperfect and infinitive; perfect and participle forms of "give" are expressed with the more characteristically Aramaic verb יהב. This root also occurs in Hebrew parts of the Bible, where its imperative (הָבָה and הָבוּ) is used both literally ("give") and with the connotation "let us." Thus Rachel implores Jacob הָבָה לִי בָנִים ("Give me sons," Genesis 30:1), whereas the inhabitants of Babel say: הָבָה נִבְנֶה לָנוּ עִיר ("Let's build a city for ourselves," Genesis 11:4).

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

I ..... אֲנָה
man ..... אֱנָשׁ
destroy (D) ..... חבל
infinitive ..... חַבָּלָה
all ..... כֹּל
what ..... מָה
dunghill ..... נְוָלוּ
message, word ..... פִּתְגָם
pray (D) ..... צלה
participle mp ..... מְצַלַּיִן
distant ..... רְחִיק
leave (alone) ..... שׁבק
G imv mp ..... שְׁבֻקוּ

Reference

build ..... בנה
G inf ..... מִבְנֵא
be ..... הוה
G imv mp ..... הֱווֹ
G imf 3 ms ..... לֶהֱוֵא
G imf 3 fs ..... תֶּהֱוֵא
G imf 3 mp ..... לֶהֱוֹן
life ..... חַיִּין
needed thing ..... חַשְׁחָה
hand ..... יַד
give ..... יהב
Gt (passive) participle
ms .... מְתְיְהֵב
fs .... מִתְיַהֲבָא
overthrow (D) ..... מגר
D imf 3 ms ..... יְמַגַּר
property ..... נְכַס
expenses ..... נִפְקָה
do ..... עבד
Gt (passive) imf 3 ms יִתְעֲבֵד
people ..... עַם
sacrifice (H) ..... קרב
H participle mp .. מְהַקְרְבִין
change (D, H) ..... שנה
H (trans) imf 3 ms .. יְהַשְׁנֵא

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 6:6–12)

כְּעַן תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁתַר־בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן רַחִיקִין הֱוֹו מִן תַּמָּה.
שְׁבֻקוּ לַעֲבִידַת בֵּית אֱלָהָא וּמְנִי שֵׂים טְעֵם לִיהוּדָיֵא לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית אֱלָהָא וּמִנְכְסֵי
מַלְכָּא נִפְקָתָא תֶּהֱוֵא מִתְיַהֲבָא לְגֶבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי לָא לְבַטָּלָא. וּמָה חַשְׁחָן לֶאֱלָהּ
שְׁמַיָּא לֶהֱוֵא מִתְיְהֵב לְהֹם דִּי לֶהֱוֹן מְהַקְרְבִין לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וּמְצַלַּיִן לְחַיֵּי מַלְכָּא.
וּמְנִי שֵׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל אֱנָשׁ דִּי יְהַשְׁנֵא פִּתְגָמָא דְנָה וּבַיְתֵהּ נָוָלוּ יִתְעֲבֵד עַל דְּנָה.
וֵאלָהָא יְמַנַּר כָּל מֶלֶךְ וְעַם דִּי יִשְׁלַח יְדֵהּ לְחַבָּלָה בֵּית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם.
אֲנָא דָּרְיָוֶשׁ שָׂמֶת טְעֵם.

The phrase דִּי לָא לְבַטָּלָא (v. 8) literally means "in order not to stop (the work)," i.e., "not to stop."

EXERCISES

Find the Hebrew and English words that mean the same as each of the following Aramaic words. (Be careful—not all the Hebrew-Aramaic pairs are cognates.)

English translations: arm, big, come, do, document, dwell, give, go, god, go down, gold, go out, go up, heaven, it will be, known, land, lie (*noun*), many, memorandum, one, ox, peace, return, sacrifice, scribe, six, snow, son, summer, there is, this, to them, three, tree, two, weigh, we, work

Hebrew equivalents: אֶחָד, אֱלֹהִים, אֲנַחְנוּ, אֶרֶץ, בּוֹא, בֵּן, גָּדוֹל, הלך, הַסּוֹפֵר, זֶבַח, זֶה, זָהָב, זִכָּרוֹן, זֶרַע, יָדוּעַ, יִהְיֶה, יצא, יֶרֶד, יֵשׁ, יֹשֵׁב, כָּזָב, לָהֶם, נתן, סֵפֶר, עבד, עלה, עֵץ, עֶשֶׂה, קַיִץ, רַב, שׁוּב, שׁוֹר, שֶׁלֶג, שָׁלוֹם, שָׁלוֹשׁ, שָׁמַיִם, שְׁנַיִם, שֶׁקֶל, שֵׁשׁ

Hebrew equivalent		*English translation*
אזל		
אִיתַי		
אֱלָהַיָּא		
אֲנַחְנָה		

	Hebrew equivalent	*English translation*
אָע		
אַרְעָא		
אתה		
בַּר		
דְּבַח		
דְּהַב		
דְּכְרָן		
דְּנָה		
דְּרָע		
חַד		
יְדִיעַ		
יהב		
יתב		
כְּרְבָה		
לֶהֱוֵא		
לְהֹם		
נחת		
נפק		
סלק		
סְפַר		
סָפְרָא		

	Hebrew equivalent	*English translation*
עבד		
פלח		
קֵיט		
רַב		
שַׁגִּיא		
שְׁלָם		
שְׁמַיָּא		
שֵׁת		
תּוּב		
תּוֹר		
תְּלַג		
תְּלָת		
תְּקֵל		
תְּרֵי		

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The treasures are far from the dunghill.

(2) I wrote a letter to the scribes.

(3) He sent God's message to the city.

(4) The head of the province is a man.

(5) Leave everything there!

(6) They are praying to God to destroy the earth.

Chapter 11

INDEPENDENT PRONOUNS, אִ֫תִּי

In the Semitic languages, pronouns exist in several different forms. Some of these stand alone, while others are suffixes which can be attached to the end of words, including verbs, where they serve as direct objects, nouns, indicating possession, or prepositions, of which they are the object.

Aramaic's pronominal suffixes will be described in chapter 13. The independent forms look very much like their Hebrew equivalents, especially if one allows for the sound changes already described as characteristic of each language.

		Singular	*Plural*
1		אֲנָה	אֲנַחְנָה
2	masculine	אַנְתְּ (or אַנְתָּה)*	אַנְתּוּן (or אַנְתֻּם)
	feminine	אַנְתִּי	אַנְתֶּן
3	masculine	הוּא	הִמּוֹ (or הִמּוֹן or אִנּוּן)
	feminine	הִיא	אִנִּין

Although 2d person Hebrew pronouns do not have a נ where their Aramaic equivalents do, the *dagesh* in the ת indicates that there was once a נ which has now assimilated to the ת. (The *dagesh* in the Aramaic forms is *lene*, since these letters follow a now closed syllable.) Although the 2d person feminine singular pronoun (אַנְתִּי) may appear unfamiliar, its Hebrew equivalent (אַתִּי) can be found several places in the Hebrew Bible, albeit only as the כְּתִיב.** The ־ִי ending is also used to mark feminine forms of the Hebrew imperfect (תִּכְתְּבִי) and imperative (כִּתְבִי).

One of the differences between Hebrew and Aramaic has to do with the verb "to be." Although the root היה exists in both languages, neither one uses it in the present tense. For that, Hebrew uses noun sentences, in which there simply is no verb:

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* Most Bibles show a mixed form אַנְתָּה, which has the consonants (כְּתִיב) for אַנְתָּה and the vowels (קֶרִי) for אַנְתְּ.

** Cf. Judges 17:2, 1 Kings 14:2, 2 Kings 4:16,23, 8:1, Jeremiah 4:30, and Ezekiel 36:13.

דָּוִד מֶלֶךְ. David is king.
דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ. David is the king.

Aramaic accomplishes this differently—by using the 3d person pronouns as a copula:

כּוֹרֶשׁ הוּא מֶלֶךְ. Cyrus is king.
כּוֹרֶשׁ הוּא מַלְכָּא. Cyrus is the king.

The subject of such sentences need not be in the 3d person:

אֲנַחְנָא הִמּוֹ עַבְדּוֹהִי. We are his servants. (Ezra 5:11)
אַנְתְּ הוּא רֵאשָׁה דִּי דַהֲבָא. You are the head of gold. (Daniel 2:38)

This same construction also occurs in biblical Hebrew; for example:

אַתָּה הוּא מַלְכִּי. You are my king. (Psalm 44:5)

Sometimes Aramaic uses the particle אִיתַי to express the present tense of "to be." Like the Hebrew word יֵשׁ, to which it may be related,* אִיתַי normally means "there is":

אִיתַי אֱלָהּ בִּשְׁמַיָּא. There is a god in heaven. (Daniel 2:28)
לָא אִיתַי אֱלָהּ אָחֳרָן. There is no other god. (Daniel 3:29)

Also like יֵשׁ, אִיתַי is used with the preposition -לְ to indicate possession:

חֲלָק בַּעֲבַר־נַהֲרָא לָא אִיתַי לָךְ.
You (will) have no portion in Trans-Euphrates. (Ezra 4:16)

Notice that Aramaic uses לָא (= Hebrew לֹא) to negate אִיתַי, whereas in Hebrew an entirely separate word (אֵין) functions as the negative of יֵשׁ. Centuries after the Bible was written, לָא and אִיתַי merged into a single word— לֵית. Thus Targum Onkelos, an Aramaic translation of the Pentateuch, renders the Hebrew phrase וְלֶחֶם אֵין בְּכָל הָאָרֶץ (Genesis 47:13) as וְלַחְמָא לֵית בְּכָל אַרְעָא. The Masoretes used this same word, abbreviated as ל, to identify forms which occur only once in the Hebrew Bible. Examples can be seen in the marginal notes on almost any page of the *Biblia Hebraica* or in many editions of the rabbinic Bible (מִקְרָאוֹת גְּדוֹלוֹת).

* Note 2 Samuel 14:19 and Micah 6:10, where the word אֵשׁ may have the same meaning (and perhaps אִישׁ in Proverbs 18:24).

In addition to those functions, אִיתַי can also serve as a copula (present tense of "to be," i.e. "am, are, is"). This is clearest in those passages where it has a pronominal suffix (see chapter 13) and cannot, therefore, easily be rendered "there is/are":*

לֵאלָהָיִךְ לָא אִיתַינָא פָּלְחִין. We do not worship your god. (Daniel 3:18)

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned	*Reference*
exactly, diligently ..... אָסְפַּרְנָא	*plural construct of* בַּר ..... בְּנֵי
priest ..... כָּהֵן	exile ..... גָּלוּ
thus ..... כְּנֶמָא	joy ..... חֶדְוָה
writing ..... כְּתָב	dedication ..... חֲנֻכָּה
reign ..... מַלְכוּ	day ..... יוֹם
book ..... סְפַר	month ..... יַרְח
just as ..... (לָ)קֳבֵל	prophecy ..... נְבוּאָה
rest ..... שְׁאָר	succeed (H) ..... צלח
they completed ..... שַׁכְלְלוּ	*H participle mp* ... מַצְלְחִין
six ..... שֵׁת	establish (H) ..... קום
	H pf 3 mp ..... הֲקִימוּ
	he finished ..... שֵׁיצִיא

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 6:13–18)

אֱדַיִן תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁתַר־בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן לָקֳבֵל דִּי שְׁלַח דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כְּנֶמָא אָסְפַּרְנָא עֲבַדוּ. יְהוּדָיֵא בָּנַיִן וּמַצְלְחִין בִּנְבוּאַת חַגַּי וּזְכַרְיָה בַּר עִדּוֹ וְשַׁכְלְלוּ מִן טַעַם אֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִטְעֵם כּוֹרֶשׁ וְדָרְיָוֶשׁ וְאַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מַלְכֵּי פָּרָס וְשֵׁיצִיא בַּיְתָה דְנָה עַד יוֹם תְּלָתָה לִירַח אֲדָר דִּי הִיא שְׁנַת שֵׁת לְמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא. וַעֲבַדוּ בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא וּשְׁאָר בְּנֵי גָלוּתָה חֲנֻכַּת בֵּית אֱלָהָא דְנָה בְּחֶדְוָה. וַהֲקִימוּ כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא עַל עִבִידַת אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם כִּכְתָב סְפַר מֹשֶׁה.

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* Compare the Hebrew אִם יֵשְׁךָ מוֹשִׁיעַ — "if you will save" (Judges 6:36; cf. Genesis 24:42 and 49).

Proper Names

אֲדָר — Last month of the Hebrew calendar (late winter).

לֵוִיֵא — Ritual officials whose ancestry was traced back to Jacob's son Levi.

פָּרַס — Sixth-century empire founded by Cyrus II when he conquered Media, Lydia, and Babylon.

EXERCISES

Fill in the correct pronoun and translate into English:

(1) _____ דְּבַחְתְּ תּוֹר לֵאלָהָא.

(2) _____ יְדַע דִּי שָׁבְיָא בִּמְדִינְתָּא.

(3) _____ יְהַבְתֵּן סִפְרָא לְפֻחָה.

(4) _____ כְּתַבְתּוּן אִגְּרָה.

(5) _____ נְפַלוּ לְאַרְעָא.

(6) _____ נְפַקְנָא מִבַּיְתָא.

(7) _____ פִּלְחַת בִּירוּשְׁלֶם.

(8) _____ שָׁם טָעֵם.

(9) _____ שְׁלַחְתִּי פִּתְגָם לְבָבֶל.

(10) _____ יְדֵעַת לְמִבְנֵא בַּיִת.

(11) _____ סְלִקוּ לִשְׁמַיָּא.

(12) _____ שְׁלַחְנָא מְגִלָּה לְבֵית גִּנְזַיָּא.

Translate the following sentences into English:

(1) אִיתַי הֵיכַל בִּקְרִיְתָא רַבְתָּא.

(2) אַנְתּוּן הִמּוֹ כָּהֲנֵי אֱלָהָא דִי שְׁמַיָּא.

(3) בֵּית אֱלָהָא אִיתַי בִּירוּשְׁלֶם.

(4) לְגַבְרָא לָא אִיתַי רֵאשׁ.

(5) זְרֻבָּבֶל הוּא פֶּחָה דִי יְהוּדֵיא.

(6) כְּנֶמָא כְּתִיב בִּסְפַר דָּרְיָוֶשׁ: אֲנַחְנָא מְצַלִּין לְאַרְעָא.

(7) אַנְתְּ הוּא מֶלֶךְ שְׁלֶם.

(8) אֱדַיִן שַׂכְלְלוּ עֲבִידַת בַּיִת תַּקִּיף.

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The six men did exactly as the king said.

(2) We gave the rest of the kingdom to Darius.

(3) The decree is in writing.

(4) There is no palace in Judah.

(5) She is sending a book to the priest there.

Chapter 12

PREPOSITIONS

Some Aramaic prepositions are prefixed to an object; others can stand on their own:

Prefixed		*Independent*	
in	-בְּ	after	אֲחֲרֵי
like, as	-כְּ	between	בֵּין
to, for	-לְ	from	מִן
from	-מִ	until	עַד
		on, concerning, to, against	עַל
		with	עִם
		under	תְּחוֹת

Prefixed prepositions are vocalized according to the same patterns that are used in Hebrew. -ב, -כ, and -ל normally have a *sh'va*, which shifts to a *ḥiriq* (e.g., -בְּ) when the next consonant has a *sh'va*.

לְהֵיכְלָא to the palace
לְמְדִינְתָּא to the province

When מִן is attached to its object, the נ assimilates, where possible, to the first consonant of the following noun (e.g., מִטַּעֲם).

Several other prepositions are unique to Aramaic. Some of these obviously originated from nouns (like the Hebrew לִפְנֵי and בְּתוֹךְ):

בָּאתַר — From the noun אַתַר ("place"), the preposition means "after" (i.e. "in place of"). Because the א has no vowel, it can drop out, leaving בָּתַר (e.g., Daniel 2:39 on p. 87; for a later development of this form, see p. 153).

גַּו (when standing alone, it is spelled גּוֹא)—"Midst"; can be combined with other prepositions, such as -בְּ and -לְ to mean "inside (i.e. in the midst) of" or "into."

לָקֳבֵל (notice the composite *sh'va* under the ק, as explained on p. 19)—"Just as, opposite, corresponding to"; this preposition often occurs in the expanded form כָּל קֳבֵל דִּ- ("because").

קֳדָם — "In front of"; though literally spatial, it can also be used temporally (e.g., קַדְמָה, "former time"; cf. Hebrew לִפְנֵי, "to the face of").

Aramaic has a direct object marker just like the Hebrew אֵת. Its form is יָת. (The Phoenician equivalent is spelled איתּ.) Although it is common in later texts (see the synagogue inscription on p. 173 and the Targum Pseudo-Jonathan to Genesis 22:1–2 on pp. 198–200) as well as in Syriac and Nabatean, it occurs only once in the Bible (Daniel 3:12), where direct objects are more often indicated by the preposition -לְ:

e.g., הַרְגִּזוּ אֲבָהָתַנָא לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא
Our ancestors angered the God of heaven. (Ezra 5:12)*

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned		*Reference*	
judgment	דִּין	tax	בְּלוֹ
judge	דַּיָּן	search	בקר
law	דָּת	*D inf*	בַּקָּרָה
be	הוה/הוא	ram	דְּכַר
G imperfect 3 ms	לֶהֱוֵא	him/his	-ֵהּ
go	הלך	*1s suffix*	-ִי
G infinitive	מְהָךְ	bring	יבל
G imperfect 3 ms	יְהָךְ	*H inf*	הֵיבָלָה

* This same usage occurs occasionally in biblical Hebrew, e.g., זְכֹר לְאַבְרָהָם וּלְיִצְחָק וּלְיִשְׂרָאֵל ("Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel"—Exodus 32:13).

To Be Learned

know . . . . . ידע

H (inform) *ptc mp* . מְהוֹדְעִין

H imf 2 mp . . . . . תְּהוֹדְעוּן

be willing (D) . . . . . נדב

Dt ptc ms . . . . . מִתְנַדֵּב

people . . . . . עַם

ask . . . . . שׁאל

G imf 3 ms + 2 mp . יִשְׁאֲלֻנְכוֹן

(the נ is energic and need not be translated)

authorized . . . . . שַׁלִּיט

Reference

give . . . . . יהב

Gt ptc mp . . . . . מְתְיַהֲבִין

be pleasing . . . . . יטב

G imf 3 ms . . . . . יֵיטַב

you . . . . . דְּ

appoint (D) . . . . . מנה

imperative . . . . . מֲנִי

do . . . . . עבד

G inf . . . . . מֶעְבַּד

Gt imf 3 ms . . . . . יִתְעֲבֵד

G imf 2 mp . . . . . תַּעְבְּדוּן

buy . . . . . קנה

G imf 2 ms . . . . . תִּקְנֵה

sacrifice (D) . . . . . קרב

D imf 2 ms . . . . . תְּקָרֵב

impose (lit. throw) . . . . . רמה

G inf . . . . . לְמִרְמֵא

wish . . . . . רעו

deliver (H) . . . . . שׁלם

imperative . . . . . הַשְׁלֵם

FROM THE BIBLE (Ezra 7:12–26)

Ezra 6:19–7:11 is in Hebrew. After describing the celebration of the Passover by those who had returned from the exile and those "who had separated themselves from the impurity of the nations of the land," it announces the return of more exiles. Among them was Ezra, a priest and "scribe, expert in the Teaching of Moses," who presented a letter he had received from Artaxerxes, the text of which is given in Aramaic:

אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא מֶלֶךְ מַלְכַיָּא לְעֶזְרָא כָּהֲנָא סָפַר דָּתָא דִי אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא: מִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי
כָל מִתְנַדַּב בְּמַלְכוּתִי מִן עַמָּא יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכָהֲנוֹהִי וְלֵוָיֵא לְמֵהָךְ לִירוּשְׁלֶם עִמָּךְ יְהָךְ.
מִן קֳדָם מַלְכָּא שְׁלִיחַ לְבַקָּרָה עַל יְהוּד וְלִירוּשְׁלֶם בְּדָת אֱלָהָךְ וּלְהֵיבָלָה כְּסַף וּדְהַב
דִּי מַלְכָּא לֶאֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְכֹל כְּסַף וּדְהַב בְּכֹל מְדִינַת בָּבֶל
לְבֵית אֱלָהֲהֹם דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם. אָסְפַּרְנָא תִקְנָא בְּכַסְפָּא דְנָה דִכְרִין וּתְקָרֵב הִמּוֹ
בִּירוּשְׁלֶם. וּמָה דִי עֲלָךְ יֵיטַב בִּשְׁאַר כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָה לְמֶעְבַּד כִּרְעוּת אֱלָהֲכֹם
תַּעַבְדוּן. וּמָאנַיָּא דִי מְתִיהֲבִין לָךְ לְבֵית אֱלָהָךְ הַשְׁלֵם קֳדָם אֱלָהּ יְרוּשְׁלֶם. וּמִנִּי אֲנָה
אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא מַלְכָּא שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל דִּי יִשְׁאֲלִנְכוֹן עֶזְרָא כָּהֲנָא סָפַר דָּתָא דִי אֱלָהּ
שְׁמַיָּא אָסְפַּרְנָא יִתְעֲבַד. כָּל דִּי מִן טַעַם אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא יִתְעֲבַד לְבֵית אֱלָהּ
שְׁמַיָּא. וּלְכֹם מְהוֹדְעִין דִּי כָל כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא בְּלוֹ לָא שַׁלִּיט לְמִרְמֵא עֲלֵיהֹם.
וְאַנְתְּ עֶזְרָא כִּחְכְמַת אֱלָהָךְ מֵנִּי דַיְנִין לְכָל עַמָּא דִי בַּעֲבַר־נַהֲרָה לְכָל יָדְעֵי דָתֵי
אֱלָהָךְ וְדִי לָא יָדַע תְּהוֹדְעוּן. וְכָל דִּי לָא לֶהֱוֵא עָבֵד דָּתָא דִי אֱלָהָךְ וְדָתָא
דִּי מַלְכָּא אָסְפַּרְנָא דִינָה לֶהֱוֵא מִתְעֲבֵד מְנַהּ.

This concludes the Aramaic section of Ezra. You may wish to read the rest of the book either in Hebrew or in English translation.

EXERCISES

Translate the following sentences into English:

(1) הוּא שְׁאֵל עַל דַּת מַלְכָּא.

(2) עַמָּא דְנָה שַׁלִּיט לְהֵיבָלָא מָאנַיָּא מִן הֵיכְלָא.

(3) נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הֲוָה מֶלֶךְ בָּבֶל מִן עָלְמָא.

(4) מַן מְתַנַּדֵב לְמֶעְבַּד נָוָלוּ עַל אַרְעָא.

(5) אַנְתּוּן תְּהוֹדְעוּן לְדַיָּנָא דִּי לֶהֱוֹא מְרַד בְּמַדִינְתָּא.

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) We will go to Jerusalem with Ezra.

(2) The city will be built after they give tax to the king.

(3) The judgment was between the king and the people.

(4) They said: Leave the book in Babylon.

(5) The head was in the sky.

Chapter 13

Pronominal Suffixes

Besides independent pronouns, Aramaic also has pronominal suffixes, which can be attached to verbs (direct object), to nouns (possession), and to prepositions (object). Although the actual suffixes can vary, depending on the nature of the word to which they are attached, the various possibilities are all similar to each other and to the independent forms of the pronouns.

singular	1 common	אֲנָה	־י (on verbs ־נִי)
	2 masculine	אַנְתְּ	־ךְ
	2 feminine	אַנְתִּי	־כִי
	3 masculine	הוּא	־הּ (־הִי, ־וֹהִי)
	3 feminine	הִיא	־הּ
plural	1 common	אֲנַחְנָה	־נָא
	2 masculine	אַנְתּוּן (אַנְתֻּם)	־כֹם (־כוֹן)
	2 feminine	אַנְתֶּן	־כֶן
	3 masculine	הִמּוֹ (אִנּוּן)	־הֹם (־הוֹן)
	3 feminine	אִנִּין	־הֶן

Notice the resemblance between these suffixes and their Hebrew counterparts, which extends to the use of ת as a base for the 2d person independent pronouns while the suffixes have a כ (thus Hebrew אַתָּה and ־ךָ). The exact form of the suffixes depends on the number and gender of the noun to which they are attached.

SUFFIX	SINGULAR NOUNS *Masculine*	SINGULAR NOUNS *Feminine*	PLURAL NOUNS *Masculine*	PLURAL NOUNS *Feminine*
singular 1c	פִּשְׁרִי	מַלְכוּתִי	פִּשְׁרַי	מַלְכָוָתִי
2m	פִּשְׁרָךְ	מַלְכוּתָךְ	*פִּשְׁרָיִךְ	מַלְכָוָתָךְ
2f	פִּשְׁרֵכִי	מַלְכוּתֵכִי	פִּשְׁרֵיכִי	מַלְכָוָתֵכִי
3m	פִּשְׁרֵהּ	מַלְכוּתֵהּ	פִּשְׁרוֹהִי	מַלְכָוָתֵהּ
3f	פִּשְׁרַהּ	מַלְכוּתַהּ	*פִּשְׁרַיהּ	מַלְכָוָתַהּ
plural 1c	פִּשְׁרָנָא	מַלְכוּתָנָא	*פִּשְׁרַיְנָא	מַלְכָוָתָנָא
2m	פִּשְׁרְכֹם (-כוֹן)	מַלְכוּתְכֹם (-כוֹן)	פִּשְׁרֵיכֹם (-כוֹן)	מַלְכָוָתְכֹם (-כוֹן)
2f	פִּשְׁרְכֶן	מַלְכוּתְכֶן	פִּשְׁרֵיכֶן	מַלְכָוָתְכֶן
3m	פִּשְׁרְהֹם (-הוֹן)	מַלְכוּתְהֹם (-הוֹן)	פִּשְׁרֵיהֹם (-הוֹן)	מַלְכָוָתְהֹם (-הוֹן)
3f	פִּשְׁרְהֶן	מַלְכוּתְהֶן	פִּשְׁרֵיהֶן	מַלְכָוָתְהֶן

As in Hebrew, these suffixes are attached to a shortened form of the noun, such as -פִּשְׁר (which is the same base as that used for the determined suffix— פִּשְׁרָא), rather than the absolute פִּשַׁר. Sometimes, however, they are added to irregular forms of the words. This happens most often with words that refer to family members, such as אַב (אֲבָהָתָנָא, אֲבוּהִי), אַח (אֲחָיִךְ), and בַּר (בְּרֵהּ).

When these suffixes are attached to nouns, they express possession:

e.g., בֵּיתִי my house
אֱלָהֵהּ his god
חַבְרָתָהּ her companion

This can help explain an Aramaic phrase which is preserved in the New Testament:

μαραναθα = מָרַנָא תָּה "Our master, come!" (1 Corinthians 16:22)**

Pronominal suffixes can also appear on prepositions and on verbs. The prepositions -לְ, מִן, עִם, -בְּגַו, לְוָת, and לָקֳבֵל take the pronominal endings that go on singular nouns; others, such as עַל, אֲחֹרֵי, בֵּין, קֳדָם, and תְּחוֹת, take those for plural nouns.

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* These are really mixed forms. The ' (which is not pronounced) belongs to the כְּתִיב, where it would have been part of a diphthong (e.g., פִּשְׁרַיִךְ); cf. the 3rd person masculine singular suffix Hebrew uses for plural nouns, such as אֱלֹהָיו.

** Cf. Revelation 22:20.

singular	1	לִי	עֲלַי
	2 masculine	לָךְ	עֲלָיִךְ
	2 feminine	* לְכִי	* עֲלֵיכִי
	3 masculine	לֵהּ	עֲלוֹהִי
	3 feminine	לַהּ	עֲלֵיהּ
plural	1	לָנָא	עֲלֵינָא
	2 masculine	(לְכוֹן) לְכֹם	* עֲלֵיכֹם
	2 feminine	* לְכֵן	* עֲלֵיכֵן
	3 masculine	(לְהוֹן) לְהֹם	(עֲלֵיהוֹן) עֲלֵיהֹם
	3 feminine	* לְהֵן	* עֲלֵיהֵן

The suffixes for plural nouns are also used with the particle of existence (אִיתַי) and are then translated as the subject of a copula (see chapter 11):

לֵאלָהָיִךְ לָא אִיתַינָא פָּלְחִין We do not worship your god. (Daniel 3:18)

הַאִיתָיִךְ כָּהֵל לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי Are you able to inform me? (Daniel 2:26)

Pronominal suffixes commonly appear as direct objects of a verb. (This same structure occurs in Hebrew, although its pronominal suffixes can also be attached to אֶת in forms like אוֹתוֹ.) Because the exact form of the suffix (and the verbal base onto which it is attached) varies, it is not practical to try to memorize all possibilities. Here are some examples to demonstrate what such forms look like on one verb:

		Perfect	*Imperfect*
singular	1	הוֹדַעְתַּנִי	** יְהוֹדְעִנַּנִי
	2 masculine	הוֹדָעָךְ	_____
	3 masculine	_____	אֲהוֹדְעִנֵּהּ
plural	1	הוֹדַעְתָּנָא	_____

* These are hypothetical forms, which do not actually occur in the Bible.

** Note that the נ is doubled before the pronominal suffix.

When a noun is emphasized by being placed at the beginning of a sentence or clause, its place in the sentence proper is taken by a subsequent (resumptive) pronoun. This usage is called "casus pendens" (lit. "the hanging case") because the noun is technically neither the subject nor the object of the sentence.

e.g., בַּיְתָא דְנָה סַתְּרֵהּ This house—he destroyed it. (Ezra 5:12)

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

another . . . . . אָחֳרָן

tell (D, H) . . . . . חוה/חוא

D imperfect 1 p . . . . . נְחַוֵּא

D imf 3 ms + 3 fs . . . . . יְחַוִּנַּהּ

H imf 1 p . . . . . נְהַחֲוֵה

H imf 2 mp . . . . . תְּהַחֲוֹן

H imv mp + 1 s . . . . . הַחֲוֹנִי

H inf . . . . . לְהַחֲוָיָא

wise . . . . . חַכִּים

dream . . . . . חֶלֶם

therefore, except . . . . . לָהֵן

word, thing . . . . . מִלָּה

time . . . . . עִדָּן

answer . . . . . ענה

G pf 3 mp . . . . . עֲנוֹ

interpretation . . . . . פְּשַׁר

change (D) . . . . . שׁנה

Dt (passive) imperfect

3 ms . . . . . יִשְׁתַּנֵּה

Reference

kill (H) . . . . . אבד

H infinitive . . . . . הוֹבָדָה

say . . . . . אמר

G imf 3 ms . . . . . יֵאמַר

G imperative . . . . . אֱמַר

limb . . . . . הַדָּם

buy . . . . . זבן

inform (H) . . . . . ידע

H imf 2 mp . . . . . תְּהוֹדְעוּנַנִי

be able . . . . . יכל

difficult . . . . . יַקִּיר

glory . . . . . יְקָר

receive . . . . . קבל

D imf 2 mp . . . . . תְּקַבְּלוּן

be angry . . . . . קצף

issue . . . . . שִׂים

Gt (passive) imperfect

3 mp . . . . . יִתְשָׂמוּן

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 2:4–13)

The opening section of Daniel (1:1–2:4) is written in Hebrew. Read it in the original or in translation before beginning the Aramaic selection for this chapter.

מַלְכָּא אֱמַר חַלְמָא לְעַבְדָיִךְ וּפִשְׁרָא נְחַוֵא. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְכַשְׂדָּיֵא: הֵן לָא
תְהוֹדְעוּנַנִי חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ הַדְּמִין תִּתְעַבְדוּן וּבָתֵּיכוֹן נְוָלִי יִתְשָׂמוּן וְהֵן חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ
תְּהַחֲוֹן יְקָר שַׂגִיא תְּקַבְּלוּן מִן קֳדָמָי. לָהֵן חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ הַחֲוֹנִי. עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין:
מַלְכָּא חֶלְמָא יֵאמַר לְעַבְדוֹהִי וּפִשְׁרָה נְהַחֵוֵה. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר: יָדַע אֲנָה דִּי עִדָּנָא
אַנְתּוּן זָבְנִין עַד דִּי עִדָּנָא יִשְׁתַּנֵא. עֲנוֹ כַשְׂדָּיֵא קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְאָמְרִין: לָא אִיתַי אֱנָשׁ
דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא יוּכַל לְהַחֲוָיָה. כָּל מֶלֶךְ רַב מִלָּה כִדְנָה לָא שְׁאֵל לְכָל כַּשְׂדִּי וּמִלְּטָא
דִּי מַלְכָּה שָׁאֵל יַקִּירָה. וְאָחֳרָן לָא אִיתַי דִּי יְחַוֵנַּהּ קֳדָם מַלְכָּא לָהֵן אֱלָהִין.
מַלְכָּא קְצַף שַׂגִיא וַאֲמַר לְהוֹבָדָה לְכָל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל.

Proper Names

כַּשְׂדִּי — This term, which originally designated the inhabitants of a geographic region, came to mean "magician"; it is used with both meanings in the book of Daniel (cf. 5:11 and 30 on pp. 126 and 137). Although it is spelled with a שׂ here and throughout the book of Daniel, it occurs with ס (כַּסְדָּי) in Ezra 5:12 (see p. 38). Over time, שׂ tended to be replaced by ס, even in words where the former was historically correct. A similar process took place in post-biblical Hebrew; however, it is only beginnng to occur in the Bible (cf. Artaxerxes' name, which is spelled with a ס in Ezra 7:21; see p. 64).

Although the forms אָמַר and יָדַע look like Hebrew perfects, they are participles in Aramaic (compare the syntactically parallel עָנֵה); the perfect would be אֲמַר and יְדַע. אֱמַר is imperative.

EXERCISES

Translate:

אֲבוּךְ

אַחֲרֵיהֹון

אִיתַיכֹון

אִיתֹוהִי

אֱלָהִי

אֱלָהֵהּ

בְּתְרָךְ

בֵּינֵיהֹון

בַּיְתֵהּ

בְּרֵהּ

בְּנַוְהִי

הֵיכְלִי

יְתְהֹון

כְּהַנֹוהִי

עַבְדָיִךְ

עֲלַי

עֲלָיִךְ

עִמֵּהּ

לְקִבְלָךְ

קֳדָמֹוהִי

רֵאשְׁהֹון

שְׁמֵהּ

שְׁמָהָתְהֹם

תְּחֹתֹוהִי

תְּלָתְהֹון

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The king will be a servant in another time.

(2) The wise men answered the head of the province.

(3) The interpretation will change if the scribe goes out from the city.

(4) There is a word in my dream that I did not know.

(5) We will tell everything except the name of our god.

(6) His house is on a dunghill.

Chapter 14

Demonstrative, Relative, and Interrogative Pronouns

Besides the personal pronouns, there are demonstratives ("this, that," etc.), relatives (which, that), and interrogatives (who, what). In Hebrew, the singular forms of the demonstrative pronouns are built around the letter ז (זֶה, זֹאת); Aramaic uses ד:

		Singular	*Plural*
Near (this, these)	masculine	דְּנָה	אִלֵּין (also אֵל and אֵלֶּה)
	feminine	דָּא	
Far (that, those)	masculine	דֵּךְ	אִלֵּךְ
	feminine	דָּךְ	
masculine and feminine		דְּכֵן	

Third person pronouns can also be used as demonstratives:

הוּא צַלְמָא רֵאשֵׁהּ דִּי דְהַב
That statue—its head was of gold. (Daniel 2:32)

וּבְיוֹמֵיהוֹן דִּי מַלְכַיָּא אִנּוּן
And in the days of those kings (Daniel 2:44)

As in Hebrew, the demonstratives can function either as nouns, which stand on their own, or act like adjectives, in which case they usually follow the noun they modify (which must be determined):

בַּיְתָא דְנָה	this house (Ezra 5:3, 12, 6:15)
כֹּל דְּנָה יְדַעְתָּ	you know all of this (Daniel 5:22)
כִּדְנָה תֵּאמְרוּן לְהוֹם	thus ("like this") shall you say to them (Jeremiah 10:11)

We have already encountered the Aramaic relative pronoun דִּי ("which, that"). It is especially common after verbs of perception and communication, such as ידע, אמר, and שמע, and frequently introduces direct quotations. It can also express purpose or cause.

הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם the temple which is in Jerusalem (Ezra 5:14)

יָדַע אֱנָה דִּי עִדָּנָא אַנְתּוּן זָבְנִין I know that you are buying time. (Daniel 2:8)

עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי כָל אֱנָשׁ דִּי יִקְרֵה כְּתָבָה דְנָה
וּפִשְׁרֵהּ יְחַוִּנַנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא יִלְבַּשׁ

The king answers and says to the wise men of Babylon: "Any man who will read this writing and tell me its interpretation will wear purple." (Daniel 5:7)

אַנְתְּ כְּהֵל דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ

You are able because the spirit of the holy gods is in you. (Daniel 4:15)

שְׁמָהָתְהֹן שְׁאֵלְנָא . . . דִּי נִכְתֵּב שֵׁם גֻּבְרַיָּא דִּי בְרָאשֵׁהֹם

We asked their names so that we can write the names of the men who are at their head. (Ezra 5:10)

In addition to standing on its own, דִּי is often attached to various prepositions to form a relative phrase:

כְּדִי	when
מִן דִּי	after, because
כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי	inasmuch as, because
עַד דִּי	until

The interrogative pronouns are מַן ("who") and מָה ("what"). They can also be joined with the relative דִּי to form indefinite pronouns:

מַן דִּי	whoever
מָה דִּי	whatever

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

father . . . . . אַב

plural . . . . . אֲבָהָת

destroy (H) . . . . . אבד

H imf 3 mp . . . . . יְהוֹבְדוּן

H imf 2 ms . . . . . תְּהוֹבֵד

H infinitive . . . . . לְהוֹבָדָה

seek . . . . . בעה

G infinitive . . . . . לְמִבְעֵה

reveal . . . . . גלה

passive perfect 3 ms . . . . גְּלִי

time . . . . . זְמַן

wisdom . . . . . חָכְמָה

enter . . . . . עלל

G perfect 3 ms . . . . . עַל

H imv 3 ms . . . . . הַעֵל

thereupon . . . . . כָּל קֳבֵל דְּנָה

secret . . . . . רָז

praise (D) . . . . . שבח

D participle ms . . . . . מְשַׁבַּח

Reference

bless . . . . . ברך

D pass participle . . . מְבָרַךְ

power . . . . . גְּבוּרָה

companion . . . . . חֶבְר

tell (D, H) . . . . . חוה/חוא

D imf 1 s . . . . . אֲחַוֵא

H infinitive . . . . . לְהַחֲוָיָה

inform (H) . . . . . ידע

H perfect 3 ms . . . . . הוֹדַע

thus . . . . . כֵּן

appoint (D) . . . . . מנה

G perfect 3 ms . . . . . מַנִּי

deep . . . . . עַמִּיק

establish, raise up (H) . . . . קום

H participle ms . . . . מְהָקֵים

compassion . . . . . רַחֲמִין

change (H—transitive) . . . . שנה

H participle ms . . . . . מְהַשְׁנֵא

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 2:14–24)

בֵּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל בְּעָה מִן מַלְכָּא דִּי זְמָן יִנְתֵּן לֵהּ וּפִשְׁרָא לְהַחֲוָיָה לְמַלְכָּא. אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל לְבַיְתֵהּ אֲזַל וְלַחֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה חַבְרוֹהִי מִלְּתָא הוֹדַע וְרַחֲמִין לְמִבְעֵא מִן קֳדָם אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא עַל רָזָה דְּנָה דִּי לָא יְהוֹבְדוּן דָּנִיֵּאל וְחַבְרוֹהִי עִם חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל.

אֱדַיִן לְדָנִיֵּאל רָזָה גֱלִי. אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל בָּרֵךְ לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא. עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר.
לֶהֱוֵא שְׁמֵהּ דִּי אֱלָהָא מְבָרַךְ מִן עָלְמָא וְעַד עָלְמָא דִּי חָכְמְתָא וּגְבוּרְתָא דִּי לֵהּ הִיא
וְהוּא מְהַשְׁנֵא עִדָּנַיָּא וְזִמְנַיָּא. מְהָקִים מַלְכִין יְהֵב חָכְמְתָא לְחַכִּימִין. הוּא גָּלֵא
עַמִּיקָתָא. לָךְ אֱלָהִ אֲבָהָתִי מְשַׁבַּח אֲנָה דִּי חָכְמְתָא וּגְבוּרְתָא יְהַבְתְּ לִי וּכְעַן הוֹדַעְתַּנִי
דִּי בְעֵינָא מָנָךְ דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא הוֹדַעְתֶּנָא. כָּל קֳבֵל דְּנָה דָּנִיֵּאל עַל עַל אַרְיוֹךְ דִּי מַנִּי
מַלְכָּא לְהוֹבָדָה לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל. אֱזַל וְכֵן אֲמַר לֵהּ. לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל אַל תְּהוֹבֵד. הַעֱלֵנִי
קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וּפִשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא אֲחַוֵּא.

Proper Nouns

אַרְיוֹךְ — the captain of Nebuchadnezzar's guard.

דָּנִיֵּאל — a Jew who was taken to Babylon, where he served in the royal court, interpreting dreams and surviving great danger.

חֲנַנְיָה, מִישָׁאֵל, עֲזַרְיָה — young Judean exiles trained in the Babylonian court.

EXERCISES

Translate into English:

(1) יְדַעְנָא רָזָיָא אִלֵּין.

(2) מַן בְּנָה הֵיכְלָא דְּךְ?

(3) סָפְרָא כְּתַב דִּי חָכְמָה אָבְדָה מִבָּבֶל בִּזְמַן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר.

(4) דָּנִיֵּאל עַל לִשְׁמַיָּא.

(5) כָּל קֶבֶל דְּנָה גְּלִי דִי מְהָקִים מַלְכָּא רֵאשׁ פֻּחָה עַל קִרְיְתָא דָּא.

(6) אִיתַי אֱנַשׁ דִי בָּעֵה רַחֲמִין.

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) This father praises the law of God.

(2) I am authorized to seek that book in the treasure house.

(3) These provinces are under a strong king.

(4) They left that letter there.

(5) We are giving many vessels in the midst of the earth.

Chapter 15

G IMPERFECT

The verbal system of most Northwest Semitic languages has two major tenses (or aspects)—one formed by adding suffixes to the root (the perfect), while the other (the imperfect) adds prefixes, with suffixes used to indicate plurals. (By contrast, Akkadian, which is an East Semitic language, has two distinct prefix tenses—one for the past, and the other for future action.)

Having already examined Aramaic's perfect conjugation, we can now consider the imperfect. Although the vowels are somewhat different, the basic structure is the same as in Hebrew:

G Imperfect

	Singular	*Plural*
1st person	אֶכְתֹּב	נִכְתֹּב
2d masculine	תִּכְתֹּב	תִּכְתְּבוּן
feminine	תִּכְתְּבִין	תִּכְתֹּבָן
3d masculine	יִכְתֹּב	יִכְתְּבוּן
feminine	תִּכְתֹּב	יִכְתֹּבָן

As in Hebrew, the theme vowel (the one under the second root letter) is not fixed, but can vary from root to root. Although *u* is the most common theme vowel (as in the case of כתב above), it is not universal:

e.g.,	יִפֹּל	(root נפל)	he will fall
	יִנְתֵּן *	(root נתן)	he will give
	יִשְׁלַט	(root שלט)	he will rule
	יִלְבַּשׁ	(root לבשׁ)	he will wear

* Notice that the initial נ does not assimilate in this form as it does in the Hebrew equivalent (יִתֵּן) and, indeed, in the form יִפֹּל given above.

A very important exception to this pattern involves the verb הוה (to be), in which several third person forms begin with -ל:

לֶהֱוֵא	he will be
לֶהֱוֹן	they (m) will be
לֶהֱוֶין	they (f) will be

Thus:

אֱלָהּ רַב הוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא מָה דִי לֶהֱוֵא אַחֲרֵי דְנָה

The great God informed the king what will be after this. (Daniel 4:45)

The jussive appears to be the same as the imperfect, although final ן may fall off of some plural forms.

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

stone . . . . . אֶבֶן
break off . . . . . גזר
is broken off . . . . . הִתְגַּזַּר
be crushed . . . . . דקק
H perfect 3 ms . . . . . הַדֵּק
see . . . . . חזה
clay . . . . . חֶסֶף
mountain . . . . . טוּר
copper . . . . . נְחָשׁ
iron . . . . . פַּרְזֶל
statue . . . . . צְלֶם
foot . . . . . רֶגֶל

Reference

but . . . . . בְּרַם
exile . . . . . גָּלוּ
arm . . . . . דְּרָע
breast . . . . . חֲדֵה
inform (H) . . . . . ידע
H perfect 3 ms . . . . . הוֹדַע
H imperfect 3 mp . . יְהוֹדְעוּן
be able . . . . . יכל
thigh . . . . . יַרְכָה
be able . . . . . כהל
hit . . . . . מחא
belly . . . . . מְעֵה
enter . . . . . עלל
H perfect 3 ms . . . . . הַנְעֵל
find . . . . . שׁכח
H perfect 1 s . . . . . הַשְׁכַּחַת
leg . . . . . שָׁק

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 2:25–36)

אֱדַיִן אַרְיוֹךְ הַנְעֵל לְדָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְכֵן אֲמַר לֵהּ: הַשְׁכַּחַת גֻּבַר מִן בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא
דִּי יְהוּד דִּי פִּשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדַע. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל דִּי שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר:
הַאִיתָיִךְ כָּהֵל לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי חֶלְמָא דִּי חֲזֵית וּפִשְׁרֵהּ? עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר:
רָזָה דִּי מַלְכָּא שָׁאֵל לָא חַכִּימִין אָשְׁפִין חַרְטֻמִּין גְּזָרִין יָכְלִין לְהַחֲוָיָה לְמַלְכָּא בְּרַם אִיתַי אֱלָהּ בִּשְׁמַיָּא
גָּלֵא רָזִין וְהוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא. וַאֲנָה לָא בְחָכְמָה דִּי אִיתַי בִּי
רָזָא דְנָה גֶּלִי לִי לָהֵן דִּי פִּשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדְעוּן. אַנְתְּ מַלְכָּא חָזֵה הֲוַיְתָ צְלֵם
חַד שַׂגִּיא. צַלְמָא דֵכֵן רַב. הוּא צַלְמָא — רֵאשֵׁהּ דִּי דְהַב טָב חֲדוֹהִי וּדְרָעוֹהִי
דִּי כְסַף מְעוֹהִי וְיַרְכָתֵהּ דִּי נְחָשׁ שָׁקוֹהִי דִּי פַּרְזֶל רַגְלוֹהִי מִנְהֶן דִּי פַּרְזֶל וּמִנְּהֶן
דִּי חֲסַף. חָזֵה הֲוַיְתָ עַד דִּי הִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן דִּי לָא בִידַיִן וּמְחָת לְצַלְמָא עַל רַגְלוֹהִי
דִּי פַּרְזְלָא וְחַסְפָּא וְהַדֶּקֶת הִמּוֹן. בֵּאדַיִן דֻּקוּ כַחֲדָה פַּרְזְלָא חַסְפָּא נְחָשָׁא כַּסְפָּא
וְדַהֲבָא. וַאֲבָנָא דִּי מְחָת לְצַלְמָא הֲוָת לְטוּר רַב. דְּנָה חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ נֵאמַר
קֳדָם מַלְכָּא.

EXERCISES

Conjugate the following verbs in the G imperfect:

		סגד	שׁבק
singular	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		
plural	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		

		שׁלט	נפל
singular	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		
plural	1		
	2 m		
	2 f		
	3 m		
	3 f		

Identify the form of the following imperfect verbs:

	Root	Person	Gender	Number
תֵּאכֶל				
נֵאמַר				
אֶבְעֵא				
תֶּהֱוֵא				
לֶהֱוֹן				
נִכְתֹּב				
תַּעַבְדוּן				
יִפְלְחוּן				
אֶקְרָא				

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) I will write a letter on a stone from the mountain.

(2) She will send a message to the scribe.

(3) He broke the foot and the head off of the statue.

(4) That man sees vessels of clay which Daniel smashed.

(5) There is iron under the earth.

(6) We will ask to build a palace there.

(7) The Judeans left copper in Babylon.

Chapter 16

Adjectives and Genitive Constructions (דִּי)

Aramaic adjectives behave very much like nouns—they have number and gender, and can be determined or undetermined. Moreover, their endings are exactly the same as those for nouns.

		Masculine	*Feminine*
singular	absolute	רַחִיק	רַחִיקָה
	determined	רַחִיקָא	רַחִיקְתָא
plural	absolute	רַחִיקִין	רַחִיקָן
	determined	רַחִיקַיָּא*	רַחִיקָתָא

In general, adjectives must agree with the noun that they modify in number, gender, and determination; however, predicate adjectives are always undetermined.

Another way in which Aramaic expresses description is with nouns. This is done by using genitival constructions, such as construct phrases in which two nouns are joined together:

שֵׁם אֱלָהָא the name of God

As in Hebrew, these word pairs are treated as if they were one word. Therefore, the first word loses its accent.

Another way of expressing genitival relationships is with the conjunction דִּי ("which, of"):

שֵׁם דִּי אֱלָהָא the name of God

* The ending for plural determined gentilics is יָּא-.

Later on, Aramaic inserted a pronominal suffix (see chapter 13), which anticipates the genitive word, into this construction:

שְׁמֵהּ דִּי אֱלָהָא	His name, the one of God
	i.e., the name of God

This construction eventually became almost normative in both Hebrew and Aramaic. However, it was still relatively uncommon in the biblical period, although it does sometimes occur (e.g., הֵנָּה מִטָּתֹו שְׁלִשְׁלֹמֹה— "Behold, the bed of Solomon," Song of Songs 3:7).

Genitival constructions are not limited to possession. They can also indicate the composition of an object or what it is attached to:

שְׁבִבִין דִּי נוּר	flames of fire (Daniel 7:9)
צְלֶם דִּי דְהַב	statue of gold (Daniel 3:1)
אֶצְבְּעָן דִּי יַד אֱנָשׁ	fingers of a human hand,
	i.e., human fingers (Daniel 5:5)

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

another . . . . . אָחֳרִי

field . . . . . בַּר

dwell . . . . . דּוּר

G participle mp . . . . . דָּאְרִין

animal . . . . . חֵיוָה

be able . . . . . יכל

fall . . . . . נפל

bow down . . . . . סגד

fourth . . . . . רְבִיעָי

rule . . . . . שׁלט

third . . . . . תְּלִיתָי

Reference

after . . . . . אַחֲרֵי

face (*p*) . . . . . אֲנַף

finger . . . . . אֶצְבַּע

after (lit. "in place of") . . . בָּתַר

reveal . . . . . גלה

G infinitive . . . . . לְמִגְלֵא

smash (H) . . . . . דקק

H participle ms . . . . מְהַדֵּק

destroy (D) . . . . . חבל

Dt (passive) imf 3 fs תִּתְחַבַּל

inform (H) . . . . . ידע

H imf 3 ms . . . . . הוֹדַע

day . . . . . יוֹם

bird . . . . . עוֹף

divided . . . . . פְּלִיגָה

rise . . . . . קום

H imf 3 ms . . . . . יְקִים

foot . . . . . רַגְל

leave, abandon . . . . . שׁבק

Gt (passive) imf 2 fs תִּשְׁתְּבֵק

breakable . . . . . תְּבִיר

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 2:37–49)

אַנְתְּ מַלְכָּא מֶלֶךְ מַלְכַיָּא דִּי אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא מַלְכוּתָא יְהַב לָךְ וּבְכָל דִּי דָאְרִין בְּנֵי אֲנָשָׁא
חֵיוַת בָּרָא וְעוֹף שְׁמַיָּא יְהַב בִּידָךְ וְהַשְׁלְטָךְ בְּכָלְהֹן. אַנְתְּ הוּא רֵאשָׁה דִּי דַהֲבָא.
וּבָתְרָךְ תְּקוּם מַלְכוּ אָחֳרִי אַרְעָא מִנָּךְ וּמַלְכוּ תְלִיתָיָא אָחֳרִי דִּי נְחָשָׁא דִּי תִשְׁלַט בְּכָל
אַרְעָא. וּמַלְכוּ רְבִיעָיָה תֶּהֱוֵא תַקִּיפָה כְּפַרְזְלָא מְהַדֵּק כֹּלָּא. וְדִי חֲזַיְתָה רַגְלַיָּא
וְאֶצְבְּעָתָא מִנְּהֶן חֲסַף מִן פַּרְזֶל מַלְכוּ פְלִיגָה תֶּהֱוֵה וְאֶצְבְּעָת רַגְלַיָּא מִנְּהֶן פַּרְזֶל
וּמִנְּהֶן חֲסַף מִן מַלְכוּתָא תֶּהֱוֵא תַקִּיפָה וּמִנַּהּ תֶּהֱוֵה תְּבִירָה. וּבְיוֹמֵיהוֹן דִּי מַלְכַיָּא אִנּוּן
יְקִים אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא מַלְכוּ דִּי לְעָלְמִין לָא תִתְחַבַּל וּמַלְכוּתָהּ לְעַם אָחֳרָן לָא תִשְׁתְּבֵק
וְהִיא תְקוּם לְעָלְמַיָּא. כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי חֲזַיְתָ דִּי מִטּוּרָא אִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן דִּי לָא בִידַיִן
וְהַדֶּקֶת פַּרְזְלָא נְחָשָׁא חַסְפָּא כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא. אֱלָהּ רַב הוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא
אַחֲרֵי דְנָה. בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר נְפַל עַל אַנְפּוֹהִי וּלְדָנִיֵּאל סְגֵד. עֲנֵה מַלְכָּא
לְדָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר. אֱלָהֲכוֹן הוּא אֱלָהּ אֱלָהִין וְגָלֵה רָזִין דִּי יְכֵלְתְּ לְמִגְלֵא רָזָה דְנָה.
אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא הַשְׁלְטֵהּ עַל כָּל מְדִינַת בָּבֶל וְעַל כָּל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל.

EXERCISES

Translate into English:

(1) אֲנַחְנָא דָּאְרִין בְּבַיִת דִּי דְהַב.

(2) יִשְׁלַט מַלְכָּא עַל מְדִינַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָא.

(3) חַגֵּי הַדֶּק חֵיוָה תַּקִּיפָה.

(4) אֱנָשׁ רְבִיעָי אֱזַל.

(5) הִמּוֹ יִסְגְּדוּן לְרֵאשֵׁה דִּי צַלְמָא.

(6) אִיתַי אֶצְבְּעָן שַׁגִּיאָן עַל יַד דַּרְיָוֶשׁ.

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The interpretation of the fourth decree is written in the temple.

(2) They fall from their feet and they pray to God.

(3) We went out to the distant field.

(4) The wise scribe came with a third message.

(5) We were able to build another house.

Chapter 17

NUMBERS

We have already encountered several Aramaic numerals which are etymologically related to their Hebrew equivalents. Thus "1" is חַד, which is only lacking the initial א of its Hebrew cognate אֶחָד. "3" and "6" are תְּלָת and שֵׁת, reflecting the Aramaic realization of Semitic *th* as ת, where Hebrew uses שׁ (hence שָׁלוֹשׁ and שִׁשׁ).

As in Hebrew, Aramaic numerals, which can appear either before or after the nouns to which they refer, have both masculine and feminine forms.

	Masculine	*Feminine*
1	חַד	חֲדָה
2	תְּרֵין (תְּרֵי)	תַּרְתֵּין (תַּרְתֵּי)
3	תְּלָתָה	תְּלָת
4	אַרְבְּעָה	אַרְבַּע
5	חַמְשָׁא	חֲמֵשׁ
6	שְׁתָּה	שֵׁת (or שְׁת)
7	שְׁבְעָה	שְׁבַע
8	תְּמָנְיָה	תְּמָנֵה
9	תִּשְׁעָה	תְּשַׁע
10	עַשְׂרָה	עֲשַׂר

As in Hebrew, except for "1," the simpler form is used with feminine nouns, whereas the form ending with ה־ is used with masculine nouns:

e.g.,	גֻּבְרִין אַרְבְּעָא	4 men (Daniel 3:25)
	אַמִּין שֵׁת	6 cubits (Daniel 3:1)

The number "2" has a construct form (תְּרֵי), which is used in the phrase for "12" (תְּרֵי־עֲשַׂר).

The decades between ten and one hundred are based on plural forms of the digits; thus twenty is עֶשְׂרִין, thirty is תְּלָתִין, and so on. Larger numbers include מְאָה (100), אֶלֶף (1,000) and רִבּוֹ (10,000). (Recall that 200 is מָאתַיִן, as noted on p. 27.)

As the determined state became the "normal" form for nouns in later Aramaic, the language had to develop another way to indicate whether a word was determined or not. To do this, the numeral "one" (חַד) was used as a marker of *in*determinacy. Intimations of this practice can be found in the Bible:

צְלֶם חַד	an image (Daniel 2:31)
מְגִלָּה חֲדָה	a scroll (Ezra 6:2)

חַד is also used to indicate multiples:

חַד שִׁבְעָה	seven times more than. . . . (Daniel 3:19)

Ordinal numbers (except for "2") end with י־:

first	קַדְמָי
second	תִּנְיָן *
third	תְּלִיתָי
fourth	רְבִיעָי

*This form is much closer to the Hebrew שֵׁנִי than is the cardinal form תְּרֵין.

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

furnace . . . . . אַתּוּן

music . . . . . זְמָר

type . . . . . זַן

burn . . . . . יקד

fire . . . . . נוּר

worship . . . . . פלח

sound . . . . . קָל

horn . . . . . קֶרֶן

throw . . . . . רמה

Gt imf 3 ms . . . . . יִתְרְמֵא

hear . . . . . שׁמע

Reference

live (G) . . . . . חיה

strength . . . . . חַיִל

dedication . . . . . חֲנֻכָּה

when . . . . . כְּדִי

gather . . . . . כנשׁ

G infinitive . . . . . לְמִכְנָשׁ

Dt participle mp . . מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין

herald . . . . . כָּרוֹז

prefect . . . . . סְגַן

rise . . . . . קוּם

G participle mp . . . . קָאֲמִין

H perfect 3 ms . . . . הֲקִים

call . . . . . קרא

approach . . . . . קרב

pay attention . . . . . שִׂים טְעֵם

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 3:1–12)

נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד צְלֶם דִּי דְהַב וּשְׁלַח לְמִכְנַשׁ לְסַגְנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא לַחֲנַכַת צַלְמָא דִּי
הֲקִים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא. בֵּאדַיִן מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין סִגְנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא לַחֲנֻכַת צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקִים
נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא וְקָאֲמִין לָקֳבֵל צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקִים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְכָרוֹזָא קָרֵא בְּחָיִל:
לְכוֹן אָמְרִין עַמְמַיָּא: בְּעִדָּנָא דִּי תִשְׁמְעוּן קָל קַרְנָא וְכָל זְנֵי זְמָרָא תִּפְלוֹן וְתִסְגְּדוּן
לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקִים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא וּמַן דִּי לָא יִפֵּל וְיִסְגֻּד יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא אַתּוּן
נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא. כָּל קֳבֵל דְּנָה בְּהּ זִמְנָא כְּדִי שָׁמְעִין כָּל עַמְמַיָּא קָל קַרְנָא וְכָל זְנֵי
זְמָרָא נָפְלִין כָּל עַמְמַיָּא סָגְדִין לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקִים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא. כָּל קֳבֵל
דְּנָה בְּהּ זִמְנָא קְרִבוּ גֻּבְרִין כַּשְׂדָּאִין. עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין לְנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא: מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין
חֱיִי. אַנְתְּ מַלְכָּא שַׂמְתָּ טְעֵם דִּי כָל אֱנָשׁ דִּי יִשְׁמַע קָל קַרְנָא וְכָל זְנֵי זְמָרָא יִפֵּל וְיִסְגֻּד
לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא וּמַן דִּי לָא יִפֵּל וְיִסְגֻּד יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא. אִיתַי גֻּבְרִין
יְהוּדָאִין שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ. גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ לָא שָׂמוּ עֲלָיךְ מַלְכָּא טְעֵם. לֵאלָהָיךְ
לָא פָלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקִימְתָּ לָא סָגְדִין.

Proper Nouns

שַׁדְרַךְ, מֵישַׁךְ, עֲבֵד־נְגוֹ — Names given to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah by Babylonian officials

EXERCISES

How many different pairs of numbers can you list that add up to 10?

_____ + _____ _____ + _____

_____ + _____ _____ + _____

_____ + _____

Fill in the blank with the correct Aramaic numbers:

$4 + 5 =$ _____ $10^3 =$ _____

$7 -$ _____ $= 6$ $2 +$ _____ $= 5$

$8 \div 4 =$ _____ $20 \times 10 =$ _____

$20 \div$ _____ $= 2$ $4 + 2 =$ _____

$8 - 3 =$ _____ $3^2 =$ _____

$1 + 2 =$ _____ $56 \div 8 =$ _____

$2 \times 3 =$ _____ $10 - 2 =$ _____

$8 \div 2 =$ _____ $60 + 40 =$ _____

_____ $+ 1 = 6$ $17 \div 17 =$ _____

$11 - 9 =$ _____ $24 -$ _____ $= 16$

$7 + 0 =$ _____ $19{,}286 +$ _____ $= 29{,}286$

_____ $- 4 = 2$ $10 \times 2 =$ _____

$17 -$ _____ $= 13$ $6 + 6$ _____

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The first man is the head of the province.

(2) We pray to the God of heaven.

(3) Five secrets were in the dream.

(4) The sound went out from Babylon like a fire.

(5) They will worship a statue of iron.

(6) There are 10,000 books burning in the palace.

(7) One horn is thrown into the furnace.

(8) They heard four kinds of music.

Chapter 18

G Imperative and Infinitive

As in Hebrew, Aramaic imperatives are based on the corresponding imperfect forms, from which the (pronominal) prefix has been removed and some necessary adjustments made for shifting vowels. The resulting forms are:

	Singular	*Plural*
masculine	כְּתֻב	כְּתֻבוּ
feminine	כְּתֻבִי	כְּתֻבָה

Technically, the forms derive from the jussive, which is very much like the imperfect except without the final ן on plural forms. It is, therefore, understandable, that negative commands are expressed by the full jussive along with אַל:

חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵא אַל יְבַהֲלָךְ

Don't let the dream and interpretation frighten you. (Daniel 4:16)

That leaves only one G form which has not yet been described—the infinitive. It is characterized by a prefixed -מ:

מִכְתַּב

The infinitive frequently appears with the preposition -ל and sometimes with the negative לָא to express a prohibition (see the inscription on p. 172).

Interestingly, the infinitive of the verb בנה ("build") occurs with both a prefixed -לְ (לִבְנָא in Ezra 5:3, 13) and, sometimes, an additional מ (לְמִבְנֵא in Ezra 5:2, 6:8). This form is expanded still further in one passage by the addition of a feminine (or perhaps determinative) ending: לְמִבְנְיָה (Ezra 5:9).

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

heat . . . . . אזה

G infinitive . . . . . לְמֶזֵא

pass ptc . . . . . אֱזֵה

come . . . . . אתה

H (bring) *passive*

perfect 3 mp . . . . . הֵיתָיוּ

H infinitive . . . . . לְהַיְתָיָה

need . . . . . חשח

hand . . . . . יַד

very, excellent . . . . . יַתִּיר

bind (D) . . . . . כפת

D infinitive . . . . . לְכַפָּתָה

D pass ptc mp . . . . . מְכַפְּתִין

ready . . . . . עֲתִיד

kill (D) . . . . . קטל

he saves . . . . . יְשֵׁיזֵב

imf 3ms + 2 mp . . . יְשֵׁיזְבִנְכוֹן

infinitive + 1 p . . . לְשֵׁיזְבוּתָנָא

hour . . . . . שָׁעָה

Reference

see . . . . . חזה

G pass ptc (“proper”) . חֲזֵה

urgent . . . . . מַחְצְפָה

because . . . . . מִן דִּי

go up . . . . . סלק

H pf 3 mp (sacrifice) . הַסְקוּ

true . . . . . צְדָא

rise . . . . . קוּם

H perfect 1 s . . . . . הֲקִימֵת

anger . . . . . רְגַז

throw . . . . . רמה

Gt imperfect 2 mp . תִּתְרְמוֹן

seven . . . . . שִׁבְעָה

seven times . . . . חַד שִׁבְעָה

reply (H) . . . . . תוּב

H infinitive + 2 ms לְהַתָּבוּתָךְ

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 3:13–23)

בֵּאדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר בְּרֻגְז וְאָמַר לְהַיְתָיָה לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ. בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ
הֵיתָיוּ קֳדָם מַלְכָּא. עָנֵה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְאָמַר לְהוֹן: הַצְדָא שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ
לֵאלָהַי לָא אִיתֵיכוֹן פָּלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקִימֵת לָא סָגְדִין? כְּעַן הֵן אִיתֵיכוֹן
עֲתִידִין דִּי בְּעִדָּנָא דִּי תִשְׁמְעוּן קָל קַרְנָא וְכָל זְנֵי זְמָרָא תִּפְּלוּן וְתִסְגְּדוּן לְצַלְמָא דִּי
עֲבֵדֵת וְהֵן לָא תִסְגְּדוּן בַּהּ שַׁעֲתָה תִּתְרְמוֹן לְגוֹא אַתוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא. וּמַן הוּא אֱלָהּ דִּי

יְשֵׁיזִבְנְכוֹן מִן יְדֵי. עֲנוֹ שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֶד־נְגוֹ וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא: נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לָא חַשְׁחִין אֲנַחְנָה עַל דְּנָה פִּתְגָם לַהֲתָבוּתָךְ. הֵן אִיתַי אֱלָהֲנָא דִּי אֲנַחְנָא פָּלְחִין יָכֵל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתָנָא מִן אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא וּמִן יְדָךְ מַלְכָּא יְשֵׁיזֵב וְהֵן לָא יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לָךְ מַלְכָּא דִּי לֶאֱלָהָיִךְ לָא אִיתַינָא פָּלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקִימְתָּ לָא נִסְגֻּד. בֵּאדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר עָנֶה וְאָמַר לְמֵזָא לְאַתּוּנָא חַד שִׁבְעָה עַל דִּי חֱזֵה לְמֵזֵהּ וּלְכַפְתָּה לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֶד־נְגוֹ לְמַרְמֵא לְאַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא. כְּל קֳבֵל דְּנָה מִן דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא מַחְצְפָה וְאַתּוּנָא אֵזֵה יַתִּירָא גְּבַרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי הַסְקוּ לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֶד־נְגוֹ קַטֵּל הַמּוֹן נוּרָא. וְגֻבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ תְּלָתֶהוֹן שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֶד־נְגוֹ נְפַלוּ לְגוֹא אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא מְכַפְּתִין.

NOTE that 3d person plural verbs are often used indefinitely ("they . . ."); in such cases, they are often best translated into English with passive verbs. For example, גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הֵיתָיוּ literally means "they [indefinite] brought those men," but is better rendered, "those men were brought."

EXERCISES

Fill in the complete conjugation of the verb כתב:

	Perfect	*Imperfect*		*Participles*		*Imperative*
				Active	*Passive*	
1 cs						
2 ms			ms			
2 fs			fs			
3 ms						
3 fs			mp			
			fp			
1 cp						
2 mp						
2 fp			*Infinitive:*			
3 mp						
3 fp						

What form are the following verbs?

	Root	*Form*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*	*Meaning*
מֶעְבַּד						
שְׁבֶקוּ						
מֶחֱזֵא						
אֲכֶלִי						
מִגְלֵא						
אֱמַר						
מִבְנֵא						
מִכְנַשׁ						
מִבְעֵא						
מִקְרֵא						
מִפְשַׁר						

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) Do not kill these strong men.

(2) God is ready to make a place in the heavens.

(3) The hand will write a very good letter.

(4) The king needs to burn this city with fire.

(5) Hear the sound of music in the distant field.

(6) They brought the bound scribe to a dunghill.

(7) The people will save many treasures.

Chapter 19

D Conjugation

The second major conjugation in Aramaic is called D because the middle letter of the root is *doubled.* (It is also known as *paʿʿel.*) As in the Hebrew *piʿel,* a *dagesh* is used to indicate the doubled letter. Also as in Hebrew, the first root letter of Aramaic verbs in the D conjugation always has a vowel. (This is not true of G forms, such as כְּתַבוּ.) These two features are related: since the first of the two letters indicated by the *dagesh* always has a *sh'va,* it must be preceded by a vowel.

In other regards, the prefixes and suffixes are the same in the D as in the G conjugation:

		Perfect	*Imperfect*
Singular	1	קַבֶּלֶת	אֲקַבֵּל
	2 masculine	קַבֶּלְתָּ	תְּקַבֵּל
	2 feminine	קַבֶּלְתִּי	תְּקַבְּלִין
	3 masculine	קַבֶּל	יְקַבֵּל
	3 feminine	קַבְּלַת	תְּקַבֵּל
Plural	1	קַבֶּלְנָא	נְקַבֵּל
	2 masculine	קַבְּלְתּוּן	תְּקַבְּלוּן
	2 feminine	קַבְּלְתֶּן	תְּקַבְּלָן
	3 masculine	קַבְּלוּ	יְקַבְּלוּן
	3 feminine	קַבְּלָה	יְקַבְּלָן

If the second consonant is a guttural and cannot, therefore, be doubled (i.e. take a *dagesh*), the preceding vowel is usually lengthened:

e.g., בָּרְכֵת perfect, 1 singular

בָּרֵךְ perfect, 3 masculine singular

As one would expect, imperative forms correspond to those for the second person imperfect, without the prefixed -תְּ:

D Imperative

	Masculine	*Feminine*
Singular	קַבֵּל	קַבְּלִי
Plural	קַבְּלוּ	קַבֵּלָה

Finally, the participle and infinitive forms follow patterns which, as we shall see, are typical of all the derived (non-G) conjugations: participles begin with -מְ, and infinitives end with the suffix -ָה:

D Participle

	Masculine	*Feminine*
Singular	מְקַבֵּל	מְקַבֶּלָה
Plural	מְקַבְּלִין	מְקַבְּלָן

D Infinitive קַבָּלָה

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned		*Reference*	
four	אַרְבַּע	sign	אָת
body	גֶּשֶׁם	bless (D)	ברך
generation	דָּר	resemble	דמה
damage	חֶבֶל	behold	הָא
surely	יַצִּיב	is it not *(interrogative)*	הֲלָא
how	כְּמָה	scorch	חרך
grow great (G)	שְׂגָא	*Dt (passive) pf 3 ms*	הִתְחָרַךְ

Reference

angel . . . . . מַלְאָךְ

make, do . . . . . עבד

Gt (pass) imperfect

3ms . . . . . יִתְעֲבֵד

go out . . . . . נפק

imperative mp . . . . . פֻּקוּ

cause to prosper (H) . . . . . צלח

blasphemy . . . . . שְׁלָה

three . . . . . תְּלָת

To Be Learned

hair . . . . . שְׂעַר

dominion . . . . . שָׁלְטָן

loosen . . . . . שרה

pass participle mp . . . . שְׁרַיִן

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 3:24–33)

אֱדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא קָם עָנֵה וְאָמַר: הֲלָא גֻבְרִין תְּלָתָא רְמֵינָא לְגוֹא נוּרָא מְכַפְּתִין?
עָנִין וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא: יַצִּיבָא מַלְכָּא. עָנֵה וְאָמַר: הָא אֲנָה חָזֵה גֻּבְרִין אַרְבְּעָה שְׁרַיִן
מַהְלְכִין בְּגוֹא נוּרָא וַחֲבָל לָא אִיתַי בְּהוֹן וּרְבִיעָיָא דְמֵה לְבַר אֱלָהִין. בֵּאדַיִן קְרֵב
נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לְאַתּוּן נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא עָנֵה וְאָמַר: שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ עַבְדוֹהִי דִּי אֱלָהָא
פֻּקוּ וְאֵתוֹ. בֵּאדַיִן נָפְקִין שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ מִן גּוֹא נוּרָא. לָא שְׁלֵט נוּרָא
בְּגֶשְׁמְהוֹן וּשְׂעַר רֵאשְׁהוֹן לָא הִתְחָרַךְ. עָנֵה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְאָמַר: בְּרִיךְ אֱלָהֲהוֹן דִּי
שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ דִּי שְׁלַח מַלְאֲכֵהּ וְשֵׁיזַב לְעַבְדוֹהִי דִּי יְהַבוּ גֶּשְׁמְהוֹן דִּי לָא
יִפְלְחוּן וְלָא יִסְגְּדוּן לְכָל אֱלָהּ לָהֵן לֵאלָהֲהוֹן. וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל עַם דִּי יֵאמַר
שְׁלָה עַל אֱלָהֲהוֹן דִּי שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ בֵּיתֵהּ נְוָלִי יִתְעֲבֵד כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי לָא אִיתַי
אֱלָהּ אָחֳרָן כִּדְנָה. בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא הַצְלַח לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ בִּמְדִינַת בָּבֶל.
נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא לְכָל עַמְמַיָּא דִּי דָאֲרִין בְּכָל אַרְעָא: שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא. אָתַיָּא דִּי
עֲבַד עִמִּי אֱלָהָא כְּמָה תַקִּיפִין. מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עִם דָּר וְדָר.

EXERCISES

Identify the form of the following verbs which appear in the Bible in the D conjugation:

	Root	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מְמַלֵּל					
בַּטְּלוּ					
יְטַעֲמוּן					
שַׁבְּחֵת					
מְהַדַּר					
חַבְּלוּ					
לְנַסָּכָה					
הַדְּרֵת					
חַבָּלָה					
יְבַקֵּר					
מְמַלֶּלָא					
מְהַלֵּךְ					
מַנִּיתָּ					
מְפַשֵּׁר					
תְּקַבְּלוּן					
קַטֵּל					

	Root	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
יְשַׁמְּשׁוּן					
שַׁבַּחְתָּ					
מְצַבְּעִין					
לְקַטָּלָה					
יְמַלֵּל					
מְשָׁרֵא					
יְבַהֲלוּ					
בַּדַּרוּ					
מְשַׁבַּח					

Fill in the full conjugation of the verb חבל ("damage") in the D:

	Perfect	*Imperfect*	*Participle*	*Imperative*
1 cs				
2 ms			ms	
2 fs			fs	
3 ms				
3 fs			mp	
			fp	
1 cp				
2 mp				
2 fp			*Infinitive:*	
3 mp				
3 fp				

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) They bound his body from head to foot.

(2) Surely, we will destroy four provinces.

(3) The king gave dominion to his son for eternity.

(4) How wise you are to leave the rebellious city in peace.

(5) She is praising the judge, who grew great in this generation.

(6) I searched in the treasure house, and there was damage there.

(7) He will tell us the interpretation of your dream.

(8) The wise men said to loosen the hair from my head.

Chapter 20

H Conjugation

Semitic languages have four basic verbal conjugations, which are generally identified by the letters G, D, H, and N on the basis of their form. (The Hebrew terms *piʿel, hifʿil,* and *nifʿal* correspond to the vocalization of the 3d person masculine singular perfect of each conjugation; according to this system, the *qal,* which literally means "simple," would be called *paʿal.*) We have already considered the Aramaic G (chapters 8, 9, 15, and 18) and D (chapter 19) conjugations. Since biblical Aramaic has no N (*nifʿal*) conjugation, that leaves only the H.

Its general pattern is the same as that of the other conjugations, except for the obvious presence of the prefixed -ה. Since that usually has an "*a*" vowel, the conjugation is sometimes called the *hafʿel* in contrast to the *hifʿil.* However, unlike Hebrew, the initial ה is usually retained in Aramaic participles and imperfects. (It typically elides in Hebrew so that מְהַשְׁלִיךְ becomes מַשְׁלִיךְ and תְּהַשְׁלִיךְ becomes תַּשְׁלִיךְ).

			Perfect	*Imperfect*
Singular	1		הַשְׁלֵטֵת	אֶהַשְׁלֵט
	2	masculine	הַשְׁלֵטְתְּ	תְּהַשְׁלֵט
	2	feminine	הַשְׁלֵטְתִּי	תְּהַשְׁלְטִין
	3	masculine	הַשְׁלֵט	יְהַשְׁלֵט
	3	feminine	הַשְׁלְטַת	תְּהַשְׁלֵט
Plural	1		הַשְׁלֵטְנָא	נְהַשְׁלֵט
	2	masculine	הַשְׁלֵטְתּוּן	תְּהַשְׁלְטוּן
	2	feminine	הַשְׁלֵטְתֶּן	תְּהַשְׁלְטָן
	3	masculine	הַשְׁלִטוּ	יְהַשְׁלְטוּן
	3	feminine	הַשְׁלֵטָה	יְהַשְׁלְטָן

Having said this, we should add that the -הַ does sometimes elide in biblical Aramaic, precisely as in Hebrew. (This may be due to Hebrew influence.)

As was true with the G and D conjugations, in Aramaic as in Hebrew, the imperative forms are based on the imperfect, without the pronominal prefixes:

H Imperative

	Masculine	*Feminine*
Singular	הַשְׁלֵט	הַשְׁלְטִי
Plural	הַשְׁלְטוּ	הַשְׁלֵטָה

The prefixed -הַ, which is characteristic of this conjugation, is also retained in the participles:

H Participle

	Masculine	*Feminine*
Singular	מְהַשְׁלֵט	מְהַשְׁלְטָה
Plural	מְהַשְׁלְטִין	מְהַשְׁלְטָן

Finally, the H infinitive is, like the D, characterized by the ending הָ־:

הַשְׁלְטָה

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned		*Reference*	
tree	אִילָן	last	אָחֳרִין
behold	אֲלוּ	trouble	אנס
disturb (D)	בהל	vision	חֶזוּ
fear (D—scare)	דחל	seek shade (H)	טלל
magician	חַרְטֹם	food	מָזוֹן
foliage	עֲפִי	reach	מטא

To Be Learned

holy ..... קַדִּישׁ
grow ..... רבה
wind ..... רוּחַ
under ..... תְּחוֹת

Reference

enter ..... עלל
G participle ms ..... עַל
G participle mp ..... עָלִין
H infinitive ..... *לְהַנְעָלָה
branch ..... עֲנַף
bird ..... צִפַּר
height ..... רוּם
beautiful ..... שַׂפִּיר

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 4:1–9)

אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר חֲוֵית בְּבֵיתִי. חֵלֶם חֲזֵית וִידַחֲלַנֵּנִי. וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלֻנַּנִי וּמַנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם לְהַנְעָלָה קָדָמַי לְכֹל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי פִּשַׁר חֶלְמָא יְהוֹדְעֻנַנִי. בֵּאדַיִן עָלִין חַרְטֻמַּיָּא וְכַשְׁדָּיֵא וְחֶלְמָא אֲמַר אֲנָה קֳדָמֵיהוֹן וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לָא מְהוֹדְעִין לִי. וְעַד אָחֳרִין עַל קָדָמַי דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר כְּשֵׁם אֱלָהִי וְדִי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בֵּהּ וְחֶלְמָא קָדָמוֹהִי אֲמַרֵת: בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר רַב חַרְטֻמַּיָּא דִּי אֲנָה יְדַעֵת דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ וְכָל רָז לָא אָנֵס לָךְ. חֶזְוֵי חֶלְמִי דִּי חֲזֵית וּפִשְׁרֵהּ אֱמַר. וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲלוּ אִילָן בְּגוֹא אַרְעָא וְרוּמֵהּ שַׂגִּיא. רְבָה אִילָנָא וְרוּמֵהּ יְמֻטָא לִשְׁמַיָּא. עָפְיֵהּ שַׂפִּיר וּמָזוֹן לְכֹלָּא בֵּהּ. תְּחוֹתוֹהִי תַּטְלֵל חֵיוַת בָּרָא וּבְעַנְפוֹהִי יְדָרָן צִפְּרֵי שְׁמַיָּא.

Proper Names

בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר — The Babylonian name given to Daniel (see Daniel 1:7), which means "May he protect his life" in Akkadian.

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*This form is explained on p. 119.

EXERCISES

Identify the form of the following H verbs:

	Root	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מַהֲלְכִין					
לְהַחֲוָיָה					
נְהַחֲוֵה					
הַשְׁפָּלָה					
הָחֱסִנוּ					
לְהַשְׁנָיָה					
הוֹדַעְנָא					
מְהוֹדְעִין					
מְהַנְזַקְתְּ					
תְּהַנְזֵק					
הַצְלַח					
מְהַחְצְפָה					
יְהַשְׁפֵּל					
הַרְגְּזוּ					
הַרְגִּשׁוּ					
הַשְׁכַּחַת					
לְהַשְׁכָּחָה					
מְהַשְׁנֵא					

Fill in the full conjugation of the verb קרב in the H:

	Perfect	*Imperfect*	*Participle*	*Imperative*
1 cs				
2 ms			ms	
2 fs			fs	
3 ms				
3 fs			mp	
			fp	
1 cp				
2 mp				
2 fp			*Infinitive:*	
3 mp				
3 fp				

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The sound of the horn reaches the heavens.

(2) Behold, the wind is smashing the vessels under the palace.

(3) The hair grew like foliage.

(4) The bird brought gold out of the tree.

(5) The word of the king will frighten the holy men of Babylon.

(6) The magicians fear that God will make Daniel ruler over them.

(7) The scribes said to bring the message before God.

Chapter 21

Weak Verbs

Weak verbs contain letters that cause phonological problems when they occur in certain situations. For example, some letters cannot take certain vowels, while others tend to assimilate with adjoining consonants. Because the "weaknesses" which cause problems for these roots typically have to do with the pronunciation of specific consonants, many irregularities are common to Hebrew and Aramaic.

Some letters encounter problems when they occur at the beginning of a root. For example, when the letter נ is preceded by a vowel but has none of its own (i.e. when it has a silent *sh'va*), it often assimilates to the following letter. Thus, the imperfect of the root נפל (fall) includes forms like יִפֵּל (compare the Hebrew יִפֹּל). Since the imperative is based on this form (without the pronominal prefix), it frequently has no נ at all (e.g., שְׂא from נשׂא and פֻּקוּ from נפק). However, Aramaic is not as consistent in this as is Hebrew. Thus, the נ remains in several forms of the verb נתן, such as תִּנְתֵּן and יִנְתֵּן (the *dagesh* in the ת is *lene*) and frequently in H forms (הַנְפֵּק, תְּהַנְזִיק, etc.). Alternatively, it is possible that these forms are actually secondary developments. In other words, rather than having been retained, the נ may have initially assimilated and then later returned through a process of nasalized dissimilation. This process can be seen in other Aramaic verbs; for example, the H infinitives הַנְסָקָה and הַנְעָלָה are derived from the roots סלק and עלל respectively (see chapter 22). If a similar process was at work with נתן, the imperfect would have developed in something like the following stages:

יִנְתֵּן → יִתֵּן (assimilation) → יִנְתֵּן (dissimilation/nasalization)

A similar development takes place with the root ידע. Its imperfect, 2 masculine singular form should have been תִּידַע, but that apparently became תִּדְדַע, with the י assimilating to the ד), and then תִּנְדַע, as the first ד dissimilated, becoming a (nasal) נ. In the same way, the 3 masculine plural form יִידְעוּן became יִנְדְּעוּן. This process also lies behind the name of the Mandeans, which comes from the root ידע and is used for a gnostic group that claims special religious knowledge (cf. מַנְדַּע, "knowledge," in Daniel 4:31 and 33 on p. 120).

The verb ידע demonstrates another characteristic of the Northwest Semitic languages, namely the shift of initial ו to י. (The root was originally ודע.) Sometimes the initial י is lost altogether, as in the infinitive and imperative (e.g., הַב; see p. 49 above). However, under other circumstances, the shift to י never takes place at all. Hebrew examples include *hifʿil* and *nifʿal* forms such as הוֹלִיד and נוֹלַד, both of which come from the root ילד. Analogously, Aramaic has H forms such as הוֹתֵב and לְהוֹדָעָה from the roots יתב and ידע.

Gutturals often cause nearby vowels to shift to an *ah* sound (i.e. a *pataḥ* or *qameṣ*). We have already seen examples of this in the G active participle (אָמַר). The same phenomenon is responsible for D participles such as מְשַׁבַּח, G perfect forms like עַבְדֵת ("I made"), and G imperfects such as תַּעַבְדוּן.

"Hollow" verbs have a long vowel—either *î* or *û*—instead of a middle consonant. Because their roots do not have three consonants, these verbs inevitably encounter problems fitting into "regular" conjugations. (This clearly does not apply to verbs such as חוה, "tell," in which the middle ו or י is consonantal.) Hollow roots have no middle letter at all in the G perfect (e.g., שָׂמְתָ, "I ordered"). However, the G participle often developed an א in the middle position, apparently in an effort to make the verb more clearly triliteral—e.g., קָאֵם (he rises).* (In some verbs the *kĕtîv* has an א but the *qĕrê* a י, e.g., דָאֲנִין/דָיְנִין in Ezra 7:25 and דָאֲרִין/דָיְרִין in Daniel 2:38.) The long middle vowel does appear in the imperfect, where the pronominal prefix takes a *sh'va* (e.g., יְקוּם; contrast Hebrew, where the pronominal prefix takes a *qameṣ*, reflecting how that language treats short vowels in syllables preceding the accent).

Final ה and א are not as distinct in Aramaic as they are in Hebrew. One of them may appear in forms attributed to roots derived from the other, such as מִשְׁרֵא from the root שרה and הִתְמְלִי from the root מלא. This blurring also occurs in the suffixes used for feminine and determined forms, which should be ־ה and ־א respectively, but are not consistently distinguished. This ambiguity is compounded by the tendency of א to become quiescent and even fall away. This is evident in the root אתא, the H conjugation of which, as we have seen, has forms such as the infinitive לְהֵיתָיָה and the masculine singular third person perfect הֵיתִי, where there is a י instead of the expected א. As a consequence, the following forms are all derived from initial-א verbs:

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* The same form occurs in the Hebrew passage Hosea 10:14.

תְּהוֹבֵד (Daniel 2:24)—from the root אבד in the H conjugation, with the א acting like a י, which then "becomes" a ו.

מְהֵימַן (Daniel 2:45, 6:5)—an H passive participle from the root אמן, where the א has become and remained a י (just like הַיְתִי).

מֵמַר (Ezra 5:11)—the א in this G infinitive has dropped (so too in the infinitives מֵחֵא and מֵזֵא); the same form occurs in Daniel 2:9 with the א intact (מֵאמַר).

Final ה verbs (which were originally final י) follow patterns familiar from Hebrew, except that the perfect, 3 plural suffix is וֹ- (e.g., בְּנוֹ, "they built"):

		Perfect	*Imperfect*		*Participles*		*Imperative*
					Active	*Passive*	
singular	1 c	בְּנֵית	אֶבְנֵא	ms	בָּנֵה	בְּנֵה	בְּנִי
	2 m	בְּנַיְתָ	תִּבְנֵא	fs	בָּנְיָה	בְּנְיָה	
	2 f	בְּנַיְתִי	תִּבְנִין	mp	בָּנִין	בְּנִין	בְּנוֹ
	3 m	בְּנָה	יִבְנֵא	fp	בָּנְיָן	בְּנְיָן	
	3 f	בְּנָת	תִּבְנֵה				
plural	1 c	בְּנֵינָא	נִבְנֵא	*Infinitive*		מִבְנֵא	
	2 m	בְּנֵיתוּן	תִּבְנוֹן				
	2 f	בְּנֵיתֵן	תִּבְנֶין				
	3 m	בְּנוֹ	יִבְנוֹן				
	3 f	בְּנָה	יִבְנֶין				

Geminate verbs (those in which the second and third root consonants are the same) are handled in a variety of ways:

(1) Sometimes these roots behave as if they were perfectly regular (e.g., יְמַלֵּל, קַצְצוּ, מְרָעֵע, שַׁכְלְלוּ, תַּטְלֵל).

(2) Often, the repeated consonant appears only once, sometimes without any indication that it is doubled. In those cases, the vowel pattern may shift (e.g., תֵּרַע, גְּדוּ, מְחַן, נַדַּת).

(3) In certain cases, the doubling (gemination) one would have expected in the final letter of the root shifts to the first letter (this is most common in H forms of the root דקק, such מְהַדֵּק, תַּדִּק, and הַדִּקוּ).

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned		*Reference*	
cut down	גדד	but	בְּרַם
dew	טַל	in order that	(עַד) דִּבְרָה
be able	כהל	living	חַי
heart	לֵבַב	give	יהב
reach	מטא	*Gt imf 3 ms*	יִתְיְהֵב
descend	נחת	food	מָזוֹן
Most High	עִלָּי	flee	נוד
want	צבה	enemy	עָר
be wet	צבע	call	קרא
Dt	יִצְטַבַּע	greatness	רְבוּ
		be appalled	שׁמם
		ʾitpolel pf	אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם
		root	שֹׁרֶשׁ

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 4:10–19)

חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי וַאֲלוּ קַדִּישׁ מִן שְׁמַיָּא נָחֵת. קָרָא וְכֵן אָמַר: גִּדּוּ אִילָנָא וְתֻנֵּד
חֵיוְתָא מִן תַּחְתּוֹהִי בְּרַם שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי בְּאַרְעָא שְׁבָקוּ וּבְטַל שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע. לִבְבֵהּ מִן
אֲנָשָׁא יְשַׁנּוֹן וּלְבַב חֵיוָה יְתְיְהֵב לֵהּ עַד דִּי יִנְדְּעוּן חַיָּא דִּי שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא
בְּמַלְכוּת אֲנָשָׁא וּלְמַן דִּי יְצִבֵּא יְתְנִנֵּהּ. דְּנָה חֶלְמָא חֱזֵית אֲנָה מַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְאַנְתְּ

בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַר פִּשְׁרָא אֲמַר כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי כָּל חַכִּימֵי מַלְכוּתִי לָא יָכְלִין פִּשְׁרָא לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי
וְאַנְתְּ כָּהֵל דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ. אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַר אִשְׁתּוֹמַם
כְּשָׁעָה חֲדָה. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר. בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַר חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרָא אַל יְבַהֲלָךְ.
עָנֵה בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַר וְאָמַר. חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְעָרִיךְ. אִילָנָא דִּי חֲזַיְתָ דִּי רְבָה וְיִמְטֵא
לִשְׁמַיָּא וּמָזוֹן לְכֹלָּא בֵּהּ, תְּחֹתוֹהִי תְּדוּר חֵיוַת בָּרָא—אַנְתְּ הוּא מַלְכָּא דִּי רַבֵּית
וּרְבוּתָךְ רְבָת וּמְטָת לִשְׁמַיָּא.

EXERCISES

Identify the form of the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
טְאֵב						
יַדַּע						
מְנַתַּן						
יִקְרוֹן						
יְהוֹבְדוּן						
יָדַע						
יַחְלְפוּן						
תִּפְּלוּן						
הַדֵּקְתְּ						

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
הוֹתֵב						
שָׂם						
מְהָקִים						
אֶבְעֵא						
פְּקוּ						
אֲתוֹ						
הֵיבֵל						
נֵאמַר						
הוֹבָדָה						
יְנַדְּעוּן						
יִפֵּל						

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) Then the magicians knew that the king heard the dream.

(2) I am able to bind the body on top of the mountain.

(3) Wisdom is like a burning fire.

(4) The interpretation damaged all who heard it.

(5) One man builds a house, and another man smashes it.

(6) My hair is wet with dew.

(7) The interpretation of the dream changed the king's heart.

(8) A holy one came down when he heard the word of the Most High.

(9) They cut down the tree that reached into the heavens.

(10) We went to praise them.

Chapter 22

Unusual Verbs

There are several common verbs with idiosyncratic forms. Some of these have already been described.

הוה (to be)—As noted in chapter 15, imperfect 3d person forms often use a prefixed -ל (thus לֶהֱוֵא, לֶהֱוֹן, לֶהֱוֶן). Although in biblical Aramaic this involves only the verb הוה, the prefix is more extensively attested in later dialects, including rabbinic Aramaic, Syriac, and Mandaic.

הלך (go)—Participles are conjugated in the D and H (מְהַלֵּךְ and מַהְלְכִין). Imperfect and infinitive forms are kept in the G conjugation, where they act as if they were derived from a hollow root (הוך) with no middle consonant nor any evidence of assimilation—thus, יְהָךְ (he will go) and לְמֶהָךְ (to go).

יכל (be able) has several different forms. The imperfect follows the pattern יִכֵּל, תִּכֵּל, although some Aramaic passages have the same form (יוּכַל) as is known from Hebrew. Participles can be based on either יכל (יָכֵל, יָכְלָה, יָכְלִין, יָכְלָן) or כהל (כָּהֵל, כָּהֲלָה, כָּהֲלִין, כָּהֲלָן).

סלק (go up)—Whenever the initial ס has a silent *sh'va*, the ל assimilates to it. This happens in several H forms, such as הַסְקוּ (lift up!) and הֶסַּק (be lifted up). In the H infinitive, the double ס then *dissimilates*, resulting in the form הַנְסָקָה through a process of nasalization:

הַסְלָקָה → הַסָּקָה → הַנְסָקָה

עלל (enter)—The G participle of this geminate root has two forms, with the *kětîv* showing both ל's (עַלֵּלַת and עָלְלִין), but the *qĕrê* only one (עַלַת and עָלִין). Nasalization sometimes occurs in the H forms of this verb, yielding the perfect, 3d person masculine singular form הַנְעֵל and the infinitive הַנְעָלָה, which exists alongside of הֶעָלָה.

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned		*Reference*	
bless, kneel (D)	בָּרַךְ	living	חַי
strength, army	חַיִל	pass by	חלף
drive out	טָרַד	add	יסף
day	יוֹם	*H pass pf 3 fs*	הוֹסְפַת
dwelling	מְדוֹר	month	יַרְחַ
lift	נטל	because	מִן דִּי
pass away (G)	עדה	understanding	מַנְדַּע
mouth	פֻּם	eye	עַיִן
end	קְצַת	enduring	קַיָּם
return	תוּב	greatness	רְבוּ
		seven	שִׁבְעָה
		root	שָׁרַשׁ
		restore (H)	תקן
		H passive	הָתְקְנַת
		twelve	תְּרֵי עַשַׂר

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 4:20–34)

וְדִי חֲזָה מַלְכָּא קַדִּישׁ נָחֵת מִן שְׁמַיָּא וְאָמַר גַּדּוּ אִילָנָא וְחַבְּלוּהִי בְּרַם שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי בְּאַרְעָא שְׁבָקוּ וּבְטַל שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע. דְּנָה פִּשְׁרָא דִּי מְטָה עַל מַלְכָּא: לָךְ טָרְדִין מִן אֱנָשָׁא וְעִם חֵיוַת בָּרָא לֶהֱוֵה מְדָרָךְ וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא לָךְ מְצַבְּעִין וְשִׁבְעָה עִדָּנִין יַחְלְפוּן עָלָיִךְ עַד דִּי תְנַדַּע דִּי שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא וּלְמַן דִּי יְצִבֵּא יִתְנִנַּהּ. וְדִי אֲמַרוּ לְמִשְׁבַּק שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי דִּי אִילָנָא —מַלְכוּתָךְ לָךְ קַיָּמָה מִן דִּי תְנַדַּע דִּי שַׁלְטַן שְׁמַיָּא. כְּלָא מְטָא עַל נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא. לִקְצַת יַרְחִין תְּרֵי־עַשַׂר עַל הֵיכַל מַלְכוּתָא דִּי בָבֶל מְהַלֵּךְ הֲוָה. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר: הֲלָא דָא הִיא בָּבֶל רַבְּתָא דִּי אֲנָה בְנֵיתַהּ לְבֵית מַלְכוּ? מִלְּתָא בְּפֻם מַלְכָּא וְקָל מִן שְׁמַיָּא נְפַל. לָךְ אָמְרִין נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא: מַלְכוּתָה עֲדָת מִנָּךְ וּמִן אֱנָשָׁא לָךְ טָרְדִין וְעִם חֵיוַת בָּרָא מְדָרָךְ וְשִׁבְעָה עִדָּנִין יַחְלְפוּן עָלָיִךְ עַד דִּי תְנַדַּע דִּי שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא וּלְמַן דִּי יְצִבֵּא יִתְנִנַּהּ. בַּהּ שַׁעֲתָא מִן אֱנָשָׁא טְרִיד וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע. וְלִקְצָת יוֹמַיָּא אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר עֵינַי לִשְׁמַיָּא נְטֶלֶת וּמַנְדְּעִי עֲלַי יְתוּב וּלְעִלָּיָא בָּרֶכֶת וּלְחַי עָלְמָא שַׁבְּחֶת דִּי שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ עִם דָּר וְדָר וּכְמִצְבְּיֵהּ עָבֵד בְּחֵיל שְׁמַיָּא וְדָאְרֵי אַרְעָא וְלָא אִיתַי דִּי יֵאמַר לֵהּ: מָה עֲבַדְתְּ? בֵּהּ זִמְנָא מַנְדְּעִי יְתוּב עֲלַי וְעַל מַלְכוּתִי הָתְקְנַת. וּרְבוּ יַתִּירָה הוֹסְפַת לִי.

EXERCISES

Identify the form of the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
הַנְעֵל						
הֶעַל						
לִהְיוֹת						
הָיוֹ						
הַסְּקוּ						
הִנָּסְקָה						
מַהֲלְכִין						
מְהַלֵּךְ						
יְהָךְ						
יְכֻלְתָּ						
יְכֹל						
תֹּכַל						
יוּכַל						
כָּהֲלִין						

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The priests drove the governor from the city.

(2) The animal's dwelling is in a tree.

(3) At the end of the day his strength passed away.

(4) The magician lifted his hands and blessed the silver statue.

(5) I returned to bring the letter up to the top of the mountain.

Chapter 23

SYNTAX

Aramaic syntax differs from that of biblical Hebrew in some important ways. For example, we have already pointed out that Aramaic's definite object marker (יָת), which is cognate to the Hebrew אֵת, occurs only once in the Bible (Daniel 3:12; see p. 62). More often, definite direct objects are marked with the preposition -ל:

אֱדַיִן אַרְיוֹךְ . . . הַנְעֵל לְדָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא

Then Arioch . . . brought Daniel before the king. (Daniel 2:25)

Many times, however, definite direct objects stand alone, without any indicator at all:

כָּל אֱנָשׁ דִּי יְהַשְׁנֵא פִּתְגָמָא דְנָא . . .

Anyone who will change this message. . . . (Ezra 6:11)

On the other hand, the relationship between nouns and adjectives is very much like that in Hebrew. Adjectives follow the nouns they modify and must agree not only with respect to number and gender, but determination as well (just as in Hebrew both must have or lack the definite article). However, as in Hebrew, this applies only if the adjective is attributive, that is, if it describes the noun; when it is predicative, they need agree only with respect to number and gender:

מַלְכָּא רַבָּא	the great king
מַלְכָּא רַב	the king is great

Similar rules apply to demonstratives. When they function as adjectives, they normally follow the noun they modify, which *must* be definite (i.e. determined). However, demonstrative pronouns need not be directly adjacent to the noun to which they refer, and the noun may or may not be determined:

גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּין	these men
אִלֵּין גֻּבְרִין	these are men
אִלֵּין גֻּבְרַיָּא	these are the men

Aramaic sentence structure is, overall, far looser than Hebrew's. To be sure, there are numerous cases of the familiar verb-subject-object word order:

מְהוֹדְעִין אֲנַחְנָה לְמַלְכָּא — We inform the king. (Ezra 4:16)

However, it is more common for the object to come first:

פִּתְגָמָא שְׁלַח מַלְכָּא עַל רְחוּם . . . וְשִׁמְשַׁי

The king sent a message to Rehum and Shimshai. (Ezra 4:17)

Frequently, it is reiterated by a resumptive pronoun:

גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ . . . קַטֵּל הַמּוֹן שְׁבִיבָא דִּי נוּרָא

Those men—the flame of fire killed them. (Daniel 3:22)

Sometimes, the subject comes at the very beginning of a sentence:

רְחוּם . . . וְשִׁמְשַׁי . . . כְּתַבוּ אִגְּרָה חֲדָה עַל יְרוּשְׁלֶם לְאַרְתַּחַשַׁשְׂתְּא מַלְכָּא

Rehum and Shimshai wrote a letter concerning Jerusalem to Artaxerxes, the king. (Ezra 4:8)

Finally, both the particle אִיתַי (functioning as a copula) and the verb הוה are often used with Aramaic participles. Although in such situations the participles are technically predicate nouns or adjectives, the resulting verb phrases come very close to comprising compound tenses:

e.g., לֵאלָהָיִךְ לָא אִיתַיְנָא פָּלְחִין — We *do not worship* your god. (Daniel 3:18)

אַנְתְּ מַלְכָּא חָזֵה הֲוַיְתָ — Oh king, you *were seeing.* (Daniel 2:31)

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

finger . . . . . אֶצְבַּע
splendor . . . . . זִיו
wine . . . . . חֲמַר
wear . . . . . לבשׁ
meal . . . . . לְחֶם
interpret (D) . . . . . פשׁר
read, call . . . . . קרא/קרה
Gt (pass) imf 3 ms . . . יִתְקְרֵי
thought . . . . . רַעְיוֹן
find . . . . . שׁכח
Gt (pass) pf 3 fs הִשְׁתְּכַחַת
drink . . . . . שׁתה

Reference

wood . . . . . אָע
purple . . . . . אַרְגְּוָן
disturb (D) . . . . . בהל
Dt (pass) ptc ms . . מִתְבַּהַל
taste . . . . . טְעֵם
understanding . . . . . מַנְדַּע
wall . . . . . כְּתַל
banquet . . . . . מִשְׁתֵּא
illumination . . . . . נְהִירוּ
palm (of hand) . . . . . פַּס
change (G) . . . . . שׁנה
Dt (pass) imf 3 mp . יִשְׁתַּנּוֹ
ruler (over 1/3 kingdom) . . תַּלְתִּי

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 5:1–12)

בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד לְחֶם רַב וְחַמְרָא שָׁתֵה. בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר אֲמַר בְּטַעֵם חַמְרָא לְהַיְתָיָה לְמָאנֵי דַּהֲבָא וְכַסְפָּא דִּי הַנְפֵּק נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּהִי מִן הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְיִשְׁתּוֹן בְּהוֹן. בֵּאדַיִן הַיְתִיו מָאנֵי דַּהֲבָא דִּי הַנְפְּקוּ מִן הֵיכְלָא דִּי בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְשַׁבַּחוּ לֵאלָהֵי דַּהֲבָא וְכַסְפָּא נְחָשָׁא פַּרְזְלָא אָעָא וְאַבְנָא. בַּהּ שַׁעֲתָה נְפַקָה אֶצְבְּעָן דִּי יַד אֱנָשׁ וְכָתְבָן עַל כְּתַל הֵיכְלָא דִּי מַלְכָּא וּמַלְכָּא חָזֵה פַּס יְדָה דִּי כָתְבָה. אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא זִיוֹהִי שְׁנוֹהִי וְרַעְיֹנֹהִי יְבַהֲלוּנֵּהּ. קָרֵא מַלְכָּא בְּחַיִל לְהֵעָלָה כַּשְׂדָּיֵא. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי כָל אֱנָשׁ דִּי יִקְרֵה כְּתָבָה דְנָה וּפִשְׁרֵהּ יְחַוִנַּנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא יִלְבַּשׁ וְתַלְתִּי בְמַלְכוּתָא יִשְׁלַט. אֱדַיִן עֲלַלִין כֹּל חַכִּימֵי מַלְכָּא וְלָא כָהֲלִין כְּתָבָא לְמִקְרֵא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעָה לְמַלְכָּא. אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר שַׂגִּיא מִתְבַּהַל וְזִיוֹהִי שָׁנַיִן עֲלוֹהִי. מַלְכְּתָא לְקֳבֵל מִלֵּי מַלְכָּא לְבֵית מִשְׁתְּיָא עַלֶלַת.

עֲנָת מַלְכְּתָא וַאֲמֶרֶת: מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי אַל יְבַהֲלוּךְ רַעְיוֹנָךְ וְזִיוָךְ אַל יִשְׁתַּנּוֹ. אִיתַי גְּבַר בְּמַלְכוּתָךְ דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בֵּהּ וּבְיוֹמֵי אֲבוּךְ נַהִירוּ וְחָכְמָה כְּחָכְמַת אֱלָהִין הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ וּמַלְכָּא נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּךְ רַב חַרְטֻמִּין וְכַשְׁדָּאִין הֲקִימֵהּ אֲבוּךְ מַלְכָּא. כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי רוּחַ יַתִּירָה וּמַנְדַּע מְפַשַּׁר חֶלְמִין הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ בְּדָנִיֵּאל דִּי מַלְכָּא שָׂם שְׁמֵהּ בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר. כְּעַן דָּנִיֵּאל יִתְקְרֵי וּפִשְׁרָה יְהַחֲוֵה.

EXERCISES

Rewrite the following sentences twice, expressing the direct object differently each time:

(1) מַלְכָּא כַּפֵּת חַרְטֻמַּיָּא.

(a)

(b)

(2) יַת חֶלְמָא פְּשַׁר דָּנִיֵּאל.

(a)

(b)

(3) קְטַלוּ גִּבְרַיָּא לְכָהֲנַיָּא.

(a)

(b)

Now rearrange each of the original sentences above twice, beginning with a different word each time.

(1a)

(1b)

(2a)

(2b)

(3a)

(3b)

Translate each sentence into English:

(1)

(2)

(3)

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) They drank wine with the meal.

(2) The big finger wrote a message.

(3) The golden vessels were found in the temple.

(4) The priest called the people to pray.

(5) The queen wore gold on her head.

(6) The strong thoughts frightened me.

(7) The wall of the house is wood.

(8) The splendor of his wisdom went out to the whole land.

Chapter 24

PASSIVE CONJUGATIONS

The G passive participle (e.g., כְּתִיב), which was described in chapter 9, is only a small part of a far more elaborate system, one which is significantly more developed in Aramaic than in biblical Hebrew. There one finds a *qal* (G) passive participle (e.g., בָּרוּךְ) as well as two passive conjugations—the *puʿal* and the *hofʿal*. These latter two really belong to the *piʿel* (D) and the *hifʿil* (H), as is evident from the fact that they share the characteristic features of those conjugations—the doubled middle root letter of the *piʿel* and the prefixed ה of the *hifʿil*. Where they differ from the active forms is in their vowel pattern, for which both use *u-a*. These conjugations are, therefore, called *internal* passives of the *piʿel* and *hifʿil*.

Although biblical Hebrew's *qal* has only a passive participle, some anomalous forms have led scholars to suspect that at one time it too must have had a full internal passive. Whatever the facts about that, there are internal passives for all the major conjugations in biblical Aramaic.

The G passive is characterized by the theme vowel *î*. It is found in both the participle and perfect forms. (There are no imperfect forms for any of the internal passive conjugations in the Bible.)

G PASSIVE	*Perfect*		*Participle*		
	Singular	*Plural*			
1	כְּתִיבֶת	כְּתִיבְנָא	singular	masculine	כְּתִיב
2 masculine	כְּתִיבְתָּ	כְּתִיבְתּוּן		feminine	כְּתִיבָה
feminine	כְּתִיבְתִּי	כְּתִיבְתֵּן			
3 masculine	כְּתִיב	כְּתִיבוּ	plural	masculine	כְּתִיבִין
feminine	כְּתִיבַת	כְּתִיבָה		feminine	כְּתִיבָן

The D passive resembles the Hebrew *puʿal*, except that the participle has a *pataḥ (a)* theme vowel instead of *u*. Since Aramaic rules of pronunciation call for this vowel to be reduced to a *sh'va* in all forms of the passive participle except the masculine singular, that is the only participial form in which the active and the passive differ.

D PASSIVE	*Perfect*		*Participle*		
	Singular	*Plural*			
1	קְבִּלֵת	קְבַּלְנָא	singular	masculine	מְקַבַּל
2 masculine	קְבִּלְתָּ	קְבַּלְתּוּן		feminine	מְקַבְּלָה
feminine	קְבַּלְתִּי	קְבַּלְתֶּן			
3 masculine	קְבַּל	קְבַּלוּ	plural	masculine	מְקַבְּלִין
feminine	קְבִּלַת	קְבַּלָה		feminine	מְקַבְּלָן

The H internal passive follows the same pattern in the perfect as the Hebrew *hofʿal*, while the passive participle is identical with its active counterpart, except that the theme vowel shifts from *ṣere* to *pataḥ* (when it shows), precisely as occurs in the D passive.

H PASSIVE	*Perfect*		*Participle*		
	Singular	*Plural*			
1	הֶשְׁלַטֵת	הֶשְׁלַטְנָא	singular	masculine	מְהַשְׁלַט
2 masculine	הֶשְׁלַטְתָּ	הֶשְׁלַטְתּוּן		feminine	מְהַשְׁלְטָה
feminine	הֶשְׁלַטְתִּי	הֶשְׁלַטְתֶּן			
3 masculine	הֶשְׁלַט	הֶשְׁלַטוּ	plural	masculine	מְהַשְׁלְטִין
feminine	הֶשְׁלְטַת	הֶשְׁלְטָה		feminine	מְהַשְׁלְטָן

As in Hebrew, the initial vowel in the perfect may be either a short *ŏ* (הָ) or *ŭ* (הֻ).

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

glory ..... יְקָר
throne ..... כָּרְסֵא
master ..... מָרֵא
greatness ..... רְבוּ
rise ..... רוּם
G pass ptc ms ..... רִים
H (causative) ptc ms .. מָרִים
Hitpolel (reflexive)
pf 2 ms ..... הִתְרוֹמַמְתָּ
write ..... רשׁם
be like ..... שׁוה
be finished ..... שׁלם
be low (*H causative*) ..... שׁפל
rule (over 1/3 of kingdom) . תַּלְתָּא

Reference

purple ..... אַרְגְּוָן
lacking ..... חַסִּיר
proclaim (H) ..... כרז
count (G) ..... מנה
remove (H) ..... עדה
divide ..... פרס
kill ..... קטל
chiefs ..... רַבְרְבָנִין
weigh ..... תקל

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 5:13–29)

בֵּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל הֵעַל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא. עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל: אַנְתְּ הוּא דָנִיֵּאל דִּי מִן בְּנֵי יְהוּד דִּי הַיְתִי מַלְכָּא אֲבִי מִן יְהוּד. וְשִׁמְעֵת עֲלָיִךְ דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין בָּךְ וְחָכְמָה יַתִּירָה הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בָּךְ. וּכְעַן הֵעֲלוּ קָדָמַי חַכִּימַיָּא דִּי כְתָבָה דְנָה יְקָרוֹן וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי וְלָא כָהֲלִין פִּשַׁר מִלְּתָא לְהַחֲוָיָה. וַאֲנָה שְׁמִעֵת עֲלָיִךְ דִּי תִכֵּל פִּשְׁרִין לְמִפְשַׁר. כְּעַן הֵן תִּכֵּל כְּתָבָא לְמִקְרֵא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא תִלְבַּשׁ וּתַלְתָּא בְמַלְכוּתָא תִשְׁלַט. בֵּאדַיִן עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר קֳדָם מַלְכָּא: כְּתָבָא אֶקְרֵא לְמַלְכָּא וּפִשְׁרָא אֲהוֹדְעִנֵּהּ. אַנְתְּ מַלְכָּא אֱלָהָא עִלָּיָא מַלְכוּתָא וּרְבוּתָא וִיקָרָא יְהַב לִנְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּךְ. וּמִן רְבוּתָא דִּי יְהַב לֵהּ כֹּל עַמְמַיָּא הַוֹוֹ דָחֲלִין מִן קֳדָמוֹהִי. דִּי הַוָּה צָבֵא הֲוָא קָטֵל וְדִי הַוָּה צָבֵא הַוָּה מָרִים וְדִי הַוָּה צָבֵא הַוָּה מַשְׁפִּיל. וּכְדִי רָם לִבֵּהּ

וְרוּחַהּ הָנַחַת מִן כָּרְסָא מַלְכוּתֵהּ וְיִקָּרָה הֶעְדִיוּ מִנֵּהּ. וּמִן בְּנֵי אֱנָשָׁא טְרִיד וְלִבְבֵהּ עִם חֵיוָתָא שְׁוִי וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע עַד דִּי יְדַע דִּי שַׁלִּיט אֱלָהָא עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא וּלְמַן דִּי יְצַבֵּה יְהָקִים עֲלַיהּ. וְאַנְתְּ בְּרֵהּ בֵּלְשַׁאצַר לָא הַשְׁפֵּלְתְּ לִבְבָךְ כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי כָל דְּנָה יְדַעְתָּ. וְעַל מָרֵא שְׁמַיָּא הִתְרוֹמַמְתְּ וּלְמָאנַיָּא דִּי בַיְתֵהּ הַיְתִיו קָדָמָיִךְ וְאַנְתְּ וְרַבְרְבָנָיִךְ חַמְרָא שָׁתַיִן בְּהוֹן וְלֵאלָהֵי כַסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא נְחָשָׁא פַּרְזְלָא אָעָא וְאַבְנָא דִּי לָא חָזִין וְלָא שָׁמְעִין וְלָא יָדְעִין שַׁבַּחְתָּ. בֵּאדַיִן מִן קֳדָמוֹהִי שְׁלִיחַ יְדָא וּכְתָבָא דְנָה רְשִׁים. וּדְנָה כְתָבָא דִּי רְשִׁים: מְנֵא מְנֵא תְּקֵל וּפַרְסִין. דְּנָה פְּשַׁר מִלְּתָא:

מְנֵא—מְנָה אֱלָהָא מַלְכוּתָךְ וְהַשְׁלְמַהּ. תְּקֵל—תְּקִילְתָּה וְהִשְׁתְּכַחַתְּ חַסִּיר. פְּרֵס—פְּרִיסַת מַלְכוּתָךְ וִיהִיבַת לְמָדַי וּפָרָס. בֵּאדַיִן אֲמַר בֵּלְשַׁאצַר וְהַלְבִּישׁוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל אַרְגְּוָנָא וְהַכְרִזוּ עֲלוֹהִי דִּי לֶהֱוֵא שַׁלִּיט תַּלְתָּא בְּמַלְכוּתָא.

Proper Names

מָדַי — Region in western Iran from which a powerful kingdom emerged in the seventh century, but was conquered by Cyrus of Persia in the sixth century.

EXERCISES

Identify the form of the following passive verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation (G, D, H)*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
שְׁלִיחַ						
יְהִיב						
קְטִילַת						
מְפָרַשׁ						
עֲשִׁית						

	Root	*Conjugation (G, D, H)*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מְעֻרָב						
שִׂים						
הֻסַּפַת						
יְהִיבַת						
חֻשְׁבִין						
זְקִיף						
זְהִירִין						
שְׁמַת						
דְּחִיל						
גְּמִיר						
יְהִיבוּ						
פְּרִיסַת						
מְכַפְּתִין						
שְׁלִם						

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The letter was written in Jerusalem.

(2) He is raising the palace on the mountain.

(3) The throne was lowered from the heavens.

(4) The master's dream was interpreted there.

(5) The great gods are praised on earth.

(6) They asked him to bring the silver to the big palace.

(7) Daniel became ruler, and his glory was like a king.

(8) God gave greatness to the province and to its governor.

(9) The earth was finished in six days.

Chapter 25

REFLEXIVE CONJUGATIONS

Just as each major conjugation has an internal passive, so can each theoretically be made reflexive by adding the prefix -הִתְ. Hebrew normally does this only for the D (*pi'el*) conjugation (for other possibilities, see pp. 32–33). Aramaic, however, uses this prefix as a passive for both G and D.* We have already seen examples of verbs in both of these conjugations (e.g., הִתְעֲבֵד, הִתְבַּקַּר, הִתְיְהִב, and הִתְבְּנָה).

There are some clues that can help determine which conjugation is involved:

(a) Spelling—whether the middle root letter is doubled (D) or not (G)

(b) Etymology—whether the verbal root normally appears in the G or D

In any case, these conjugations follow the same general principles as other Aramaic conjugations and their Hebrew equivalents:

(1) Perfect forms use the standard suffixes.

(2) The prefixed -ה elides in the imperfect and the participle because of its location between a prefix (pronominal in the case of the imperfect; -מ for the participle) and the following ת.**

(3) Infinitives end with the suffix -ָה.

(4) Initial sibilants (שׂ, שׁ, צ, ס, ז) switch places (metathesize) with the ת of the prefix, which becomes ט (a sharpened dental) when the root begins with צ (a sharpened sibilant) and ד (a voiced dental) when the first root letter is ז (a voiced sibilant).

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*The Bible may contain a trace of this for the H conjugation if the words תְּהַנְזוּק מַלְכִּים in Ezra 4:13 are redivided to read מַלְכִּי מְתְהַנְזוּק ("my king is damaged"), as some have suggested.

**Compare the Hebrew definite article, which elides when it is preceded by a preposition (e.g., בַּבַּיִת→בְּהַבַּיִת) and the prefixed ה of the H conjugation both in Hebrew and sometimes in Aramaic (see p. 106). In talmudic Aramaic, the ת also elides.

The actual forms are exactly what one would expect:

			Gt	Dt
PERFECT				
Singular	1		הִתְקַטֶּלֶת	הִתְחַבֶּלֶת
	2	masculine	הִתְקַטֶּלְתָּ	הִתְחַבֶּלְתָּ
	2	feminine	הִתְקַטֶּלְתִּי	הִתְחַבֶּלְתִּי
	3	masculine	הִתְקַטֶּל	הִתְחַבֶּל
	3	feminine	הִתְקַטַּל	הִתְחַבַּל
Plural	1		הִתְקַטֶּלְנָא	הִתְחַבֶּלְנָא
	2	masculine	הִתְקַטֶּלְתּוּן	הִתְחַבֶּלְתּוּן
	2	feminine	הִתְקַטֶּלְתֶּן	הִתְחַבֶּלְתֶּן
	3	masculine	הִתְקַטְלוּ	הִתְחַבְּלוּ
	3	feminine	הִתְקַטְלָה	הִתְחַבְּלָה
IMPERFECT				
Singular	1		אֶתְקַטֶּל	אֶתְחַבַּל
	2	masculine	תִּתְקַטֶּל	תִּתְחַבַּל
	2	feminine	תִּתְקַטְּלִין	תִּתְחַבְּלִין
	3	masculine	יִתְקַטֶּל	יִתְחַבַּל
	3	feminine	תִּתְקַטֶּל	תִּתְחַבַּל
Plural	1		נִתְקַטֶּל	נִתְחַבַּל
	2	masculine	תִּתְקַטְּלוּן	תִּתְחַבְּלוּן
	2	feminine	תִּתְקַטֶּלָן	תִּתְחַבְּלָן
	3	masculine	יִתְקַטְּלוּן	יִתְחַבְּלוּן
	3	feminine	יִתְקַטֶּלָן	יִתְחַבְּלָן
PARTICIPLES				
Singular	masculine		מִתְקַטֶּל	מִתְחַבַּל
	feminine		מִתְקַטְּלָה	מִתְחַבְּלָה
Plural	masculine		מִתְקַטְּלִין	מִתְחַבְּלִין
	feminine		מִתְקַטְּלָן	מִתְחַבְּלָן
INFINITIVE			הִתְקַטָּלָה	הִתְחַבָּלָה

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

satrap ..... אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפַּן
be faithful (H) ..... אמן
H pass ptc ..... מְהֵימַן
lion ..... אַרְיֵה
pit ..... גּוֹב
night ..... לֵילֵי
pretext ..... עִלָּה
receive (D) ..... קבל
statute ..... קְיָם
assemble (H) ..... רגשׁ
please ..... שׁפר

Reference

petition ..... בָּעוּ
take counsel (Dt) ..... יעט
hundred ..... מְאָה
suffer damage ..... נזק
distinguish self (Dt) ..... נצח
chief ..... סָרַךְ
above ..... עִלָּא
twenty ..... עֶשְׂרִין
intend ..... עשׁת
establish (D) ..... קום
D infinitive ..... לְקַיָּמָה
negligence ..... שָׁלוּ

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 5:30–6:10)

בֵּהּ בְּלֵילְיָא קְטִיל בֵּלְאשַׁצַּר מַלְכָּא כַּשְׂדָּיָא וְדָרְיָוֶשׁ מָדָיָא קַבֵּל מַלְכוּתָא כְּבַר שְׁנִין שִׁתִּין וְתַרְתֵּין. שְׁפַר קֳדָם דָּרְיָוֶשׁ וְהָקִים עַל מַלְכוּתָא לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא מְאָה וְעֶשְׂרִין דִּי לֶהֱוֹן בְּכָל מַלְכוּתָא. וְעֵלָּא מִנְּהוֹן סָרְכִין תְּלָתָא דִּי דָנִיֵּאל חַד מִנְּהוֹן דִּי לֶהֱוֹן אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא אִלֵּין יָהֲבִין לְהוֹן טַעְמָא וּמַלְכָּא לָא לֶהֱוֵא נָזק. אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דְּנָה הֲוָא מִתְנַצַּח עַל סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי רוּחַ יַתִּירָא בֵּהּ וּמַלְכָּא עָשִׁית לַהֲקָמוּתֵהּ עַל כָּל מַלְכוּתָא. אֱדַיִן סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא הֲווֹ בָּעַיִן עִלָּה לְהַשְׁכָּחָה לְדָנִיֵּאל וְכָל עִלָּה לָא יָכְלִין לְהַשְׁכָּחָה כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי מְהֵימַן הוּא וְכָל שָׁלוּ לָא הִשְׁתְּכַחַת עֲלוֹהִי. אֱדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ אָמְרִין דִּי לָא נְהַשְׁכַּח לְדָנִיֵּאל כָּל עִלָּא לָהֵן הַשְׁכַּחְנָה עֲלוֹהִי בְּדָת אֱלָהֵהּ. אֱדַיִן סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא אִלֵּן הַרְגִּשׁוּ עַל מַלְכָּא וְכֵן אָמְרִין לֵהּ: דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי. אִתְיָעַטוּ כָּל סָרְכֵי מַלְכוּתָא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא לְקַיָּמָה קְיָם מַלְכָּא דִּי כָל דִּי יִבְעֵה בָּעוּ מִן כָּל אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד יוֹמִין תְּלָתִין לָהֵן מִנָּךְ מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגֹב אַרְיָוָתָא. כְּעַן מַלְכָּא תִּרְשֵׁם כְּתָבָא דִּי לָא לְהַשְׁנָיָה כְּדָת מָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי לָא תֶעְדֵּא. כָּל קֳבֵל דְּנָה מַלְכָּא דָּרְיָוֶשׁ רְשֵׁם כְּתָבָא.

EXERCISES

Identify the base conjugation and form of the following Aramaic verbs:

	Root	*Base Conjugation (G or D)*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מִתְיְהֵב						
הִתְמְלִי						
יְצְטַבַּע						
הִתְחָרַךְ						
מִתְנַשְּׂאָה						
הִזְדְּמְנָתוּן						
מְשְׁתַּכַּל						
יְתְקְרֵי						
תִּשְׁתְּבַק						
תִּתְעַבְּדוּן						
הִשְׁתְּכַחְתְּ						
יְתְעֲבֵד						
יְשְׁתַּמְעוּן						
הִתְנַדְּבוּ						
יְתְבַּקַּר						

	Root	*Base Conjugation (G or D)*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין						
יִשְׁתַּנֵּא						
הִתְגְּזֶרֶת						
יִתְבְּנֵא						
תִּתְחַבַּל						
הִתְרְחִצוּ						

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The wise father wrote a statute at night.

(2) A strong lion fell into the big pit.

(3) The satraps assembled before the throne.

(4) The message was received in the rebellious city.

(5) Surely, the faithful priest will be pleasing to the people.

(6) The governor sought a pretext to kill the men.

Chapter 26

Other Conjugations

Alongside the major conjugations (G, D, and H) and their passive variations (*pᵉᶜil, puᶜal, hofᶜal, hitpᵉᶜel,* and *hitpaᶜal*) are a host of others. Many of these are familiar from Hebrew. For example, since hollow roots cannot occur in the D inasmuch as they do not have a middle root letter to double, they often use the *polel* conjugation, in which the final letter is doubled, as if to compensate for the lack of a middle letter:

e.g., מְרוֹמֵם (masc. sing. participle from the root רום), "raise up"

The related *ʾetpolel* conjugation is used for the geminate root שׁמם:

אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם, "be disturbed"

This word illustrates another phenomenon, which became characteristic of later Aramaic through a process that is only beginning to be evident in the Bible. We can see it by looking closely at the biblical passage where אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם occurs:

(Daniel 4:16) אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם כְּשָׁעָה חֲדָה

Since דָּנִיֵּאל is the subject of אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם, the verb must be 3 masculine singular perfect ("then Daniel . . . was disturbed"); however, one would have expected the first letter of a perfect verb to be ה (for *hit-polel*) instead of א. A similar anomaly occurs in several other words:

אִתְגְּזֶרֶת	(Daniel 2:45)	Root גזר; perfect 3 feminine singular
אִתְכְּרַיִת	(Daniel 7:15)	Root כרה; perfect 3 feminine singular
אֶשְׁתַּנִּי	(Daniel 3:19)	Root שׁנה; perfect 3 masculine singular
אֲקִימֵהּ	(Daniel 3:1)	Root קום; perfect 3 masculine singular with 3 masculine singular pronominal suffix
אַתַּרוּ	(Daniel 4:11)	Root נתר; imperative masculine plural
אֲחֵת	(Ezra 5:15)	Root נחת; imperative masculine singular

All of these forms would have been expected to begin with ה. When they were written, the letter ה must have weakened to the point that it was not heard. This weakening may also account for the vacillation between ה and א in final weak roots as well as in the feminine and determined endings (see pp. 26 and 113). Over time, then, the H conjugation became an א conjugation (i.e., *ʾafʿel* rather than *hafʿel*); analogously, Gt became *ʾitpeʿel* rather than *hitpeʿel,* and Dt became *ʾitpaʿʿel* rather than *hitpaʿʿel.* To be sure, this process is only beginning in the Bible, where a handful of initial-א forms exist alongside others with initial -ה. (Thus the perfect 3 masculine singular is given as אֲקִימַה in Daniel 3:1, but הֲקִימַה in 5:11, and the perfect 3 feminine singular is אִתְגְּזֶרַת in Daniel 2:45 but הִתְגְּזֶרַת in 2:34.) However, it may be more widespread than we can tell, since other examples of these conjugations could be obscured by the elision of the א with the participle's prefixed -מ or with the imperfect pronominal prefixes, so that we cannot identify all the words which belong to initial -א conjugations with certainty.*

The form אִשְׁתִּיו (Daniel 5:3–4) also has a prefixed א; however, it does not occur in place of a ה, since the word means "he drank," which is normally expressed with the G conjugation of שׁתה. That א must, therefore, be regarded as prosthetic (see p. 15), rather than signalling a different conjugation.

Several other peculiar forms suggest that biblical Aramaic may have had yet another conjugation. These verbs begin with שׁ, which appears to be a prefix attached to more familiar 3-letter roots:

שֵׁיזִיב	save (Daniel 3:28; cf. vv. 15, 17; 16:15, 17, 21, 28), root: עזב
שֵׁיצִיא	complete (Ezra 6:15), root: יצא
שַׁכְלֵל	complete (Ezra 4:12; 5:3, 9, 11; 6:14), root: כלל
מְסוֹבְלִין	laid (Ezra 6:3), root: יבל, passive

Both Akkadian and Ugaritic have causative conjugations that begin with שׁ rather than ה. It is, therefore, reasonable to connect these words with a distinct conjugation. However, there are several reasons to regard them as Akkadian loanwords rather than evidence that there was a functioning *shafʿel* in Aramaic:

(1) the paucity of such forms, which are limited to a mere handful of roots;

(2) the fact that the causative conjugation normally begins with a prefixed -ה in the Northwest Semitic group of languages, to which Aramaic belongs;

(3) the ample evidence of a *hafʿel* (and *ʾafʿel*) in Aramaic;

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* אֶשְׁתּוֹלְלוּ (Ps 76:6) may demonstrate the same process in Hebrew.

(4) the presence of ס in one of these words (מְסוֹבְלִין), where the others have a שׁ; this is especially striking given that the same root occurs several times in the *haf'el* (viz., הֵיבֵל in Ezra 5:14; 6:5, and לְהֵיבָלָה in Ezra 7:15);

(5) the י in שֵׁיזִיב, which is etymologically derived from the Semitic root עזב. Akkadian is unique among Semitic languages in not representing ע (although its presence can often be inferred from the shift of nearby vowels to *e*, another mark of Akkadian influence), so this form must have been taken over from Akkadian rather than generated within Aramaic.

For all these reasons, biblical Aramaic appears to have borrowed these verbs directly from Akkadian. They are, therefore, best regarded as loanwords from Akkadian *shaf'el* forms rather than evidence of an Aramaic *shaf'el.*

As a result of these separate processes, we can identify three distinct prefixes that can be added to roots in biblical Aramaic in order to make them causal and thus list three separate, if related, causal conjugations:

ה *haf'el*
א *'af'el*
שׁ *shaf'el*

VOCABULARY

To Be Learned

prohibition . . . . . אֱסָר
exile . . . . . גָּלוּ
living . . . . . חַי
when . . . . . כְּדִי
speak (D) . . . . . מלל
close . . . . . סגר
go up . . . . . סלק
make prosper (H) . . . . . צלח
formerly . . . . . קַדְמָה
approach . . . . . קרב

Reference

also . . . . . אַף
bottom . . . . . אַרְעִית
sign . . . . . אָת
be evil . . . . . באשׁ
is it not *(interrogative)* . . . . הֲלָא
innocence . . . . . זָכוּ
damage . . . . . חֲבוּלָה
angel . . . . . מַלְאָךְ
flee . . . . . נדד
women . . . . . נָשִׁין
piece . . . . . קְרַץ
accuse . . . . . אכל קרץ
pay attention . . . . . שִׂים טְעֵם
sleep . . . . . שְׁנָה

FROM THE BIBLE (Daniel 6:11–29)

וְדָנִיֵּאל כְּדִי יְדַע דִּי רְשִׁים כְּתָבָא עַל לְבַיְתֵהּ וְזִמְנִין תְּלָתָה בְּיוֹמָא הוּא בָּרֵךְ מְצַלֵּא
קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי הֲוָא עָבֵד מִן קַדְמַת דְּנָה. אֱדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הַרְגִּשׁוּ וְהַשְׁכַּחוּ
לְדָנִיֵּאל בָּעֵא קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ. בֵּאדַיִן קְרִיבוּ וְאָמְרִין קֳדָם מַלְכָּא עַל אֱסָר מַלְכָּא:
הֲלָא אֱסָר רְשַׁמְתָּ דִּי כָל אֱנָשׁ דִּי יִבְעֵה מִן כָּל אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד יוֹמִין תְּלָתִין לָהֵן מִנָּךְ
מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹב אַרְיָוָתָא? עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר: יַצִּיבָא מִלְּתָא כְּדָת מָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי
לָא תֶעְדֵּא. בֵּאדַיִן עָנוֹ וְאָמְרִין קֳדָם מַלְכָּא דִּי: דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי מִן בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד
לָא שָׂם עֲלָיךְ מַלְכָּא טְעֵם וְעַל אֱסָרָא דִּי רְשַׁמְתָּ וְזִמְנִין תְּלָתָה בְּיוֹמָא בָּעֵא. אֱדַיִן
מַלְכָּא כְּדִי מִלְּתָא שְׁמַע שַׂגִּיא בְּאֵשׁ עֲלוֹהִי. בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הַרְגִּשׁוּ עַל מַלְכָּא
וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא דַּע מַלְכָּא דִּי דָת לְמָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי כָל אֱסָר וּקְיָם דִּי מַלְכָּא יְהָקִים
לָא לְהַשְׁנָיָה. בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא אֲמַר וְהֵיתִיו לְדָנִיֵּאל וּרְמוֹ לְגֻבָּא דִּי אַרְיָוָתָא.
עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל: אֱלָהָךְ דִּי אַנְתְּ פָּלַח לֵהּ הוּא יְשֵׁיזְבִנָּךְ. וְהֵיתָית אֶבֶן
חֲדָה וְשַׂמַת עַל פֻּם גֻּבָּא. אֱדַיִן אֲזַל מַלְכָּא לְהֵיכְלֵהּ וְשַׁנְתֵּהּ נַדַּת עֲלוֹהִי.
בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא יְקוּם וּבְהִתְבְּהָלָה לְגֻבָּא דִּי אַרְיָוָתָא אֲזַל וּכְמִקְרְבֵהּ לְגֻבָּא לְדָנִיֵּאל עָנֵה
מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל: דָּנִיֵּאל עַבֵד אֱלָהָא חַיָּא אֱלָהָךְ דִּי אַנְתְּ פָּלַח לֵהּ הַיְכֵל
לְשֵׁיזָבוּתָךְ מִן אַרְיָוָתָא. אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל עִם מַלְכָּא מַלֵּל: מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי.
אֱלָהִי שְׁלַח מַלְאֲכֵהּ וּסְגַר פֻּם אַרְיָוָתָא וְלָא חַבְּלוּנִי כָּל קֳבֵל דִּי קֳדָמוֹהִי זְכוּ הִשְׁתְּכַחַת
לִי וְאַף קֳדָמָיךְ מַלְכָּא חֲבוּלָה לָא עַבְדֵת. בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא שַׂגִּיא טְאֵב עֲלוֹהִי וּלְדָנִיֵּאל
אֲמַר לְהַנְסָקָה מִן גֻּבָּא. וְהֻסַּק דָּנִיֵּאל מִן גֻּבָּא וְכָל חֲבָל לָא הִשְׁתְּכַח בֵּהּ דִּי הֵימִן
בֶּאלָהֵהּ. וַאֲמַר מַלְכָּא וְהֵיתִיו גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי אֲכָלוּ קַרְצוֹהִי דִּי דָנִיֵּאל וּלְגֹב אַרְיָוָתָא
רְמוֹ אִנּוּן בְּנֵיהוֹן וּנְשֵׁיהוֹן וְלָא מְטוֹ לְאַרְעִית גֻּבָּא עַד דִּי שְׁלְטוּ בְהוֹן אַרְיָוָתָא.
בֵּאדַיִן דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כְּתַב לְכָל עַמְמַיָּא דִּי דָאְרִין בְּכָל אַרְעָא שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא.
מִן קֳדָמַי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי בְכָל שָׁלְטָן מַלְכוּתִי לֶהֱוֹן דָּחֲלִין מִן קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ דִּי דָנִיֵּאל
דִּי הוּא אֱלָהָא חַיָּא וְקַיָּם לְעָלְמִין וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי לָא תִתְחַבַּל מְשֵׁיזִב וְעָבֵד אָתִין
בִּשְׁמַיָּא וּבְאַרְעָא דִּי שֵׁיזִיב לְדָנִיֵּאל מִן יַד אַרְיָוָתָא. וְדָנִיֵּאל דְּנָה הַצְלַח בְּמַלְכוּת
דָּרְיָוֶשׁ וּבְמַלְכוּת כּוֹרֶשׁ פָּרְסָיָא.

EXERCISES

Identify the root and conjugation of the following verbs:

הַב	נִפַּקָה
מֶעְבַּד	הֵיבֵל
תְּקַבְּלוּן	קָאֵם
הֵסַק	מְשֵׁיזֵב
דָּאֲנִין	יִפֵּל
מְכַפְּתִין	יְדִיעַ
תּוּכַל	אַחֲוָיָה
מַנִּיתָ	יִשְׁתַּנֵּא
פְּקוּ	הִתְחָרַךְ
חֲזֵיתוּן	הַנְעֵל
אֶקִימֵה	אֶשְׁתַּנִּי
מְבָרַךְ	שֵׁיצִיא
יִשְׁתַּכְלְלוּן	הֲוָת
בְּעֵינָא	פְּתִיחוּ
הוֹתֵב	אִנְדַּע
מֵמַר	תְּהַשְׁכַּח
יְשֵׁיזֵב	תְּהוֹבֵד

הֲיתִי	לְהֵוֹן
מְתַקְרְבִין	יִתְקְרֵי
תֵּרַע	יְהָקִים
יְהוֹדַע	שָׁמַת
עֲנוֹ	תֶּעְדֵּא
הַדְּקֵת	תִּתְבְּנֵא
יְהָךְ	נְחַוֵּא
הִתְרוֹמַמְתָּ	יְשַׁנּוֹן

Explain the *grammatical* difference between the following pairs of forms:

יְקִים (Daniel 2:44) and יְקוֹם (Daniel 7:24)

לְהַנְעָלָה (Daniel 4:3) and לְהֶעָלָה (Daniel 5:7)

מִתְבָּהַל (Daniel 5:9) and הִתְבְּהָלָה (Daniel 2:25)

אָמַר (Daniel 4:11) and אֲמַר (Ezra 5:15)

תִּתְיְהֵב (Ezra 6:4) and תִּתְחַבַּל (Daniel 2:44)

מִתְנַשְּׂאָה (Ezra 4:19) and מִתְעֲבֵד (Ezra 5:8)

מִתְקַטְּלִין (Daniel 2:13) and לְהִתְקַטָּלָה (Daniel 2:13)

הִתְגְּזֵרַת (Daniel 2:34) and אִתְגְּזֵרַת (Daniel 2:45)

Translate into Aramaic:

(1) The father saved his son from the wild animals (lit. "of the field").

(2) The scribe completed the work on the fourth kingdom.

(3) The king assembled the people to praise God at night.

(4) I sought to leave the city when the king issued that prohibition.

(5) I went up on the mountain when a lion approached.

(6) We are closing the statue's mouth.

(7) The Jews succeeded when they were driven out into exile.

(8) The living God spoke in former times.

Chapter 27

DANIEL 7

The biblical texts in the preceding chapters have all been changed from the original, if only to reduce the amount of new vocabulary they require to a reasonable level. In this chapter, we will read Daniel 7, the last Aramaic passage in the Bible, exactly as it appears. All the necessary vocabulary can be found in the glossary at the end of this book.

The chapter describes Daniel's vision of four animals, which symbolize a succession of four empires. The history of this theme is discussed in "The Theory of the Four Monarchies: Opposition History Under the Roman Empire" by J. W. Swain in *Classical Philology* 35 (1940) 1–21, "The Four Empires in the Fourth Sibyl and in the Book of Daniel" by David Flusser in *Israel Oriental Studies* 2 (1972) 148–75, and the commentaries by James Montgomery (International Critical Commentary; New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1927), Louis Hartman and Alexander Di Lella (Anchor Bible; Garden City, NY: Doubleday & Co., 1978), and John Collins (Hermeneia; Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1993).

(1) בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר מֶלֶךְ בָּבֶל דָּנִיֵּאל חֶלֶם חָזָה וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשֵׁה עַל מִשְׁכְּבֵהּ
בֱּאדַיִן חֶלְמָא כְּתַב רֵאשׁ מִלִּין אֲמַר.

Translate into English:

רֵאשׁ מִלִּין is understood by some scholars as meaning a "complete account"; others think it refers to the "essential contents." There is a similar Hebrew phrase in Psalm 119:160.

NOTICE the -ל prefixed to לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר, which expresses possession, just like a construct phrase. The name itself is Babylonian (Bel-shar-uṣur) and means

"Bel guards the king." In Daniel 5 it occurs with the א following the ש (verses 1, 2, 9, 22, and 29); that kind of inconsistency is to be expected in the transliteration of a foreign name (compare our spellings Eileen and Ilene).

List all the verbs in this sentence and identify the form of each:

Verbal forms	*Root*	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*

Translate each of the following words into Hebrew:

חֲדָה

רֵאשָׁה

חֶלְמָא

מִלִּין

(2) עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוִי עִם לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ אַרְבַּע רוּחֵי שְׁמַיָּא מְגִיחָן
לְיַמָּא רַבָּא. (3) וְאַרְבַּע חֵיוָן רַבְרְבָן סָלְקָן מִן יַמָּא שָׁנְיָן דָּא מִן דָּא.

Translate into English:

NOTICE: The meaning of עִם is apparently temporal ("at the time of") as in Daniel 3:33 and 4:31 (עִם דָּר וְדָר, see chapters 19 and 22).

"Wind" (רוּח) and "sea" (יַם) are common elements in ancient Near Eastern stories about primeval time, including the creation story in Genesis 1.

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
עָנֵה						
חָזֵה						
הֲוֵית						
סְלִקוּ						
שְׁנִין						
מְגִיחָן						

The subject of מְגִיחָן is _____; although that noun does not have a formal feminine ending (ה- or ת-), the verb's feminine ending makes its gender clear.

אָמַר is equivalent to the Hebrew form _____.

The phrase חָזֵה הֲוֵית means _____.

(4) קֳדָמָיְתָא כְּאֲרִיֵה וְגַפִּין דִּי נְשַׁר לַהּ חֲזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי מְרִיטוּ גַּפַּיהּ וּנְטִילַת מִן אַרְעָא וְעַל רַגְלַיִן כֶּאֱנָשׁ יְהִיב לַהּ. (5) וַאֲרוּ חֵיוָה אָחֳרִי תִּנְיָנָה דָּמְיָה לְדֹב וְלִשְׁטַר חַד הֲקִמַת וּתְלָת עִלְעִין בְּפֻמַּהּ בֵּין שִׁנַיהּ וְכֵן אָמְרִין לַהּ קוּמִי אֱכֻלִי בְּשַׂר שַׂגִּיא. (6) בָּאתַר דְּנָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲרוּ אָחֳרִי כִּנְמַר וְלַהּ גַּפִּין אַרְבַּע דִּי עוֹף עַל גַּבַּיהּ וְאַרְבְּעָה רֵאשִׁין לְחֵיוְתָא וְשָׁלְטָן יְהִיב לַהּ.

Translate into English:

Translate the following words into Hebrew:

עִלְעִין

(The singular occurs in the Garden of Eden story.)

אָמְרִין

לְחֵיוְתָא

נְשַׁר

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מְרִיטוּ						
נְטִילַת						
הָקִימַת						
דְּמְיָה						
יְהִיב						

What is the subject of הָקִימַת in verse 5? _____

This passage includes a series of ordinal numbers:

"first" קַדְמָיְתָא

"second" תִּנְיָנָה

(for "third" תְּלִיתָיָא, see Daniel 2:39 on p. 87.)

"fourth" רְבִיעָיָה (see verse 7 below)

In post-biblical Aramaic, the ד in קַדְמָא ("first") assimilated to the מ, leaving the form קַמָּא; thus the three subdivisions of the talmudic tractate נְזִיקִין are called:

בָּבָא קַמָּא בָּבָא מְצִיעָא בָּבָא בַּתְרָא

בַּתְרָא is an adjectival form, which developed from בָּאתַר ("after," see verse 6 and p. 62), itself a composite of the preposition -בְּ ("in") and the noun אֲתַר ("place").

(7) בָּאתַר דְּנָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ חֵיוָה רְבִיעָיָה דְּחִילָה וְאֵימְתָנִי וְתַקִּיפָא
יַתִּירָא וְשִׁנַּיִן דִּי פַרְזֶל לַהּ רַבְרְבָן אָכְלָה וּמַדֵּקָה וּשְׁאָרָא בְּרַגְלַיהּ רָפְסָה וְהִיא מְשַׁנְיָה
מִן כָּל חֵיוָתָא דִּי קֳדָמַיהּ וְקַרְנַיִן עֲשַׂר לַהּ. (8) מְשְׁתַּכַּל הֲוֵית בְּקַרְנַיָּא וַאֲלוּ קֶרֶן אָחֳרִי
זְעֵירָה סְלִקַת בֵּינֵיהֶן וּתְלָת מִן קַרְנַיָּא קַדְמָיָתָא אֶתְעֲקָרָה מִן קֳדָמַיהּ וַאֲלוּ עֵינִין
כְּעֵינֵי אֱנָשָׁא בְּקַרְנָא דָא וּפֻם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבָן.

Translate into English:

NOTICE the suffix on יַתִּירָא (verse 7), which functions adverbially; it may be a remnant of an old accusative ending.

The adjectives אֵימְתָנִי (verse 7) and אָחֳרִי (verse 8) are both feminine singular.

What are the number and gender of:

		Number	*Gender*
רַבְרְבָן	(verses 7 and 8)		
חֵיוָתָא	(verse 7)		

What does the phrase מִשְׁתַּכַּל חֱוֵית (verse 8) mean?

What part of the sentence are the following words in verse 8?

פֻּם

מְמַלֶּל

רַבְרְבָן

NOTICE the word order in the various clauses found in these sentences.

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
דְּחִילָה						
רָפְסָה						
מְשַׁנְּיָה						
מִשְׁתַּכַּל						
סְלֶקֶת						
אִתְעֲקַרָה						

The subject of אִתְעֲקַרָה (verse 8) is _____. Since this Gt verb is in the perfect, which normally begins with הִתְ־, the prefixed א must have weakened from an original ה.

מַדְּקָה and אָכְלָה (verse 7) are both the same form, albeit in different conjugations. To what conjugations do they belong?

אָכְלָה

מַדְּקָה

What form are they? _____

NOTE that the root of מַדְקָה is דקק. The (doubling) *dagesh* would normally be expected in the ק rather than the ד; Hebrew has analogous forms (e.g., יִסֹּב, which comes from the root סבב).

קַרְנִין עֲשַׂר לַהּ expresses possession ("it had 10 horns"); this chapter of Daniel contains several other examples of this construction:

גַּפִּין דִּי נְשַׁר לַהּ (verse 4) means _____.

לַהּ גַּפִּין אַרְבַּע דִּי עוֹף (verse 6) means _____.

שְׁנַיִן דִּי פַרְזֶל לַהּ רַבְרְבָן (verse 7) means _____.

(9) חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי כָרְסָוָן רְמִיו וְעַתִּיק יוֹמִין יְתֵב לְבוּשֵׁהּ כְּתַלַג חִוָּר וּשְׂעַר רֵאשֵׁהּ
כַּעֲמַר נְקֵא כָּרְסְיֵהּ שְׁבִיבִין דִּי נוּר גַּלְגְּלוֹהִי נוּר דָּלִק. (10) נְהַר דִּי נוּר נָגֵד וְנָפֵק
מִן קֳדָמוֹהִי אֶלֶף אַלְפִים יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵּהּ וְרִבּוֹ רִבְבָן קֳדָמוֹהִי יְקוּמוּן דִּינָא יְתֵב
וְסִפְרִין פְּתִיחוּ.

Translate into English:

List all the passive verbs in this passage:

List all the active participles in this passage:

NOTICE that יְתִב is in the perfect; the *ḥiriq* is the theme vowel. The phrase דִּינָא יְתִב means "sat in justice."

What other verbs can you find in this passage?

Verb	*Root*	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*

Identify the suffixes on the following words:

כָּרְסָוָן (verse 9)

לִבוּשֵׁהּ (verse 9)

גַּלְגְּלוֹהִי (verse 9)

שְׁבִיבִין (verse 10)

דִּינָא (verse 10)

This passage, which is widely regarded as a poem (note the parallelistic sentence structure), is one of several throne visions in the Bible (compare 1 Kings 22:19, Isaiah 6, and Ezekiel 1, 3:23–34 and 10:1, as well as 1 Enoch 14:18–23). "The ancient of days" (עַתִּיק יוֹמִין) is God.

(11) חֲזֵה הֲוֵית בֶּאדַיִן מִן קֶל מִלַּיָּא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּי קַרְנָא מְמַלֶּלָה חֲזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי קְטִילַת חֵיוְתָא וְהוּבַד גִּשְׁמַהּ וְיְהִיבַת לִיקֵדַת אֶשָּׁא. (12) וּשְׁאָר חֵיוָתָא הֶעְדִּיו שָׁלְטָנְהוֹן וְאַרְכָה בְחַיִּין יְהִיבַת לְהוֹן עַד זְמַן וְעִדָּן.

Translate into English:

קֶל is equivalent to the Hebrew word _____.

קְטִילַת and הוּבַד are both passive forms; what are their roots and to what conjugations do they belong?

	Root	*Conjugation*
קְטִילַת		
הוּבַד		

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
מְמַלֶּלָה						
הֶעְדִּיו						

Identify the suffixes on the following words:

מִלַּיָּא

אֱשָׁא

גִּשְׁמַהּ

רַבְרְבָתָא

What is the difference between חֱיוָתָא (verse 11) and חֱיוָתָא (verse 10)?

זְמַן and עִדָּן are synonyms; the phrase זְמַן וְעִדָּן should, therefore, probably be understood as a hendiadys, meaning "a time and a(nother) time," i.e., "two times."

(13) חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ עִם עֲנָנֵי שְׁמַיָּא כְּבַר אֱנָשׁ אָתֵה הֲוָה וְעַד עַתִּיק יוֹמַיָּא מְטָה וּקְדָמוֹהִי הַקְרִבוּהִי. (14) וְלֵהּ יְהִיב שָׁלְטָן וִיקָר וּמַלְכוּ וְכָל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַּיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא לֵהּ יִפְלְחוּן שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם דִּי לָא יֶעְדֵּה וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי לָא תִתְחַבַּל.

Translate into English:

What is the function of the suffix on לֵילְיָא (verse 13)? The י corresponds to the final ה on the Hebrew form לַיְלָה, which cannot be a feminine ending since that invariably carries the accent; note the Hebrew form לֵיל, which occurs in Isaiah 16:3.

The phrase אָתֵה הֲוָה (verse 13) means _____ .

What is the relationship between מַלְכוּ and מַלְכוּתֵהּ (verse 14)?

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
אָתֵה						
מְטָה						
יְעִדֵה						
תִּתְחַבַּל						
יִפְלְחוּן						
הַקְרֵבוּהִי						

What is the subject of:

הַקְרֵבוּהִי (verse 13)

יִפְלְחוּן (verse 14)

The phrase כְּבַר אֱנָשׁ is famous, but problematic. בַּר is used in Aramaic, as בֶּן is in Hebrew, to indicate the possessor of a quality or the member of a class, in this case "human being" (אֱנָשׁ; cf. בֶּן אֱנוֹשׁ in Ps 144:3). The equivalent phrase (υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου) occurs in the New Testament, where its meaning is widely debated. For further discussion, see "The Son of Man" by John Bowker in *Journal of Theological Studies* new series 28 (1977) pp. 19–48, and "The New Testament Title 'Son of Man' Philologically Considered" by Joseph A. Fitzmyer in *A Wandering Aramean: Collected Aramaic Essays* (Missoula, MT: Scholars Press, 1979) pp. 143–60.

(15) אִתְכְּרִית רוּחִי אֲנָה דָנִיֵאל בְּגוֹא נִדְנֵה וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלָנְנִי. (16) קְרֵבֵת עַל
חַד מִן קָאֲמַיָּא וְיַצִּיבָא אֶבְעֵא מִנֵּה עַל כָּל דְּנָה וַאֲמַר לִי וּפְשַׁר מִלַּיָּא יְהוֹדְעִנְנִי.
(17) אִלֵּין חֵיוָתָא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּי אִנִּין אַרְבַּע אַרְבְּעָה מַלְכִין יְקוּמוּן מִן אַרְעָא.
(18) וְיִקְבְּלוּן מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְיַחְסְנוּן מַלְכוּתָא עַד עָלְמָא וְעַד עָלַם עָלְמַיָּא.

Translate into English:

NOTICE how the phrase אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל functions as an appositive to the pronominal suffix of רוּחִי in verse 15, resulting in the meaning: "my spirit—me, Daniel. . . ."

The reference to Daniel's spirit as having a sheath (נִדְנָה) suggests a distinction between the body and the mind, which emerged only late in the biblical period.

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
קְרֵבַת						
אֶבְעֵא						
יְהוֹדְעִנַּנִי						
יְקַבְּלוּן						
קָאֲמָיָא						

NOTICE how the weak middle letter of the hollow root קוּם has been "strengthened" to an א.

Although אֶתְכְּרִית (verse 15) clearly belongs to the Gt conjugation, the fact that it is perfect demonstrates that the א is not a pronominal prefix (the form is 3d person feminine singular), but softened from ה, making this an *ʾitpeʿel* form (compare the *hafʿel* conjugation, which sometimes weakens into *ʾafʿel*).

אִנִּין (verse 17) literally means _____; in this sentence, it functions as a copula, as pronouns often do in Aramaic and later Hebrew.

קַדִּישֵׁי (verse 18) is a term with a long and important history. In ancient Canaanite texts it refers to gods; however, the Hebrew Bible uses it primarily for angels (e.g., Psalm 89:6 and Job 15:15). Jews later applied it to themselves. In the Middle Ages, the Latin equivalent (*sanctus*) was used for "saints." (The English word is derived from the same Latin root.) For further reading on this term, see "The Saints of the Most High and Their Kingdom" by C. H. W. Brekelmans in *Oudtestamentische Studiën* 14 (1965) 305–29, and "The Identity of 'the Saints of the Most High' in Daniel 7" by G. F. Hasel in *Biblica* 56 (1975) 173–92.

(19) אֱדַיִן צְבִית לְיַצָּבָא עַל חֵיוְתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא דִּי הֲוָת שָׁנְיָה מִן כָּלְהֵן דְּחִילָה יַתִּירָה שַׁנַּיהּ דִּי פַרְזֶל וְטִפְרַיהּ דִּי נְחָשׁ אָכְלָה מַדֲקָה וּשְׁאָרָא בְּרַגְלַיהּ רָפְסָה. (20) וְעַל קַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר דִּי בְרֵאשַׁהּ וְאָחֳרִי דִּי סְלִקַת וּנְפַלָה מִן קֳדָמַיהּ תְּלָת וְקַרְנָא דְכֵן וְעַיְנִין לַהּ וּפֻם מְמַלֵל רַבְרְבָן וְחֶזְוַהּ רַב מִן חַבְרָתַהּ. (21) חָזֵה הֲוֵית וְקַרְנָא דְכֵן עָבְדָה קְרָב עִם קַדִּישִׁין וְיָכְלָה לְהוֹן. (22) עַד דִּי אֲתָה עַתִּיק יוֹמַיָּא וְדִינָא יְהַב לְקַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְזִמְנָא מְטָה וּמַלְכוּתָא הֶחֱסִנוּ קַדִּישִׁין.

Translate into English:

דִּכֵּן (verse 20) is what part of speech: _____

gender _____

number _____

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
צְבִית						
שְׁנִיָה						
דְּחִילָה						
מַדְקָה						
סִלְקַת						
נְפַלָה						
מְטָה						

The subject of נְפַלָה is _____.

NOTE that the description of the fourth beast in verse 19 includes the phrase טִפְרַיהּ דִי נְחָשׁ ("claws of bronze"), which is not found in verse 7 where it may, therefore, have been accidentally omitted.

(23) כֵּן אֲמַר חֵיוְתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא מַלְכוּ רְבִיעָיָא תֶּהֱוֵא בְאַרְעָא דִי תִשְׁנֵא מִן כָּל מַלְכְוָתָא וְתֵאכֵל כָּל אַרְעָא וּתְדוּשִׁנַּהּ וְתַדְקִנַּהּ. (24) וְקַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר מִנַּהּ מַלְכוּתָה עַשְׂרָה מַלְכִין יְקוּמוּן וְאָחֳרָן יְקוּם אַחֲרֵיהוֹן וְהוּא יִשְׁנֵא מִן קַדְמָיֵא וּתְלָתָה מַלְכִין יְהַשְׁפֵּל. (25) וּמִלִין לְצַד עִלָּיָא יְמַלֵל וּלְקַדִישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין יְבַלֵא וְיִסְבַּר לְהַשְׁנָיָה זִמְנִין וְדָת וְיִתְיַהֲבוּן בִּידֵהּ עַד עִדָּן וְעִדָּנִין וּפְלַג עִדָּן. (26) וְדִינָא יִתֵב וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ יְהַעְדּוֹן לְהַשְׁמָדָה וּלְהוֹבָדָה עַד סוֹפָא. (27) וּמַלְכוּתָה וְשָׁלְטָנָא וּרְבוּתָא דִי מַלְכְוָת תְּחוֹת כָּל שְׁמַיָּא יְהִיבַת לְעַם קַדִישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְכֹל שָׁלְטָנַיָּא לֵהּ יִפְלְחוּן וְיִשְׁתַּמְּעוּן.

Translate into English:

NOTICE the difference between אָחֳרָן ("another") and אַחֲרֵיהוֹן ("after them") in verse 24, which are comparable to the Hebrew pair אַחֵר ("other") and אַחֲרֵי ("after").

לְצַד (lit. "to the side of") apparently means "against" in verse 25.

עִדָּן וְעִדָּנִין וּפְלַג עִדָּן (verse 25) refers to the three and one half units of time (1 + 2 + 1/2) which are also mentioned in Daniel 8:14 and 9:27.

What form are the following verbs:

	Root	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*
תֶּהֱוֵה						
יִתְיַהֲבוּן						
יְהִיבַת						
יְהַשְׁפֵּל						

NOTICE that the ה is retained in this last form, as in the grammatically similar יְהַעְדּוֹן (verse 26).

To what conjugation does each of the following verbs belong:

יְמַלֵּל

יְבַלֵּא

יְסַבַּר

What is the root of:

לְהַשְׁנָיָה

לְהַשְׁמָדָה

לְהוֹבָדָה

All three of these words are _____.

What are the roots and the conjugations for the following verbs?

	Conjugation	*Root*
יִפָּלְחוּן		
יִשְׁתַּמְּעוּן		
יַהַעְדוֹן		

(28) עַד כָּה כּוֹפָא דִּי מַלְכָּה אֲנָה דָנִיאֵל שַׁגִּיא רַעְיוֹנַי יְבַהֲלֻנַנִי וְזִיו יְשַׁנּוֹן עֲלַי
יְמַלְכָּא בִּלְבַבִי נְטָרֵת׃

Translate into English:

NOTICE the similar phrase near the end of Ecclesiastes (12:13).

List all the verbs in this verse and give the form of each:

Verb	*Root*	*Conjugation*	*Tense*	*Person*	*Gender*	*Number*

Chapter 28

INSCRIPTIONS

The oldest surviving texts in Aramaic are inscriptions. We will consider three of these, one from the language's earliest known period, another that was found in a modern collection so that its original date and location are unknown, and a third that comes from a seventh-century synagogue.

The following words are common in inscriptions and should be learned:

brother . . . . . אח
evil (sometimes באש) . . ביש
remember . . . . . דכר
see . . . . . חמה
direct object marker . . . . ית
thus . . . . . כן
is not . . . . . לישה
open . . . . . פתח

Our earliest evidence of Aramaic's long history comes from a series of inscriptions which were found in northern Syria and had been written during the time of Israel's divided monarchy.* Several of these are from the rulers of a country known as Samʾal, a petty kingdom of the ninth and eighth centuries, a time during which the Arameans established several small countries in this region. (The Bible mentions Damascus, Zobah, Beth Rechob, and Maacah.) The example which follows is by one Barrakib, who apparently ruled Samʾal towards the end of the eighth century, about the same time that Amos, Hosea, Micah, and Isaiah were active in Israel. It was found at Zinjirli in northwest Syria at the end of the last century. A relief with his picture (see p. 168) is inscribed with the words אנה בר רכב בר פנמו at the top. This same phrase opens the much longer inscription which we will read here.

*These are conveniently collected in H. Donner and W. Röllig's *Kanaanäische und Aramäische Inschriften* (Wiesbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1966).



אנה בר רכב בר פנמו מלך שמאל עבד תגלתפליסר מרא רבעי ארקא.
בצדק אבי ובצדקי הושבני מראי רכבאל ומראי תגלתפליסר על כרסא אבי.
ובית אבי עמל מן כל. ורצת בגלגל מראי מלך אשור במצעת מלכן
רברבן בעלי כסף ובעלי זהב. ואחזת בית אבי והיטבתה מן בית חד
מלכן רברבן. והתנאבו אחי מלכיא לכל מה טבת ביתי. ובי טב
לישה לאבהי מלכי שמאל. הא בית כלמו להם פהא בית שתוא להם
והא בית כיצא. ואנה בנית ביתא זנה.

Vocabulary

אבה . . . . . desire (Htn)	זהב . . . . . gold
אחז . . . . . grasp	זנה . . . . . this
בי . . . . . *dialect form of* בית	טבה . . . . . goodness
גלגל . . . . . wheel	יטב . . . . . be pleasing (H)
הא . . . . . behold	ישב . . . . . settle (H)

Vocabulary (cont.)

righteousness	צדק	summer	כיץ
quarter	רבע	middle	מצעת
run	רוץ	exert oneself, toil	עמל
winter	שתו	and	פ-

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the above text.

Translate it into English:

Proper Names

בר רכב — This name is pronounced Barrakib according to an inscribed Hittite seal, where it is spelled out syllabically (*Orientalia* 20 [1957] 345).

פנמו — Pronounced Panamuwa according to cuneiform inscriptions from several Assyrian rulers (e.g., Tiglath Pileser III; see James Pritchard, *Ancient Near Eastern Texts Relating to the Old Testament,* pp. 282 and 283); *-muwa* was a common ending for names in Asia Minor (see כלמו below).

שמאל — The ancient name of the land in which Zinjirli is located; it may also have been called Yaudi.

תגלתפליסר — Tiglath Pileser III, who is mentioned several times in the Bible (2 Kings 15:29; 16:7, 10; 1 Chronicles 5:6, 26; 2 Chronicles 28:20); he is called by the Babylonian throne name Pul in 2 Kings 15:19.

רכבאל — The patron god of Sam'al.

כלמו — An earlier ruler of Sam'al from the ninth century, who is apparently the author of another inscription found in Zinjirli (see H. Donner and W. Röllig, *Kanaanäische und Aramäische Inschriften,* no. 24, and James Pritchard, *Ancient Near Eastern Texts Relating to the Old Testament,* p. 654).

NOTICE that we have already encountered ארקא in Jeremiah 10:11, where it is juxtaposed with the more common form ארעא, demonstrating two different realizations of the Semitic consonant *ḍ*, which appears as צ in Hebrew (i.e. ארץ).* The title רבעי ארקא מרא is a translation from Assyrian (*shar kibrat arba'i*).

מצעת (middle) can be compared with mishnaic אֶמְצַע; the second section of the talmudic tractate נְזִיקִין is called בָּבָא מְצִיעָא (the first section is בָּבָא קַמָּא and the last section בָּבָא בַּתְרָא, as explained on p. 153).

התנאבו appears to be a *hitnaf'al* form from a root related to אבה and יאב (wish); its meaning would be something like "envy" or "be jealous."

The most conspicuous features of this early inscription are the number of forms which agree with Hebrew, rather than biblical Aramaic:

הושבני contrast the form הותב (e.g., Ezra 4:10) from the root יתב.

לישה corresponding to the Akkadian *lā išu,* comes from the words לא יש ("it is not"); however it appears as ליח in other Aramaic sources, including the masoretes' marginal notes to the biblical text, where its abbreviation ל is used to identify forms that are spelled uniquely in the Hebrew text (see p. 55).

זהב is common in the Aramaic sections of the Bible, but appears there as דְּהַב (e.g., Ezra 5:14; 6:5, and often in Daniel 2, 3, and 5).

אחז usually spelled אחד in Aramaic.

זנה typically דְּנָה (but compare Hebrew זֶה).

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*The two forms are juxtaposed in the Elephantine letter (Cowley 6) presented in chapter 29.

רצת appears as רהט in Aramaic (compare Targum Onkelos with the original Hebrew in Genesis 24:20, 28, and 29).

These are all cases in which original Semitic sounds that came to be realized differently in Hebrew and in Aramaic (e.g., *ṯ* as שׁ or ת, *ṭ* as ט or צ, and *ḏ* as ז or ד) here follow the "Hebrew" (really Canaanite) spelling. This inscription may, therefore, have been written before these two branches of Northwest Semitic had fully separated. Thus the original *ṯ* appears as שׁ in הושב and ליש, *ṭ* as צ in רץ and כיץ, and *ḏ* as ז in זהב, אחז, and זנה.

כיצא — spelled קיט in biblical Aramaic (Daniel 2:35), but קיץ in Hebrew. The use of כ instead of ק may reflect a certain fluidity in spelling (so also שחו appears as סְחָו in Song of Songs 2:11). However, since the same spelling is found in several other inscriptions, it is more likely that dissimilation caused the ק to shift to כ, inasmuch as the word already had one sharpened letter (צ) in it.

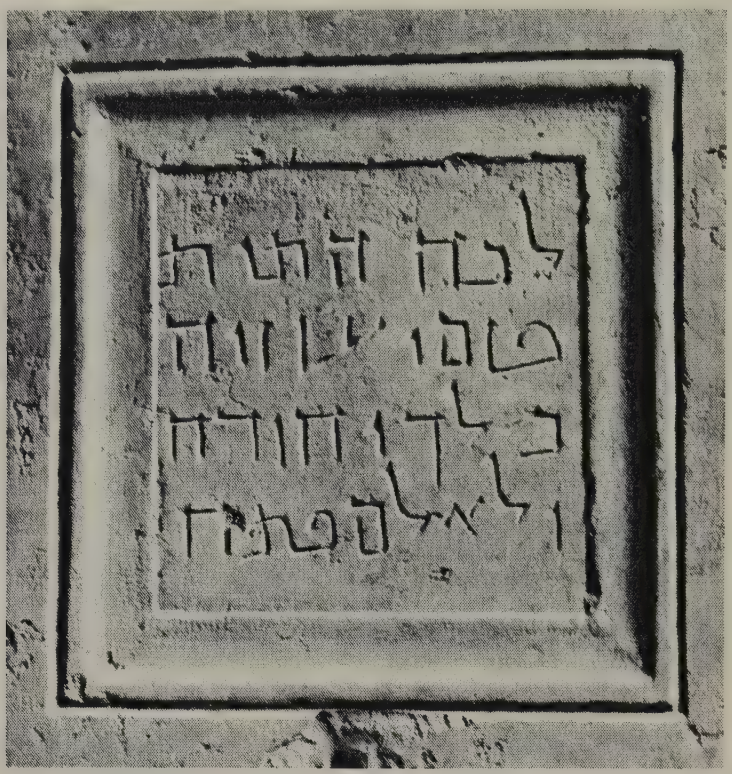
Several other features in this inscription are characteristically Aramaic:

SOUNDS: The *â* sound is evident in אנה (as opposed to Hebrew אֲנִי) and words like טב, whereas it shifted to *ô* in Hebrew.

WORDS: בר חד כרסא מרא רברבן

FORMS: The determined state (מלכיא, ביתא, ארקא);
masculine plural suffixes ending with *nun* (e.g., מלכן);
perfect, 1st person singular forms ending with *-ēt* rather than *-tî* (e.g., בנית and אחזת).

The next inscription was found on a stone plaque in a nineteenth-century collection of antiquities at the Russian convent on Jerusalem's Mount of Olives. It mentions Judah's King Uzziah, who reigned during the early part of the eighth century; however, its "Aramaic style" script was not adopted by Jews until the Babylonian Exile, when it replaced the "Phoenician" (Paleo-Hebrew) script that had been used during the monarchy period. The inscription itself was probably written sometime around the first century.



לכה התית טמי עוזיה מלך יהודה ולא למפתח.

Vocabulary

bone . . . . . טם

here . . . . . כה

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the above text.

Translate it into English:

התית is an H passive form of the common root אתה ("come," cf. Daniel 6:18).

עמי is equivalent to the Hebrew word עֶצֶם ("bone"). The loss of the ע suggests that it was not pronounced in this period; there are several reports in the Talmud indicating that the letters ע and א were often not distinguished in pronunciation during the early centuries of this era (*j. Berakhot* 2:4, *b. Berakhot* 32a, *b. Megillah* 24b, *b. Erubin* 53b).

למפתח the מ in this word is shaped like the form (ם) which is used today at the end of words (see the illustration on p. 172). Apparently, the two shapes we use for the letter מ were originally interchangeable (see Isaiah 9:6); over time, one of them (ם) was reserved for the end of words, probably on the basis of analogy with other letters in which medial (כ, נ, פ, צ) and final forms (ך, ן, ף, ץ) had come to be distinguished. Thus ם is the only final form that does not have a tail.

The prohibition against opening the vessel containing Uzziah's bones is typical of many inscriptions (for several Phoenician examples, see James Pritchard, *Ancient Near Eastern Texts Relating to the Old Testament,* pp. 661–62). 2 Chronicles 26:23 reports that King Uzziah, who suffered from leprosy, was buried in a special location outside Jerusalem's city wall (cf. Josephus, *Antiquities* 9:10.4 §227 and Nehemiah 3:15). This inscription, then, attests to his bones' having been moved some time after their initial burial.

A final inscription comes from the mosaic floor of a seventh-century synagogue located in ʿEin Gedi, along the western coast of the Dead Sea between Qumran and Masada. (An earlier, Hebrew section of the inscription lists several ancient biblical luminaries and the signs of the zodiac.)

דכירין לטב יוסה ועירון וחזיקיו בנוה דחלפי. כל מן דיהיב פלגו בן גבר לחבריה
הי אמר לשן ביש על חבריה לעממיה הי גניב צבותיה דחבריה הי מן דגלי רזה
דקרתה לעממיה דין דעינוה משוטטן בכל ארעה וחמי סתירתה הוא יתן אפוה
בגברה ההו ובזרעיה ויעקור יתיה מן תחות שומיה. וימרון כל עמה אמן ואמן
סלה. רבי יוסה בן חלפי חזקיו בן חלפי דכירין לטב. דרגי סגי
אנון עבדו לשמה דרחמנה שלום.

Vocabulary

selah *(liturgical term)* . . סלה	amen *(liturgical term)* . . . . . אמן
hidden thing . . . . . סתירה	nose . . . . . אף
uproot . . . . . עקר	between (בין) . . . . . בן
discord . . . . . פלג	steal . . . . . גנב
property . . . . . צבו(ת)	of . . . . . ד-
Merciful One . . . . . רחמן	stair . . . . . דרג
wander . . . . . שטט	seed . . . . . זרע

Proper Names

חזיקיו — This form conforms to a normal northern pattern for spelling the divine element at the end of names rather than the more familiar (southern) יהו-.

חלפי

יוסה

עירון

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the above text.

Translate it into English:

NOTICE the phrase דין דעינוה (lit. "This one, which his eyes," i.e. "the one whose eyes . . .").

Several features of this inscription are familiar from other Aramaic texts we have studied. For example, תחות occurs in the book of Daniel (also Jeremiah 10:11), as does the direct object marker ית (Daniel 3:12) in contrast to biblical Hebrew's את. דכירין and ארעה also reflect common Aramaic forms (contrast the Hebrew words זכרן and ארץ), as does דין. However, note שלום rather than שלם. Other notable spellings include:

בן for בין (between)
שומיא for שמיא (sky)
ימרון from the root אמר (say)
סגי for שגיא (much)

The last two examples, along with הי rather than the more common היא, suggest that the pronunciation of several consonants was becoming weaker. (See p. 70 regarding ש becoming ס; other examples are mentioned on pp. 171 and 206.)

On the other hand, this inscription contains several unfamiliar phenomena:

– passive participles (גניב and יהיב) used in apparently active contexts.
– the particle דִּ־ where biblical Aramaic uses דִּי.
– final י in words the Bible spells with ה (e.g., גלי and חמי).
– the determined suffix marked with ה rather than the biblical א.

Chapter 29

LETTERS

Several Aramaic letters have survived from various periods of antiquity. Although our interest here is linguistic, they provide important evidence for understanding the nature of ancient letters in general.

Vocabulary To Be Learned

women ..... נשין	fire ..... אש
burnt offering ... עלוה/עלתה	donkey ..... חמר
compassion ..... רחמן	month ..... ירח
break ..... תבר	to, with ..... לות
here ..... תנה	altar ..... מדבח
	self ..... נפש

The first letter was written in the fifth pre-Christian century at a Jewish settlement on the island of Yeb (Elephantine), which is north of the first cataract of the Nile, where the Aswan Dam is located today. The Persian Empire, which had conquered Egypt in 525 B.C.E., supported Jewish mercenaries in this military colony on the southern frontier of ancient Egypt. Their writings, on papyri, were discovered in the early part of the twentieth century. The following letter gives us a fair amount of information about the colony's history.

Lines 1–3

אל מראן בגוהי פחת יהוד. עבדיך ידניה וכנוחה כהניא זי ביב בירתא:

שלם מראן אלה שמיא ישאל שגיא בכל עדן ולרחמן ישימנך קדם דריוהוש מלכא

ובני ביתא יתיר מן זי כען חד אלף. וחין אריכן ינתן לך וחדה ושריר הוי

בכל עדן.

Vocabulary

long . . . . . אריך

fortress . . . . . בירתה

who, which . . . . . זי

happiness . . . . . חדה

life . . . . . חין

prosperous . . . . . שׂריר

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

Proper Nouns

בגוהי — governor of Judah, apparently after Nehemiah

ידניה — son of Gemariah, priest and leader of the Jewish community

דריהוש — Darius II, who ruled Persia from 423 to 403. The letter ends with the author's statement that he wrote this in the 17th year of Darius' reign, i.e. 407 B.C.E.

חד אלף — 1000 times; compare the phrase חַד שִׁבְעָה in Daniel 3:19 (see p. 90)

Lines 4–13

כען עבדך ידניה וכנותה כן אמרן: בירח תמוז שנת 14 דריהוש מלכא כזי ארשם נפק ואזל על מלכא כמריא זי אלהא חנוב אלהא זי ביב בירתא המונית עם וידרנג זי פרתרך תנה הוה. לם אגורא זי יהו אלהא זי ביב בירתא יהעדו מן תמה. אחר וידרנג זך לחיא אגרת שלח על נפין ברה זי רבחיל הוה בסון בירתא לאמר: אגורא זי ביב בירתא ינדשו. אחר נפין דבר מצריא עם חילא אחרנן אתו לבירת יב עם תליהם עלו באגורא זך נדשוהי עד ארעא ועמודיא זי אבנא זי הוו תמה תברו המו. אף הוה תרען זי אבן 5 בנין פסילה זי אבן זי הוו באגורא זך נדשו ודשיהם קימן וציריהם זי דששיא אלך נחש ומטלל עקהן זי ארז כלא זי עם שירית אשרנא ואחרן זי תמה הוה כלא באשה שרפו. ומזרקיא זי זהבא וכסף ומנדעמתא זי הוה באגורא זך כלא לקחו ולנפשהום עבדו.

Vocabulary

אגורא ..... temple	מטלל ..... roof
ארז ..... cedar	מנדעם ..... anything
אשרן ..... beams	נדש ..... destroy
דבר ..... lead (D)	עמוד ..... pillar
דש ..... door	עק ..... wood
המונית עם ... in agreement with	פסיל ..... cut stone
זי ,זך ..... that	פרתרך ..... governor
חיל ..... army	ציר ..... pivot (of a door)
כזי ..... when (cf. כדי)	קים ..... standing
כמר ..... priest	רבחיל ..... general
לחיא ..... evil	שרף ..... burn
לם ..... surely	שירי ..... remainder
לקח ..... take	תלי ..... weapon
מזרק ..... basin	תרע ..... gate

Use biblical vowels to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

Proper Nouns

אַרְשָׁם — Persian satrap over Egypt

חנוב — a male Egyptian god at Elephantine

וידרנג — commander of the Persian garrison at Elephantine and later *frataraka* ("foremost"), a position with judicial and military authority

יהו — the God of the Jews

נפין — son of Vidranga

מצריא — Egyptians

סון — Syene (ancient name of Elephantine); cf. Ezekiel 29:10 and 30:6

תמוז — a late summer month

רבחיל — the Bible includes several titles which are similarly constructed: - רַב שָׂקֵה, רַב סָרִיס, רַב מַג, רַב טַבָּחִים, רַב חַבֶּל

Lines 13–17

ומן יומי מלך מצרין אבהין בנו אגורא זך ביב בירתא. וכזי כנבוזי על למצרין אגורא זך בנה השכחה. ואגורי אלהי מצרין כל מגרו ואיש מנדעם באגורא זך לא חבל. וכזי כזנה עביד אנחנה עם נשין ובנין שקקן לבשן הוין וצימין ומצלין ליהו מרא שמיא זי החוין בוידרנג זך. כלביא הנפקו כבלא מן רגלוהי וכל נכסין זי קנה אבדו וכל גברין זי בעו באיש לאגורא זך כל קטילו וחזין בהום.

Vocabulary

be lost	אבד
chain	כבל
dog	כלב
throw down	מגר
property	נכס
fast	צים
buy	קנה
sackcloth	שׂקק

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

Proper Nouns

כנבוזי — Cambyses, son of Cyrus; ruled Persia from 530 to 522 B.C.E. He apparently found the Jewish temple already standing when he conquered Egypt in 525 B.C.E. His destruction of Egyptian temples while letting the Jewish one stand may have contributed to tension between Jews and Egyptians.

Lines 17–22

אף קדמת זנה בעדן זי זא באישתא עביד לן אגרה שלחן על מראן ועל יהוחנן כהנא רבא וכנותה כהניא זי בירושלם ועל אוסתן אחוהי זי ענני וחרי יהודיא. אגרא חדה לא שלחו עלין. אף מן ירח תמוז שנת 14 דריהוש מלכא ועד זנה יומא אנחנה שקקן לבשן וצימין. נשיא זילן כארמלה עבידן. משח לא משחין וחמר לא שתין. אף מן זכי ועד יום שנת 17 דריהוש מלכא מנחה ולבונה ועלוה לא עבדו באגורא זך.

Vocabulary

also ..... אך	incense ..... לבונה
widow ..... ארמלה	grain offering ..... מנחה
our ..... זילן	oil ..... משׁחי
that ..... זכי	anoint ..... משׁח
this ..... זנה	until ..... עד
noble ..... חרי	

Proper Nouns

יהוחנן — the high priest, mentioned also in Nehemiah 12:22 and 13:28

אוסתן — a Jew, brother of Anani

ענני — scribe and chancellor to Arsame; 1 Chronicles 3:24 mentions a descendant of David who bore the same name

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

This passage demonstrates that there were ties between the Jews of Elephantine and those in Jerusalem, an impression supported by the analogous links with those in Babylon described in the books of Ezra and Nehemiah.

Lines 22–30

כען עבדיך ידניה וכנותה ויהודיא כל בעלי יב כן אמרין. הן על מראן טב
אתעשת על אגורא זך למבנה בזי לא שבקן לן למבניה. חזי בעלי טבתך ורחמיך
זי תנה במצרין. אגרה מנך ישתלח עליהום על אגורא זי יהו אלהא למבניה
ביב בירתא לקבל זי בנה הוה קדמין. ומחתא ולבונתא ועלותא יקרבון על
מדבחא זי יהו אלהא בשמך ונצלה עליך בכל עדן אנחנה ונשין ובנין ויהודיא
כל זי תנה. הן כן עבדו עד זי אגורא זך יתבנה וצדקה יהוה לך קדם יהו אלה
שמיא מן גבר זי יקרב לה עלוה ודבחן דמן כדמי כסף כנכרין אלף ועל זהב.
על זנה שלחן הודען. אף כלא מליא באגרה חדה שלחן בשמן על דליה ושלמיה
בני סנאבלט פחת שמרין. אף בזנה זי עביד לן כלא ארשם לא ידע.
ב־20 למרחשון שנת 17 דריהוש מלכא.

Vocabulary

a coin . . . . . כנכר	1000 . . . . . אלף
grain offering (cf. מנחה) מחתא	sacrifice . . . . . דבח
intend (Gt–be thought) . עשת	price . . . . . דמי
merit . . . . . צדקה	gold . . . . . זהב

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

Proper Nouns

שלמיה and דליה — sons of Sanballat (people with the same names are mentioned in Ezra 2:60; 10:39, 41; and Nehemiah 3:30 and 13:13, supporting the picture of post-exilic Jewry presented both in this document and the Bible)

סנאבלט — (Akkadian Sin-uballiṭ)—governor of Samaria (cf. Nehemiah 2:19; 3:33; 6:1; etc.)

מרחשון — month in late fall

The most conspicuous linguistic feature in this letter is its use of ז where biblical Aramaic uses ד, especially for the demonstrative elements זנה, זך, and זכי as well as זי (cf. זיל). Note also זהב (biblical Aramaic has דהב). On the other hand, the spelling עק for "tree" contrasts with the Hebrew עץ; biblical Aramaic uses אע. (Compare the word ארקא that is found in Jeremiah 10:11 for the Hebrew ארץ, which Aramaic elsewhere presents as ארע.)

The redundant syntax of the phrase אחוהי זי ענני (lit. "his brother of Anani") is comparable to that found in biblical Aramaic, as described in chapter 16.

From almost six centuries later come a series of letters written by Simon bar Kosiba, who led a Jewish revolt against the Romans. He is better known by his title Bar Kochba (lit. "son of the star," based on Numbers 24:17). These documents, written in Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek, were found in caves near those which produced the famous Dead Sea Scrolls. The following example raises interesting possibilities about his religious views:

שמעון ליהודה בר מנשה לקרית ערביה: שלחת לך תרי חמרין די תשלח עמהן תרי גברין לות יהונתן בר בעין ולות מסבלה די יעמרן וישלחן למחניה לותך ללבין ואתרגין. ואת שלח אחרנין מלותך וימטון לך הדסין וערבין. ותקן יתהן ושלח יתהן למחניה הוא שלם.

Vocabulary

citron . . . . . אתרג

myrtle . . . . . הדס

palm . . . . . ללב

camp . . . . . מחנה

load . . . . . עמר

willow . . . . . ערבא

prepare . . . . . תקן

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

Proper Nouns

יהודה בר מנשה

יהונתן בר בעין — with Masabala, apparently Bar Kochba's military commander of Ein Gedi, to whom most of Bar Kochba's letters are addressed

מסבלה — son of Shimon

קרית ערביה — lit. "town of the Arabs" or "willows," where Judah was posted between Ein Gedi and Bar Kochba's main camp (presumably at Betar)

The preposition לות is a compound made of up -ל and ות (from יתּ, which occurs in Daniel 3:12); in other words, it is a double direct object marker, which appears once (מלותך) with an additional preposition (-מִ).

The reference to the palm (ללב), citron (אתרג), myrtle (הדס), and willow (ערבא) is reminiscent of the holiday of Sukkot (see traditional Jewish interpretations of Leviticus 23:40, as found in Targum Onkelos and *Mishnah Sukkah* 3–4, for example), at which time these four species are to be waved in celebration of a successful harvest.

Chapter 30

Dead Sea Scrolls

Several of the famous Dead Sea Scrolls, which were discovered during the 1940's and 1950's, are written in Aramaic. Many of these are the writings of a religious community that settled alongside the Wadi Qumran during the Hasmonean period (2d century B.C.E.), probably in order to avoid the wrath of the governing party in Jerusalem; other documents found there may have been the community's copies of more widely known writings.

The selections that follow are from a scroll called the Genesis Apocryphon (1QapGen) because it expands on passages in the book of Genesis. The sections here are based on Genesis 12, which describes Abraham and Sarah's visit to the land of Egypt. According to the Bible, Abraham was worried that the Pharaoh might have him killed so that he could have the beautiful Sarah for himself. In this passage, Abraham describes a dream he experienced as he entered Egypt, which foreshadows what he expected would happen there.

Vocabulary To Be Learned

face, nose . . . . . אנף

wife . . . . . אנתה

companion . . . . . חבר

lovely . . . . . יא

take . . . . . נסב

eye . . . . . עין

love . . . . . רחם

19:14–17

וחלמת אנה אברם חלם בלילה מעלי לארע מצרין. וחזית בחלמי והא ארז חד
ותמרא חדא יאיא שגיא. ובני אנוש אתו ובעון למקץ ולמעקר לארזא ולמשבוק
תמרתא בלחודיהה. ואכליאת תמרתא ואמרת אל תקוצו לארזא ארי תרינא
מן שרבא חדא. ושביק ארזא בטלל תמרתא ולא אתקץ.

Vocabulary

singly	לְחוד	human	אנוש
uproot	עקר	cedar	ארז
cut down	קצץ	dream	חלם
family	שׁרב	shadow	טלל
date	תמר	protest (*afʿel*)	כלא

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the above text.

Translate it into English:

מעלי — the G infinitive of עלל; other G infinitives in this passage are משׁבוק, מעקר, and מקץ.

-ל — marks the direct object (ארזא).

אכליאת — a perfect form from the root כלא, which must, therefore, belong to the *ʾafʿel* conjugation.

אל — introduces a negative command.

The next column of the scroll describes Sarah in a way that justifies Abraham's concern (Genesis 12:11), albeit one that seems more suitable to the Song of Songs than the book of Genesis:

20:2–8

כמה נציח ושפיר לה צלם אנפיהא . . . . . וכמא רקיק לה שער ראישה כמא יאין להין לה עיניהא ומא רגג הוא לה אנפהא וכול נץ אנפיהא . . . . . כמא יאא לה חדיה וכמא שפיר לה כול לבנהא דרעיהא מא שפירן וידיהא כמא כלילן וחמיד כול מחזה ידיהא. כמא יאין כפיה ומא אריכן וקטינן כול אצבעת ידיהא. רגליהא כמא שפירן וכמא שלמא להן לה שקיא. וכל בתולן וכלאן די יעלן לגנון לא ישפרן מנהא. ועל כול נשין שופר שפרה ועלי׳א שפרהא לעלא מן כולהן ועם כול שפרא דן חכמא שגי׳א עמהא ודלידיהא יאא.

Vocabulary

אריך . . . . . long	נץ . . . . . radiance, bloom
בתולה . . . . . virgin	נציח . . . . . splendid
גנון . . . . . bridal chamber	צלם . . . . . form
דיל- . . . . . *possessive* (*cf.* זיל)	קטין . . . . . delicate
דרע . . . . . arm	רגג . . . . . pleasant
חדה . . . . . breast	רקיק . . . . . soft
חמיד . . . . . attractive	שׁופר . . . . . beauty
כלה . . . . . bride	שׁלם . . . . . perfect
כליל . . . . . perfect	שׁפיר . . . . . beautiful
כף . . . . . hand	שׁפר . . . . . be beautiful
לבן . . . . . whiteness	שׁק . . . . . leg
מחזה . . . . . appearance	

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the above text.

Translate it into English:

דן is equivalent to the biblical demonstrative דְּנָה.

Although Abraham's statement about Sarah's beauty is surprising in light of the Bible's reference to her as having been 90 at the time Isaac was conceived (Genesis 17:17, cf. 18:12) and having lived in Canaan less than 25 years (cf. Genesis 12:4 and 17:1), her beauty was often noted in post-biblical literature. For example, the rabbis say that she lit up the entire land of Egypt (*Genesis Rabbah* 40:5).

20:8–11

וכדי שמע מלכא מלי חרקנוש ומלי תרין חברוהי די פם חד תלתהון ממללין שגי
רחמה ושלח לעובע דברהא וחזהא ואתמה על כול שפרהא ונסבהא לה לאנתא
ובעא למקטלני ואמרת שרי למלכא דאחי הוא כדי הוית מתגר על דילהא.
ושביקת אנה אברם בדילהא ולא קטילת. ובכית אנה אברם בכי תקיף אנה ולוט
בר אחי עמי בליליא כדי דבירת מני שרי באונס.

Vocabulary

force . . . . . אונס

cry . . . . . בכה

lead (away) . . . . . דבר

haste . . . . . עובע

wonder . . . . . תמה

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the above text.

Translate it into English:

Proper Nouns

חרקנוש — an Egyptian noble, not mentioned in any other traditions about this incident.

לוט — Abraham's nephew

NOTICE that שגי is spelled both with and without א.

אנתה corresponds to the Hebrew word אִשָּׁה (woman), with *t* realized as ת in Aramaic (it is שׁ in Hebrew) and the root's נ retained.

This document includes both די (the relative pronoun found throughout biblical Aramaic and at Elephantine in the form זי) and the particle דִּ־, as in the synagogue inscription from Ein Gedi.

מתגר ("benefit") is apparently an *ʾitpaʿal* of either אגר or תגר, both of which can mean "earn, gain."

Chapter 31

MIDRASH

Numerous passages in rabbinic literature are written in Aramaic, although not all texts use the same dialect and the language frequently shifts back and forth into Hebrew. The passage below is from *Genesis Rabbah,* a collection of rabbinic lore which was probably compiled in Palestine during the fifth century. It is arranged as a commentary on the book of Genesis. The following selection relates to the Bible's statement that Abraham's brother Haran died עַל פְּנֵי their father Terah (Genesis 11:28). That phrase is usually translated "in the presence of"; however, the rabbis understood it to mean that Haran had died "on account of" his father.

Vocabulary To Be Learned

place . . . . . אתר
bring (H) . . . . . יבל
when . . . . . כיון
die . . . . . מות
deliver . . . . . מסר
human . . . . . נש

תרח עובד צלמים הוה. חד זמן נפק לאתר הושיב אברהם מוכר תחתיו. הוה אתי בר נש בעי דיזבון. אמר ליה: בר כמה שנין את? אמר ליה: בר חמשין. אמר ליה: ווי להההוא גברא דאת בר חמשין ותסגוד לבר יומא. והוה מתבייש והולך לו.

Vocabulary
(Words marked with an asterisk are Hebrew.)

set (H) . . . . . ישב
how many . . . . . כמה
sell . . . . . * מכר
instead of . . . . . * תחת
embarrass (Dt) . . . . . * בוש
that . . . . . ההוא
woe! . . . . . ווי
buy . . . . . זבן
fifty . . . . . חמשין

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

NOTICE the intermingling of Hebrew and Aramaic. Forms like צלמים, and תחת are clearly Hebrew (perhaps הושיב, too, although it also occurs in the Barrakib inscription presented in chapter 29; the form הותיב is found throughout the book of Daniel); however, חד, זמן, נפק, בר, and לאתר are Aramaic, as is the particle ד־.

בר is often used to indicate a quality, as in the phrase בר נש (human being). With a time span, it indicates age:

בר כמה שנין	how old
בר חמשין	fifty years old
בר יומא	one day old

סגד ("bow down") also occurs in Arabic, where it provides the root for the word *masjid,* which designates a place of worship, just as מַזְבֵּחַ designates a place of sacrifice, i.e., an altar, and מִשְׁכָּב a place of lying, i.e., a bed. The Arabic word has come into English in the form "mosque."

חד זמן אתת איתתא טעינא חד פינך דסלת. אמרת ליה: הא לך קרב קדמיהון. קם נסיב בוקלסה ותברהון ויהב ההוא בוקלסה בידוי דרבה דבהון. כון דאתא אבוה אמר ליה: מה עבד להון כדין? אמר ליה: מה נכפור לך? אתת חדא איתתא טעינא חד פינך דסלת ואמרת לי: קרב קדמיהון. דין אמר: אנא אכיל קדמאי ודין אמר: אנא אכיל קדמאי. קם הדין רבה נסיב בוקלסה ותברהון. אמר ליה: מה את מפלה בי ידעין אינון. אמר ליה: ולא ישמעו אזניך מפיך.

Vocabulary
(Words marked with an asterisk are Hebrew.)

how	* מה	ear	* אזן
flour	סלת	eat	אכל
mouth	* פה	club	בוקלסא
plate	פינך	this	דין
trick	פלא	that	ההוא
first	קדמאי	carry	טען
sacrifice (D)	קרב	deny	* כפר

Vocalize the passage above using biblical vowels.

Translate it into English:

NOTICE the use of י as a vowel marker (*mater lectionis*), particularly in the participles (נפיק and טעין).

איתתא (woman) is the determined form, although its sense is indefinite (see p. 25). Its root is אנת, as shown by the form אנתה in the Genesis Apocryphon (chapter 30). In the Hebrew form of this word (אִשָּׁה) the נ has assimilated to the שׁ, as it does to the ת here. In the Genesis Apocryphon either the נ had not assimilated or the double ת dissimilated (like the H infinitive הנעלה, which comes from the root עלל; see p. 119).

נסתיה ומסרתיה לנמרוד. אמר ליה: נסגוד לנורא. אמר ליה: נסגוד למייא דמטפין לנורא. אמר ליה: ונסגוד למיא. אמר ליה: נסגוד לענני דטענ מיא. אמר ליה: ונסגוד לעננא. אמר ליה: נסגוד לרוחא דמובלי עננא. אמר ליה: ונסגוד לרוחא. אמר ליה: נסגוד לבר נשא דסביל רוחא. אמר ליה: מלין את משתע. לא נסגוד אלא לאור. הריני משליכך בו ויבוא אלהיך שאתה משתחוה לו ויצילך ממנו.

Vocabulary
(Words marked with an asterisk are Hebrew.)

lift . . . . . נסה	flame . . . . . אור
save (H) . . . . . * נצל	except . . . . . אלא
endure . . . . . סבל	god . . . . . * אלוהים
cloud . . . . . ענן	behold . . . . . * הרי
throw (H) . . . . . שלך	extinguish (*ʾafʿel*) . . . . . טפה
talk (Gt) . . . . . שעה	water . . . . . מייא
	prostrate self . . . . . * משתחוה

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage.

Translate it into English:

The rabbis regarded Nimrod, who is mentioned in Genesis 10:8–10, as having been a powerful but wicked ruler who tried to impose his form of idolatry on all the ancient peoples under his control.

הוה תמן הרן קאים פליג. אמר: מה נפשך? אם נצח אברם אנא אמר מן דאברם אנא אם נצח נמרוד אמר אנא מנמרוד אנא. כיון שירד אברם לכבשן האש ונוצל אמרין ליה מן דמן את? אמר ליה: מן דאברם. נטלוהו והשליכוהו באש ונחמרו מעיו ויצא ומת על פני אבוו. הדא הוא דכתיב וימת הרן על פני תרח אביו.

Vocabulary
(Words marked with an asterisk are Hebrew.)

belly	מעין	parch	חמר
will	* נפשׁ	go out	* יצא
win	* נצח	descend	* ירד
be saved (N)	* נוצל	furnace	* כבשׁן
divided	פליג	on the side of	מִן דְּ־

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

הדא הוא דכתיב (this is what is written)—introduces a biblical quotation, in this case the passage from Genesis (11:28) that the preceding story is intended to explain.

NOTICE the interweaving of Hebrew and Aramaic in this selection. The verbs נוצל and נחמרו are *nif'al,* a conjugation which does not occur in biblical Aramaic. The following phrases are pure Hebrew:

הושיב אברהם מוכר תחתיו

ולא ישמעו אזניך מפיך

הריני משליכך בו ויבוא אלהיך שאתה משתחוה לו ויצילך ממנו

ויצא ומת על פני אביו

Chapter 32

TARGUM

With the spread of Aramaic among Jews after the Babylonian exile, the Hebrew Bible became increasingly inaccessible. It was, therefore, translated into Aramaic. Reciting such a translation was even required as part of liturgical Scripture reading (*Mishna Megillah* 4:4, cf. *Babylonian Talmud Berakhot* 8a). Several different translation traditions developed, some of which were eventually written down in what have come to be known as targumim (the root first occurs in Ezra 4:7, where it introduces the Aramaic section of that book). The most important of these are a translation of the Pentateuch attributed to Onkelos and one of the Prophets attributed to Jonathan. (These names may be related to Aquila and Theodotion, who were considered the authors of ancient Greek translations of the Bible; the latter means "God gives" in Greek, just as Jonathan does in Hebrew, while Aquila and Onkelos are phonetically close.) Although these versions tend to follow the original Hebrew rather closely, other Aramaic translations expand on the biblical text. Among these is a targum to the Pentateuch which appears to have reached its present form in Palestine sometime after the seventh century and has traditionally come to be ascribed to Jonathan (hence scholars' reference to it as Pseudo-Jonathan). Its rendering of the biblical text is considerably more expansive than that of Onkelos, as demonstrated by its translation of Genesis 22 (the binding of Isaac):

Vocabulary To Be Learned

inherit	ירת	after	בתר *
height	מרום	behold, how	האנא
slaughter	נכס	lift	זקף
on	עילי	instead of	חולף
place	שׁוה	young servant	טליה

*From באתר; see p. 62 and Daniel 2:29 (p. 80) and 7:6–7 (pp. 152–54).

(1) והוה בתר פיתגמיא האילין מן דינצו יצחק וישמעאל. ישמעאל הוה אמר: לי חמי למירות ית אבא דאנא בריה בוכרייא. ויצחק הוה אמר: לי חמי למירות ית אבא דאנא בר שרה אינתתיה ואנת בר הגר אמתא דאימי. עני ישמעאל ואמר: אנא זכאי יתיר מינך דאנא איתגזרית לתלסירי שנין ואין הוה צבותי למעכבא לא הוינא מסר נפשי לאתגזרא. ואנת אתגזרת בר תמניא יומין אילו הוה בך מנדעא דילמא לא הוית מסר נפשך לאתגזרא. מתיב יצחק ואמר: האנא יומנא בר תלתין ושב שנין ואילו בעי קודשא בריך הוא לכולי איבריי לא הויתי מעכב. מן יד אישתמעו פיתגמיא האילין קדם מרי עלמא ומן יד מימרא דיי נסי ית אברהם ואמר ליה: אברהם.

Vocabulary

איבר ..... organ	מן יד ..... immediately
אילו ..... if	מנדע ..... understanding
אין ..... if	נסי ..... test
אם ..... mother	נצה ..... quarrel
אמתא ..... handmaid	עכב ..... refuse
בוכריא ..... senior	צבו ..... wish
דילמא ..... perhaps	קודשא ..... holy
זכאי ..... worthy	שב(ע) ..... seven
יומנא ..... today	תלסירי ..... thirteen
מימרא ..... word	תלתין ..... thirty
מן די ..... after	תמניא ..... eight

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

יי is the way God's name is presented in this manuscript.

NOTE: (a) the use of י as a vowel letter (*mater lectionis*) in:
nouns – פיתגם, מימרי, אימי, אינת
Gt verbs – אישתמע, איתגזר
final ה verbs – עני

(b) that the passive participle of חמי ("see") means "fitting," as does the passive form of the Hebrew verb ראה (ראוי)

(c) the Hebrew definite article on the demonstrative element in the phrase פיתגמיא האילין

(d) characteristically Aramaic features such as the direct object marker ית and the particle ד־.

ואמר ליה: האנא. (2) ואמר: דבר כדון ית ברך ית יחידך דאת רחים
ית יצחק ואיזל לך לארע פולחנא ואסיקֵהי תמן לעלתא על חד מן טווריָא
דאימר לך. (3) ואקדים אברהם בצפרא וזריז ית חמריה ודבר ית תרין טלייוי
ית אליעזר וית ישמעאל עימיה וית יצחק בריה וקטע קיסין דזיתא ותאנתא ודיקלא
דחזיין לעלתא וקם ואזל לאתרא דאמר ליה ייי. (4) ביומא תליתאה וזקף
אברהם ית עינוי וחמא ענן איקרא קטיר על טוורא ואשתמודעיה מן רחיק
(5) ואמר אברהם לעולימוי: אוריכן לכון הכא עם חמרא ואנא ועולימא נתמטי
עד כא לבחוני אין יתקיים מה דאתבשרית כדין יהון בנך ונסגוד למרי עלמא ונתוב
לוותכון. (6) ונסיב אברהם ית קיסי דעלתא ושוי עילוי יצחק בריה ונסיב בידיה
ית אישתא וית סכינא ואזלו תרוויהום כחדא. (7) ואמר יצחק לאברהם אבוי
ואמר: אבא. ואמר: האנא. ואמר: הא אישתא וקיסין והאן אימרא לעלתא?
(8) ואמר אברהם: ייי יבחר ליה אימרא לעלתא ברי: ואזלו תרויהום בלב שלים
כחדא.

Vocabulary

wait (אוריך ארך *ʾafʿel*)	here כא
lamb אימר	now כדון
if אין	here כה
glory איקרא (יקר *with prosthetic* א)	knife סכין
recognize אשתמודע	youth עולימו
examine בחן	cloud ענן
choose בחר	worship פולחן
announce (Gt) בשר	morning צפרא
seize, take דבר	do early (H, *ʾafʿel*) קדם
palm דיקלא	Dt (התקיים) be fulfilled . קום
behold הא	cut קטע
here הכא	rise in circle קטר
olive זית	wood קיסא
saddle זרז	perfect שלים
only יחיד	fig תאנה

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

כדין יהון בנך is the targum's rendering of the biblical phrase כֹּה יִהְיֶה זַרְעֶךָ in Genesis 15:5, where God promises Abraham that his descendants will be as numerous as the stars.

The spelling עים and אישתא further demonstrate the generous use of vowel letters in this text.

אסיק is an *ʾafʿel* form of the root סלק (cf. הַסְּקוּ in Daniel 3:23; see p. 119); note also אתבשר, which is *ʾitpeʿal* (the form is 3d person masculine singular perfect), and אשתמודעין, which is a verb based on the noun מודע (in the "*ʾishtafʿal*"). נתמטי is *nitpaʿel,* a mixture of *hitpaʿel* and *nifʿal.*

חזי (fitting) is a passive participle of חזה (see), providing yet again an example of a verb which means "to see" being used for "fitting" in the passive (others are Aramaic חמי and Hebrew ראוי).

(9) ואתו לאתרא דאמר ליה ייי ובנא תמן אברהם ית מדבחא דבנא אדם
ואיתפכר במוי דטובענא ותב נח ובנייה ואיתפכר בדרא דפלוגתא. וסדר עילוי ית
קיסיא וכפת ית יצחק בריה ושוי יתיה על מדבחא לעיל מן קיסין. (10) ופשט
אברהם ית ידיה ונסיבת סכינא למיכס ית בריה. עני ואמר יצחק לאבוי: כפת יתי
יאות דלא נפרכס מן צערא דנפשי ונדחי לגובא דחבלא וישתכח פסולא בקרבנך.
עייניי דאברהם מסתכלן בעינויי דיצחק ועייניי דיצחק מסתכלן למלאכי מרומא.
יצחק הוה חמי יתהום ואברהם לא חמי יתהום. עניין מלאכי מרומא: איתון חמון
תרין יחידאין דאית בעלמא חד נכיס וחד מתנכיס. דנכיס לא מעכב ודמתנכיס
פשיט צווריה. (11) וקרא ליה מלאכא דייי מן שמיא ואמר ליה: אברהם אברהם.
ואמר: האנא . (12) ואמר: אל תושיט ידך לטלייא ולא תעביד ליה מידעם ביש.
ארום כדון גלי קדמי ארום דחלא דייי אנת ולא עכיבתא ית ברך ית יחידך מיני.
(13) וזקף אברהם ית עינוי וחזא והא דיכרא חד דאיתברי ביני שימשתא דשכלול
עלמא אחיד בחרישותא דאילנא בקרנוי. ואזל אברהם ונסיב יתיה ואסיקהי
לעלתא חולף בריה.

Vocabulary

arrange . . . . . סדר
knife . . . . . סכין
look (Dt) . . . . . סכל
above . . . . . עיל
refuse . . . . . עכב
destroy . . . . . פכר
division . . . . . פלוגתא
blemish . . . . . פסולא
struggle . . . . . פרכס
extend . . . . . פשט
neck . . . . . צוור
pain . . . . . צער
wood . . . . . קיסא
offering . . . . . קרבן
place . . . . . שׁוה
sun . . . . . שׁמשׁ
twilight . . . ביני שׁימשׁתא
completion . . . . . שׁכלול

catch . . . . . אחד
plural participle of אתה . . . איתון
behold . . . . . ארום
create . . . . . ברי
thrust . . . . . דחה
ram . . . . . דיכרא
destruction . . . . . חבלה
thicket . . . . . חרישׁותא
flood . . . . . טובען
well . . . . . יאות
only . . . . . יחיד
stretch forth (H) . . . . . ישׁט
now . . . . . כדון
slaughter . . . . . כסס
water . . . . . מוי
anything . . . . . מידעם
(*see* מנדעם *on p. 178*)
banish . . . . . נדח

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

בנא must be understood as "rebuild" in this context.

פלוגתא (division) is a traditional term for the dispersion which took place after the confrontation with God involving the Tower of Babel.

נפרכס — this dialect of Aramaic uses נ- for the imperfect first person singular prefix.

עינוי דאברהם is a redundant construction, which literally means "his eye of Abraham," i.e., "Abraham's eye" (see p. 85).

איתברי — this Gt form is based on the root ברי (create), which corresponds to the Hebrew root ברא; note the convergence of final א and final ה verbs in Aramaic.

ביני שימשתא — "twilight"; according to rabbinic tradition, God created several important things just before sunset during the week of creation (e.g., *Mishna Avot* 5:6).

(14) ואודי וצלי אברהם תמן באתרא ההוא ואמר: בבעו ברחמין מן קדמך יי גלי
קדמך דלא הוה בלבבי עוקמא ובעית למיעבד גזירתך בחדווא. כדין כד יהון
בנוי דיצחק ברי עליין לשעת אניקי תהוי מידכר להום ועני יתהום ופריק יתהום.
ועתידין הינון כל דריא דקימון למהוי אמרין: בטוורא הדין כפת אברהם ית יצחק

בריה ותמן איתגליית עילוי שכינתא דיי. (15) וקרא מלאכא דיי לאברהם תניינות מן שמיא (16) ואמר: במימרי קיימית אמר יי חולף דעבדת ית פיתגמא הדין ולא מנעת ית ברך ית יחידך (17) ארום ברכא אברכינך ואסגא אסגי ית בנך ככוכבי שמיא והי כחלא דעל כיף ימא. וייתון בנך ית קוריי שנאיהון. (18) ויתברכון בגין זכוות בנך כל עממי ארעא חולף דקבילתא במימרי. (19) ודברו מלאכי מרומא ית יצחק ואובלוהי לבי מדרשא דשם רבא והוה תמן תלת שנין. ובההוא יומא תב אברהם לות עולימוי וקמו ואזלו כחדא לבירא דשבע. ויתיב אברהם בבירא דשבע. (20) והוה בתר פתגמיא האילין מן בתר דיכפת אברהם ית יצחק ואזל סטנא ותני לות שרה דאברהם נכס ית יצחק. וקמת שרה ופגנת ואשתנקת ומיתת מן אניקא.

Vocabulary

אניקה ..... anguish	מימרא ..... word
ארום ..... behold	מלאך ..... angel
בגין ..... on account of	מנע ..... withhold
*בן ..... son	סגי ..... multiply (H)
בי מדרש ..... school house	סטנה ..... Satan
בעו ..... petition	עולימו ..... youth
ברכה ..... blessing	עוקמא ..... trickery
גזירה ..... decree	פגן ..... cry out
זכו ..... innocence	פרק ..... save
חדווא ..... joy	קורא ..... city
חל ..... sand	קיים ..... swear
ידה ..... praise (H/*ʾafʿel*)	שנא ..... hate
ים ..... sea	שכינתא .... Divine Presence
יתב ..... dwell	שנק ..... choke (Gt)
כדון ..... now	תני ..... tell
כוכב ..... star	תנינות ..... second
כיף ..... shore	

Use the biblical vowel system to vocalize the passage above.

Translate it into English:

סגי — This word is consistently spelled שַׂגִּיא in the Bible, but סגי at Ein Gedi (p. 173). The letter שׂ came to be written ס in post-biblical Aramaic. Two examples of this which can be found already in the Bible are the spelling of the name אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא in Ezra 7:21 and of כַּסְדִּי in Ezra 5:12 (see p. 38).

שכינה — is a hypostasis of God's presence, as is God's מימרא (cf. the end of verse 1; the term is used more literally in verse 18).

בי — from בית

בירא דשבע — "the well of seven," a literal translation of the name Beer-sheba in accordance with the explanation of it given in Genesis 21:25–31.

Afterword

The biblical readings in this book have covered the substance of the entire Aramaic corpus in the Hebrew Bible; however, these passages have been abridged and simplified to fit the levels appropriate to the individual chapters in which they are found. Now that you are familiar with the language's grammar, you can read all of these texts in the original. The vocabulary is readily available in most standard biblical dictionaries, including:

A Hebrew and English Lexicon of the Old Testament by Francis Brown, S. R. Driver, and Charles A. Briggs (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1907).

Lexicon in Veteris Testamenti Libros by Ludwig Koehler and Walter Baumgartner (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1958).

Hebräisches und Aramäisches Lexikon zum alten Testament, Aramaic section ed. Johann Jakob Stamm and Benedikt Hartmann (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1995), translated into English under the supervision of M. E. J. Richardson as *The Hebrew and Aramaic Lexicon of the Old Testament* (vol. 5, 2000).

In addition, Ernestus Vogt's *Lexicon linguae aramaicae veteris testamenti documentis antiquis illustratum* (Rome: Pontifical Biblical Institute, 1971) is devoted solely to biblical Aramaic. The standard biblical concordances (by S. Mandelkern, G. Lisowsky, and A. Even-Shoshan) also include Aramaic sections.

There are several valuable commentaries on the biblical books which contain passages in Aramaic. The most useful ones on Ezra are by Loring Batten (International Critical Commentary), Jacob Myers (Anchor Bible), and H. G. M. Williamson (Word Biblical Commentary). For Daniel, see those by James Montgomery (International Critical Commentary), John Collins (Hermeneia), and Louis Hartman and Alexander Di Lella (Anchor Bible).

The following tools will prove helpful for grammatical questions that may arise as you read selections from the Bible or investigate specific problems:

Franz Rosenthal, *A Grammar of Biblical Aramaic* (Wiesbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1963).

Hans Bauer and Pontus Leander, *Grammatik des Biblisch-Aramäische* (Halle/Saale: Max Niemayer Verlag, 1927).

Several other bodies of literature are written in Aramaic. The best sources for ancient Aramaic inscriptions are:

Herbert Donner and Wolfgang Röllig, *Kanaanäische und Aramäische Inschriften* (Wiesbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1971–76).

John C. L. Gibson, *Textbook of Syrian Semitic Inscriptions,* vol. 2, "Aramaic Inscriptions" (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1975).

Joseph A. Fitzmyer and Daniel J. Harrington, *A Manual of Palestinian Aramaic Texts* (Rome: Biblical Institute Press, 1978).

Arthur E. Cowley, *Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century B.C.* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1923).

Emil G. Kraeling, *The Brooklyn Museum Aramaic Papyri* (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1953).

G. R. Driver, *Aramaic Documents of the Fifth Century B.C.* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, rev. ed., 1965).

Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, *Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt* (Jerusalem: Hebrew University, 1986–99).

In addition to the glossaries in these works, the following dictionaries may prove helpful:

Charles-F. Jean and Jacob Hoftijzer, *Dictionnaire des inscriptions de l'ouest* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1965).

Jacob Hoftijzer and Karel Jongeling, *Dictionary of the North-West Semitic Inscriptions* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1995).

Several of the Dead Sea Scrolls are in Aramaic. Many of these texts are collected in:

Florentino García Martínez and Eilbert J. C. Tigchelaar, *The Dead Sea Scrolls Study Edition* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1997).

B. Jongeling, C. J. Labuschagne, and A. S. van der Woude, *Aramaic Texts from Qumran* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1976–).

Klaus Beyer, *Die Aramäischen Texte vom Toten Meer* (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1987).

The diversity of rabbinic literature, much of which is written in a mixture of Aramaic and Hebrew, and the targumim makes it impossible to provide a definitive list of the material available. Most of the targumim are published in:

Alexander Sperber, *The Bible in Aramaic* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1959–73).

E. G. Clarke, *Targum Pseudo-Jonathan of the Pentateuch* (Hoboken, NJ: Ktav Publishing House, 1984).

Michael L. Klein, *The Fragment-Targums of the Pentateuch According to their Extant Sources* (Rome: Biblical Institute Press, 1980).

Alejandro Díez Macho, *Neophyti I* (Madrid: Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, 1968).

The best available tools for working with this material are:

Marcus Jastrow, *A Dictionary of the Targumim, the Talmud Babli and Jerusalmi, and the Midrashic Literature* (New York: G. P. Putnam's Sons, 1903; reprinted often).

Michael Sokoloff, *A Dictionary of Jewish Palestinian Aramaic of the Byzantine Period* (Ramat Gan: Bar-Ilan University Press, 1990).

The Syrian church and its adherents also produced a vast literature in the Syriac dialect. The best available dictionaries for this dialect are:

C. Brockelmann, *Lexicon Syriacum* (Hallis: Saxonum, 1928).

R. Payne Smith, *Thesaurus Syriacus* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1879; supplement by J. P. Margoliouth, 1927).

Reference tools for other dialects of Aramaic include:

Friedrich Schulthess, *Lexicon Syropalaestinum* (Berlin: Georg Reimer, 1903).

Ethel Drower and R. Macuch, *A Mandaic Dictionary* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1963).

J. A. MacLean, *A Dictionary of the Dialects of Vernacular Syriac* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1901).

Gotthelf Bergsträsser, *Glossar des neuaramäischen Dialekts von Maʿlūla* (1921).

Helmut Ritter, *Tūrōyo: Die Volkssprache der syrischen Christen des Tūr ʿAbdîn* (Beirut: Orient-Institut der Deutschen Morgenländischen Gesellschaft, 1976).

Rudolf Macuch, *Grammatik des samaritanischen Aramäisch* (Berlin: De Gruyter, 1982).

In recent years, scholars have begun to compile a Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon, which will embrace the entire language. As work proceeds on this project, a variety of tools and reference works are being generated; already available is the first part of *An Aramaic Bibliography* by Joseph A. Fitzmyer, S.J., and Stephen A. Kaufman (Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 1992). You may also wish to read some general descriptions of the Aramaic languages. Broad surveys of this type include:

Eduard Yechezkel Kutscher, "Aramaic" in *Current Trends in Linguistics,* ed. Thomas A. Seboek (The Hague: Mouton, 1970), vol. 6, pp. 347–412.

Eduard Yechezkel Kutscher, "Aramaic," *Encyclopedia Judaica* (Jerusalem: Keter Publishing, 1972), vol. 3, pp. 259–87.

Joseph A. Fitzmyer, S.J., "The Phases of the Aramaic Language" in *A Wandering Aramean: Collected Aramaic Essays* (Chico, CA: Scholars Press, 1979) pp. 57–84.

Klaus Beyer, *The Aramaic Language* (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1986).

Stephen A. Kaufman, "Languages (Aramaic)" in *The Anchor Bible Dictionary* (New York: Doubleday, 1992), vol. 4, pp. 173–78.

With these tools and the grammar you have already learned, you can begin to explore any part of the huge corpus of Aramaic literature. Good luck!

Paradigms

Nouns and Adjectives

		Masculine	*Feminine*
Singular	*Absolute*	מֶלֶךְ	מַלְכָּה
	Construct	מֶלֶךְ	מַלְכַּת
	Determined	מַלְכָּא	מַלְכְּתָא
Plural	*Absolute*	מַלְכִין	מַלְכָן
	Construct	מַלְכֵי	מַלְכָת
	Determined	מַלְכַיָּא	מַלְכָתָא

Pronouns

Independent Pronouns		*Possessive Suffixes*			
		Singular Nouns		*Plural Nouns*	
Singular		*Masculine*	*Feminine*	*Masculine*	*Feminine*
אֲנָה		פִּשְׁרִי	מַלְכוּתִי	פִּשְׁרַי	מַלְכָוָתִי
אַנְתָּ	(or אַנְתָּה)	פִּשְׁרָךְ	מַלְכוּתָךְ	פִּשְׁרָיִךְ	מַלְכָוָתָךְ
אַנְתִּי		פִּשְׁרֵכִי	מַלְכוּתֵכִי	פִּשְׁרַיכִי	מַלְכָוָתֵכִי
הוּא		פִּשְׁרֵהּ	מַלְכוּתֵהּ	פִּשְׁרוֹהִי	מַלְכָוָתֵהּ
הִיא		פִּשְׁרַהּ	מַלְכוּתַהּ	פִּשְׁרַיהּ	מַלְכָוָתַהּ
Plural					
אֲנַחְנָה		פִּשְׁרָנָא	מַלְכוּתָנָא	פִּשְׁרַינָא	מַלְכָוָתָנָא
אַנְתוּן	(אַנְתֵּם)	פִּשְׁרְכֹם	מַלְכוּתְכֹם	פִּשְׁרֵיכֹם	מַלְכָוָתְכֹם
אַנְתֵּן		פִּשְׁרְכֶן	מַלְכוּתְכֶן	פִּשְׁרֵיכֶן	מַלְכָוָתְכֶן
הִמּוֹ	(אִנּוּן or הִמּוֹן)	פִּשְׁרְהֹם	מַלְכוּתְהֹם	פִּשְׁרֵיהֹם	מַלְכָוָתְהֹם
אִנִּין		פִּשְׁרְהֶן	מַלְכוּתְהֶן	פִּשְׁרֵיהֶן	מַלְכָוָתְהֶן

Demonstratives

		Singular	*Plural*
Near (this, these)	*Masculine*	דְּנָה	אִלֵּין (*also* אֵל *and* אֵלֶּה)
	Feminine	דָּא	
Far (that, those)	*Masculine*	דֵּךְ	אִלֵּךְ
	Feminine	דָּךְ	
Masculine and Feminine		דְּכֵן	

Numerals

	CARDINAL		ORDINAL
	Masculine	*Feminine*	
1	חַד	חֲדָה	קַדְמָי
2	תְּרִין (תְּרֵי)	תַּרְתֵּין (תַּרְתֵּי)	תִּנְיָן
3	תְּלָתָה	תְּלָת	תְּלִיתָי
4	אַרְבָּעָה	אַרְבַּע	רְבִיעָי
5	חַמְשָׁא	חֲמֵשׁ	
6	שִׁתָּה	שֵׁת	
7	שִׁבְעָה	שְׁבַע	
8	תְּמָנְיָה	תְּמָנֵה	
9	תִּשְׁעָה	תְּשַׁע	
10	עַשְׂרָה	עֲשַׂר	
20	עֶשְׂרִין		
30	תְּלָתִין		
100	מְאָה		
200	מָאתַיִן		
1,000	אַלַף		
10,000	רִבּוֹ		

Verbs

	G	D	H
PERFECT			
Singular			
1	כְּתַבְתִּ	קִבַּלְתִּ	הִשְׁלַטְתִּ
2 masculine	כְּתַבְתָּ (or כְּתַבְתָּ)	קִבַּלְתָּ	הִשְׁלַטְתָּ
feminine	כְּתַבְתְּ	קִבַּלְתְּ	הִשְׁלַטְתְּ
3 masculine	כָּתַב	קִבֵּל	הִשְׁלִיט
feminine	כָּתְבָה	קִבְּלָה	הִשְׁלִיטָה
Plural			
1	כָּתַבְנוּ	קִבַּלְנוּ	הִשְׁלַטְנוּ
2 masculine	כְּתַבְתֶּם	קִבַּלְתֶּם	הִשְׁלַטְתֶּם
feminine	כְּתַבְתֶּן	קִבַּלְתֶּן	הִשְׁלַטְתֶּן
3 masculine	כָּתְבוּ	קִבְּלוּ	הִשְׁלִיטוּ
feminine	כָּתַבְנָה	קִבַּלְנָה	הִשְׁלַטְנָה
IMPERFECT			
Singular			
1	אֶכְתֹּב	אֲקַבֵּל	אַהְשִׁלִּיט
2 masculine	תִּכְתֹּב	תְּקַבֵּל	תְּהַשְׁלִּיט
feminine	תִּכְתְּבִי	תְּקַבְּלִי	תְּהַשְׁלְטִי
3 masculine	יִכְתֹּב	יְקַבֵּל	יְהַשְׁלִּיט
feminine	תִּכְתֹּב	תְּקַבֵּל	תְּהַשְׁלִּיט
Plural			
1	נִכְתֹּב	נְקַבֵּל	נְהַשְׁלִּיט
2 masculine	תִּכְתְּבוּ	תְּקַבְּלוּ	תְּהַשְׁלְטוּ
feminine	תִּכְתֹּבְנָה	תְּקַבֵּלְנָה	תְּהַשְׁלֵטְנָה
3 masculine	יִכְתְּבוּ	יְקַבְּלוּ	יְהַשְׁלְטוּ
feminine	יִכְתֹּבְנָה	יְקַבֵּלְנָה	יְהַשְׁלֵטְנָה

	G	D	H
PARTICIPLE			
Singular			
masculine	כָּתֵב	מְקַבֵּל	מְהַשְׁלֵט
feminine	כָּתְבָה	מְקַבְּלָה	מְהַשְׁלְטָה
Plural			
masculine	כָּתְבִין	מְקַבְּלִין	מְהַשְׁלְטִין
feminine	כָּתְבָן	מְקַבְּלָן	מְהַשְׁלְטָן
IMPERATIVE			
Singular			
masculine	כְּתֵב	קַבֵּל	הַשְׁלֵט
feminine	כְּתֵבִי	קַבְּלִי	הַשְׁלְטִי
Plural			
masculine	כְּתֵבוּ	קַבְּלוּ	הַשְׁלְטוּ
feminine	כְּתֵבָה	קַבְּלָה	הַשְׁלְטָה
INFINITIVE	מִכְתַּב	קַבָּלָה	הַשְׁלָטָה

Passives

	G	D	H
PERFECT			
Singular			
1	כְּתִיבֵת	קֻבַּלְתִּ	הָשְׁלְטֵת
2 masculine	כְּתִיבְתָּ	קֻבַּלְתָּ	הָשְׁלַטְתָּ
feminine	כְּתִיבְתִּי	קֻבַּלְתִּי	הָשְׁלַטְתִּי
3 masculine	כְּתִיב	קֻבַּל	הָשְׁלַט
feminine	כְּתִיבַת	קֻבְּלַת	הָשְׁלְטַת
Plural			
1	כְּתִיבְנָא	קֻבַּלְנָא	הָשְׁלַטְנָא
2 masculine	כְּתִיבְתּוּן	קֻבַּלְתּוּן	הָשְׁלַטְתּוּן
feminine	כְּתִיבְתֶּן	קֻבַּלְתֶּן	הָשְׁלַטְתֶּן
3 masculine	כְּתִיבוּ	קֻבַּלוּ	הָשְׁלַטוּ
feminine	כְּתִיבָה	קֻבְּלָה	הָשְׁלְטָה
PARTICIPLE			
Singular			
masculine	כְּתִיב	מְקֻבַּל	מְהָשְׁלַט
feminine	כְּתִיבָה	מְקֻבְּלָה	מְהָשְׁלְטָה
Plural			
masculine	כְּתִיבִין	מְקֻבְּלִין	מְהָשְׁלְטִין
feminine	כְּתִיבָן	מְקֻבְּלָן	מְהָשְׁלְטָן

Prefix-t Conjugations

	Gt	Dt
PERFECT		
Singular		
1	הִתְקַטְלֵת	הִתְחַבְלֵת
2 masculine	הִתְקַטֶלְתְּ	הִתְחַבַלְתְּ
feminine	הִתְקַטֶלְתִּי	הִתְחַבַלְתִּי
3 masculine	הִתְקְטֶל	הִתְחַבַּל
feminine	הִתְקַטְלַת	הִתְחַבְּלַת
Plural		
1	הִתְקַטֶלְנָא	הִתְחַבַלְנָא
2 masculine	הִתְקַטֶלְתּוּן	הִתְחַבַלְתּוּן
feminine	הִתְקַטֶלְתֶּן	הִתְחַבַלְתֶּן
3 masculine	הִתְקַטְלוּ	הִתְחַבְּלוּ
feminine	הִתְקַטְלָה	הִתְחַבְּלָה
IMPERFECT		
Singular		
1	אֶתְקְטֶל	אֶתְחַבַּל
2 masculine	תִּתְקְטֶל	תִּתְחַבַּל
feminine	תִּתְקַטְלִין	תִּתְחַבְּלִין
3 masculine	יִתְקְטֶל	יִתְחַבַּל
feminine	תִּתְקְטֶל	תִּתְחַבַּל
Plural		
1	נִתְקְטֶל	נִתְחַבַּל
2 masculine	תִּתְקַטְלוּן	תִּתְחַבְּלוּן
feminine	תִּתְקַטְלָן	תִּתְחַבְּלָן
3 masculine	יִתְקַטְלוּן	יִתְחַבְּלוּן
feminine	יִתְקַטְלָן	יִתְחַבְּלָן

	Gt	Dt
PARTICIPLES		
Singular		
masculine	מִתְקַטֵּל	מִתְחַבֵּל
feminine	מִתְקַטֶּלֶת	מִתְחַבֶּלֶת
Plural		
masculine	מִתְקַטְּלִים	מִתְחַבְּלִים
feminine	מִתְקַטְּלָן	מִתְחַבְּלָן
INFINITIVE	הִתְקַטֶּלֶת	הִתְחַבֶּלֶת

Irregular Verbs

Hollow Roots

	Perfect	*Imperfect*		*Participles*		*Imperative*
				Active	*Passive*	
Singular						
1	שָׂמֵת	אֲשַׂים	ms	שָׂאֵם	שִׂים	שִׂים
2 masculine	שָׂמְתָ	תְּשַׂים	fs	שָׂיְמָה	שִׂימָה	שִׂימִי
feminine	שָׂמְתִי	תְּשַׂימִין	mp	שָׂיְמִין	שִׂימִין	שִׂימוּ
3 masculine	שָׂם	יְשַׂים	fp	שָׂיְמָן	שִׂימָן	שִׂימָה
feminine	שָׂמַת	תְּשַׂים				
Plural						
1	שָׂמְנָא	נְשַׂים				
2 masculine	שָׂמְתוּן	תְּשַׂימוּן				
feminine	שָׂמְתֶן	תְּשַׂימָן		*Infinitive*		מְשָׂם
3 masculine	שָׂמוּ	יְשַׂימוּן				
feminine	שָׂמָה	יְשַׂימָן				

*Final-*ה

G

	Perfect	*Imperfect*		*Participles*	
				Active	*Passive*
Singular					
1	בְּנִית	אֶבְנֵא	ms	בָּנֵה	בְּנֵה
2 masculine	בְּנֵיתָ	תִּבְנֵא	fs	בָּנְיָה	בַּנְיָה
feminine	בְּנֵיתִי	תִּבְנִין	mp	בָּנִין	בְּנִין
3 masculine	בְּנָה	יִבְנֵא	fp	בָּנְיָן	בַּנְיָן
feminine	בְּנָת	תִּבְנֵא			
Plural					
1	בְּנֵינָא	נִבְנֵא	*Imperative*		*Passive Perfect*
2 masculine	בְּנֵיתוּן	תִּבְנוֹן	ms	בְּנִי/בְּנֵא	3 ms בְּנֵי
feminine	בְּנֵיתֶן	תִּבְנֶין	mp	בְּנוֹ	3 mp בְּנִיו
3 masculine	בְּנוֹ	יִבְנוֹן			
feminine	בְּנָה	יִבְנֶין	*Infinitive*	מִבְנֵא	

Answer Key

Note: English translations are rather literal in order to facilitate comparison with the original; translations into Aramaic have generally been made in the most straightforward way possible. In lessons 28–32 the vocalization of some words and names that do not exist in the Bible is uncertain.

Chapter 3

P. 11 Ezra 4:8–11

> Rehum and Shimshai, the scribe, wrote a letter concerning Jerusalem to King Artaxerxes. This is the letter which they sent to King Artaxerxes.

(1) The scribe wrote the letter to them.
(2) God made heaven.
(3) The king said concerning Jerusalem.
P. 12 (4) The king sent the letter to the scribe.
(5) God said from heaven . . .
(6) This scribe perished under the earth.
(7) God said that the earth is the king's.

Chapter 4

P. 16 Ezra 4:12–16

> Let it be known to the king that the Jews are building Jerusalem, the rebellious city. Now, let it be known to the king that if that city will be built, they will not give tax [i.e., the tax will not be paid]. We have sent and informed the king concerning this, that he search in the book of memoranda and [where] you will find that that city is a rebellious city. We are informing the king that if that city will be rebuilt, you will not have a portion in Trans-Euphrates.

P. 17

Aramaic	*Hebrew*	*Aramaic*	*Hebrew*
(guard) נטר	נצר	(there is) אִיתַי	יֵשׁ
(three) תְּלָת	שָׁלוֹשׁ	(snow) תְּלַג	שֶׁלֶג
(lie) כדבה	כָּזָב	(summer) קַיִט	קַיִץ
(advise) יעט	יעץ	(unit of weight) תְּקֶל	שֶׁקֶל
(arm) אֶדְרָע	אֶזְרַע	(memorandum) דְּכְרָן	זִכָּרוֹן
(sit, dwell) יתב	ישב	(ox) תּוֹר	שׁוֹר
(gold) דְּהַב	זָהָב	(riddle) אֲחִידָה	חִידָה
(land) אַרְעָא	אֶרֶץ	(new) חַדַּת	חָדָשׁ
(sacrifice) דְּבַח	זֶבַח	(return) תוב	שׁוּב
		(six) שֵׁת	שֵׁשׁ

P. 18 (1) We are building the city.
(2) The scribe sent that letter.
(3) You will find God in the rebellious Jerusalem.
(4) They have no portion in Trans-Euphrates.
(5) Now it is known that the Judeans will give tax to the king.
(6) Rehum wrote this memorandum.

Chapter 5

P. 22 Ezra 4:17-24

The king sent the message to Rehum, the chief official, and Shimshai, the scribe, who dwell in Samaria and the remnant of Trans-Euphrates: Peace! The letter which you sent has been read before me. Rebellion has been made in that city from eternity, and strong kings have been over Jerusalem. Now issue a decree to stop the building of that city. Then, after the letter of King Artaxerxes was read before Rehum and Shimshai, the scribe, they went to Jerusalem to the Jews, and stopped them. Then the work on the house of God which is in Jerusalem stopped.

לָא There is no Canaanite shift in Aramaic, so it preserves *ā* where Hebrew has *ō*.

עֲמַר Semitic *ḏ* becomes צ in Hebrew, but ע in Aramaic; also words that are segholates in Hebrew often have only a single vowel under their second consonant in Aramaic.

דְּא — There is no Canaanite shift in Aramaic, which represents Semitic *d̲* with ד rather than ז as in Hebrew.

אֶדְרָע — Aramaic represents Semitic *d̲* with ד rather than ז as in Hebrew, in which *ā* often shifts to *ō*.

תְּלַג — Semitic *t̲* is represented as ת in Aramaic rather than שׁ as in Hebrew, where words with one vowel become segholates rather than having a vowel under the second consonant as in Aramaic.

שָׁפְטִין — There is no Canaanite shift in Aramaic (for the plural ending ־ין where Hebrew has ־ים, see chapter 6).

נְהַר — Pretonic *a* reduces in Aramaic rather than lengthening as in Hebrew.

תּוֹב — Aramaic uses ת for Semitic *t̲*, where Hebrew uses שׁ.

P. 23 שֵׁת — Semitic *t̲* is represented with ת in Aramaic but with שׁ in Hebrew.

סָפַר — There is no Canaanite shift in Aramaic, so *ā* corresponds to Hebrew *ō*; the *a* where Hebrew has *ē* is due to the consonant ר.

נְשִׁין — Pretonic *a* reduces in Aramaic, but lengthens in Hebrew (for the plural ending ־ין rather than Hebrew ־ים, see chapter 6).

חֲדַת — Semitic *t̲* is represented as ת in Aramaic rather than as שׁ as in Hebrew; note also the reduction of pretonic *a,* which is lengthened in Hebrew.

שְׁעַר — Pretonic *a* is reduced in Aramaic but lengthened in Hebrew.

חֲבַר — Pretonic *a* is reduced in Aramaic but lengthened in Hebrew (the presence of *a* where Hebrew has *ē* is due to the consonant ר).

דְּהַב — Aramaic represents Semitic *d̲* with ד rather than ז as in Hebrew and reduces pretonic *a,* which is lengthened in Hebrew.

עֲשַׂר — Words that are segolates in Hebrew typically have one full vowel under their second consonant in Aramaic.

אָת — *ā* does not shift to *ō* in Aramaic as it does in the Canaanite languages.

תבר — Semitic *t̲* is represented as ת in Aramaic rather than שׁ as in Hebrew.

עָלַם — *ā* does not shift to *ō* in Aramaic as it does in Hebrew.

(1) The Master of Eternity wrote a letter to strong kings.
(2) We are building a house in the rebellious city.

(3) Then they stopped (the) building in Jerusalem.

P. 24 (4) Issue a decree before the scribe after the letter has been read.

(5) Now they will not give (i.e. assign) work over the Jews.

(6) The strong kings went to the city.

(7) God's decree is read before the master.

(8) Then Shimshai said to stop building this house.

(9) They made rebellion in Jerusalem.

(10) Issue peace for them from eternity.

(11) We are informing the scribe that work on the house of the king has stopped.

Chapter 6

P. 27 Ezra 5:1–5

Then the prophets Haggai and Zechariah, the son of Iddo, prophesied to the Jews who were in Judah and in Jerusalem with the name of the God of Israel over them. Then Zerubbabel, the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, arose to build the house of God which is in Jerusalem. Tattenai, the governor of Trans-Euphrates, and Shetar-Bozenai came to them and said thus to them: "Who issued a decree to build this house? What (lit. who) are the names of the men who are building this?" But their God's eye was over the Jews, and they didn't stop them.

P. 28 (1) מֶלֶךְ

(2) סָפְרָא

(3) שְׁמָהָת

	SINGULAR			PLURAL		
	Absolute	*Construct*	*Determined*	*Absolute*	*Construct*	*Determined*
P. 29	רֵאשׁ	רֵאשׁ	רֵאשָׁא	רֵאשִׁין	רֵאשֵׁי	רֵאשַׁיָּא
	נְבִיא	נְבִיא	נְבִיָּא	נְבִיאִין	נְבִיאֵי	נְבִיאַיָּא
	סְפַר	סְפַר	סִפְרָא	סִפְרִין	סִפְרֵי	סִפְרַיָּא
	עֲבִידָה	עֲבִידַת	עֲבִידְתָּא	עֲבִידָן	עֲבִידָת	עֲבִידָתָא
	קְרִיָה	קִרְיַת	קִרְיְתָה	קִרְיָן	קִרְיָת	קִרְיָתָא
P. 30	אֱלָהּ	אֱלָהּ	אֱלָהָא	אֱלָהִין	אֱלָהֵי	אֱלָהַיָּא
	סָפַר	סָפַר	סָפְרָא	סָפְרִין	סָפְרֵי	סָפְרַיָּא

P. 30 (*cont.*)

(1) סָפְרָא כְּתַב שֵׁם גִּבְרַיָּא.

(2) קָמוּ נְבִיאֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל קֶדֶם מַלְכַיָּא.

(3) שְׁלַחוּ אִגַּרְתָּא עַל עֲבַר־נַהֲרָא.

(4) אַתָּא אֱלָהּ עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל.

P. 31

(5) הִמּוֹ בָּנִין קַרְיָה יְרוּשְׁלֶם.

(6) בְּעֵל שֵׁם טְעֵם.

(7) הוֹדַעְנָא גְּבֵרֵי קַרְיְתָא.

(8) מַן פַּחַוָת יְהוּד וְשָׁמְרַיִן?

Chapter 7

P. 34 Ezra 5:6–10

The letter which Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, and Shetar-Bozenai and his colleagues who were in Trans-Euphrates sent to King Darius, and this was written in it: "To King Darius, peace (over) everything. Let it be known to the king that we went to Judah, the province, to the house of the great God. Then we asked these elders, we said to them, 'Who issued the decree to you to build this house?' And we also asked them their names so that we would write the name of the men who are at their heads."

G הִתְקְטָלָה	D נְחַוּא	G אָכְלָה
H מְהֵימַן	G סָגְדִין	D הַדְרְתָּ
D מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין	G בְּנַס	H הוּבַד
D מִתְנַשְּׂאָה	H הַרְגְּזוּ	H הָחֲרַבַת
D יְבַקֵּר	H הֶעֱלוּ	G יִשְׁאֶלֻנָּכוֹן
G תִּקְנֵא	H הַשְׁכַּחַת	G בְּטֵלַת
G רְשַׁמְתָּ	G תִּתְרְמוֹן	H הַשְׁפֵּלְתְּ
G הִתְרְחִצוּ	G נְפַלוּ	D מַלִּל
D מְהַלְּכִין	D הִתְנַבִּי	D שַׁבְּחַת
D אִתְעַקְּרוּ	D בַּטְּלוּ	G חַשִּׁבִין
D מְצַבְּעִין	H מְהַעְדֵּה	G אֶבְעֵה
	G הִתְגְּזֵרַת	

P. 35

(1) אֲזַלְנָא לְמִדִינְתָא רַבְתָא.
(2) הַמוֹ שְׁלַחוּ אִגְּרָה לְבֵיתָא וּלְגַבְרַיָא בְּגַוֵה.
(3) כְּעַן דַרְיָוֶשׁ רֵאשׁ שָׁבְיָא אִלֵךְ.
(4) שָׁבְיָא אָמְרִין דִי טַעֲמָא יְדִיעַ לְהֹם.
(5) לְהֱוֵא שְׁלָמָא עַל יְרוּשְׁלֶם.
(6) כֹּלָא כְּתִיבָא.

Chapter 8

P. 39

שְׁלִחַת	רְשִׁמַת	נְטִלַת	יְתִבַת
שְׁלַחְתְּ	רְשַׁמְתְּ	נְטַלְתְּ	יְתַבְתְּ
שְׁלַחְתִּי	רְשַׁמְתִּי	נְטַלְתִּי	יְתַבְתִּי
שְׁלַח	רְשַׁם	נְטַל	יְתַב
שְׁלִחַת	רְשִׁמַת	נְטִלַת	יְתִבַת

שְׁלַחְנָה	רְשַׁמְנָה	נְטַלְנָה	יְתַבְנָה
שְׁלַחְתּוּן	רְשַׁמְתּוּן	נְטַלְתּוּן	יְתַבְתּוּן
שְׁלַחְתֵּן	רְשַׁמְתֵּן	נְטַלְתֵּן	יְתַבְתֵּן
שְׁלַחוּ	רְשַׁמוּ	נְטַלוּ	יְתַבוּ
שְׁלַחָה	רְשַׁמָה	נְטַלָה	יְתַבָה

P. 40

יְדַעְתְּ	ידע	2 masculine singular
יְדַעַת	ידע	1 common singular
יְהַב	יהב	3 masculine singular
כְּתַבְנָא	כתב	1 common plural
כְּתַבוּ	כתב	3 masculine plural
מְלַחְנָה	מלח	1 common plural
נְטַרַת	נטר	1 common singular
נְפַל	נפל	3 masculine singular
סְלֵקֶת	סלק	1 common singular
עֲבַד	עבד	3 masculine singular

P. 41
(1) The king went before the city.
(2) We knew that the Master of Eternity was in Jerusalem.
(3) I wrote a letter to the king's house.

P. 41 (*cont.*)

(4) Then God sent a decree to that province.
(5) You gave many servants to the governor of the Jews.
(6) Our fathers gave those vessels to Cyrus.
(7) The head of the palace was in heaven.
(8) Nebuchadnezzar did not take the men out to the land.
(9) That great house will be built in one year.

Chapter 9

P. 44 Ezra 5:16–6:5

Then Sheshbazzar came; he gave (i.e. laid) the foundation of the house of God which is in Jerusalem, and from then until now it was being built, but was not completed. And now if it is good to the king, let it be searched in the king's treasure house that is there in Babylon if a decree was issued by King Cyrus to build the house of God in Jerusalem; and let him send the king's wish concerning this to us. Then King Darius issued a decree, and they searched there in Babylon, and a scroll was found and thus was written in it: "In the first year of King Cyrus, King Cyrus issued a decree (that) the house of God in Jerusalem be built, and the expenses will be given (i.e. paid) from the king's house, and they will return the gold and silver vessels of the house of God which Nebuchadnezzar brought out from the temple which is in Jerusalem."

קָטֵל	טָרַד	רָשֵׁם	נָטֵל
קָטֵל	טָרַד	רָשֵׁם	נָטֵל
קָטְלָא	טָרְדָא	רָשְׁמָא	נָטְלָא
קָטְלָה	טָרְדָה	רָשְׁמָה	נָטְלָה
קָטְלַת	טָרְדַת	רָשְׁמַת	נָטְלַת
קָטְלָתָא	טָרְדָתָא	רָשְׁמָתָא	נָטְלָתָא
קָטְלִין	טָרְדִין	רָשְׁמִין	נָטְלִין
קָטְלִי	טָרְדֵי	רָשְׁמֵי	נָטְלֵי
קָטְלַיָּא	טָרְדַיָּא	רָשְׁמַיָּא	נָטְלַיָּא
קָטְלָן	טָרְדָן	רָשְׁמָן	נָטְלָן
קָטְלָת	טָרְדָת	רָשְׁמָת	נָטְלָת
קָטְלָתָא	טָרְדָתָא	רָשְׁמָתָא	נָטְלָתָא

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קְטִיל	טְרִיד	רְשִׁים	נְטִיל
קְטִיל	טְרִיד	רְשִׁים	נְטִיל
קְטִילָא	טְרִידָא	רְשִׁימָא	נְטִילָא
קְטִילָה	טְרִידָה	רְשִׁימָה	נְטִילָה
קְטִילַת	טְרִידַת	רְשִׁימַת	נְטִילַת
קְטִילְתָא	טְרִידְתָא	רְשִׁימְתָא	נְטִילְתָא
קְטִילִין	טְרִידִין	רְשִׁימִין	נְטִילִין
קְטִילִי	טְרִידִי	רְשִׁימֵי	נְטִילִי
קְטִילַיָא	טְרִידַיָא	רְשִׁימַיָא	נְטִילַיָא
קְטִילָן	טְרִידָן	רְשִׁימָן	נְטִילָן
קְטִילָת	טְרִידָת	רְשִׁימָת	נְטִילָת
קְטִילָתָא	טְרִידָתָא	רְשִׁימָתָא	נְטִילָתָא

(1) Nebuchadnezzar says that the city will be given to Jews.
(2) A big scroll is sent to the governor of the province.
(3) The king knew that (the) work stopped.

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(4) We know (how) to build a house.
(5) There is gold in the treasure house there in Babylon.
(6) The men searched if good silver was given to the scribe.

(1) גְּבַרַיָא קָמוּ עֲלֵיהוֹן.
(2) מַן שְׁלַח כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא מִן עֲבַר־נַהֲרָא?
(3) אִיתַי פֶּחָה בְּגוֹ יְרוּשְׁלֶם.
(4) יְהַבְנָא בַּיִת לְהֹם.
(5) אֲתָה סָפְרָא לְקִרְיְתָא.

Chapter 10

P. 50 Ezra 6:6–12

Now Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, Shetar-Bozenai, and their colleagues, be (i.e. stay) far from there. Leave the work of the house of God, and from me a decree is issued for the Jews to build the house of God, and the

expenses will be given (paid) from the king's property to those men in order not to stop. And whatever they need for the God of heaven is to be given to them so that they will sacrifice to the God of heaven and pray for the king's life. And from me a decree is issued that any person who changes this message—his house will be made a dunghill concerning this, and may God overthrow any king or nation which extends its hand to destroy the house of God which is in Jerusalem. I, Darius, have issued (the) decree."

P. 50	*Aramaic*	*Hebrew*	*English*
	אזל	הלך	go
	אִיתַי	יֵשׁ	there is
	אֱלָהָיָא	אֱלֹהִים	god
P. 51	אֲנַחְנָה	אֲנַחְנוּ	we
	אָע	עֵץ	tree
	אַרְעָא	אֶרֶץ	land
	אתה	בוא	come
	בַּר	בֵּן	son
	דִּבַח	זֶבַח	sacrifice
	דְּהַב	זָהָב	gold
	דְּכְרָן	זִכָּרוֹן	memorandum
	דְּנָה	זֶה	this
	דְּרָע	זְרוֹעַ	arm
	חַד	אֶחָד	one
	יְדִיעַ	יָדוּעַ	known
	יהב	נתן	give
	יתב	ישב	dwell
	כְּדִבָה	כָּזָב	lie
	לֶהֱוֵא	יִהְיֶה	it will be
	לְהֹם	לָהֶם	to them
	נחת	ירד	go down

P. 51 (*cont.*)	*Aramaic*	*Hebrew*	*English*
	נפק	יצא	go out
	סלק	עלה	go up
	סְפַר	סֵפֶר	document
	סָפְרָא	הַסּוֹפֵר	scribe
P. 52	עבד	עשׂה	do
	פלח	עבד	work
	קֵיט	קַיִץ	summer
	רַב	גָּדוֹל	big
	שַׂגִּיא	רַב	many
	שְׁלָם	שָׁלוֹם	peace
	שְׁמַיָּא	שָׁמַיִם	heaven
	שֵׁת	שֵׁשׁ	six
	תוב	שׁוב	return
	תּוֹר	שׁוֹר	ox
	תְּלַג	שֶׁלֶג	snow
	תְּלָת	שָׁלוֹשׁ	three
	תְּקֵל	שָׁקַל	weigh
	תְּרֵי	שְׁנֵי	two

(1) גְּנַזָּיָא רַהִיקִין מִן נָוְלוּ.

(2) כְּתָבַת אִגְּרָה לְסָפְרַיָּא.

(3) שְׁלַח פִּתְגָם אֱלָהּ לְקָרְיְתָא.

(4) רֵאשׁ מְדִינְתָּא אֱנָשׁ (גְּבַר).

(5) שְׁבָקוּ כְּלָא תַּמָּה!

(6) מְצַלִּין הִמּוֹ לֶאֱלָהַיָּא לְחַבָּלָה אַרְעָא.

Chapter 11

P. 56 Ezra 6:13–18

Then Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, Shetar-Bozenai, and their colleagues did exactly as King Darius sent. The Jews are building and succeeding according to the prophecy of Haggai and Zechariah, the son of Iddo; and they completed (it) at the command of the God of Israel and the command of Cyrus and Darius and Artaxerxes, king of Persia. And he finished this house on the third day of the month Adar, which is the sixth year of King Darius' reign. And the children of Israel, the priests, and the Levites and the rest of the exiles made a dedication of this house of God with joy. And they established the priests and the Levites over the service of God, who is in Jerusalem, according to the writing of Moses' book.

P. 57 (1) אַנְתְּ You sacrifixed an ox to God.

(2) הוּא He knew that the elders are in the province.

(3) אַנְתֵּן You gave the book to a governor.

(4) אַנְתּוּן You wrote a letter.

(5) הֻמּוֹ They fell to the earth.

P. 58 (6) אֲנַחְנָה We went out from the house.

(7) אֲנָה or הֲוָא I (or she) worship(ed) in Jerusalem.

(8) הוּא He issued a decree.

(9) אַנְתְּי You sent a message to Babylon.

(10) אֲנָה I knew (how) to build a house.

(11) הֻמּוֹ They went up to heaven.

(12) אֲנַחְנָה We sent a scroll to the treasure house.

P. 59 (1) There is a palace in the large city.

(2) You are priests of the God of heaven.

(3) The house of God is in Jerusalem.

(4) The man does not have a head.

(5) Zerubbabel is governor of the Jews.

(6) Thus is it written in the book of Darius: We are praying to the earth.

(7) You are a king of peace.

(8) Then they finished the work of a strong house.

P. 60

(1) דִּי אָמַר מַלְכָּא כְנֶמָא אָסְפַּרְנָה עֲבַדוּ גְּבַרַיָּא שְׁתָה.
(2) שְׁאָר מַלְכוּתָא לְדַרְיָוֶשׁ יְהַבְנָא.
(3) טַעֲמָא אִיתַי בְּכְתַב.
(4) הֵיכַל לָא אִיתַי בִּיהוּד.
(5) סְפַר שְׁלְחַת לְכָהֲנָה תַּמָּה.

Chapter 12

P. 64 Ezra 7:12–26

Artaxerxes, king of kings, to Ezra the priest, scribe of the law of God of heaven: From me a decree is issued that anyone in my kingdom from the people of Israel and their priests and Levites who is willing to go to Jerusalem with you may go. It is sent from before the king to search concerning Judah and Jerusalem according to the law of your God and to bring the king's silver and gold to the God of Israel who is in Jerusalem along with all the silver and gold in the entire province of Babylon to the house of their God which is in Jerusalem. You will diligently buy rams with this silver and sacrifice them in Jerusalem. And whatever is pleasing to you to do with the rest of the silver and gold you may do in accordance with the wish of your God. And deliver the vessels which are given to you for your God's house before the God of Jerusalem. And from me, King Artaxerxes, issue a decree that everything that Ezra, the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, requests shall be done exactly. Everything which is from the decree of the God of heaven will be done for the house of the God of heaven. And (we) inform you that (you) are not authorized to impose a tax on all the priests and Levites. And you, Ezra, in accordance with the wisdom of your God, appoint judges for the whole people that is in Trans-Euphrates, for all who know the laws of your God, and you shall inform those who do not know. And judgement will be diligently done to all who will not do the law of your God and the law of the king.

(1) He asked about the king's law.
(2) This people is authorized to bring vessels from the palace.
P. 65 (3) Nebuchadnezzar was king of Babylon from eternity.
(4) Who is willing to make a dunghill on the earth?
(5) You will inform the judge that there will be a rebellion in the province.

P. 65 (*cont.*)

(1) נְהָךְ לִירוּשְׁלֶם עִם עֶזְרָא.
(2) קְרִיתָא תֶּהֱוֵה בַּנְיָה אַחֲרֵי דִּי יֶהֱבִין הִמּוֹ בְּלוֹ לְמַלְכָּא.
(3) הֲוָה דִינָא בֵּין מַלְכָּא לְעַמָּא.
(4) הִמּוֹ אֲמַרוּ שְׁבָקוּ סִפְרָא בְּבָבֶל.
(5) רֵאשָׁא הֲוָה בִּשְׁמַיָּא.

Chapter 13

P. 70 Daniel 2:4–13

"King, say the dream to your servants and we will tell its interpretation." The king answered and said to the Chaldeans, "If you will not tell me the dream and its interpretation, you will be made into limbs and your houses will be made a dunghill; but if you do tell the dream and its interpretation, you will receive much glory from before me. Therefore, tell me the dream and its interpretation." They answered and said, "Let the king say the dream to his servants, and we will tell the interpretation." The king answered and said, "I know that you are buying time until the time changes." The Chaldeans answered before the king and said, "There is no man who will be able to tell the king's thing. No great king has asked a thing like this of any Chaldean, and the thing which the king asks is difficult; and there is no other except the gods who will tell it before the king." The king became very angry and said to kill all the wise men of Babylon.

P. 71

כָּהֲנוֹהִי	his priests	אֲבוּךְ	your father
עַבְדָיִךְ	your servants	אַחֲרִיהוֹן	after them
עֲלַי	on me	אִיתַיכוֹן	you are
עֲלָיִךְ	on you	אִיתוֹהִי	he is
עִמֵּהּ	with him	אֱלָהִי	my God
לְקֳבְלָךְ	opposite you	אֱלָהֵהּ	his God
קֳדָמוֹהִי	before him	בָּתְרָךְ	after you
רֵאשְׁהוֹן	their head	בֵּינֵיהוֹן	between them
שָׂמֵהּ	he placed him	בַּיְתֵהּ	his house
שְׁמָהָתְהוֹם	their names	בְּרֵהּ	his son
תְּחוֹתוֹהִי	instead of him	בְּגַוַהּ	in the midst of her
תְּלָתְהוֹן	the three of them	הֵיכְלִי	my palace
		יְתְהוֹן	them

P. 72

(1) לֶהֱוֵה מַלְכָּא עֲבֵד בְּעִדָּן אָחֳרָן.
(2) עֲנוֹ גֻבְרַיָּא חַכִּימַיָּא לְרֵאשׁ מְדִינְתָּא.
(3) פִּשְׁרָא יִשְׁתַּנֵּה הֵן סָפְרָא יִנְפֵּק מִן קִרְיְתָא.
(4) אִיתַי מִלָּה דִּי לָא יְדִעַת בְּחֶלְמִי.
(5) נְחַוֵּה כְּלָא לָהֵן שֵׁם אֱלָהָנָא.
(6) בַּיְתֵהּ עַל נָוְלוּ.

Chapter 14

P. 75 Daniel 2:14–19

Then Daniel sought from the king that he would give him time in order to tell the meaning to the king. Then Daniel went to his house and informed Hannaniah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions, of the thing and to seek compassion from before the God of heaven concerning this secret that they not kill Daniel and his companions along with the wise men of Babylon.

P. 76 Then the secret was revealed to Daniel. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven. Daniel answered and said, "Let the name of God be blessed from eternity to eternity, for wisdom and power are His, and He changes the seasons and the times, establishes kings, gives wisdom to the wise. He reveals deep things. I praise You, God of my fathers, for You have given me wisdom and power, and now You have informed me of that which I sought from You so that I could make the king's matter known." Thereupon Daniel went in to Arioch, whom the king had appointed to kill the wise men of Babylon. He went and said thus to him: "Do not kill the wise men of Babylon. Bring me before the king, and I will tell the interpretation to the king."

(1) We knew these secrets.
(2) Who built that palace?
(3) The scribe wrote that wisdom is lost from Babylon in the time of Nebuchadnezzar.

P. 77 (4) Daniel entered heaven.
(5) Thereupon it was revealed that the king raised the governor's head up over this city.
(6) There is a man who seeks compassion.

P. 77 (*cont.*)

(1) אַבָּא דְנָה מְשַׁבַּח דְּתָא דִּי אֱלָהּ.
(2) שַׁלִּיט אֲנָה לְמַבְעֵה סִפְרָא דֵךְ בְּבֵית גְּנַזָּיָא.
(3) מְדִינָתָא אִלֵּין תְּחוֹת מַלְכָּךְ תַּקִּיף.
(4) שְׁבַקוּ אִגַּרְתָּא דָךְ תַּמָּה.
(5) אֲנַחְנָה יָהֲבִין מָאנִין שַׁגִּיאִין בְּגוֹא אַרְעָא.

Chapter 15

P. 80 Daniel 2:25–36

Then Arioch brought Daniel in before the king, and thus he said to him, "I found a man from among the exiles of Judah who will inform the king of the interpretation." The king answered and said to Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, "Are you able to inform me of the dream which I saw and its interpretation?" Daniel answered before the king and said, "Wise men are not able to tell the king the secret which the king asks, but there is a God in heaven (who) reveals secrets, and He has informed King Nebuchadnezzar what will be. And it is not by wisdom that is in me that this secret is revealed to me, but that the interpretation be made known to the king. You, O King, saw a large statue; that statue was big. That statue—its head was of good gold, its breasts and its arms were of silver, its belly and its thighs were of copper, its legs were of iron, its feet partly of iron and partly of clay. You saw until a stone broke off, which was not by hands, and hit the statue on its iron and clay feet and crushed them. Then the iron, clay, copper, silver, and gold were crushed together, and the stone which hit the statue became a big mountain. This was the dream, and we will say its interpretation before the king."

P. 81

אֶפֶל	אֶשְׁלַט	אֶשְׁבֶּק	אֶסְגֹּד
תִּפֶּל	תִּשְׁלַט	תִּשְׁבֶּק	תִּסְגֹּד
תִּפְּלִין	תִּשְׁלְטִין	תִּשְׁבְּקִין	תִּסְגְּדִין
יִפֶּל	יִשְׁלַט	יִשְׁבֶּק	יִסְגֹּד
תִּפֶּל	תִּשְׁלַט	תִּשְׁבֶּק	תִּסְגֹּד
נִפֶּל	נִשְׁלַט	נִשְׁבֶּק	נִסְגֹּד
תִּפְּלוּן	תִּשְׁלְטוּן	תִּשְׁבְּקוּן	תִּסְגְּדוּן
תִּפְּלָן	תִּשְׁלְטָן	תִּשְׁבְּקָן	תִּסְגְּדָן
יִפְּלוּן	יִשְׁלְטוּן	יִשְׁבְּקוּן	יִסְגְּדוּן
יִפְּלָן	יִשְׁלְטָן	יִשְׁבְּקָן	יִסְגְּדָן

P. 82

תֵּאכֶל	אכל	2 masculine singular or 3 feminine singular
נֵאמַר	אמר	1 common plural
אֶבְעֵה	בעה	1 common singular
תֶּהֱוֶה	הוה	2 masculine singular or 3 feminine singular
לֶהֱוֹן	הוה	3 masculine plural
נִכְתֻּב	כתב	1 common plural
תַּעַבְדוּן	עבד	2 masculine plural
יִפְלְחוּן	פלח	3 masculine plural
אֶקְרָא	קרא	1 common singular

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(1) אֶכְתֻּב אִגְּרָה עַל אֶבֶן מִן טוּרָא.
(2) תִּשְׁלַח פִּתְגָם לְסָפְרָא.
(3) גְּזַר רֵאשָׁא וְרַגְלָא מִן צַלְמָא.
(4) גַּבְרָא דְּךְ חָזֵה מָאנֵי חַסְפָּא דִּי הַדֶּק דָּנִיֵּאל.
(5) אִיתַי פַּרְזֶל תְּחוֹת אַרְעָא.
(6) נִשְׁאַל לְמַבְנֵה הֵיכַל תַּמָּה.
(7) יְהוּדָיֵא שְׁבַקוּ נְחָשׁ בְּבָבֶל.

Chapter 16

P. 87 Daniel 2:37–49

"You are the king, the king of kings, to whom the God of heaven gave the kingdom, and into your hand He has given human beings, animals of the field, and birds of the sky—wherever they dwell—and made you rule over all of them; you are the head of gold. And after you there will arise another kingdom, lower (lit. more earthly) than you, and afterwards a third kingdom of copper which will rule the whole earth. And a fourth kingdom will be as strong as iron, smashing everything. And the feet and toes which you saw, partly of clay and partly of iron, will be a divided kingdom, and the toes of the feet will be partly iron and partly clay—part of the kingdom will be strong and part of it will be breakable. And in the days of those kings, the God of heaven will establish a kingdom that will not ever be destroyed; and the kingdom will not be abandoned to another people, but it will stand forever, inasmuch as you saw that a stone was broken off from the mountain not by hands, and it smashed the iron, the copper, the clay, the silver, and the gold. The great God has informed the king what will be after this." Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell on his face and

bowed down to Daniel. The king answered Daniel and said, "Your God is the God of gods and revealer of secrets, since you were able to reveal this secret." Then the king made him rule over the entire province of Babylon and over all the wise men of Babylon.

(1) We dwell in a house of gold.
(2) The king will rule over the province of Trans-Euphrates.
(3) Haggai smashed a strong animal.
P. 88 (4) A fourth man came.
(5) They will bow to the head of the statue.
(6) There are many fingers on Darius' hand.

(1) פְּשַׁר טַעֲמָא רְבִיעָיָא כְּתִיב בְּבֵית אֱלָהּ.
(2) הִמּוֹ נָפְלִין מִן רַגְלֵיהֹם וּמְצַלִּין לֶאֱלָהּ.
(3) אֲזַלְנָא לְבָרָא רַחִיקָא.
(4) סָפְרָא חַכִּימָא אֲתָא עִם פִּתְגָם חְלִיתָי.
(5) יְכֵלְנָא לְמִבְנֵה בַּיִת אָחֳרִי.

Chapter 17

P. 92 Daniel 3:1–12

King Nebuchadnezzar made a statue of gold and sent to gather the prefects and the governors for the dedication of the statue which King Nebuchadnezzar had erected. Then the prefects and the governors gathered for the dedication of the statue which King Nebuchadnezzar had erected and stood before the statue which Nebuchadnezzar had erected, and the herald called out strongly, "Say to you, O peoples, 'At the time that you hear the sound of the horn and all kinds of music, you will fall and bow down to the statue of gold, which King Nebuchadnezzar has erected; and whoever will not fall down and bow will be thrown into the midst of a furnace of burning fire.'" Thereupon, at that time, when all the peoples heard the sound of the horn and all kinds of music, all the peoples fell down, bowing to the statue of gold which King Nebuchadnezzar had erected. Thereupon, at that time, Chaldean men drew near. They answered and said to King Nebuchadnezzar, "O king, live forever. You, O king, issued a decree that every person who hears the sound of the horn and all kinds of music should fall down and bow to the statue of gold, and whoever does not fall down

and bow will be thrown into the midst of a furnace of burning fire. There are Judean men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego—those men have not paid attention to you, O king. They do not worship your god, and they do not bow down to the statue of gold which you erected."

P. 93 חַד + תְּשַׁע תְּרֵתִין + תְּמָנֵה תְּלָת + שְׁבַע אַרְבַּע + שֵׁת חֲמֵשׁ + חֲמֵשׁ

$4 + 5 =$ תְּשַׁע	$10^3 =$ אֶלַף
$7 -$ חַד $= 6$	$2 +$ תְּלָת $= 5$
$8 \div 4 =$ תַּרְתֵּין	$20 \times 10 =$ מָאתַיִן
$20 \div$ עֲשַׂר $= 2$	$4 + 2 =$ שֵׁת
$8 - 3 =$ חֲמֵשׁ	$3^2 =$ תְּשַׁע
$1 + 2 =$ תְּלָת	$56 \div 8 =$ שְׁבַע
$2 \times 3 =$ שֵׁת	$10 - 2 =$ תְּמָנֵה
$8 \div 2 =$ אַרְבַּע	$60 + 40 =$ מְאָה
חֲמֵשׁ $+ 1 = 6$	חַד$= 17 \div 17$
תַּרְתֵּין $= 11 - 9$	$24 -$ תְּמָנֵה $= 16$
$7 + 0 =$ שְׁבַע	$19{,}286 +$ רִבּוֹ $= 29{,}286$
שֵׁת $- 4 = 2$	$10 \times 2 =$ עֶשְׂרִין
$17 -$ אַרְבַּע $= 13$	$6 + 6 =$ תְּרֵי־עֲשַׂר

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(1) גַּבְרָא קַדְמָיָא (הוּא) רֵאשׁ מְדִינְתָּא.
(2) אֲנַחְנָא מְצַלִּין לֵאלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא.
(3) הַוֹוּ חַמְשָׁה רָזִין בְּחֶלְמָא.
(4) נְפַק קָלָא מִבָּבֶל כְּאֵשָׁא.
(5) יִפְלְחוּן לְצַלֶם פַּרְזֶל.
(6) אִיתַי רִבּוֹ סְפָרִין יָקְדִין בְּהֵיכְלָא.
(7) קֶרֶן חַד מִתְרְמֵה לְאַתּוּנָא.
(8) הִמּוֹ שְׁמַעוּ אַרְבַּע זְנֵי זְמָרָא.

Chapter 18

P. 96 Daniel 3:13–23

Then Nebuchadnezzar said in anger to bring Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego. Then they brought those men before the king. Nebuchadnezzar answered

and said to them, "Is it true, Shadrach, Meshach and Abed-nego, that you are not worshipping my god and not bowing to the statue of gold which I erected? Now if you are ready to fall down and bow to the statue which I made at the time that you hear the sound of the horn and all kinds of music, you will; and if you do not bow down at that hour, you will be thrown into the midst of the
P. 97 furnace of burning fire. And who is the god that will save you from my hands?" Shadach, Meshach, and Abed-nego answered and said to the king, "Nebuchadnezzar, we do not need to reply to you concerning this matter. If our God, whom we worship, is able to save us from the furnace of burning fire and from your hand, O king, he will save; and if not, let it be known to you, O king, that we are not worshipping your god and not bowing down to the statue of gold which you erected." Then Nebuchadnezzar answered and said to heat the furnace seven times more than is proper to heat it and to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego to throw into the furnace of burning fire. Inasmuch as the king's word was urgent and the fire was heated very much, the fire killed those men who brought up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego. And those three men—Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego—fell bound into the midst of the furnace of burning fire.

Perfect	*Imperfect*	*Participles*		*Imperative*
		Active	*Passive*	
כְּתֻבַת	אֶכְתֻּב	כָּתֻב	כְּתִיב	כְּתֻב
כְּתַבְתְּ	תִּכְתֻּב	כָּתְבָה	כְּתִיבָה	כְּתֻבִי
כְּתַבְתִּי	תִּכְתְּבִין			
כְּתַב	יִכְתֻּב	כָּתְבִין	כְּתִיבִין	כְּתֻבוּ
כְּתַבַת	תִּכְתֻּב	כָּתְבָן	כְּתִיבָן	כְּתֻבָה
כְּתַבְנָא	נִכְתֻּב			
כְּתַבְתּוּן	תִּכְתְּבוּן			
כְּתַבְתֵּן	תִּכְתְּבָן		*Infinitive*	מִכְתַּב
כְּתַב	יִכְתְּבוּן			
כְּתַבָה	יִכְתְּבָן			

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מֶעְבַּד	עבד	G infinitive "to make"
שְׁבֻקוּ	שבק	G imperative 2 masculine plural "leave!"
מֶחֱזָא	חזה	G infinitive "to see"
אֱכֻלִי	אכל	G imperative 2 feminine singular "eat!"

P. 98 (*cont.*)	מְגַלֵּא	גלה	G infinitive "to reveal"
	אֱמַר	אמר	G imperative masculine singular "say!"
	מִבְנֵא	בנה	G infinitive "to build"
	מִכְנַשׁ	כנשׁ	G infinitive "to gather"
	מִבְעֵא	בעה	G infinitive "to seek"
	מִקְרֵא	קרא	G infinitive "to call"
	מִפְשַׁר	פשׁר	G infinitive "to interpret"

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(1) אַל תִּסְקְטֵל גֶּבְרַיָּא תַּקִּיפִין אִלֵּין.
(2) עֲתִיד אֱלָהּ לְמֶעְבַּד אַתַּר בִּשְׁמַיָּא.
(3) יְדָא תִּכְתֵּב אִגְּרָה טָבָה יַתִּירָה.
(4) חֲשַׁח מַלְכָּא קְרִיְתָא דָּא לְמֵזָא בְּנוֹרָא.
(5) שְׁמַע קָל זְמָרָא בְּבָרָא רַחִיקָא.
(6) הֵיתָיו סְפְרָא מְכַפְּתָא לִנְוָלוֹ.
(7) עַמָּא יְשִׁיזִיב גְּנָזָיָא שַׁגְיָא.

Chapter 19

P. 102 Daniel 3:24–33

Then King Nebuchadnezzar arose, answered and said, "Did we not throw three men bound into the midst of the fire?" They answered and said to the king, "Surely, O king." He answered and said, "Behold, I see four men free, walking in the midst of the fire, and there is no damage on them. And the fourth resembles a divine being (lit. son of God)." Then Nebuchadnezzar approached the furnace of burning fire. He answered and said, "Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, servants of God, leave and come (i.e. come out)." Then Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego came out from the midst of the fire. The fire had not ruled their body, nor was the hair of their head scorched. Nebuchadnezzar answered and said, "Blessed is the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, who sent His angel and saved his servants, who gave their body that they not worship nor bow to any god except their God. And from me let a decree be issued that any people that will say blasphemy concerning the God of

Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego—his house will be made a dunghill inasmuch as there is no other god like this." Then the king made Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego prosper in the province of Babylon. King Nebuchadnezzar to all peoples who live in the entire land: May your peace grow great. The signs which God did with me—how powerful; His kingdom is an eternal kingdom and His dominion is with every generation.

P. 103	מְמַלֵּל	מלל	active participle masculine singular
	בַּטְּלוּ	בטל	perfect 3 masculine plural
	יְטַעֲמוּן	טעם	imperfect 3 masculine plural
	שַׁבְּחֵת	שׁבח	perfect 1 common singular
	מְהַדַּר	הדר	participle masculine singular
	חַבְּלוּ	חבל	perfect 3 masculine plural
	לְנַסָּכָה	נסך	infinitive
	הַדְּרֵת	הדר	perfect 1 common singular
	חַבָּלָה	חבל	infinitive
	יְבַקֵּר	בקר	imperfect 3 masculine singular
	מְמַלֶּלֶת	מלל	active participle feminine singular
	מְהַלֵּךְ	הלך	active participle masculine singular
	מַנִּיתָ	מנה	perfect 2 masculine singular
	מְפַשַּׁר	פשׁר	active participle masculine singular
	תְּקַבְּלוּן	קבל	imperfect 2 masculine plural
	קַטֵּל	קטל	imperative or perfect 3 masculine singular
P. 104	יְשַׁמְּשׁוּן	שׁמשׁ	imperfect 3 masculine plural
	שַׁבַּחְתָּ	שׁבח	perfect 2 masculine singular
	מְצַבְּעִין	צבע	active participle masculine plural
	לְקַטָּלָה	קטל	infinitive
	יְמַלֵּל	מלל	imperfect 3 masculine singular
	מְשָׁרֵא	שׁרה	active participle masculine singular
	יְבַהֲלוּ	בהל	imperfect 3 masculine plural
	בַּדַּרוּ	בדר	imperative or perfect 3 masculine plural
	מְשַׁבַּח	שׁבח	active participle masculine singular

P. 104 (*cont.*)

Perfect	*Imperfect*	*Participle*	*Imperative*
חַבְּלֵת	אֶחַבֵּל	מְחַבֵּל	חַבֵּל
חַבֵּלְתְּ	תְּחַבֵּל	מְחַבְּלָה	חַבְּלִי
חַבֵּלְתִּי	תְּחַבְּלִין		
חַבֵּל	יְחַבֵּל	מְחַבְּלִין	חַבְּלוּ
חַבְּלַת	תְּחַבֵּל	מְחַבְּלָן	חַבְּלָה
חַבֵּלְנָא	נְחַבֵּל		
חַבֵּלְתּוּן	תְּחַבְּלוּן		
חַבֵּלְתֶּן	תְּחַבְּלָן	*Infinitive* חַבָּלָה	
חַבְּלוּ	יְחַבְּלוּן		
חַבְּלָה	יְחַבְּלָן		

P. 105

(1) כַּפְּתוּ גֶּשְׁמֵה מְרֵאשָׁא לְרַגְלָא.
(2) יְצִיב דִּי נְחַבֵּל אַרְבַּע מְדִינָן.
(3) יְהַב מַלְכָּא שָׁלְטָן לְבַרְהּ לְעָלְמִין.
(4) כְּמָה חַכִּים אַנְתְּ לְמִשְׁבַּק קְרִיְתָא מָרְדְתָא בִּשְׁלָם.
(5) הִיא מְשַׁבְּחָא לְשָׁפְטָא דִּי שְׁגָא בְּדָרָא דְנָה.
(6) בַּקְּרֵת בְּבֵית גְּנָזַיָּא וְאִיתַי חֲבָל תַּמָּה.
(7) יְחַוֵּה לָנָא פְּשַׁר חֶלְמָךְ.
(8) גְּבְרַיָּא חַכִּימַיָּא אֶמַרוּ לְמַשְׁרֵה שְׁעָרָא מִן רֵאשׁ.

Chapter 20

P. 108 Daniel 4:1–9

I, Nebuchadnezzar, was in my house. I saw a vision and it scared me. The visions of my head disturbed me. A decree was issued from me to bring all the wise men of Babylon before me in order to inform me the interpretation of the dream. Then the magicians and Chaldeans entered, and I said the dream before them, but they did not inform me of its interpretation. At last Daniel, whose name is Belteshazzar like the name of my god and in whom is the spirit of the holy God, entered before me, and I said the dream before him: "Belteshazzar, chief magician, in whom I know is the spirit of the holy God and no secret troubles you, tell the visions of my dream which I saw and its intepretation. I

saw visions of my head, and behold a tree in the midst of the earth, and its height was great. The tree grew and its height reached heaven. Its foliage was beautiful, and in it was food for everything. Animal(s) of the field sought shade under it, and birds of the sky dwelt in its branches."

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מַהֲלְכִין	הלך	active participle masculine plural
לְהַחֲוָיָה	חוה	infinitive
נְהַחֲוֵה	חוה	imperfect 1 common plural
הַשְׁפָּלָה	שׁפל	infinitive
הֶחֱסִנוּ	חסן	perfect 3 masculine plural
לְהַשְׁנָיָה	שׁנה	infinitive
הוֹדַעְנָה	ידע	perfect 1 common plural
מְהוֹדְעִין	ידע	active participle masculine plural
מְהַנְזֶקֶת	נזק	active participle feminine singular
תְּהַנְזֵק	נזק	imperfect 2 masculine singular or 3 feminine singular
הַצְלַח	צלח	perfect 3 masculine singular
מְהַחְצְפָה	חצף	active participle feminine singular
יְהַשְׁפֵּל	שׁפל	imperfect 3 masculine singular
הַרְגִּזוּ	רגז	perfect 3 masculine plural
הַרְגִּשׁוּ	רגשׁ	imperative or perfect 3 masculine plural
הַשְׁכַּחַת	שׁכח	perfect 1 common singular
לְהַשְׁכָּחָה	שׁכח	infinitive
מְהַשְׁנֵא	שׁנה	active participle masculine singular

P. 110

Perfect	*Imperfect*	*Participle*	*Imperative*
הַקְרֵבְתְּ	אַהַקְרֵב	מְהַקְרֵב	הַקְרֵב
הַקְרַבְתְּ	תְּהַקְרֵב	מְהַקְרֶבֶת	הַקְרֵבִי
הַקְרַבְתִּי	תְּהַקְרְבִין		
הַקְרֵב	יְהַקְרֵב	מְהַקְרְבִין	הַקְרִבוּ
הַקְרֵבַת	תְּהַקְרֵב	מְהַקְרְבָן	הַקְרֶבָה
הַקְרַבְנָא	נְהַקְרֵב		
הַקְרַבְתּוּן	תְּהַקְרְבוּן		
הַקְרַבְתֶּן	תְּהַקְרֵבְן	Infinitive הַקְרָבָה	
הַקְרִבוּ	יְהַקְרְבוּן		
הַקְרֶבָה	יְהַקְרֵבְן		

P. 110 (*cont.*)

(1) קָל קַרְנָא מָטֵא לִשְׁמַיָּא.

(2) אֱלוֹ רוּחָא מְהַדְּקֵת מָאנַיָּא תְּחוֹת הֵיכְלָא.

P. 111 (3) יְרֵבֵא שְׁעַר כְּעֻפְּי.

(4) צִפְּרָא הַיְתִיו דְּהָב מִן־אִילָנָא.

(5) מִלַּת מַלְכָּא תְּדַחַל קְדִישֵׁי בָבֶל.

(6) חַרְטֻמַּיָּא דְּחֶלִין דִּי אֱלָהּ יְהַשְׁלֵט דְּנִיֵּאל עֲלֵיהֹם.

(7) אֲמַר סָפְרַיָּא לְהַיְתָיָא פִּתְגָמַיָּא קֳדָם אֱלָהּ.

Chapter 21

P. 115 Daniel 4:10–19

I saw in visions of my head, and behold a holy one was descending from heaven. It called and said thus, "Cut down the tree; the animal(s) will flee from under it; but leave its roots in the ground, and it will be watered with dew of heaven. Its heart will be different from (that of) men, and an animal's heart will be given to it until the animals will know that the Most High is mighty (i.e. rules) over the kingdom of man and gives it to whomever He wants." This is the dream King Nebuchadnezzar saw, and you, Belteshazzar, say the interpre-

P. 116 tation inasmuch as all the wise men of my kingdom are not able to inform me of the interpretation, but you are able since the spirit of the holy God is in you." Then Daniel, whose name is Belteshazzar, was appalled for an hour. The king answered and said, "Belteshazzar, do not let the dream and its interpretation disturb you." Belteshazzar answered and said, "The dream and its interpretation are for your enemies. The tree which you saw, which grew and reached heaven with food for everything in it, under it dwelling animal(s) of the field—you are it, O king, for you grew and your greatness grew and reached heaven."

טָאֵב	טוב	G perfect 3 masculine singular
דַּע	ידע	G imperative 2 masculine singular
מִנְתַּן	נתן	G infinitive
יְקָרוֹן	קרא	G imperfect 3 masculine plural
יְהוֹבְדוּן	אבד	H imperfect 3 masculine plural
יָדַע	ידע	G active participle masculine singular
יַחְלְפוּן	חלף	G imperfect 3 masculine plural
תִּפְלוֹן	נפל	G imperfect 2 masculine plural

	הַדֶּקֶת	דקק	H perfect 3 feminine singular
P. 117	הוֹתֵב	יתב	H perfect 3 masculine singular
	שָׂם	שׂים	G perfect 3 masculine singular
	מְהָקִים	קום	H participle masculine singular
	אֶבְעֵא	בעה	G imperfect 1 common singular
	פְּקוּ	נפק	G imperative masculine plural
	אֲתוֹ	אתה	G perfect 3 masculine plural
	הֵיבֵל	יבל	H perfect 3 masculine singular
	נֵאמַר	אמר	G imperfect 1 common plural
	הוֹבָדָה	אבד	H infinitive
	יְנֶדְעוּן	ידע	G imperfect 3 masculine plural
	יִפֵּל	נפל	G imperfect 3 masculine singular

(1) אֱדַיִן יְדַעוּ חַרְטֻמַיָּא דִּי שְׁמַע מַלְכָּא חֶלְמָא.
(2) אֲנָה כָּהֵל לְכַפָּתָה גֻּשְׁמָא עַל רֵאשׁ טוּרָא.
(3) חָכְמָה דָמְיָה לְנוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא. P. 118
(4) פִּשְׁרָא חַבְלַת כָּל דִּי שְׁמַעוּ לֵהּ.
(5) בְּנֵה גְּבַר חַד בַּיִת וְחַדֵּק לֵהּ גְּבַר אָחֳרָן.
(6) שַׁעְרִי מְצְטַבַּע בְּטַל.
(7) פְּשַׁר חֶלְמָא שְׁנָה לְבַב מַלְכָּא.
(8) נְחַת קַדִּישׁ דִּי שְׁמַע מִלַּת עִלָּיָא.
(9) גַּדּוּ אִילָנָא דִּי מְטֵה לִשְׁמַיָּא.
(10) אֲזַלְנָא לְשַׁבָּחָה לְהֹם.

Chapter 22

P. 120 Daniel 4:20–34

"And that which the king saw, a holy one descending from heaven and saying, 'Cut down the tree and destroy it, but leave its roots in the earth, and let it be watered with dew of heaven'"—this is the interpretation which reached the king: They will drive you out from mankind, and your dwelling will be with the animal(s) of the field, and they will wet you with dew from the sky. And seven times will pass by you until you will know that the Most High rules over the kingdom of man and He gives it to whomever He wishes. And what they said to leave the roots of the tree—your kingdom is enduring for you because you will know that heaven reigns." Everything reached (i.e. happened to) King

Nebuchadnezzar. At the end of twelve months he was walking at Babylon's royal palace. The king answered and said, "Is this not the great Babylon which I built as a royal house?" The word was in the king's mouth when a voice fell from heaven, "To you they say, O King Nebuchadnezzar: 'The kingdom has passed away from you, and they are driving you out from men. And your dwelling will be with the animal(s) of the field, and seven times will pass over you until you know that the Most High is ruler over the kingdom of man, and He will give it to whomever He wishes." At that time he was driven from men, and his flesh was watered from heavenly dew. And at the end of the days, I, Nebuchadnezzar—I lifted my eyes to heaven, and my knowledge returned to me. And I blessed the Most High, and I praised the Ever-living, whose dominion is an eternal dominion and whose kingdom is forever. And He does as He wishes with the host of heaven and those who dwell on earth. And there is none who says to Him, "What did you do?" At that time my knowledge returned to me and I was restored to my kingdom, and much greatness was added to me.

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הַנְעֵל	עלל	H perfect 3 masculine singular
הֶעַל	עלל	H passive perfect 3 masculine singular
לֶהֱוֵא	הוה	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
הֲווֹ	הוה	G perfect 3 masculine plural
הַסְקוּ	סלק	H perfect 3 masculine plural
הַנְסָקָה	סלק	H infinitive
מַהְלְכִין	הלך	H active participle masculine plural
מְהַלֵּךְ	הלך	D active participle masculine singular
יְהָךְ	הלך	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
יְכֵלְתָּ	יכל	G perfect 2 masculine singular
יָכֵל	יכל	G participle masculine singular
תִּכַּל	יכל	G imperfect 2 masculine singular or 3 feminine singular
יוּכַל	יכל	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
כָּהֲלִין	(יכל) כהל	G active participle masculine plural

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(1) כְּהַנַּיָּא טַרְדוּ פַּחֲתָא מִן קַרְיְתָא.
(2) מְדוֹר חֵיוְתָא בְּאִילָן.
(3) בְּסוֹפָא דִּי יוֹמָא עֲדָה חֵילֵהּ.
(4) נְטַל חַרְטֻמָּא יְדוֹהִי וּבָרֵךְ צַלְמָא דִּי כְסַף.
(5) תָּבַת לְהַנְסָקָה אִגַּרְתָּא לְרֵאשׁ טוּרָא.

Chapter 23

P. 125 Daniel 5:1–12

King Belshazar made a big meal and drank wine. Under the influence of the wine Belshazar said to bring the gold and silver vessels which Nebuchadnezzar, his father, had brought out from the temple which was in Jerusalem and they would drink from them. Then they brought the gold vessels which they had brought out from the temple of the house of God which is in Jerusalem, and they praised the gods of gold and silver, copper, iron, wood, and stone. At that time, fingers of a human hand came out and wrote on the wall of the king's palace, and the king saw the palm of the hand which was writing. Then the king—his splendor changed and his thoughts disturbed him. The king called with strength to bring the Chaldeans. The king answered and said to the wise men of Babylon that, "Any man who will read this writing and tell me its interpretation will wear purple and rule third in the kingdom. Then all the wise men of the king entered, but they were not able to read the writing and make its interpretation known to the king. Then King Belshazar was greatly disturbed, and his splendor changed. On account of the king's words, the queen entered
P. 126 the drinking house. The queen answered and said, "O king, live forever. Do not let your thoughts disturb you nor your splendor be changed. There is a man in your kingdom in whom is the spirit of the holy God, and illumination and wisdom like the wisdom of the gods was found in him in the days of your father. And King Nebuchadnezzar, your father—your father, the king, established him as chief of the magicians and Chaldeans inasmuch as great spirit and knowledge of interpreting dreams was found in him, in Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar. Now let Daniel be called, and he will tell the interpretation."

P. 126	*Rewrite Direct Object*	P. 127 *Rearrange Sentence*	*Translate*
1.	לְחַרְטֻמַיָּא יָת חַרְטֻמַיָּא	כַּפֵּת מַלְכָּא חַרְטֻמַיָּא. חַרְטֻמַיָּא כַּפֵּת מַלְכָּא.	The king bound the magicians.
2.	לְחֶלְמָא חֶלְמָא	פְּשַׁר דָּנִיֵּאל יָת חֶלְמָא. דָּנִיֵּאל פְּשַׁר יָת חֶלְמָא.	Daniel interpreted the dream.
3.	יָת כָּהֲנַיָּא כָּהֲנַיָּא	גֻּבְרַיָּא קְטַלוּ לְכָהֲנַיָּא. לְכָהֲנַיָּא קְטַלוּ גֻּבְרַיָּא.	The men killed the priests.

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(1) שְׁתוֹ חֲמַר עִם לַחְמָא.
(2) אֶצְבְּעָא רַבְתָא כְּתַבָה פִּתְגָם.
(3) מָאנֵי דַּהֲבָא הִשְׁתַכְחוּ בְּבֵית אֱלָהּ.
(4) קְרָא כָּהֲנָא לְעַמְמָא לְצַלָיָה.
(5) לְבְשַׁת מַלְכְּתָא דְּהַב עַל רֵאשַׁה.
(6) בַּהֲלוּ רַעְיוֹנָיָא תַּקִיפָיָא לִי.
(7) כְּתַל בַּיְתָא אָע.
(8) זִיו חָכְמְתַה נְפַק לְכֹל אַרְעָא.

Chapter 24

P. 131 Daniel 5:13–29

Then Daniel was brought in before the king. The king answered and said to Daniel, "You are Daniel from the Jews that the king, my father, brought from Judah. And I have heard concerning you that the spirit of God is in you and much wisdom is found in you. And now the wise men have been brought in before me in order that they read this writing and to inform me of its interpretation, but they are not able to tell the interpretation of the thing. And I have heard concerning you that you are able to give interpretations. Now if you are able to read the writing and to tell me its interpretation, you will wear purple and rule third in the kingdom." Then Daniel answered and said before the king, "I will read the writing to the king, and I will tell him the meaning. You, O King—God Most High gave the kingdom and greatness and glory to Nebuchadnezzar, your father. And on account of the greatness which He gave him, all the peoples were afraid before him. He would kill whomever he wanted, and he would raise up whomever he wanted, and he would lower whomever he
P. 132 wanted. And when his heart and his spirit were elevated, he was brought down from the throne of his kingdom and they removed the glory from him. He was driven out from men, and his heart was like (that) with (the) animal(s); and his body was watered by the dew of heaven until he knew that God Most High was ruler over the kingdom of man and he would raise over it whomever He wished. And you, his son, Belshazzar, did not lower your heart because you knew all of this. You raised yourself up over the Master of Heaven, and they brought the vessels of His house before you, and you and your chiefs drink wine in them and you praised the gods of silver and gold, copper, iron, wood, and stone who do not see nor hear nor know. Then a hand was sent from before him and this writing inscribed. And this is the writing which was inscribed: *meney meney teqel ufarsin.* This is the interpretation of the thing: *meney*—God

has counted your kingdom and completed it; *teqel*—you have been weighed and found lacking; *peres*—your kingdom has been divided and given to Media and Persia." Then Belshazaar said, and they clothed Daniel in purple and proclaimed concerning him that he would be third ruler in the kingdom.

	שְׁלִיחַ	שלח	G participle masculine singular
	יְהִיב	יהב	G participle masculine singular
	קְטִילַת	קטל	G perfect 3 feminine singular
	מְפָרַשׁ	פרשׁ	D participle masculine singular
	עָשִׁית	עשׁת	G participle masculine singular
P. 133	מְעָרַב	ערב	D participle masculine singular
	שִׁים	שׂים	G participle masculine singular
	הֶסֵפַת	יסף	H perfect 3 feminine singular
	יְהִיבַת	יהב	G perfect 3 feminine singular
	חַשִׁיבִין	חשׁב	G participle masculine plural
	זָקִיף	זקף	G participle masculine singular
	זְהִירִין	זהר	G participle masculine plural
	שְׂמַת	שׂים	G perfect 3 feminine singular
	דְּחִיל	דחל	G participle masculine singular
	גְּמִיר	גמר	G participle masculine singular
	יְהִיבוּ	יהב	G perfect 3 masculine plural
	פְּרִיסַת	פרס	G perfect 3 feminine singular
	מְכַפְּתִין	כפת	D participle masculine plural
	שְׁלִם	שׁלם	G participle masculine singular

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(1) אִגַּרְתָּה כְּתִיבָה בִּירוּשְׁלֶם.

(2) הוּא מְהָקֵים הֵיכְלָא עַל טוּרָא.

(3) כַּרְסָא הָנְחַת מִן שְׁמַיָּא.

(4) חֶלֶם מָרֵא פְּשַׁר תַּמָּה.

(5) אֱלָהַיָּה רַבַּיָּא מְשַׁבְּחִין עַל אַרְעָא.

(6) שְׁאֲלוּ לֵהּ כַּסְפָּא לְחַיְתָה לְהֵיכְלָא רַבָּא.

(7) דָּנִיֵּאל הֲוָה שַׁלִּיט וְיָקָרָה שְׁוִי מֶלֶךְ.

(8) יְהַב אֱלָהּ רְבוּ לְמַדִּינְתָּא וּלְפֶחַתֵּהּ.

(9) שְׁלִים אַרְעָא בְּיוֹמִין שֵׁת.

Chapter 25

P. 137 Daniel 5:30–6:10

In that night, Belshazzar, king of the Chaldeans, was killed; and Darius the Mede received the kingdom at the age of 62. It was pleasing before Darius to establish 120 satraps over the kingdom who would be in the whole kingdom, and above them were 3 chiefs, of whom Daniel was one, that these satraps report to them so that the king not suffer damage. Then this Daniel was distinguishing himself over the chiefs and the satraps inasmuch as an excellent spirit was in him, and the king intended to establish him over the entire kingdom. Then the chiefs and the satraps sought to find a pretext against Daniel, but they were not able to find any pretext, since he was faithful and no negligence was found concerning him. Then those men said that, "We will not find any pretext in Daniel except if we find a pretext concerning him in his God's law." Then these chiefs and satraps assembled before the king and said thus, "Darius, O king, live forever! All the chiefs of the kingdom and the satraps and the governors have taken counsel to establish a royal statute that anyone who seeks a petition from any God or man except from you, O king, for 30 days will be thrown into the pit of lions. Now, O king, write a decree (lit. writing) that can not be changed like the law of Media and Persia which will not pass away." Thereupon Darius wrote the decree.

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מְתְיְהֵב	יהב	G active participle masculine singular
הִתְמְלִי	מלא	G perfect 3 masculine singular
יְצַטַּבַּע	צבע	D imperfect 3 masculine singular
הִתְחָרַךְ	חרך	G perfect 3 masculine singular
מְתַנַּשָּׂא	נשׂא	D active participle feminine singular
הִזְדְּמַנְתּוּן	זמן	G perfect 2 masculine plural
מְשַׁתַּכַּל	שׂכל	D active participle masculine singular
יִתְקְרִי	קרא	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
תִּשְׁתְּבֵק	שׁבק	G imperfect 2 masculine or 3 feminine singular
תִּתְעַבְּדוּן	עבד	G imperfect 2 masculine plural
הִשְׁתְּכַחַת	שׁכח	G perfect 3 feminine singular
יִתְעֲבֵד	עבד	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
יִשְׁתַּמְעוּן	שׁמע	G imperfect 3 masculine plural
הִתְנַדְּבוּ	נדב	D perfect 3 masculine plural
יִתְבַּקַּר	בקר	D imperfect 3 masculine singular

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מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין	כנש	D active participle masculine plural
יְשַׁתַּנֵּא	שנה	D imperfect 3 masculine singular
הִתְגְּזֶרֶת	גזר	G perfect 3 feminine singular
יִתְבְּנֵא	בנה	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
תִּתְחַבַּל	חבל	D imperfect 2 masculine singular or 3 feminine singular
הִתְרְחִצוּ	רחץ	G perfect 3 masculine plural

(1) אַבָּא חַכִּימָא כְּתַב קְדָם בְּלֵילְיָא.
(2) אַרְיֵא תַּקִּיף נְפַל לְגֻבָּא רַבָּא.
(3) אֶחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא הִתְכַּנְּשׁוּ קֳדָם כַּרְסָא.
(4) פִּתְגָמָא קַבֵּל בְּקִרְיְתָא מָרְדְּתָא.
(5) יַצִּיבָא כָּהֲנָא מִהֵימְנָא יְשַׁפַּר לְעַמְמַיָּא.
(6) בְּעָה פֻּחֲתָא עִלָּה לְקַטָּלָה לְגֻבְרַיָּא.

P. 140

Chapter 26

P. 144 Daniel 6:11–29

And when Daniel knew that the decree had been written, he went into his house and he knelt, praying before his God three times a day, just as he had done previously. Then those men assembled and found Daniel praying before his God. Then they approached and said before the king concerning the royal prohibition, "Did you not write a prohibition that any man who seeks from any god or man except from you, O king, for 30 days will be thrown into the lions' pit?" The king answered and said, "The thing is certain, like the law of Media and Persia that will not pass away." Then they answered and said before the king that, "Daniel, who is from the children of the exiles of Judah, has not paid attention to you, O king, and to the prohibition that you wrote; and he prays 3 times a day." Then when the king heard the thing, it was very distressing to him. Then those men gathered before the king and said to the king, "Know, O king, that it is a law of Media and Persia not to change any prohibition or statute which the king establishes." Then the king said and they brought Daniel and threw into the pit of lions. The king answered and said to Daniel, "Your God, whom you serve, He will save you." And a stone was brought and put over the mouth of the pit. Then the king went to his palace and his sleep fled (over) him. Then the king arose and in his distress he went to the pit of the lions, and as he approached the pit, the king answered Daniel and said to

Daniel, "Daniel, servant of the living God: your God, whom you serve — was He able to save you from the lions?" Then Daniel spoke with the king, "O king, live forever. My God sent His angel, and he closed the lions' mouth, and they did not harm me inasmuch as I was found innocent (lit. innocence was found to me) before Him; and even before you, O king, I have not done damage." Then the king was very pleased (lit. it was very good over the king), and he said to bring Daniel up from the pit. And Daniel was brought up from the pit, and no harm was found on him since he had faith in his God. And the king said and they brought those men who had accused Daniel and threw them, their sons, and their wives into the pit of the lions; and they had not reached the bottom of the pit when the lions overpowered them. Then King Darius wrote to all the peoples who dwelt in all the land, "May your peace be great. A decree is issued before me that in every dominion of my kingdom they will fear the God of Daniel, since He is the living God and enduring forever; and He saves His kingdom which will not be damaged. And he makes signs in heaven and on earth, as He saved Daniel from the lions." And this Daniel prospered in the kingdom of Darius and in the kingdom of Cyrus, the Persian.

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נְפַקָה	נפק	G	הַב	יהב	G
הֵיבֵל	יבל	H	מְעַבַּד	עבד	G
קָאֵם	קום	G	תְּקַבְּלוּן	קבל	D
מְשֵׁיזֵב	עזב	Š	הַסַּק	סלק	H
יְפֵל	נפל	G	דְּאֵנִין	דין	G
יְדִיעַ	ידע	G	מְכַפְּתִין	כפת	D
אַחֲוָיָה	חוה	A	תּוּכַל	יכל	G
יִשְׁתַּנֵּא	שנה	Dt	מַנִּיתָ	מנה	D
הִתְחָרַךְ	חרך	Dt	פְּקוּ	נפק	G
הַנְעֵל	עלל	H	חֲזֵיתוּן	חזה	G
אֶשְׁתַּנִי	שנה	At	אֲקִימֵה	קום	A
שֵׁיצִיא	יצא	Š	מְבָרַךְ	ברך	D
הֲוָת	הוה	G	יִשְׁתַּכְלְלוּן	כלל	Št
פְּתִיחוּ	פתח	G	בְּעֵינָא	בעה	G
אִנְדַּע	ידע	G	הוֹתֵב	יתב	H
תְּהַשְׁכַּח	שכח	H	מֵמַר	אמר	G
תְּהוֹבַר	אבד	H	יְשֵׁיזֵב	עזב	Š

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לֶהֱוֹן	הוה	G	הַיְתִי	אתה	H
יִתְקְרֵי	קרא	Gt	מְהַקְרְבִין	קרב	H
יְהָקִים	קום	H	תִּרְעַ	רעע	G
שָׂמֵת	שׂים	G	יְהוֹדָע	ידע	H
תֶּעְדֵּא	עדה	G	עֲנוֹ	ענה	G
תִּתְבְּנֵא	בנה	Gt	הַדֶּקֶת	דקק	H
נְחַוֵּא	חוה	D	יְהָךְ	הלך	G
יְשַׁנּוֹן	שנה	D	הִתְרוֹמַמְתָּ	רום	polel-t

יְקִים is H, יְקוּם is G; both are imperfect 3 masculine singular.

לְהֶעָלָה and לְהַנְעָלָה are both H infinitives of עלל; the נ in לְהַנְעָלָה is a result of nasalization.

מִתְבָּהַל is a Dt active participle (there is no dagesh because ה is guttural), whereas הִתְבְּהָלָה is Gt (infinitive).

P. 147 אָמַר is an active participle; אֲמַר is perfect (3 masculine singular)

תִּתְיְהֵב is Gt, תִּתְחַבַּל is Dt (both are imperfect 2 masculine singular)

מִתְנַשְּׂאָה is Dt, מִתְעֲבֵד is Gt (both are active participles, though מִתְנַשְּׂאָה is feminine and מִתְעֲבֵד masculine).

מִתְקַטְּלִין is Dt (active participle mp); לְהִתְקַטָּלָה is Gt (infinitive).

הִתְגַּזֶּרֶת is Ht; אִתְגְּזֶרֶת is At.

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(1) אַבָּא שֵׁיזִיב בְּרֵהּ מִן חֵיוָת בָּרָא.

(2) סָפְרָא שַׁכְלֵל עֲבִידְתָא עַל מַלְכוּתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא.

(3) מַלְכָּא הַרְגֵּשׁ עַמָּא לְשַׁבָּחָא לֵאלָהָּ בְּלֵילְיָא.

(4) בְּעֵית לְמִנְפַּק מִן קְרְיְתָא כְּדִי מַלְכָּא שָׁם אֶסָר דֵּךְ.

(5) סַלְקַת עַל טוּרָא כְּדִי קְרִיב אַרְיֵה.

(6) אֲנַחְנָא סָגְרִין פֻּם צַלְמָא.

(7) יְהוּדָיֵא הַצְלְחוּ כְּדִי טְרִידוּ לְגָלוּ.

(8) אֱלָהָא חָיָא מַלֵּל מִקַּדְמַת דְּנָה.

Chapter 27

P. 149 Daniel 7:1

In the first year of Belshazzar, king of Babylon, Daniel saw a dream and visions of his head on his bed. Then he wrote (down) the dream, a complete account; he said:

P. 150

חֲזָה	חזה	G perfect 3 masculine singular
כְּתַב	כתב	G perfect 3 masculine singular
אֲמַר	אמר	G perfect 3 masculine singular

חֲדָה	אֶחָד	(or רִאשׁוֹן)
רֵאשֵׁה	רֵאשׁוֹ	
חֶלְמָא	חֲלוֹם	
מִלִּין	מִלִּים	

(2) Daniel answered and said, "I saw in a night vision, and behold 4 winds of the heaven were stirring up the great sea. (3) And 4 great animals, each different from the other, were coming up from the sea.

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עָנֵה	ענה	G active participle masculine singular
חָזֵה	חזה	G active participle masculine singular
הֲוֵית	הוה	G perfect 1 common singular
סָלְקָן	סלק	G active participle feminine plural
שָׁנְיָן	שנה	G active participle feminine plural
מְגַחָן	גוח	H active participle feminine plural

the subject of מְגַיְחָן is רוּחֵי

אָמַר = Hebrew אוֹמֵר

חָזֵה הֲוֵית means "was seeing" (i.e., saw)

P. 152 (4) The first was like a lion, and it had wings like an eagle. I saw until its wings were torn out and it was lifted from the earth and set up on feet like a man, and a human heart was given to it. (5) And behold, another, second animal, resembling a bear; and it was raised up on one side, and there were 3 ribs in its mouth between its teeth. And thus they said to it, "Arise, eat much flesh." (6) After this I saw and, behold, another like a panther, and it had 4 bird wings on its back; and the animal had 4 heads, and dominion was given it.

P. 152 (*cont.*)

צְלָעוֹת	עִלְעִין
אוֹמְרִים	אָמְרִין
לַחַיָּה	לְחֵיוְתָא
נֶשֶׁר	נְשַׁר

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מְרִיטוּ	מרט	G passive perfect 3 masculine plural
נְטִילַת	נטל	G passive perfect 3 feminine singular
הָקִימַת	קום	H passive perfect 3 feminine singular
דְּמְיָה	דמה	G active participle feminine singular
יְהִיב	יהב	G passive participle masculine singular

subject — חֵיוָה

P. 154 (7) After this I saw in night visions, and behold a fourth animal, frightening and frightful and very strong; and it had big iron teeth, eating and smashing and trampling on the remnant with its feet. And it was different from any of the animals that were before it, and it had 10 horns. (8) I looked at its horns and, behold, another, small horn went up among them, and three of the first horns were uprooted from before it; and behold, there were eyes like human eyes on this horn and a mouth speaking great things.

רַבְרְבָן	plural feminine
חֵיוָתָא	plural feminine

P. 155

מִשְׁתַּכַּל הֲוֵית	I was looking
פֻּם	subject
מְמַלֵּל	predicate (or verb)
רַבְרְבָן	object

דְּחִילָה	דחל	G passive participle feminine singular
רָפְסָה	רפס	G active participle feminine singular
מְשַׁנְיָה	שנה	D active participle feminine singular
מִשְׁתַּכַּל	שכל	Dt active participle masculine singular
סְלְקָת	סלק	G perfect 3 feminine singular
אִתְעֲקָרָה	עקר	At perfect 3 feminine plural

subject — תִּלְתַּ קַרְנַיָּא

אָכְלָה G
מַדֶּקָה H
} both are feminine singular active participles

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גַּפִּין דִּי נְשַׁר לַהּ it had wings of an eagle
לַהּ גַּפִּין אַרְבַּע דִּי עוֹף it had 4 wings of a bird
שִׁנַּיִן דִּי פַרְזֶל לַהּ רַבְרְבָן it had large iron teeth

(9) I saw until thrones were overthrown, and one old of days sat, his dress like white snow and the hair of his head like pure wool. His throne was flames of fire, its wheels burning fire. (10) A river of fire was flowing and going out from before Him; a thousand thousands served Him, and a myriad of myriads rose before Him, the judgment sat and books were open.

Passive verbs: רְמִיו, פְּתִיחוּ

P. 157 Active participles: נָפֵק, נָגֵד, דָּיְלִק, חָזֵה

Verbs
הֲוִית הוה G perfect 1 common singular
יְתֵב יתב G perfect 3 masculine singular
יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵהּ שמש D imperfect 3 masculine plural + 3 masculine singular pronominal suffix
יְקוּמוּן קום G imperfect 3 masculine plural

Suffixes
כָּרְסָוָן feminine plural
לְבוּשֵׁהּ 3 masculine singular
גַּלְגְּלוֹהִי 3 masculine singular
שְׁבִיבִין masculine plural
דִּינָא masculine singular determined

P. 158 (11) I saw, then, from the sound of the great words which the horn was speaking; I saw until the animal was killed and its body destroyed and given over to the burning fire. (12) And the rest of the animals—they removed their dominion, but length of life was given to them until a time and a season.

קָל = Hebrew קוֹל

P. 158 (*cont.*)

קְטִילַת	קטל	G
הוּבַד	אבד	H

מְמַלֶּלָה	מלל	D active participle feminine singular
הֶעְדִּיו	עדה	H perfect 3 masculine plural

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מִלַּיָּא	masculine plural determined
אֶשָּׁא	masculine singular determined
גִּשְׁמַהּ	feminine singular possessive
רַבְרְבָתָא	feminine plural determined

חֵיוָתָא is singular, הֵיוָתָא is plural (both are feminine determined)

(13) I saw in night visions and behold (one) like a son of man (i.e. human being) was coming with the clouds of the sky; and he reached the Ancient of Days, and they brought him near before Him. (14) And dominion was given to him, and glory and kingship and all the peoples, the nations and the languages served Him. His dominion is an eternal dominion which will not pass, and His kingdom one which will not be destroyed.

לֵילְיָא has a masculine singular determined suffix
אָתֵה הֲוָה — "was coming"
מַלְכוּתֵהּ is מַלְכוּ with a 3 masculine singular possessive suffix

P. 160

אָתֵה	אתה	G active participle masculine singular
מְטָה	מטה	G perfect 3 masculine singular
יֶעְדֵּה	עדה	G imperfect 3 masculine singular
תִּתְחַבַּל	חבל	Dt imperfect 3 feminine singular
יִפְלְחוּן	פלח	G imperfect 3 masculine plural
הַקְרֵבוּהִי	קרב	H perfect 3 masculine plural + 3 masculine singular

הַקְרֵבוּהִי — the subject is indefinite
יִפְלְחוּן — כֹּל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא

(15) My spirit—I, Daniel—became distressed in the midst of a sheath (i.e. my body), and the visons of my head disturbed me. (16) I approached one of those standing before me, and I sought certainty from him concerning all this. And he said to me and informed me of the thing's interpretation: (17) "These great animals which are 4—4 kings will arise from the earth; (18) and holy ones of the Most High will receive the kingdom, and they will possess the kingdom forever and forever."

קְרֵבֵת	קרב	G perfect 1 common singular
אֶבְעֵה	בעה	G imperfect 1 common singular
יְהוֹדְעַנַּנִי	ידע	H imperfect 3 masculine singular + 1 common singular
יְקַבְּלוּן	קבל	D imperfect 3 masculine plural
קָאֲמַיָּא	קום	G active participle masculine plural determined

P. 162 אִנִּין — they (feminine plural)

(19) Then I wanted to make certain concerning the fourth animal, which was different from all of them, more frightening with teeth of iron and claws of copper, eating, smashing, and trampling the rest with its feet. (20) And on the ten horns which were on its head and the other one which went up and before which three fell—that horn had eyes and a mouth speaking great things, and its appearance was bigger than its companions. (21) I saw, and that horn made war with the holy ones and prevailed over them. (22) Until the Ancient of Days came and judgment was given to the holy ones of the Most High, for the time had arrived and the holy ones possessed the kingdom.

P. 163 דְּכֵן demonstrative pronoun feminine singular (it can also be masculine)

צְבִית	צבה —	G perfect 1 common singular
שְׁנָיָה	שנה —	G active participle feminine singular
דְּחִילָה	דחל —	G passive participle feminine singular
מַדְקָה	דקק —	H active participle feminine singular
סְלִקַת	סלק —	G perfect 3 feminine singular
נְפַלָה	נפל —	G perfect 3 feminine plural
מְטָה	מטה —	G perfect 3 masculine singular

P. 164 תְּלַת קַרְנַיָּא

(23) Thus he said: The fourth animal—there will be a fourth kingdom on the earth which will be different form all the kingdoms, and it will devour the entire earth and trample it and smash it. (24) And the 10 horns—from the kingdom will arise ten kings, and after them will arise another, and he will be different from the earlier ones and will lower three kings. (25) And he will speak words against the Most High and will wear out the holy ones of the Most High, and he will intend to change times and law. And they will be given into his hand for a time and times and half a time. (26) And he will sit in judgment and they will remove his dominion to be destroyed and killed until the end. (27) And the kingdom and dominion and greatness of the kingdoms under all heaven is given to the people of the holy ones of the Most High. His kingdom is an eternal kingdom, and all dominions will worship and be obedient to Him.

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תִּהֱוֶה	הוה	G imperfect 3 feminine singular
יִתְיַהֲבוּן	יהב	Gt imperfect 3 masculine plural
יְהִיבַת	יהב	G passive perfect 3 feminine singular
יְהַשְׁפֵּל	שפל	H imperfect 3 masculine singular

יְמַלֵּל	D
יְבַלֵּא	D
יְסַבַּר	G

לְהַשְׁנָיָה	שנה	all are H infinitives
לְהַשְׁמָדָה	שמד	
לְהוֹבָדָה	אבד	

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יִפְלְחוּן	G	פלח
יִשְׁתַּמְּעוּן	Dt	שמע
יְהַעְדוּן	H	עדה

(28) Here is the end of the word. I, Daniel, my ideas disturbed me very much, and my spendor changed over me. And I guarded the thing in my heart.

יְבַהֲלַנְנִי	בהל	D imperfect 3 masculine plural + 1 common singular
יִשְׁתַּנּוֹן	שנה	Dt imperfect 3 masculine plural
נְטַרֵת	נטר	G perfect 1 common singular

Chapter 28

Pp. 168–69

אֲנָה בַר רָכִב בַּר פַּנַמֻו מֶלֶךְ שַׂמְאַל עֶבֶד תִּגְלַתְפַּלְיֶסֶר מָרֵא רִבְעֵי אַרְקָא.
בְּצִדֶק אֲבִי וּבְצִדְקִי הוֹשַׁבְנִי מָרְאִי רַכְבְּאֵל וּמָרְאִי תִּגְלַתְפַּלְיֶסֶר עַל כָּרְסֵא אֲבִי.
וּבֵית אֲבִי עֲמַל מִן כָּל. וְרָצֵת בְּגַלְגַּל מָרְאִי מֶלֶךְ אַשׁוּר בְּמִצְעַת מַלְכִן
רַבְרְבִן בַּעֲלֵי כְסַף וּבַעֲלֵי זְהַב. וְאַחֲזֵת בֵּית אֲבִי וְהֵיטַבְתֵּהּ מִן בֵּית חַד
מַלְכִן רַבְרְבִן. וְהִתְנַאֲבוּ אַחַי מַלְכַיָּא לְכָל מַה טָבַת בַּיְתִי. וּבֵי טָב
לֵישׁ לַאֲבָהַי מַלְכֵי שַׂמְאַל. הָא בֵית כַּלַמֻו לְהֹם פְּהָא בֵית שְׁתָוָא לְהֹם
וְהָא בֵית כֵּיצָא. וַאֲנָה בְּנֵית בַּיְתָא זְנָה.

I am Bar Rakib, son of Panamuwa, king of Sam'al, servant of Tiglath-Pileser, the master of the four quarters of the earth. Because of my father's righteousness and my (own) righteousness, my master Rakib-el and my master Tiglath-Pileser seated me on my father's throne. And my father's house toiled more than all others, and I ran in the wheel of my master, the king of Assyria, in the midst of many kings, owners of silver and owners of gold. And I grasped my father's house and made it better than the house of any of the great kings. And my brothers, the kings, envied all the goodness of my house. And there was no good house for my fathers, the kings of Sam'al. Behold, the house of Kilamuwa was theirs, and behold, the winter house was theirs and the summer house. But I built this house.

P. 172

לְכָה הֻתָּיִת טְמֵי עוּזִיָּה מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה וְלָא לְמִפְתַּח.

Hither were brought the bones of Uzziah, king of Judah. Do not open.

Pp. 173–174

דְּכִירִין לְטָב יוֹסֵה וְעִירוֹן וְחִזְקִיוֹ בְּנוֹהִי דְּחַלְפִּי. כָּל מַן דְּיָהֵיב פַּלְגוּ בֵּן גְּבַר לְחַבְרֵיהּ
הִי אָמַר לִשַׁן בִּישׁ עַל חַבְרֵיהּ לְעַמְמַיָּה הִי גָּנִיב צְבוּתֵיהּ דְּחַבְרֵיהּ הִי מַן דְּגָלֵי רָזָה
דְּקִרְתָּה לְעַמְמַיָּה דַּיָּן דְּעֵינוֹהִי מְשׁוֹטְטָן בְּכָל אַרְעָה וְחָמֵי סְתִירְתָּה הוּא יְתֵן אַפּוֹהִי
בְּגַבְרָה הַהוּ וּבְזַרְעֵיהּ וַיַּעֲקוֹר יָתֵיהּ מִן תְּחוֹת שׁוּמַיָּה. וְיִמְרוֹן כָּל עַמָּה אָמֵן וְאָמֵן
סֶלָה. רַבִּי יוֹסֵה בֵּן חַלְפִּי חִזְקִיוֹ בֵּן חַלְפִּי דְּכִירִין לְטָב. דַּרְגֵי סַגִּי
אֲנוּן עֲבַדוּ לִשְׁמֵהּ דְּרַחֲמָנָה שָׁלוֹם.

May Yose and Iron and Hezekiah, the sons of Halpy, be remembered for good. Whoever gives (i.e. makes) discord between a man and his comrade, speaking (with an) evil tongue concerning his comrade to the peoples (i.e. foreigners) or stealing his comrade's property, or whoever reveals the city's secret to the peoples—the Judge whose eyes wander over the whole earth and sees hidden things will direct His anger against that man and against his seed (descendants), and He will uproot him from under heaven. And let all the people say, "Amen, amen, selah." May Rabbi Yose, son of Halpy, (and) Hezekiah, son of Halpy, be remembered for good. They made many stairs for the name of the Merciful One. Peace.

Chapter 29

Pp. 176–77 (lines 1–3)

אֶל מָרַאן בָּגוֹהִי פַּחַת יְהוּד. עַבְדָיִךְ יְדַנְיָה וּכְנָוָתֵהּ כָּהֲנַיָּא זִי בִּיֵב בִּירְתָּא.
שְׁלָם מָרַאן אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא יְשְׁאַל שַׂגִּיא בְּכָל עִדָּן וּלְרַחֲמִן יְשִׂימָנָךְ קֳדָם דָּרְיָוֶהוּשׁ מַלְכָּא
וּבְנֵי בַיְתָא יַתִּיר מִן זִי כְעַן חַד אֶלַף. וְחַיִּין אֲרִיכִין יִנְתִּן לָךְ וַחֲדֵה וְשַׂרִיר הֱוֵי
בְּכָל עִדָּן.

To our master Bagohi, governor of Judah. Your servants Yedaniah and his colleagues, the priests who are in Yeb, the fortress: May the God of heaven seek our master's peace abundantly at every time, and may He give you and the members of his household compassion before King Darius, a thousand times more than now. And may He give you long life and may (you) be happy and prosperous at all times.

Pp. 178–79 (lines 4–13)

כְּעַן עַבְדָךְ יְדַנְיָה וּכְנָוָתֵהּ כֵּן אָמְרִין: בִּירַח תַּמּוּז שְׁנַת 14 דָּרְיָוֶהוּשׁ מַלְכָּא כְּזִי אַרְשָׁם
נְפַק וַאֲזַל עַל מַלְכָּא כְּמַרְיָא זִי אֱלָהָא חְנוּב אֱלָהָא זִי בִּיֵב בִּירְתָּא הַמּוֹנִית עִם וִידַרְנָג
זִי פְּרָתְרָךְ תִּנָּה הֲוָה: לַם אֲגוּרָא זִי יהו אֱלָהָא זִי בִּיֵב בִּירְתָּא יְהַעְדוּ מִן תַּמָּה.
אַחַר וִידַרְנָג זְךְ לַחְיָא אִגֶּרֶת שְׁלַח עַל נְפָיָן בְּרֵהּ זִי רַבְחַיִל הֲוָה בְּסִוָן בִּירְתָּא לְאמַר:
אֲגוּרָא זִי בִּיֵב בִּירְתָּא יִנְדְּשׁוּ. אַחַר נְפָיָן דְּבַר מִצְרָיֵא עִם חַיְלָא אָחֳרָנִן אֲתוֹ לְבִירַת
יֵב עִם תִּלֵּיהֹם עֲלוֹ בַּאֲגוּרָא זְךְ נִדְּשׁוּהִי עַד אַרְעָא וְעַמּוּדַיָּא זִי אַבְנָא זִי הֲווֹ תַּמָּה
תְּבַרוּ הִמּוֹ. אַף הֲוָה תְּרֵעָן זִי אֶבֶן 5 בְּנִין פְּסִילָה זִי אֶבֶן זִי הֲווֹ בַּאֲגוּרָא זְךְ נִדְּשׁוּ
וְדַשֵּׁיהֹם קַיְמִן וְצִירֵיהֹם זִי דַּשְׁשַׁיָּא אִלֵּךְ נְחָשׁ וּמַטְלָל עָקְהֵן זִי אֶרֶז כֻּלָּא זִי עִם שֵׁירִית
אֲשַׁרְנָא וְאָחֳרָן זִי תַּמָּה הֲוָה כֻּלָּא בְּאִשָּׁה שְׂרֵפוּ. וּמִזְרָקַיָּא זִי זַהֲבָא וּכְסַף וּמְנַדַּעֲמָתָא
זִי הֲוָה בַּאֲגוּרָא זְךְ כֻּלָּא לְקַחוּ וּלְנַפְשָׁהוֹם עֲבַדוּ.

Now your servant Yedaniah and his colleagues say thus: In the month of Tammuz, year 14 of King Darius, when Arsham went out and came to the king, the priests of the god Khnub, the god who is in Yeb the fortress, were in agreement with Vidranga, who is the governor here. "Surely, they will remove the temple of YHW, the God which is in Yeb the fortress, from there." After that, the evil Vidranga sent a letter to Naphaina, his son, who is military chief in Syene, the fortress, saying, "They will destroy the temple which is in Yeb, the fortress." After Naphaina led the Egyptians with the other forces, they came to the fortress of Yeb with their weapons. They entered that temple, destroyed it to the ground, and smashed its stone pillars which were there. Also, there were five stone gates, built out of cut stone, which were in that temple—they destroyed; and their standing doors and the copper pivots of those doors, and their wooden roof which was entirely of cedar with the rest of the beams and the other things which were there they burned entirely with fire. And the gold and silver basins and anything which was in that temple—all of it they took and made it for themselves.

P. 180 (lines 13–17)

וּמִן יוֹמֵי מַלְכָּא מִצְרַיִן אֲבָהִין בְּנוֹ אֲגוּרָא זְדְ בְּיֵב בִּירְתָא. וּכְזִי כַּנְבוּזִי עַל לְמִצְרַיִן
אֲגוּרָא זְדְ בְּנָה הַשְׁכַּחֵהּ. וַאֲגוּרִי אֱלָהֵי מִצְרַיִן כָּל מְגַרוּ וְאִישׁ מִנְדַּעַם בַּאֲגוּרָא זְדְ
לָא חַבֵּל וּכְזִי כְּזָנָה עֲבִיד אֲנַחְנָה עִם נְשִׁין וּבְנִין שַׁקִּקִן לָבְשִׁן הֲוִין וְצָיְמִין וּמְצַלִּין
לֵיהוֹ מָרֵא שְׁמַיָּא זִי הַחֲוִין בְּוִידְרַנְגְ זְדְ. כַּלְבַיָּא הַנְפַּקוּ כִּבְלָא מִן רַגְלוֹהִי וְכָל נְכְסִין
זִי קְנָה אֲבַדוּ וְכָל גְּבְרִין זִי בְּעוֹ בְּאִישׁ לַאֲגוּרָא זְדְ כָּל קְטִילוּ וַחֲזִין בְּהוֹם.

And from the days of the king of Egypt, our ancestors had built that temple in Yeb, the fortress. And when Cambyses entered Egypt, he found that temple built. And they overthrew all the temples of the Egyptian gods, but no one destroyed anything in that temple. And when this was done, we were wearing sack-cloth and with our wives and children fasting and praying to YHW, the Lord of Heaven, who let us see (vengeance upon) that Vidranga. The dogs removed the chain from his feet, and all the property which he had bought was lost, and all the men who sought evil for that temple were all killed, and we saw them.

P. 182 (lines 17–22)

אַף קַדְמַת זְנָה בְּעִדָּן זִי זָא בְּאִישְׁתָּא עֲבִיד לַן אִגְּרָה שְׁלַחְ עַל מָרַאן וְעַל יְהוֹחָנָן
כָּהֲנָא רַבָּא וּכְנָוָתֵהּ כָּהֲנַיָּא זִי בִּירוּשְׁלֶם וְעַל אוֹסְתָּן אֲחוּהִי זְ עֲנָנִי וְחֹרֵי יְהוּדָיֵא.
אִגְּרָא חָדָה לָא שְׁלַחוּ עֲלַיִן. אַף מִן יַרְח תַּמּוּז שְׁנַת 14 דָּרְיַהְוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא וְעַד זְנָה יוֹמָא
אֲנַחְנָה שַׁקְקִין לָבְשִׁין וְצָיְמִין. נְשַׁיָּא זִילַן כְּאַרְמְלָה עֲבִידָן. מְשַׁח לָא מָשְׁחִין וַחֲמַר לָא
שָׁתִין. אַף מִן זַכִי וְעַד יוֹם שְׁנַת 17 דָּרְיַהְוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא מִנְחָה וּלְבוֹנָה וַעֲלָוָה לָא עֲבַדוּ
בַּאֲגוּרָא זְךְ.

Pp. 181–82

Even before this, at the time that this evil was done to us, we sent a letter to our master and to Yehohanan, the high priest, and his colleagues, the priests who are in Jerusalem, and to Ostanes, Anani's brother, and the Judean nobles. They did not send us a single letter. Even from the month of Tammuz in the 14th year of King Darius and to this day we wear sackcloth and fast. Our wives are made like widows; we do not anoint (with) oil and do not drink wine. Even from that (time) and to the day of King Darius' 17th year they have not made a grain offering or incense or burnt offering in that temple.

P. 183 (lines 22–30)

כְּעַן עַבְדָיִךְ יְדַנְיָה וּכְנָוָתֵהּ וְיהוּדָיֵא כָּל בַּעֲלֵי יֵב כֵּן אָמְרִין. הֵן עַל מָרַאן טָב
אִתְעֲשַׁת עַל אֲגוּרָא זְךְ לְמִבְנֵה בְּזִי לָא שָׁבְקִן לַן לְמִבְנֵיהּ. חֲזִי בַּעֲלֵי טָבְתָךְ וְרַחֲמָיִךְ
זִי תִּנָּה בְּמִצְרִין. אִגְּרָה מִנָּךְ יִשְׁתְּלַח עֲלֵיהוֹם עַל אֲגוּרָא זִי יהו אֱלָהָא לְמִבְנֵיהּ
בִּיב בִּירְתָא לָקֳבֵל זִי בְּנֵה הֲוָה קֳדְמִין. וּמִחָתָא וּלְבוֹנְתָא וַעֲלָוָתָא יְקָרְבוּן עַל
מַדְבְּחָא זִי יהו אֱלָהָא בִּשְׁמָךְ וּנְצַלֵּה עֲלָיִךְ בְּכָל עִדָּן אֲנַחְנָה וּנְשֵׁין וּבְנִין וְיהוּדָיֵא
כָּל זִי תִּנָּה. הֵן כֵּן עֲבַדוּ עַד זִי אֲגוּרָא זְךְ יִתְבְּנֵה וְצִדְקָה יֶהֱוֵה לָךְ קֳדָם יהו אֱלָהּ
שְׁמַיָּא מִן גְּבַר זִי יְקָרֵב לֵהּ עֲלָוָה וְדִבְחִן דְּמִן כְּדְמֵי כְּסַף כִּנְכָּרִין אֲלַף וְעַל זְהַב.
עַל זְנָה שְׁלַחְ הוֹדַעְנָךְ. אַף כֹּלָּא מִלַּיָּא בְּאִגְּרָה חָדָה שְׁלַחְ בִּשְׁמַן עַל דְּלָיָה וְשֶׁלֶמְיָה
בְּנֵי סַנְאבַלַּט פַּחַת שֹׁמְרִין. אַף בְּזְנָה זִי עֲבִיד לַן כֹּלָּא אַרְשָׁם לָא יְדַע
בְּ־20 לְמַרְחֶשְׁוָן שְׁנַת 17 דָּרְיַהְוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא.

Pp. 182–83

Now your servants, Yedaniah and his colleagues and the Judeans, all citizens of Yeb, say thus: "If it is good to our master, let it be thought to build that temple, since they do not let us build it. See to your well-wishers and your friends

who are here in Egypt. Let a letter be sent to them from you concerning this temple of YHW, the God—to build it in Yeb, the fortress, as it was built before. And they will offer grain offerings and incense and burnt offerings on the altar of YHW, the God, in your name; and we will pray for you at all times—we and our wives and our children and the Judeans, everyone who is here. If they do this until that temple is built, there will be merit for you before YHW, the God of Heaven, more than for a person who offers Him a burnt offering and sacrifices whose price is 1000 silver coins and gold. Concerning this we sent, we informed. We also sent all the words in a letter in our name to Delaiah and Shelemiah, the sons of Sanballat, governor of Samaria. Also, Arsham did not know about this which was done to us at all. On the 20th of Marheshvan, the 17th year of King Darius.

P. 184

שִׁמְעוֹן לִיהוּדָה בַּר מְנַשֶּׁה לִקְרִית עֲרַבָיָה: שִׁלְחֵת לָךְ תְּרֵי חֲמָרִין דִּי תִּשְׁלַח עִמְּהֵן תְּרֵי גֻּבְרִין לְוָת יְהוֹנָתָן בַּר בַּעְיַן וּלְוָת מַסַּבָּלָה דִּי יַעַמְרֵן וְיִשְׁלְחֵן לְמַחֲנֵיהּ לְוָתָךְ לֻלְבִין וְאֶתְרֹגִין. וְאַתְּ שְׁלַח אָחֳרָנִין מִלְוָתָךְ וְיִמְטוֹן לָךְ הֲדַסִין וְעֲרָבִין. וְתַקֵּן יָתְהֹן וּשְׁלַח יָתְהֹן לְמַחֲנֵיהּ הוּא שְׁלָם.

Pp. 184–85

Simon to Judah, son of Manasseh, of Kiryat Arbaya. I sent you two donkeys with which you will send two men—Jonathan, son of Ba'yan, and Masabala —who will load (them). And they will send palms and citrons to his camp, to you. And you—send others from you, and the myrtle and willow (branch) will reach you. And prepare them and send them to his camp. Peace!

Chapter 30

P. 186 (19:14–17)

וְחַלְמֵת אֲנָה אַבְרָם חֶלֶם בְּלֵילֵה מֵעָלִי לְאַרַע מִצְרִין. וַחֲזֵית בְּחֶלְמִי וְהָא אֶרֶז חַד וְתַמְרָא חֲדָא יָאְיָא שַׂגִיא. וּבְנֵי אֱנוֹשׁ אֲתוֹ וּבְעוֹן לְמִקַּץ וּלְמֶעֱקַר לְאַרְזָא וּלְמִשְׁבּוֹק תַּמְרָתָא בִּלְחוֹדֶיהָ. וַאֲכִלְיָאת תַּמְרָתָא וְאַמְרַת אַל תְּקוּצוּ לְאַרְזָא אֲרֵי תְּרֵינָא מִן שַׁרְבָּא חֲדָא. וּשְׁבִיק אַרְזָא בְּטַלָל תַּמְרָתָא וְלָא אִתְקַץ.

Pp. 186–87

And I, Abram, dreamed a dream on the night of my entering into the land of Egypt. And in my dream I saw, and behold a cedar and a very lovely palm.

And people (lit. sons of men) came and sought to cut down and uproot the cedar and to leave the palm alone. But the palm tree protested and said, "Do not cut down the cedar, the two of us are from one family." So the cedar was left in the shadow (i.e. with the help) of the palm tree and not cut down.

P. 188 (20:2–8)

כְּמָה נְצִיחַ וְשַׂפִּיר לַהּ צְלֵם אַנְפַּיהָא . . . וּכְמָא רְקִיק לַהּ שְׂעַר רֵאישַׁהּ כְּמָא יָאֵין לְהֵין לַהּ עֵינֵיהָא וּמָא רַגֵּג הוּא לַהּ אַנְפָּהָא וְכוֹל נֵץ אַנְפַּיהָא . . .כְּמָא יָאָא לַהּ חֲדֵיהּ וּכְמָא שַׂפִּיר לַהּ כּוֹל לְבֵנְהָא דְּרָעֵיהָא מָא שַׂפִּירָן וִידֵיהָא כְּמָא כְּלִילָן וַחֲמִיד כּוֹל מַחֲזֵה יְדֵיהָא כְּמָא יָאֵין כַּפַּיהּ וּמָא אַרִיכָן וּקְטִינָן כּוֹל אֶצְבְּעָת יְדֵיהָא. רַגְלֵיהָא כְּמָא שַׂפִּירָן וּכְמָא שְׁלָמָא לְהֵן לַהּ שָׁקָיָא. וְכָל בְּתוּלָן וְכַלָּאן דִּי יַעֲלָן לְגִנּוֹן לָא יְשַׂפְּרָן מִנָּהָא. וְעַל כּוֹל נְשִׁין שׁוּפַּר שַׂפְּרָה וְעִלָּיָא שַׂפְּרָהָא לְעֵלָּא מִן כּוֹלְהֵן וְעִם כּוֹל שַׂפְּרָא דֵּן חָכְמָה שַׂגִּיא עִמָּהָא וְדִלְיְדֵיהָא יָאָא.

Pp. 188–89

How splendid and beautiful the form of her face, and how soft the hair of her head. How lovely are her eyes, and how pleasant is her nose and all the radiance of her face. How lovely are her breasts, and how beautiful all her whiteness. Her arms, how beautiful, and her hands, how perfect; how attactive all the appearance of her hands. How lovely her hands (palms), and how long and delicate all the fingers of her hands. Her feet, how beautiful, and how perfect her legs. And no virgins nor brides who go into the bridal chamber are more beautiful than she. And her beauty is more beautiful than all women; her beauty is above all of theirs. And with all this beauty she has great wisdom. And everything she has is lovely.

P. 189 (20:8–11)

וּכְדִי שְׁמַע מַלְכָּא מִלֵּי חִרְקְנוֹשׁ וּמִלֵּי תְּרֵין חַבְרוֹהִי דִּי פֻּם חַד תְּלָתְהוֹן מְמַלְלִין שַׂגִּי רַחֲמָה וּשְׁלַח לְעוּבַע דְּבַרְהָא וְחָזָהָא וְאִתְמָה עַל כּוֹל שַׂפְּרָהָא וּנְסַבְהָא לַהּ לְאִנְתָּא וּבְעָא לְמִקְטַלְנִי וְאַמְרַת שָׁרֵי לְמַלְכָּא דְּאַחִי הוּא כְּדִי הֲוִית מִתַּגַּר עַל דִּילְהָא. וּשְׁבִיקַת אֲנָה אַבְרָם בְּדִילְהָא וְלָא קְטִילַת. וּבְכִית אֲנָה אַבְרָם בְּכִי תַּקִּיף אֲנָה וְלוֹט בַּר אַחִי עִמִּי בְּלֵילְיָא כְּדִי דְּבִירַת מִנִּי שָׁרֵי בְּאוֹנֶס.

Pp. 189–90

And when the king heard the words of Hirkenos and the words of his two comrades, since the three of them spoke in harmony (lit. with one mouth), he loved her and sent in haste. He led her away and saw her and was surprised at all her

beauty. So he took her for his wife and sought to kill me, but Sarai said to the king, "He is my brother," that I benefit on her account. So I, Abraham, was left (alone) on her account and not killed. And I, Abram, cried powerfully—I and Lot, my brother's son with me—on the night when Sarai was led away from me by force.

Chapter 31

P. 191

תֶּרַח עוֹבֵד צְלָמִים הֲוָה. חַד זִמַן נְפַק לַאֲתַר הוֹשִׁיב אַבְרָהָם מוֹכֵר תַּחְתָּיו. הֲוָה אָתֵי בַּר נָשׁ בָּעֵי דְּיִזְבּוּן. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: בַּר כַּמָּה שְׁנִין אַתְּ? אֲמַר לֵיהּ: בַּר חַמְשִׁין. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: וֹי לְהָהוּא גַּבְרָא דְּאַתְּ בַּר חַמְשִׁין וְתִסְגּוּד לְבַר יוֹמָא. וַהֲוָה מִתְבַּיֵּישׁ וְהוֹלֵךְ לוֹ.

Pp. 191–92

Terah was a statue maker. One time he went out someplace, placing Abraham as a seller in his place. A person came wanting to buy. [Abraham] said to him, "How old are you?" [The buyer] said to him, "Fifty years old." [Abraham] said to him, "Woe to that man, for you are fifty years old and you bow down to a one day old!" And [the buyer] was embarrassed and walked on.

P. 192

חַד זִמַן אֲתַת אִיתְתָּא טְעִינָא חַד פִּינָךְ דְּסֹלֶת. אֲמְרַת לֵיהּ: הָא לָךְ קָרֵב קֳדָמֵיהוֹן. קָם נָסֵיב בּוּקְלָסָה וּתְבַרְהוֹן וְיַהֵב הָהוּא בּוּקְלָסָה בִּידּוֹי דְּרַבְּה דְּבְהוֹן. כֵּן דַּאֲתָא אֲבוּהּ אֲמַר לֵיהּ: מַה עֲבַד לְהוֹן כְּדֵין? אֲמַר לֵיהּ: מָה נִכְפּוֹר לָךְ? אֲתַת חֲדָא אִיתְתָּא טְעִינָא חַד פִּינָךְ דְּסֹלֶת וַאֲמְרַת לִי: קָרֵב קֳדָמֵיהוֹן. דֵּין אֲמַר: אֲנָא אֵכִיל קַדְמָאי וְדֵין אָמַר: אֲנָא אֵכִיל קַדְמָאי. קָם הָדֵין רַבָּה נָסֵיב בּוּקְלָסָה וּתְבַרְהוֹן. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: מָה אַתְּ מַפְלֵה בִּי יָדְעִין אִינּוּן. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: וְלָא יִשְׁמְעוּ אָזְנֶיךָ מַפִּיךָ.

Pp. 192–93

One time a woman came carrying a plate of flour. She said to him, "Behold, sacrifice before them [the statues]." He rose, took a club and broke them and gave (i.e. put) that club in the hands of the largest of them. When his father came, [the father] said to him, "Why did you do this to them?" [Abraham] said to him, "How can I deny to you? A woman came carrying a plate of flour, and she said to me, 'Sacrifice [it] before them.' This [statue] said, 'I will eat first,' and that one [statue] said, 'I will eat first.' This big one rose, took the club, and broke them [the other statues]." [His father] said to him, "Why are you trick-

ing me? Do these [statues] know?" [Abraham] said to him, "Would your ears not listen to your mouth?"

P. 194

נְסָתֵיהּ וּמְסַרְתֵּיהּ לְנִמְרוֹד. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: נִסְגוֹד לְנוּרָא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: נִסְגוֹד לְמַיָּא דְּמַטְפִין לְנוּרָא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: וְנִסְגוֹד לְמַיָּא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: נִסְגוֹד לַעֲנָנֵי דְּטָעֲנֵי מַיָּא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: וְנִסְגוֹד לַעֲנָנָא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: נִסְגוֹד לְרוּחָא דְּמוֹבֵלִי עֲנָנָא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: וְנִסְגוֹד לְרוּחָא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: נִסְגוֹד לְבַר נָשָׁא דְּסָבֵיל רוּחָא. אֲמַר לֵיהּ: מִלִּין אַתְּ מְשַׁתֵּעִי. לָא נִסְגוֹד אֶלָּא לְאוּר. הֲרֵינִי מַשְׁלִיכָךְ בּוֹ וְיֵבוֹא אֱלָהֵיךְ שֶׁאַתָּה מִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה לוֹ וְיַצִּילְךָ מִמֶּנּוּ.

He lifted him and delivered him to Nimrod. [Nimrod] said to [Abraham], "Let us bow down to the fire." [Abraham] said to him, "Let us bow down to the water that extinguishes the fire." [Nimrod] said to him, "So let us bow down to the water." [Abraham] said to him, "Let us bow down to the clouds that carry the water." [Nimrod] said to him, "So we will bow down to the cloud." [Abraham] said to him, "Let us bow down to the wind that brings the cloud." [Nimrod] said to him, "So we will bow down to the wind." [Abraham] said to him, "Let us bow down to the person who endures [i.e. withstands] the wind." [Nimrod] said to him, "You are talking words [i.e. nonsense]. We will only bow down to the flame. Behold, I am throwing you into it. So let your God, to whom you prostrate yourself, come and save you from it."

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הֲוָה תַּמָּן הָרָן קָאֵים פְּלִיג. אֲמַר: מַה נַּפְשָׁךְ? אִם נָצַח אַבְרָם אֲנָא אֵימַר מִן דְּאַבְרָם אֲנָא אִם נָצַח נִמְרוֹד אֵימַר אֲנָא מִנִּמְרוֹד אֲנָא. כֵּיוָן שֶׁיָּרַד אַבְרָם לְכִבְשַׁן הָאֵשׁ וְנוֹצַל אָמְרִין לֵיהּ מִן דְּמַן אַתְּ? אֲמַר לֵיהּ: מִן דְּאַבְרָם. נְטָלוּהוּ וְהִשְׁלִיכוּהוּ בָּאֵשׁ וְנֶחְמְרוּ מֵעָיו וְיָצָא וָמֵת עַל פְּנֵי אֲבִיו. הֲדָא הוּא דִּכְתִיב וַיָּמָת הָרָן עַל פְּנֵי תֶּרַח אָבִיו.

Haran was standing there, divided [i.e. uncertain]. He said, "What is your will? If Abram wins, I will say I am with Abram; if Nimrod wins, I will say I am with Nimrod." When Abram went down into the furnace of fire and was saved, they said to him [Haran], "Whose side are you on (lit. whose are you)?" He said to them, "Abram's." They lifted him and threw him into the fire, and his belly was parched, and he came out and died in front of his father. This is what is written: "And Haran died עַל פְּנֵי [i.e. in front of] Terah, his father."

Chapter 32

P. 198

(1) וַהֲוָה בָּתַר פִּיתְגָמַיָא הָאִילֵין מִן דִּינְצוֹ יִצְחָק וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל. יִשְׁמָעֵאל הֲוָה אָמַר: לִי חֲמֵי לְמֵירוֹת יָת אַבָּא דַּאֲנָא בְּרֵיהּ בּוּכְרָנָיָא. וְיִצְחָק הֲוָה אָמַר: לִי חֲמֵי לְמֵירוֹת יָת אַבָּא דַּאֲנָא בַּר שָׂרָה אִינְתְּתֵיהּ וְאַנְתְּ בַּר הָגָר אַמְתָּא דְּאִימִי. עָנִי יִשְׁמָעֵאל וְאָמַר: אֲנָא זְכָאי יַתִּיר מִנָּךְ דַּאֲנָא אִיתְגְּזֵרִית לְתֵלֵסְרֵי שְׁנִין וְאִין הֲוָה צְבוּתִי לְמֶעְכְּבָא לָא הֲוֵינָא מָסַר נַפְשִׁי לְאִתְגְּזָרָא. וְאַנְתְּ אִתְגְּזֵרְתְּ בַּר תְּמָנְיָא יוֹמִין אִילּוּ הֲוָה בָּךְ מַנְדְּעָא דֵּילְמָא לָא הֲוַיְתְּ מָסַר נַפְשָׁךְ לְאִתְגְּזָרָא. מְתִיב יִצְחָק וְאָמַר: הַאֲנָא בַּר תְּלָתִין וּשְׁבַע שְׁנִין וְאִילּוּ בָּעֵי קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְכוֹלֵי אֵיבָרַיי לָא הֲוֵיתִי מְעַכֵּב. מִן יַד אִישְׁתְּמְעוּ פִּיתְגָמַיָא הָאִילֵין קֳדָם מָרֵי עָלְמָא וּמִן יַד מֵימְרָא דְּיֵי נַסֵּי יָת אַבְרָהָם וְאָמַר לֵיהּ: אַבְרָהָם.

Pp. 198–99

(1) It happened after these words, after Isaac and Ishmael quarreled, Ishmael said, "It is fitting for me to inherit father, since I am his senior son," and Isaac said, "It is fitting for me to inherit father, since I am the son of Sarah his wife and you are the son of Hagar, my mother's handmaid." Ishmael answered and said, "I am more worthy than you, since I was cut (i.e. circumcised) at thirteen years; and if it had been my wish to refuse, I could have not delivered myself to be circumcised. But you were circumcised at eight days; if you had knowledge, perhaps you would not have delivered yourself to be circumcised." Isaac answered and said, "Behold, today I am thirty-seven years old, and if the Holy One, blessed be He, sought all my limbs, I would not refuse." Immediately after these words were heard before the Master of the Universe, "the Word of the LORD tested Abraham and said to him, 'Abraham.'"

P. 200

וְאָמַר לֵיהּ: הָאֲנָא. (2) וְאָמַר: דְּבַר כְּדוֹן יָת בְּרָךְ יָת יְחִידָךְ דְּאַתְּ רַחֵים יָת יִצְחָק וְאֵיזֵל לָךְ לַאֲרַע פּוּלְחָנָא וְאַסִּיקֵהִי תַּמָּן לַעֲלָתָא עַל חַד מִן טַוּרַיָּיא דְּאֵימַר לָךְ. (3) וְאַקְדֵּים אַבְרָהָם בְּצַפְרָא וְזָרִיז יָת חֲמָרֵיהּ וּדְבַר יָת תְּרֵין טַלְיָיוֹי יָת אֶלִיעֶזֶר וְיָת יִשְׁמָעֵאל עִימֵיהּ וְיָת יִצְחָק בְּרֵיהּ וּקְטַע קִיסִין דְּזֵיתָא וּתְאֵנְתָּא וְדִיקְלָא דַּחֲזַיִין לְעַלְתָּא וְקָם וַאֲזַל לְאַתְרָא דַּאֲמַר לֵיהּ יְיָ. (4) בְּיוֹמָא תְּלִיתָאָה וּזְקַף אַבְרָהָם יָת עֵינוֹי וַחֲמָא עֲנָן אִיקָרָא קָטִיר עַל טַוּרָא וְאִשְׁתַּמּוֹדְעֵיהּ מִן רַחִיק (5) וְאָמַר אַבְרָהָם לְעוּלֵימוֹי: אוֹרִיכוּ לְכוֹן הָכָא עִם חֲמָרָא וַאֲנָא וְעוּלֵימָא נְתְמְטֵי עַד כְּא לְבָחוֹנֵי אִין יְתַקְּנִים מַה דְּאִתְבַּשַּׂרִית כְּדֵין יְהוֹן בְּנָךְ וְנִסְגּוּד לְמֵרֵי עָלְמָא וּנְתוּב לְוָותְכוֹן. (6) וְנָסֵיב אַבְרָהָם יָת קִיסֵי דַּעֲלָתָא וְשַׁוִּי עִילּוֹי יִצְחָק בְּרֵיהּ וְנָסֵיב בִּידֵיהּ

יָת אִישְׁתָּא וְיָת סַכִּינָא וַאֲזַלוּ תַּרְוֵיהוֹם כַּחֲדָא. (7) וְאָמַר יִצְחָק לְאַבְרָהָם אֲבוּי
וְאָמַר: אַבָּא. וְאָמַר: הָאֲנָא. וְאָמַר: הָא אִישְׁתָּא וְקִיסִין וְהָאן אִמְּרָא לַעֲלָתָא?
(8) וְאָמַר אַבְרָהָם: יְיָ יִבְחַר לֵיהּ אִמְּרָא לַעֲלָתָא בְּרִי: וַאֲזַלוּ תַּרְוֵיהוֹם בְּלֵב שְׁלִים כְּחַד.

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And he said to him, "Behold!" (2) And he said, "Now, take your son, your only one that you love, Isaac, and go to the land of worship and offer him up there as a burnt offering on one of the mountains which I will tell you." (3) And Abraham acted early in the morning, and he saddled his donkey and took his two young servants, Eliezer and Ishmael, with him and Isaac, his son. And he cut olive and fig and palm wood which were fit for the offering, and arose and went to the place that the LORD said to him. (4) On the third day, Abraham lifted his eyes and saw the cloud of glory rising over the mountain, and he recognized it from afar. (5) And Abraham said to his youths, "You wait here with the donkey, and I and the youth will proceed hither to examine if what has been announced—"thus will be your son"—will be fulfilled; and we will bow down to the Master of the Universe and return to you. (6) And Abraham took wood for the burnt offering and placed it on Isaac, his son, and he took the fire and the knife in his hand, and the two of them went together. (7) And Isaac said to Abraham, his father, "Father"; and he said, "Behold." And he said, "Here is the fire and wood, but where is the lamb for the burnt offering?" (8) And Abraham said, "The LORD will choose the lamb for the burn offering for Himself, my son;" and the two of them went with a perfect heart (i.e. in complete harmony).

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(9) וַאֲתוֹ לְאַתְרָא דַּאֲמַר לֵיהּ יְיָ וּבְנָא תַּמָּן אַבְרָהָם יָת מַדְבְּחָא דִּבְנָא אָדָם
וְאִיתְפְּכַר בְּמוֹי דְּטוֹבְעָנָא וְתָב נֹחַ וּבְנֵיהּ וְאִיתְפְּכַר בְּדָרָא דִּפְלוּגְתָּא וְסַדַּר עֲלוֹי יָת
קִיסַיָּא וְכַפֵּת יָת יִצְחָק בְּרֵיהּ וְשַׁוִּי יָתֵיהּ עַל מַדְבְּחָא לְעֵיל מִן קִיסִין. (10) וּפְשַׁט
אַבְרָהָם יָת יְדֵיהּ וּנְסִיבַת סַכִּינָא לְמִיכַס יָת בְּרֵיהּ. עָנִי וְאָמַר יִצְחָק לְאַבּוֹי: כַּפֵּת יָתִי
יָאוּת דְּלָא נִפְרְכֵס מִן צַעֲרָא דְּנַפְשִׁי וְנִדְחֵי לְגוֹבָא דְּחַבָּלָא וְיִשְׁתְּכַח פְּסוּלָא בְּקָרְבָּנָךְ.
עֵינוֹי דְּאַבְרָהָם מִסְתַּכְּלָן בְּעֵינוֹי דְּיִצְחָק וְעֵינוֹי דְּיִצְחָק מִסְתַּכְּלָן לְמַלְאֲכֵי מְרוֹמָא.
יִצְחָק הֲוָה חֲמֵי יָתְהוֹם וְאַבְרָהָם לָא חֲמֵי יָתְהוֹם. עָנַיִן מַלְאֲכֵי מְרוֹמָא: אִיתּוֹן חֲמוֹן
תְּרֵין יְחִידָאִין דְּאִית בְּעָלְמָא חַד נָכֵיס חַד מִתְנַכֵּיס. דְּנָכֵיס לָא מְעַכֵּב וּדְמִתְנַכֵּיס
פָּשֵׁיט צַוְּרֵיהּ. (11) וּקְרָא לֵיהּ מַלְאָכָא דְּיְיָ מִן שְׁמַיָּא וְאָמַר לֵיהּ: אַבְרָהָם אַבְרָהָם.
וְאָמַר: הָאֲנָא (12) וְאָמַר: אַל תּוֹשֵׁיט יְדָךְ לְטַלְיָא וְלָא תַּעֲבִיד לֵיהּ מִידַּעַם בִּישׁ.
אֲרוּם כְּדוֹן גְּלֵי קֳדָמַי אֲרוּם דְּחֲלָא דְּיְיָ אַנְתְּ וְלָא עֲכַבְתָּא יָת בְּרָךְ יָת יְחִידָךְ מִנִּי.

(13) וּזְקַף אַבְרָהָם יָת עֵינוֹי וַחֲזָא וְהָא דִיכְרָא חַד דְּאִיתְבְּרִי בֵּינֵי שִׁמְשָׁתָא דְּשַׁכְלוּל עָלְמָא אֲחִיד בַּחֲרִישׁוֹתָא דְּאִילָנָא בְּקַרְנוֹי. וַאֲזַל אַבְרָהָם וְנָסִיב יָתֵיהּ וְאַסִּיקֵהּ לַעֲלָתָא חוֹלַף בְּרֵיהּ.

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(9) And they came to the place that the LORD had said to him, and there Abraham (re)built the altar which Adam had built and had been destroyed in the waters of the flood, and Noah had returned and built it, but it was destroyed in the generation of the division. And he arranged the wood on it and bound Isaac, his son, and placed him on the altar above the wood. (10) And Abraham extended his hand and took the knife to slaughter his son. Isaac answered and said to his father, "Bind me well so that I will not struggle from my soul's pain and be thrust into the pit of destruction and a blemish be found in your sacrifice." Abraham's eyes were looking at Isaac's eyes, and Isaac's eyes were looking at the angels on high. Isaac saw them, but Abraham did not see them. The angels on high answered, "Come, see two unique ones in the world—one slaughters and one is slaughtered. The one that slaughters does not refuse, and the one that is being slaughtered extends his neck." (11) And the angel of the LORD called to him from heaven and said to him, "Abraham, Abraham." And he said, "Behold." (12) And he said, "Do not extend your hand to the youth, and do not do anything bad to him. Behold, now it is revealed before Me that, behold, you are a fearer of the LORD and have not refused your son, your only one, from Me." (13) And Abraham lifted his eyes, and he saw a ram, that had been created at twilight of the completion of the world, caught in the thicket of a tree by its horns. And Abraham went and took it and offered it as a burnt offering instead of his son.

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(14) וְאוֹדֵי וּצְלֵי אַבְרָהָם תַּמָּן בְּאַתְרָא הָהוּא וַאֲמַר: בְּבָעוּ בְּרַחֲמִין מִן קֳדָמָךְ יְיָ גְּלִי קֳדָמָךְ דְּלָא הֲוָה בִּלְבָבִי עוֹקָמָא וּבְעֵית לְמֵיעְבַּד גְּזֵירָתָךְ בְּחֶדְוָא. כְּדֵין כַּד יְהוֹן בְּנוֹי דְּיִצְחָק בְּרִי עָלְיִין לְשַׁעַת אֲנִיקִי תֶּהֱוֵי מִידְכַּר לְהוֹם וַעֲנִי יָתְהוֹם וּפְרִיק יָתְהוֹם. וַעֲתִידִין הִינּוֹן כָּל דָּרַיָּא דְּקִימוּן לְמֶהֱוֵי אָמְרִין בְּטַוּוְרָא הָדֵין: כַּפֵּת אַבְרָהָם יָת יִצְחָק בְּרֵיהּ וְתַמָּן אִיתְגַּלְיַית עִילּוֹי שְׁכִינְתָּא דְיְיָ. (15) וּקְרָא מַלְאַכָּא דְיְיָ לְאַבְרָהָם תִּנְיָנוּת מִן שְׁמַיָּא (16) וַאֲמַר: בְּמֵימְרִי קַיְימִית אֲמַר יְיָ חוֹלַף דַּעֲבַדְתְּ יָת פִּיתְגָּמָא הָדֵין וְלָא מְנַעְתְּ יָת בְּרָךְ יָת יְחִידָךְ (17) אֲרוֹם בָּרְכָא אֲבָרְכִינָךְ וְאַסְגָּא אַסְגֵּי יָת בְּנָךְ כְּכוֹכְבֵי שְׁמַיָּא וְהֵי כְּחָלָא דְעַל כֵּיף יַמָּא. וְיֵרְתוּן בְּנָךְ יָת קוֹרֵי שָׂנְאֵיהוֹן. (18)

וְיִתְבָּרְכוּן בְּגִין זַכְוּוֹת בְּנָךְ כָּל עַמְמֵי אַרְעָא חוֹלַף דְּקַבֵּילְתָּא בְּמֵימְרִי. (19) וּדְבַרוּ מַלְאֲכֵי מְרוֹמָא יָת יִצְחָק וְאוֹבִלוּהִי לְבֵי מִדְרָשָׁא דְּשֵׁם רַבָּא וַהֲוָה תַּמָּן תְּלָת שְׁנִין. וּבְהָהוּא יוֹמָא תָּב אַבְרָהָם לְוָת עוּלֵימוֹי וְקָמוּ וַאֲזָלוּ כְּחַדָּא לְבֵירָא דְּשָׁבַע. וְיָתֵיב אַבְרָהָם בְּבֵירָא דְּשָׁבַע. (20) וַהֲוָה בְּתַר פִּתְגָמַיָּא הָאִילֵּין מִן בְּתַר דְּיַכִּפַת אַבְרָהָם יָת יִצְחָק וַאֲזַל סָטָנָא וְתַנִּי לְוָת שָׂרָה דְּאַבְרָהָם וְכַס יָת יִצְחָק. וְקָמַת שָׂרָה וּפְגָנַת וְאִשְׁתַּנְקַת וּמֵיתַת מִן אֲנִיקָא.

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(14) And Abraham thanked and prayed there in that place and said, "In a petition of compassion before You, O LORD, it is revealed before You that there was no trickery in my heart, and I sought to do Your decree with joy. Now when the descendants of Isaac, my son, enter into an hour of anguish, let it be remembered for them and answer them and save them. And all generations that are to be will be prepared to say, "Abraham bound Isaac, his son, on this mountain,
P. 205 and the LORD's presence was revealed to him there." (15) And the angel of the LORD called to Abraham a second time from heaven (16) and said, "By My word have I sworn, says the LORD, inasmuch as you did this thing and did not withhold your son, your only one, (17) behold, I will bless you very much and greatly multiply your son like the stars of heaven and like the sand that is on the shore of the sea. And your son will inherit the cities of those who hate them, (18) and all the people of the earth will be blessed on account of your son's merit, inasmuch as you accepted My word." (19) And the angels on high led Isaac and brought him to the school-house of Shem, the great, and he was there for three years. And on that day Abraham returned to his servants, and they rose and went together to Beersheba; and Abraham dwelt in Beersheba. (20) And after these things, after Abraham bound Isaac, the Satan went and told Sarah that Abraham had slaughtered Isaac; and Sarah arose and cried out and choked and died of anguish.

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